

- (c) Buildings of worship (d) Art and architecture
(e) None of the above/ More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C. (Pre.) 2017

Ans (a)

The use of burnt bricks in the construction of buildings was one of the main features of the Indus Valley Civilization. Burnt bricks were used in abundance in Harappa and Mohenjo Daro. In Lothal, burnt bricks were used in the construction of drainage. Well planned architecture, advanced trade and commerce were other main feature of this civilisation.

7. Which of the following animals was not known to the people of the Indus Valley Civilization?

- (a) Bull (b) Horse
(c) Elephant (d) None of the above

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (d)

Among the given options evidence of cow and elephant have been found. A seal of zebu bull has been found. Seals depicting elephant has also been found. There is some dispute regarding horse but latest excavation has revealed the evidence of horse. However Horse did not play any major role during Indus Valley Civilisation. BPSC has accepted (b) as correct answer.

8. Which of the following is a Harappan port?

- (a) Alexandria (b) Lothal
(c) Mahasthangarh (d) Nagapattinam

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (b)

Lothal is the only place of Indus Valley civilization from where the pieces of evidence of ports have been found which is located in the Gujarat State.

9. Which of the following is a Harappan Site in Gujarat?

- (a) Lothal (b) Dabarkot
(c) Kalibanga (d) Rakhigarhi
(e) None of the above/ More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

10. Who among the following was not associated with the excavation of Harappa and Mohenjodaro?

- (a) R. D. Banerjee (b) K.N. Dikshit
(c) M.S. Vats (d) V.A. Smith

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (d)

In 1921, Daya Ram Sahni excavated Harappa. In 1926-27 and 1933-34, M.S. Vats was associated with the excavation of Harappa. MohenjoDaro was discovered in 1922 by Rakhal Das Banerjee. In addition to him, some other scholars like K.N. Dixit, Ernest Mackay, Aurel Stein, A. Ghosh and J.P. Joshi also contributed to the excavation of this civilization. Hence, it is clear that V.A. Smith was not associated with the discovery of Harappan Civilization rather was a British Indologist and art historian.

11. According to the report of IIT Kharagpur study group, continuous low rainfall for how many years was the cause of fall of the Indus Valley civilization?

- (a) 600 years (b) 700 years
(c) 800 years (d) 900 years
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

64th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (d)

According to the reports of IIT Kharagpur, the continuous low or negligible rainfall for 900 years was the cause of fall of the Indus Valley Civilization. In other words, it can be said that continuous drought for 900 years led to the fall of Indus Valley Civilization.

Vedic Age

1. When did the use of iron begin in Indian subcontinent?

- (a) Around 9000 years ago
(b) Around 12000 years ago
(c) Around 6000 years ago
(d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

68th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (e)

The history of early iron smelting, practiced by the tribal artisans in different regions of ancient India dates back to 1300 to 1200 B.C. Most archaeologists accept around 1000 B.C. as start of the iron age in subcontinent. So earliest use of Iron in the Indian subcontinent can be placed around 3000 years ago. Hence option (e) None of the above is correct.

2. Which Mandala of Rig Veda is completely dedicated to 'Soma'?

- (a) Seventh Mandala (b) Eighth Mandala
(c) Ninth Mandala (d) Tenth Mandala

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

40th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (c)

Rig Veda is the oldest Veda. It comprises of 10 Mandals. The 9th Mandal of Rig Veda comprises 114 hymns dedicated to 'Soma.'

3. Boghaz-Koi is important because:

- (a) It was an important trading centre between Central Asia and Tibet
- (b) Inscriptions were found which mentioned the names of Vedic Gods and Goddesses
- (c) Original Texts of the Vedas were composed here
- (d) None of the above

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (b)

Boghaz-Koi inscription (Asia Minor, Turkiye) is important because there is mention of four Vedic Gods, namely Indra, Varuna, Mitra, and Nasatya.

4. Famous Battle of 'Ten Kings' was fought on the bank of the river:

- (a) The Ganges
- (b) Brahmaputra
- (c) Kaveri
- (d) Parushni

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (d)

There is an ancient story mentioned in the Rig Veda called the Dasharajnya or 'Battle of 10 Kings' on the bank of the Parushni River. There lived a descendant of India's eponymous king Bharata, named Sudas. The greatest achievement of Sudas was his thumping victory over a confederacy of ten kings.

5. Gayatri Mantra is found in which book?

- (a) Upanishad
- (b) Bhagwatgita
- (c) Rig Veda
- (d) Yajurveda

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (c)

The Gayatri Mantra was first written in Sanskrit in the Rig Veda by the Brahmarshi Vishwamitra. Its meaning is "May the Almighty God illuminate our intellect to lead us along the righteous path."

6. In which phase, the concept of untouchability was put clearly?

- (a) Rigvedic phase
- (b) Later Vedic phase
- (c) Later Gupta phase
- (d) Dharmashastra phase

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (d)

The concept of untouchability assumed a definite shape in the early Christian era which was the period known as the era of Dharmashastra in ancient Indian history. During this period, the Brahmanical religion was in ascendance. Various scriptures were being written and the social customs of different types were practised strictly and untouchability was one of them.

7. Which ancient Indian text, composed during the later Vedic period, contains philosophical hymns and discussions on cosmology and ethics?

- (a) Yajurveda
- (b) Upanishads
- (c) Rigveda
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

BPSC (Tre-3) {Class 6-8}-2024

Ans. (b)

The Upanishads are a collection of philosophical texts composed during the later Vedic period in ancient India. They explore concepts of cosmology, ethics, and the nature of reality.

The Upanishads are late Vedic and post-Vedic Sanskrit texts that "document the transition from the archaic ritualism of the Veda into new religious ideas and institutions" and the emergence of the central religious concepts of Hinduism. They are the most recent addition to the Vedas, the oldest scriptures of Hinduism, and deal with meditation, philosophy, consciousness, and ontological knowledge.

Buddhism

1. Where did Mahatma Buddha's 'Mahaparinirvana' take place?

- (a) Lumbini
- (b) Bodh Gaya
- (c) Kushi Nagar
- (d) Kapilvastu

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (c)

Mahatma Buddha delivered his first sermon at the site of Deer Park at Sarnath. Later he moved towards Kosala, Kapilavastu, Vaishali and Rajgriha to propagate the teachings of Buddhism. The king of Kosala Prasenjit with his entire family adopted discipleship of Buddha. During his campaign, he reached 'Pava', the capital of Mallas. At Pava, Buddha stayed in the mango grove of Chund, the blacksmith. There Chund provided him a large amount of Sukaramaddava, which resulted in sickness with the flow of blood and violent deadly pains, but Buddha reached Kushinara or Khushi Nagar (Capital of Republic of Malla). Here he abandoned his body in 483 B.C. at the age of 80 years. It is also known as Mahaparinirvana.

2. The ruler of Suvarnabhumi, who founded a Buddhist monastery at Nalanda and requested Devapala through his ambassador to grant, five villages for its maintenance, was:

- (a) Dharanindra
- (b) Sangramadhananjaya
- (c) Balaputradeva
- (d) Chudamanivarmana

(e) None of the above/More than on of the above.

64th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (c)

Balaputradeva was the ruler of Suvarnabhumi who founded a Buddhist monastery at Nalanda and requested Devapala through his ambassador to grant five villages for its maintenance.

3. At which place did Mahatma Buddha give his first 'Dhammachakkhapavathana'?

- (a) Lumbini (b) Sarnath
(c) Pataliputra (d) Vaishali

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (b)

After his enlightenment in Bodh Gaya, Buddha went to Sarnath, where he delivered his first sermon which is known in Pali as the 'Dhammachakkhapavathana' or "Dharma Chakra Pravartana." Sarnath is one of the four holy places associated with the life of Buddha. Other three important places related to Buddhism are Lumbini (the birthplace of Buddha) Bodh Gaya (the place of enlightenment of Buddha) and Kushi Nagar (place of his death popularly known as Mahaparinirvana in Buddhism).

4. Who got enlightenment in Bodh Gaya?

- (a) Mahavir Swami (b) Gautam Buddha
(c) Smandhar Swami (d) Parshvanath Swami
(e) None of the above/ More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

5. Gautam Buddha gave his first sermon at:

- (a) Vaishali (b) Kaushambi
(c) Sarnath (d) Pawapuri

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

6. Which of the following rulers convened the Fourth Buddhist Council in Kashmir?

- (a) Ashoka (b) Ajatashatru
(c) Kanishka (d) Kalashoka
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre.) 2020

Ans. (c)

The Fourth Buddhist Council was held at Kundalvana, Kashmir under the patronage of Kushan King Kanishka and the president of this council was Vasumitra, with Ashvag-hosa as his deputy president. This council distinctly divided Buddhism into two sects, namely Mahayana and Hinayana.

7. A Buddhist Council during the reign of Kanishka was held at –

- (a) Magadha (b) Pataliputra
(c) Kashmir (d) Rajgriha

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

8. Where was the third Buddhist Council held?

- (a) Taxila (b) Sarnath
(c) Bodh Gaya (d) Pataliputra

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (d)

The Third Buddhist Council was held during the reign of Ashoka in 247 B.C. at Pataliputra under presidentship of Moggaliputta Tissa.

9. The Third Buddhist Council was presided over by

- (a) Mahakassapa (b) Vasumitra
(c) Ashvaghosha (d) Moggaliputta-Tissa
(e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2022

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of the above question.

10. Four important events of Buddha's life and thereby related four places are mentioned below.

Match Schedule- I and Schedule- II and select correct answer from the codes given below -

Schedule - I

Schedule - II

A. Birth

1. Sarnath

B. Enlightenment

2. Bodh Gaya

C. First preaching

3. Lumbini

D. Death

4. Kushinagar

Code :

- | | A | B | C | D |
|-----|--------------------|---|---|---|
| (a) | 1 | 2 | 4 | 3 |
| (b) | 2 | 3 | 1 | 4 |
| (c) | 3 | 2 | 1 | 4 |
| (d) | None of the above. | | | |

41st B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (c)

Mahatma Buddha was born in 563 B.C. in Lumbini near Kapilvastu (Nepal). He got enlightenment at Bodh Gaya. Buddha gave his first sermon at Sarnath (Rishipattan) called “Dharma Chakra Pravartana” and died in Kushinagar called “Mahaparinirvana.

11. In Indian art, the construction of ‘Stupa’, ‘Chaitya’ and ‘Vihara’ is related to which of the following?

- (a) Ajivika sect (b) Vaishnava sect
(c) Buddhism (d) Shaiva sect

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (c)

'Stupa', 'Chaitya', and 'Vihara' all are related to Buddhism. Stupa is a dirt burial mound faced with stone. In Buddhism, the earliest stupas contained portions of the Buddha's ashes, and as a result, it began to be associated with the body of the Buddha. Chaitya is a place of worship while Vihara is the dwelling place of monks.

12. Mahabodhi Temple has been built at Bodh Gaya where-

- (a) Gautama Buddha was born
(b) Gautama Buddha received enlightenment
(c) Gautama Buddha gave his first sermon
(d) Gautama Buddha passed away

45th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (b)

For full six years, Gautam sought a due solution to the sufferings, ultimately he got enlightenment at the age of 35 years at Bodh Gaya under the Pipal tree on a Vaisakh Purnima night. Hence he was called “Buddha.” Mahabodhi temple was built at this site.

13. The ‘Bodhi Vriksh’ in Bodh Gaya belongs to which generation of its family?

- (a) Third (b) Fourth
(c) Fifth (d) Sixth

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (c)

At present, the ‘Bodhi Vriksh’ at the Mahabodhi temple is not the real one, where Mahatma Buddha got enlightenment. According to the Hiuen Tsang, a Chinese traveler, King Shashank destroyed the original tree in the seventh century A.D. The present tree which we see was planted by the orders of Alexander Cunningham and called the fifth generation tree. It is a heritage site and only fallen leaves of this tree are allowed to touch and pick.

14. After the Mahaparinirvana of Lord Buddha, the first Buddhist council was held at:

- (a) Rajgriha (Rajgir) (b) Gaya
(c) Pataliputra (d) Vaishali
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

64th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (a)

The first Buddhist council was held just after the death (Mahaparinirvana) of Lord Buddha during the tenure of Magadh king Ajatashatru in the Sattapanni caves of Rajgriha (Rajgir).

15. Where was the first Buddhist Council convened?

- (a) Pataliputra (b) Rajagriha
(c) Amaravati (d) Kanganhalli
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Re-Exam) (Pre) 2021

Ans. (b)

The first Buddhist Mahasabha/Sangeet was organised in the Sattapanni cave of Rajagriha immediately after the death of Mahatma Buddha. At that time Ajatashatru was the ruler of Magadha.

16. Tripitakas are the sacred books of the:

- (a) Jains (b) Hindus
(c) Parsees (d) Buddhists
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C (Pre.) 2017

Ans. (d)

Tripitaka is the most important holy book of Buddhism. It is divided into three parts - Sutta Pitaka – which consists of sermons and teachings of Buddha, Vinaya Pitaka – a collection of rules governing the Sanghas and Monks and Abhidhamma Pitaka - which deals with the philosophy of Buddhism.

17. Where is the highest in the world ‘Vishwa Shanti Stupa’ located in Bihar –

- (a) Vaishali (b) Nalanda
(c) Rajgir (d) Patna

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (c)

The Vishwa Shanti Stupa or the World Peace Pagoda (height about 400 metres) situated on the hills of Rajgir in Bihar is the highest Vishwa Shanti Stupa in the world.

18. Barabudur is the most wonderful Stupa in the world and its images and sculptures are the finest examples of

- (a) Indo-Tibetan Art (b) Indo-Cambodian Art

- (c) Indo-Champan Art (d) Indo-Javanese Art
(e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2022

Ans. (d)

The Barabudur (Borobudur) Stupa is located on the Island of Java in Indonesia. Its sculptures are the finest example of Indo-Javanese Art. The construction of this stupa took place in the about 8th and 9th century.

19. Gautam Buddha was elevated to the position of God during the period of:

- (a) Ashoka
(b) Kanishka
(c) Chandragupta Vikramaditya
(d) Harsha

45th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (b)

The fourth council held during the reign of Kanishka divided Buddhism into two sects, namely Hinayana and Mahayana. In Mahayana, Gautam Buddha was treated as God and they started worshipping Buddha through idols. Hence, Gautam Buddha was elevated to the position of God during the period of Kanishka.

20. The oldest sculpture of Buddha is made in which style?

- (a) Gandhara Style (b) Mathura Style
(c) Mauryan Style (d) Gupta Style
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. Re-Exam (Pre) 2020

Ans (e)

During the Kushana period various statues of Buddha and Bodhisattva (both in standing and sitting position) were made in Mathura and Gandhara style. As per V.S. Agrawal, Buddha statues were first made in Mathura only. As per Huein Tsang first Buddha statue was made in Kaushambi but various other historian gives credit to Gandhara style for the first statue of Buddha. Hence, it cannot be said conclusively where the first statue of Buddha was made.

21. Which among the following state 'Odantipur' Education Centre was situated?

- (a) Bengal (b) Bihar
(c) Gujarat (d) Tamil Nadu
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (b)

Odantipur (also called Uddandapura) was a prominent educational centre of ancient times. It was situated in Magadha, now Bihar, India. It was established by the Pala emperor Gopala first.

22. Nalanda University was founded during the dynasty of

- (a) Maurya (b) Kushan
(c) Gupta (d) Pala

43rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (c)

Nalanda was a large Buddhist monastery in the ancient kingdom of Magadha (modern-day Bihar) in India. Historians often described Nalanda as a University. Nalanda flourished under the Gupta Empire and was famous for Buddhist religious philosophy.

23. Why was Nalanda University famous in the world?

- (a) Medical Science
(b) Philosophy
(c) Buddhist Religious Philosophy
(d) Chemical Science

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

24. Who was the founder of Nalanda University?

- (a) Chandragupta Vikramaditya
(b) Kumargupta
(c) Dharmapala
(d) Pushyagupta

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (b)

Nalanda University was the International University founded in the reign of the Kumar Gupta-I in 450 AD. The great archaeologist Alexander Cunningham identified this site as Nalanda University in 1915-16.

25. Out of two statements below first is Assertion(A) and second is Reason (R), carefully read both statements.

Assertion (A) : Till the end of twelfth century Nalanda Mahavihara lost its glory

Reason (R) : State protection ceased to be available to Mahavihara.

With respect to the above-mentioned two statements, which of the following is true?

- (a) (A) and (R) both are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
(b) (A) and (R) both are true, and (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
(c) (A) is true, but (R) is false.
(d) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

41st B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (a)

In ancient India, Nalanda was a famous centre of Buddhist learning and University as well. It was located at Rajgir (at present Rajgriha) in southern Bihar. Nalanda University came into existence during the period of Guptas. By the end of the twelfth century, Mahavihara waned due to Muslim invasion. The importance of Nalanda started declining due to the Pala rulers of Bengal as they started giving protection to Vikramshila University. Hence, both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are correct, and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A).

26. 'Nav Nalanda Mahavihar' is famous for –

- (a) Hsuan-Tsang memorial
- (b) Birth place of Mahavir
- (c) Pali Research Centre
- (d) Museum

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (c)

In 1951, the Nav Nalanda Mahavihar, a modern-day research center for Pali and Buddhism, was founded by the government of Bihar near the ruins of ancient Nalanda.

27. Which one of the following is not common between Buddhism and Jainism?

- (a) Ahimsa
- (b) Indifference to Vedas
- (c) Self-mortification
- (d) Rejection of Rituals

44th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (c)

Avoidance of extremities of penance and enjoyment and choosing a middle path between them was a trait of Buddhism while extreme penance leading to self-mortification was a trait of Jainism.

28. The painting of 'Bodhisattva Padmapani' is located at

- (a) Bagh
- (b) Ellora
- (c) Ajanta
- (d) Badami

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (c)

The painting of Bodhisattva Padmapani is one of the most famous art structure in the cave I of Ajanta. Padmapani in Sanskrit literally translates into "one who holds the lotus." The Bodhisattva Padmapani sits among a crowd of devotees, both princesses and commoners with long, dark hair hanging down below a jewelled crown, he stands holding his attribute, a blue lotus flower in his right hand.

Jain Religion

1. Where was Mahavira Swami born?

- (a) Kundagram
- (b) Pataliputra
- (c) Magadha
- (d) Vaishali

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (a)

Mahavira Swami was born in Kundagram (Kundalpur) near Vaishali in 599 B.C. His mother Trishala was the sister of Chetak, the king of Lichchhavi Republic, and his father Siddhartha was the head of Gyatrik Kshatriya. Nandivardhan was his elder brother.

2. Mahavira Jain breathed his last at –

- (a) Rajgir
- (b) Ranchi
- (c) Pavapuri
- (d) Samastipur

45th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (c)

Mahavira Swami was born in Kundagram near Vaishali in 599 B.C. He attained Nirvana at the age of (approx) 72 years in 527 B.C. in Pavapuri, located near Rajgriha (Rajgir).

3. The salvation place of Mahavirji, the originator of Jain religion, is located at –

- (a) Maner
- (b) Rajgir
- (c) Pavapuri
- (d) Jalan Port
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C (Pre.) 2017

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

4. Triratna or Three Jewels, i.e., right knowledge, right faith and right action are related to which of the following?

- (a) Buddhism
- (b) Hinduism
- (c) Jainism
- (d) Christianity
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre.) 2020

Ans. (c)

Three means are said to be important for 'Moksha' in Jain philosophy: Right faith, Right action (conduct) and Right knowledge. These are known as 'Triratna' in Jain religion. Freedom from the bondage and effect of evil omens is called Sanvar Tattva to make the spirit free from the bondage of all. The destruction of Karma is the Nirjara element.

5. Which of the following is the earliest holy book of Jain?

- (a) Twelve Angas (b) Twelve Upangas
(c) Fourteen Purvas (d) Fourteen Uppurva

40th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (c)

The Fourteen Purvas is the ancient Jain scripture, which was preached by all Tirthankaras. At the time of the last Nand Ruler, Sambhootvijay and Bhadrabahu were the presidents of the Sangha. These two were the last to possess knowledge about the ancient Jain texts 14 Purvas given by Mahavira.

6. The first disciple of Lord Mahavira was –

- (a) Jamali (b) Yashoda
(c) Bipin (d) Prabhash

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (a)

Among the early visitors to Mahavira during his wandering was Jamali, his son-in-law. Jamali met Mahavira while the later was in Kshatriya- Kundagram, the village where Mahavira was born. He took the vow together with five hundred of the warrior caste. Jamali was the first disciple of Lord Mahavira.

7. 'Ajivaka', sect was founded by:

- (a) Anand (b) Rahulabhadra
(c) Makkhali Gosala (d) Upali

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (c)

Makkhali Gosala was a disciple of Mahavira in the early period, later fell out with Mahavira due to the difference of opinion with him and founded an independent creed "Ajivaka." The belief of the sect is known as 'Niyatiwad' according to which every matter in the world is being controlled and operated by destiny (fate).

8. Who used the caves of Barabar as their shelter-house?

- (a) Ajivakas (b) Tharus
(c) Jains (d) Tantrikas

40th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (a)

The act of cutting the mountain caves and developing them as residences was fully developed during the period of Ashoka and his grandson Dasaratha. Residences were made for Ajivaka followers after cutting the hills of Barabar and Nagarjuni.

9. Who of the following kings was strongly inclined towards Jainism?

- (a) Dasaratha (b) Brihadrath
(c) Kharavel (d) Huvishk

(e) None of the above/ More than one of the above

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (c)

Kharavel, the Chedi dynasty ruler of Kalinga was one of the greatest emperors in ancient India history. An inscription without date has been received from the 'Hathigumpha' of the Udayagiri hill, located three miles from Bhubaneswar in Odisha province. This record is the only source to know the history of Kharavel. It had a heavy inclination towards Jainism. The Hathigumpha inscription is in Prakrit Language.

10. Gorathagiri in the Barabar Hills was conquered by

- (a) Rajaraja Chola (b) Kharavela
(c) Menander (d) Pushyamitra Sunga
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2018

Ans. (b)

Gorathagiri in the Barabar Hill was conquered by Emperor Kharavela. Kharavela was the greatest king of the Mahameghavahana dynasty of Kalinga, it was an ancient ruling dynasty of Kalinga after the decline of the Mauryan Empire. The primary source for Kharavela is the Hathigumpha inscription Udaygiri.

Shaiva, Bhagavata Religion

1. Nathpanthis, Siddhas and Yogis made devotional religion popular in

- (a) Northern India (b) Southern India
(c) Eastern India (d) Western India

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (a)

Nathpanthis, Siddhas and Yogis made Bhakti (devotional) religion popular in Northern India. They criticised the ritual and other aspects of conventional religion and the social order. They also advocated renunciation of the world.

2. Who contributes the most in the development of Bhagavata sect?

- (a) Persian (b) Indo-Greek people
(c) Kushan (d) Gupta

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (d)

The Bhagavata or Vaishnava religion reached its peak in the reign of Gupta kings. Gupta kings were follower of the Vaishnava religion, and they made it a religion of the state. Most of the Gupta rulers hold the title of 'Parambhagavata.' Garuda, the mount (Vahana) of Lord Vishnu was the state symbol of Guptas.

Sixth century B.C.E. - Political Condition

1. In ancient times, the area to the south of the Ganga was known as

(a) Anarta (b) Takshashila
(c) Chola (d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

68th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (e)

In ancient times the area along rivers to the south of Ganga was known as Magadha. Takshashila was situated between the Indus and Jhelum. Chola was situated in the south of Godavari river. Anarta was a Vedic era kingdom of ancient India. Hence option (e) None of the above is correct answer.

2. Who founded Pataliputra?

(a) Udayin (b) Ashoka
(c) Bimbisara (d) Mahapadmanada

44th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (*)

Pataliputra was founded by Ajatashatru, who was the successor of Bimbisara. He built a fort at the confluence of the Son and Ganga rivers. Udayin shifted the capital of the Magadha Empire from Rajgriha to Pataliputra. However, the Bihar Public Service Commission has allowed answer option (a).

3. By which ruler Pataliputra was chosen as the capital for the first time?

(a) Ajatashatru (b) Kalashoka
(c) Udayin (d) Kanishka

46th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

4. Which ruler founded the beautiful city, Pataliputra?

(a) Ajatashatru (b) Bimbisara
(c) Bindusara (d) Udayin
(e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. Assistant Audit Officer 2022

Ans. (a)

Pataliputra was founded by Ajatashatru, who was the successor of Bimbisara. Udayin shifted the capital of Magadha Empire from Rajgriha to Pataliputra.

5. Which ruler had made Pataliputra the capital of his empire for the first time?

(a) Chandragupta Maurya
(b) Ashoka the Great
(c) Chandragupta Vikramaditya
(d) Kanishka

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (a)

Pataliputra was established by Ajatashatru, the ruler of Haryanka dynasty at the confluence of the Son and Ganga rivers and Udayin transferred his capital from Rajgriha to Pataliputra. But Udayin is not mentioned in the above options. Here, Chandragupta Maurya will be the correct answer.

6. According to the Mahavamsa, Bimbisara ascended the throne at the age of

(a) 15 years (b) 18 years
(c) 20 years (d) 21 years
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2018

Ans. (a)

Bimbisara was the king of the Magadha Empire in eastern India. Bimbisara was the son of Bhattiya. He ascended to throne at the age of 15. He established the Haryanka dynasty and laid the foundation of Magadha with the fortification of a village, which later became the city of Pataliputra.

7. In which century did the first Magadhan Empire rise?

(a) Fourth Century B.C. (b) Sixth Century B.C.
(c) Second Century B.C. (d) First Century B.C.

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (b)

The first Magadhan empire flourished in the 6th century B.C. The actual founder of this empire was King Bimbisara (approximately 544-492 century B.C.). He was related to the Haryanka dynasty.

8. Which was the first capital of ancient Mahajanapada Magadh?

(a) Pataliputra (b) Vaishali
(c) Champa (d) Anga
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre.) 2020

Ans. (e)

Magadh was an ancient kingdom in southern Bihar. Its first capital was Rajgriha (Modern day Rajgir) which was also known as Girivraj. During the reign of Udayin (Haryanka dynasty), the Capital was moved to Patliputra.

9. Which one was the capital of Magadh?

- (a) Pataliputra (b) Vaishali
(c) Girivraj (Rajagriha) (d) Champa

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (*)

In the given options two options (a) and (c) are correct. The initial capital, of Magadha was Girivraj, later Udayin made Pataliputra the capital, which remained the capital of Magadha till the Gupta period. Different details are found in Buddhist texts and Puranas regarding the first dynasty that ruled the Magadha empire. According to the Puranas. The first king of this dynasty was Jarasandha, who made Girivraj his capital.

10. Magadha and Anga plains are parts of which of the following?

- (a) Upper Ganga Valley (b) Middle Ganga Valley
(c) Lower Ganga Valley (d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

B.P.S.C. School Teacher (Class 6-8) 10-12-2023

Ans. (b)

Magadha and Anga plains are the parts of Middle Ganga Valley.

11. By whom the first republic of the world was established in Vaishali –

- (a) Maurya (b) Nanda
(c) Gupta (d) Lichchhavi

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (d)

The Lichchhavi dynasty of Vaishali established the first republic in the world. Vaishali took its name from King Vishal of the Mahabharata era. Vaishali is a great Buddhist pilgrimage and also the birthplace of Lord Mahavira.

12. Where was the world's first republican system in the sixth century BC?

- (a) Vaishali (b) Athens
(c) Sparta (d) Pataliputra

46th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2003-04

Ans. (a)

The world's first republic system was in Vaishali in the sixth century B.C. In fact, in the 6th century B.C., where there was monarchical governance was prevalent in two states named. Vajji and Malla. Vajji was a confederation of 8 states, in which the lichchhavis of Vaishali were the most powerful.

13. The list of sixteen Mahajanapadas is available in –

- (a) Mahabharata (b) Anguttar Nikaya

(c) Chandogya Upanishad (d) Samyukta Nikaya

46th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (b)

The 16 Mahajanapadas of 6th century B.C. were mentioned in Buddhist text 'Anguttara Nikaya' and Jain text 'Bhagwati Sutra'.

14. Which was the capital of Magadha?

- (a) Pratishthan (b) Vaishali
(c) Rajgriha (d) Champa

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (c)

Rajgriha was the first capital of Magadha. Where the first 'Buddhist Council' was organized and Lord Mahavir sermoned first). According to Puranas, the first dynasty to rule over Magadh was Brihadrath dynasty. King Brihadrath's son, Jarasandha, made Girivraja (Rajgir) his capital. Later on, Udayin, son of Ajatashatru, moved the capital to Patliputra.

15. Which was the initial capital of Magadha?

- (a) Pataliputra (b) Vaishali
(c) Girivraja (Rajgriha) (d) Champa

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

16. What was the name of the dynasty of Ajatshatru?

- (a) Maurya (b) Haryanka
(c) Nanda (d) Gupta

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (b)

Ajatashatru (492-460 BC) belonged to Haryanka dynasty. He became king after killing his father Bimbisara.

17. Who was the Physician of Magadh ruler Bimbisara?

- (a) Shilabhadra (b) Vijayasena
(c) Jeevaka (d) Manu
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Re-Exam) (Pre)-2021

Ans. (c)

Jeevaka was the doctor of Bimbisara the ruler of Magadha. Bimbisara also sent him for the treatment of Awanti Naresh Chand Pradyot.

18. Which dynasty did rule over Magadha after Nanda Dynasty?

- (a) Maurya (b) Shunga
(c) Gupta (d) Kushana

44th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (a)

Nanda dynasty of Magadha was founded after the end of Shishunaga dynasty. There were 9 kings in Nanda dynasty- (1) Ugrasen, called Mahapadma in Puranas (2) Panduk (3) Pandugati (4) Bhootpal (5) Rastrapal (6) Govishanak (7) Dashasiddhak (8) Kaivart (9) Dhanananda. During last years of Nanda dynasty, people became turbulent because of extortion and imposing heavy taxes on small items. By taking advantage of this, Chandragupta Maurya with the help of Chanakya killed Dhanananda and established Maurya Empire. Thus, option (a) is the correct answer.

19. Who was the last King of Karnata dynasty?

- (a) Harisimha
- (b) Ramsimha
- (c) Matisimha
- (d) Shyamsimha
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (a)

The last ruler of Karnata Dynasty was Harisimha Dev. He was a great patron of art and literature. He was the pro-founder of Panji system.

Greek Invasion

1. Which one of the following rulers of Magadha was the contemporary of Alexander, the Great?

- (a) Mahapadmananda
- (b) Dhanananda
- (c) Sukalpa
- (d) Chandragupta Maurya

44th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (b)

There were eight inheritors of Mahapadmananda found in purans and Buddhist texts. Dhanananda was the ruler contemporary of Alexander, the Great Greek writers referred him to as Agrammes.

2. Who wrote the Periplus of the Erythraen Sea?

- (a) Tessius
- (b) Pliny
- (c) Ptolemy
- (d) Strabo

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (*)

The 'Periplus of the Erythraean Sea' is a Greco-Roman periplus (manuscript document). It describes the opportunities for navigation and trade from the ports of Roman Egypt. It was written by an anonymous sailor from Alexandria. It has also mentioned the items to be imported and exported from India.

Maurya Empire

1. The first Empire was established by which ruler in India?

- (a) Chandragupta Maurya
- (b) Ashoka
- (c) Kanishka
- (d) Chandragupta-II Vikramaditya
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. Re-Exam (Pre) 2020

Ans. (a)

Chandragupta Maurya is considered one of the greatest emperors of India. He was the first emperor who brought together the small fragmented kingdoms of the country and combined them into a single large empire. He expanded his empire to the edge of what is now known as Iran. He was the one who first unified India politically.

2. Chandragupta Maurya figures prominently in the book of –

- (a) Bhasa
- (b) Sudraka
- (c) Vishakhadatta
- (d) Ashvaghosha

46th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2004

Ans. (c)

Mudrarakshasa authored by Vishakhadatta provides various information about the reign of Chandragupta Maurya. Dhundiraja had written a commentary on Mudrarakshasa. In this drama, Chandragupta is described as the son of Nandiraja. This book depicts Chandragupta as "Vrishal" and "Kulheen".

3. Who recognized Sandrokottos as Chandra Gupta Maurya?

- (a) William Jones
- (b) V. Smith
- (c) R. K. Mukherjee
- (d) D. R. Bhandarkar

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (a)

William Jones was the first scholar who recognized Sandrokottos as Chandra Gupta Maurya. Arian and Plutarch also described him as Androkottos.

4. Kautilya's Arthashastra is a book on -

- (a) Economic relations
- (b) Principles and practice of statecraft
- (c) Foreign policy
- (d) Wealth accumulation
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C (Pre.) 2017

Ans. (e)

Arthashastra by Kautilya is the treatise on polity during the Mauryan monarch/kingdom. The Saptang theory of the state was first introduced in it, which includes the seven elements of the states, these are – The King (Swami), Minister (Amatya), Territory (Janpada), Fort (Durg), Treasury (Kosa), Army (Danda) and Allies (Mitra). Arthashastra gives a detailed description of the then administration and agrarian system.

5. **Kautilya's Arthashastra deals with the aspects of –**

- (a) Economic life (b) Political policies
(c) Religious life (d) Social life

45th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (b)

Arthashastra renders a wide range of information about Mauryan dynasty. This is the unique saga of political policies.

6. **Chandragupta's palace situated at Pataliputra is mainly made up of –**

- (a) Bricks (b) Stones
(c) Woods (d) Clays

41st B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (c)

The archaeological remains of the Mauryan period have been discovered in Bulandibagh and Kumrahar near Patna (Ancient Pataliputra). It is known that the palace of Chandragupta Maurya was made of wood. The excavation was carried out by D.B. Spooner. The remains of the city wall from Bulandibagh and the remains of palace from Kumrahar have been found during the excavation.

7. **Who amongst the following Mauryan rulers did conquer the Deccan?**

- (a) Ashoka (b) Chandragupta
(c) Bindusara (d) Kunala

46th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (b)

The founder of the Mauryan dynasty, Chandragupta Maurya conquered the Deccan plateau. Jain and Tamil sources inscriptions found at various sites of southern India proved that Chandragupta Maurya expanded his empire into Deccan trap. Inscriptions of Ashoka were also found in many sites in the southern part of India, but he conquered the Kalinga only. In this situation, Chandragupta should be given the credit for Deccan Victory as Victory of Bindusara is doubtful and history never remembered him as a victor.

8. **Which book describes Bindusara as an anointed Kshatriya?**

- (a) Arthashastra (b) Indica

- (c) Divyavadana (d) Rajatarangini
(e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. Auditor 2021

Ans. (c)

Buddhist account Divyavadana describes Bindusara, son of Chandragupta, as an anointed Kshatriya.

9. **The Inscription which proves Chandragupta's sway over western India is:**

- (a) Kalinga Rock Inscription
(b) Girnar Rock Inscription of Ashoka
(c) Junagarh Rock Inscription of Rudradaman
(d) Sopara Rock Inscription of Ashoka

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (c)

The description of the construction of irrigation dam by Mauryan provincial governor "Pushyagupta" was found from the Junagarh rock inscription of Rudradaman which proves that this western part of India was once the part of Mauryan empire.

10. **Which one territory of the following was not a part of Ashoka's empire?**

- (a) Afghanistan (b) Bihar
(c) Sri Lanka (d) Kalinga

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (c)

Sri Lanka was not part of Ashoka's territory. The second inscription of Ashoka clarifies that Chola, Pandayas, Sattiyaputta, Keralaputta and Tamraparni (Sri Lanka) were not the part of Mauryan reign. That's why they were called as edge states.

11. **A Buddhist Council during the reign of Ashoka was held at –**

- (a) Magadha (b) Pataliputra
(c) Samastipur (d) Rajgriha

45th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (b)

According to Sinhalese Folklore – "Dipavamsa" and "Mahavamsa", the Third Buddhist Council was held in "Pataliputra" during the reign of Ashoka.

12. **Language used in the inscriptions of Ashoka is:**

- (a) Sanskrit (b) Prakrit
(c) Pali (d) Hindi

44th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (b)

Ashokan inscriptions describe the history of Ashoka properly. The inscription can be divided into three classes;

- (1) Rock inscription / petrography
- (2) Column inscription
- (3) Cave inscription.

Rock inscription is the group of 14 various inscriptions that found at eight different places –

Shahbazgarhi, Mansehra, Kalsi, Girnar, Dhauri, Jaugada, Yerraguddi and Sopara. Most of the inscription of Ashoka are written in Prakrit language and Brahmi script, only two inscriptions, Shahbazgarhi and Mansehra's are in Kharoshthi script. One ruined inscription, written in Aramaic script, was found in Taxila. Shar-i-Kuna (Kandhar Inscription) is in the bilingual (Greek-Aramaic) script while one Aramaic script of Ashokan inscription was obtained from Laghman.

13. Which one of the following scripts of ancient India was written from right to left?

- (a) Brahmi
- (b) Sharada
- (c) Kharosthi
- (d) Nandanagari
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (c)

The Kharosthi Script is an ancient script used by the ancient Gandhara culture of South Asia primarily in modern-day Afghanistan & Pakistan Kharosthi was A cursive script written from right to left.

14. Who first deciphered the Brahmi script ?

- (a) A. Cunningham
- (b) A.H. Dani
- (c) Buhler
- (d) James Prinsep

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (d)

The Brahmi script was first deciphered through the letters inscribed on stone tablets. Sir James Prinsep was the first philologist who accomplished the task of deciphering the script of Ashokan inscription. So, option (d) is the correct answer.

15. The name by which Ashoka is referred to his inscriptions is :

- (a) Chakravarti
- (b) Dharmadeva
- (c) Dharmakirti
- (d) Priyadarshi
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (d)

The name by which Ashoka is referred in his inscription is "Priyadarshi", "Devanampiya Piyadasi" which means "Beloved of the Gods". He has also been stated as "Ashok Vardhan" in Puranas.

16. The only pillar on which Ashoka declares himself as the emperor of Magadha –

- (a) Minor pillar of Maski
- (b) Rummindei pillar
- (c) Queen pillar
- (d) Bhabru pillar

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (d)

Bhabru's (Bairat) inscription proves Ashoka as Buddhist. In the same inscription, he referred to himself as 'Piyadasi Raja' Magadha, i.e. the king of Magadha.

17. The central point in Ashoka's Dhamma is -

- (a) Loyalty to the king
- (b) Peace and non-violence
- (c) Respect to elders
- (d) Religious toleration
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C (Pre.) 2017

Ans. (e)

Ashoka's Dhamma was primarily based on policy of peace, non-violence & religious toleration. In his 12th rock edict, religious longanimity and growth of the essence of all communities are mentioned. Hence as per the options, (e) is correct.

18. In which inscription, Kalinga victory is mentioned?

- (a) Maski Inscription
- (b) Rudradaman Inscription
- (c) Junagarh Inscription
- (d) Hathigumpha Inscription
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. Re-Exam (Pre) 2020

Ans. (e)

Kalinga Victory is mentioned in Ashoka's Rock Edict Number 13. Hence, option (e) is the correct answer.

19. Megasthenes was the ambassador of -

- (a) Seleucus
- (b) Alexander
- (c) Darius
- (d) the Greeks
- (e) None of the above/ More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C (Pre.) 2017

Ans. (a)

Megasthenes was a Greek historian who came to India in the Fourth Century B.C. as a representative of Seleucus Nicator.

20. In how many categories did Megasthenes divide the Indian Society?

- (a) Four
- (b) Five
- (c) Six
- (d) Seven

46th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (d)

Megasthenes divided Mauryan society into seven categories in his book 'Indica', which are as follows :

(1) Philosophers (2) Farmers (3) Herdsmen (4) Artisans (5) Military (Soldier) (6) Overseers or Spies (7) Councillors and Assessors. Megasthenes does not mention slavery in India. According to him, no one could marry outside his caste, and no one could take to occupation from the one fixed for his caste according to the Varnasystem.

21. The division of Mauryan society into seven classes is particularly mentioned in:

- (a) Kautilya's Arthashastra
- (b) Ashokan edicts
- (c) The Puranas
- (d) The Indica of Megasthenes
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C. (Pre.) 2017

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of the above question.

22. The description of the administration of Pataliputra is available in?

- (a) Divyanadan
- (b) Arthashastra
- (c) Indica
- (d) Ashoka's inscriptions

46th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (c)

The description of the administration of Pataliputra is found in Megasthenes' 'Indica'. Megasthenes mentioned six committees of five members each to look after the administration of Pataliputra. He referred to the town officials as 'Astynomi.'

23. What is the name of Megasthenes' book?

- (a) Economics
- (b) Rig Veda
- (c) Purana
- (d) Indica

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of the above question.

24. Who was the author of 'Indica'?

- (a) Vishnugupta
- (b) Megasthenes
- (c) Deimachus
- (d) Pliny

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

25. The most famous centre of learning during Mauryan period was:

- (a) Vaishali
- (b) Nalanda

(c) Taxila

(d) Ujjain

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (c)

At present, Vaishali is a district of Bihar. It was related to both Buddhism and Jainism in ancient times. It was established in 6th century B.C. before the birth of Gautam Buddha (563 B.C.). Mahavira Swami was born in Kundapur near Vaishali. **Nalanda** – Nalanda was an important centre of Buddhist education. Firstly, Buddha temples were established here in the Gupta period.

Taxila – Taxila was a major centre of learning for Hindus and Buddhists who came here from all over the world to get education. It was situated few miles west of present Islamabad. It was most famous during the Mauryan period. Ujjain was the conventional capital of Chandragupta II (Vikramaditya).

26. The last Mauryan emperor was:

- (a) Jaloka
- (b) Avanti Verma
- (c) Nandi Vardhana
- (d) Brihadratha

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (d)

The last Mauryan emperor was Brihadratha. Brihadratha was assassinated by his commander/lieutenant Pushyamitra Shunga in 184 B.C. Pushyamitra Shunga established a new dynasty which is known as Shunga Dynasty.

27. The decline of the Mauryan Empire was largely due to the economic consequences of Ashoka's policy. Who believed in this fact?

- (a) Romila Thapar
- (b) D. N. Jha
- (c) V. A. Smith
- (d) H. C. Raychaudhuri
- (e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2022

Ans. (a)

Renowned historian Romila Thapas believes that it was the economic consequences of Ashoka's policies that led to the decline of the Mauryan Empire.

28. Pradyota was the king of–

- (a) Kasi
- (b) Koshala
- (c) Magadha
- (d) Avanti
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2018

Ans. (d)

Pradyota was the ruler of the ancient Mahajanapada Avanti. Avanti is located in the present-day Madhya Pradesh State. Pradyota was contemporary to Gautama Buddha and Bimbisara.

Post-Mauryan Period

1. Which inscription tells about the various achievements of Rudradaman-I?

(a) Junagadh (b) Bhitari
(c) Nasik (d) Sanchi

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (a)

The Junagadh inscription written in Sanskrit dated approx. 150 A.D. credits Rudradaman-I for supporting the cultural arts and Sanskrit literature and reconstructing the dam built by the Mauryas. In fact, he repaired the embankments of the lake Sudarshana, which was constructed by the Mauryas or checking floods.

2. According to the rock inscription in Sanskrit, composed around second century CE, Sudarshan Lake, an artificial reservoir, was repaired by

(a) Harsha (b) Kanishka
(c) Rudradaman (d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

68th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (c)

Junagadh inscription written in Sanskrit, composed around second century CE credits Rudradaman-I for repairment of Sudarshan Lake which was an artificial reservoir constructed by Mauryas.

3. Who among the following first issued gold coins on a large scale?

(a) Pushyamitra Shunga (b) Menander
(c) Vima Kadphises (d) Gautamiputra Satakarni
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

64th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (c)

Kushan emperor Vima Kadphises, who was the father of Kanishka-I, had introduced gold coins on a large scale in India. He is known as the First King, who introduced gold coins, while Kujul Kadphises circulated copper coins.

4. Which dynasty ruled over India after Shunga dynasty?

(a) Satvahana (b) Kushana
(c) Kanva (d) Gupta

45th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (c)

The last ruler of the Shunga emperors was Devabhuti. He was killed by his minister (Vasudeva Kanva). The Shunga dynasty was then replaced by the subsequent Kanvas. They were also Brahmin like Shunga.

5. Who was the leader of the Ghadar Movement, a revolutionary movement aimed at overthrowing British rule in India?

(a) Kartar Singh Sarabha (B) Lala Lajpat Rai
(c) Bhagat Singh (d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

BPSC (Tre-3) {Class 6-8}-2024

Ans. (a)

Kartar Singh Sarabha (24 May 1896 — 16 November 1915) was an Indian revolutionary. He was 15-years old when he became a member of the Ghadar Party; he then became a leading luminary member and started fighting for the independence movement. He was one of the most active members of the movement.

6. Art of Gandhara style flourished during the reign of –

(a) Kushans (b) Guptas
(c) Akbar (d) Mauryas

38th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1992

Ans. (a)

The Gandhara School of Art was developed during the Kushan period. It was based on Gandhara style. They were provided adequate encouragement and protection from Kanishka. Gandhara art was influenced by Greek art.

7. King Kharavela is related to –

(a) Piller inscription of Girnar
(b) Piller inscription of Junagarh
(c) Hathigumpha inscription
(d) Sarnath inscription

43rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (c)

Kharavela of Chedi dynasty was the king of Kalinga present day Odisha, India. Much of the available information about Kharavela comes from the undated and partially damaged Hathigumpha inscription, plus a few other minor inscriptions found in Udayagiri and Khandagiri Caves, in present-day Odisha. This is the only known source of Kharavela inscriptions. The Kharavela is believed to be a follower of Jainism.

8. Who among the following kings had heavily leaned towards Jainism?

(a) Dashratha (b) Brihadratha
(c) Kharavela (d) Huvishka

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (c)

Kharavela of Chedi dynasty was the king of Kalinga, present in Odisha, India. Much of the available information about Kharavela comes from the Hathigumpha inscription. He is believed to be a follower of Jainism.

9. **Kaling king Kharavel was related to-**

- (a) Mahameghavahan Dynasty
- (b) Chedi Dynasty
- (c) Satavahan Dynasty
- (d) Rath-Bhojak Dynasty
- (e) None of the above/ More than one of the above

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (e)

The founder of the Chedi dynasty of Kalinga was a person named Mahameghavahana. Therefore the name of this dynasty also became the Mahameghavahana dynasty. The most powerful ruler of this dynasty was Kharavela. The Hathigumpha inscription is the only means of studying Kharavela's history.

Gupta and Post-Gupta Period

1. **Which Gupta ruler assumed the throne after killing his elder brother?**

- (a) Shri Gupta
- (b) Samudragupta
- (c) Chandragupta II
- (d) Skandagupta
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Re-Exam) (Pre)-2021

Ans. (c)

After Samudragupta, his son Ramagupta become the ruler, but He was not able to oppose the invasion of Shaka, his brother Chandragupta II Killed Ramagupta and married his wife Dhruv Devi and won against Shaka.

2. **Who is called 'the Napoleon of Ancient India'?**

- (a) Chandragupta Maurya
- (b) Pushyamitra
- (c) Kanishka
- (d) Samudragupta

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (d)

Historian V.A. Smith in his composition 'The Early History of India' called Samudragupta (335-375 A.D.) of Gupta dynasty as 'Napoleon of India' for his great military conquests.

3. **According to Chinese source, Meghavarman, the ruler of Sri Lanka, sent a missionary to which of the following Gupta Kings for permission to build a Buddhist temple at Gaya?**

- (a) Chandragupta I
- (b) Samudragupta

- (c) Chandragupta II
- (d) None of them

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (b)

Meghavarman sent a missionary to Samudragupta to build a Buddhist temple at Gaya. Samudragupta granted permission to Buddhist king of Ceylon (Sri Lanka) Meghavarman to build a monastery at Bodh Gaya.

4. **The Gupta emperor who defeated the 'Hunas' was:**

- (a) Samudragupta
- (b) Chandragupta- II
- (c) Skandagupta
- (d) Ramagupta

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (c)

The first invasion of Hunas took place during the reign of Skandagupta and Hunas were comprehensively defeated by him. This invasion was just like a raid, and there was not lasting impact on India, but this invasion intensified the decline of the Gupta Empire. Hunas annexed many regions of the north-west in the transition period of the 5th-6th centuries after the death of Skandagupta.

5. **Which one of the following ports was in use for the north Indian trade during the Gupta period?**

- (a) Kalyan
- (b) Tamralipti
- (c) Broach
- (d) Cambay
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (e)

During the Gupta period Tamralipti of Bengal was an important port that used for trading with South-East Asia, China, Sri Lanka, Java, Sumatra etc. Bhargukatchha (Bharuch) was an important port of western India from where trade of North India with western countries occurred through sea-route. During the Gupta period, most of the Indian trade happened with South-East Asia, hence Tamralipti was most important port of this period. However, Bharuch, Kalyan, Cambay etc. were also used for North Indian trade. Hence most suitable answer would be more than one which is option (e).

6. **Which Gupta ruler is mentioned as 'Param Bhagawata' in Nalanda Copper Plates?**

- (a) Chandragupta I
- (b) Chandragupta II
- (c) Samudragupta
- (d) Skandagupta
- (e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. Assistant Audit Officer 2022

Ans. (c)

Copper plate inscription of Samudragupta from Nalanda and Gaya describes Param Bhagavata title of Samudragupta.

7. In pre-Gupta times, a large number of lead coins were issued by the

- (a) Satavahanas (b) Shakas
- (c) Kushanas (d) Mauryas
- (e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2022

Ans. (a)

The Satavahanas were the early rulers of the region between the rivers, Godavari and the Krishna. They were also referred to as the Andhras. They soon brought under their control, both the Western-Deccan and Central India. Their coins were pre-dominantly of copper and lead, however, silver issues are also known. These coins carried the motifs of fauna like elephants, lions, bulls, horses etc. after juxtaposed against motifs from nature like hills, trees etc. The silver coins of the Satavahanas carried portraits and bilingual legends which were inspired by the Kshatrapa type.

8. Who among the following is known for his work on medicine during the Gupta period?

- (a) Sushruta (b) Saumilla
- (c) Shudraka (d) Shaunaka
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (e)

Sushruta is called the father of surgery. He was a resident of Kashi. It is believed that his period was around 600 B.C. Shaunak was the sage of the Rigveda. Shudraka was a dramatist of the Gupta period (litterateur). Saumilla is a playwright of Gupta period who has been remembered by Kalidasa with Bhasa and Kaviputra. Thus, none of the above had worked in the field of medicine during the Gupta period. Although Bihar Public Service Commission in its initial answer sheet has considered the correct answer as option (a). Since the Gupta period begins with 275-A.D. (Sri Gupta), which is about 875 years later than the valid period of Sushruta (usually 600 BC), it is not reasonable to consider Sushruta a contemporary of the Gupta period.

9. The gradual decline of towns was an important feature of which period?

- (a) Gupta period
- (b) Pratihara era
- (c) Rashtrakut
- (d) Satavahana era

40th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (a)

During the Gupta period, towns declined gradually. All the towns which were prosperous in the valley, most of them had declined in that age. A major city, Patliputra became village when Hiuen-Tsang came to India. Mathura, Sonpur, and Sohagama- all major cities provided evidence of a decline in this age. So, we can say that the gradual decline of towns is an important feature of the Gupta period.

10. Which ruling dynasty donated maximum villages to temples and Brahmins?

- (a) Gupta Dynasty (b) Pala Dynasty
- (c) Rashtrakuta (d) Pratihara

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (a)

The ruler of Gupta dynasty donated a maximum number of villages to temples and Brahmins. Also, the income generated from the land of the village used to be given to the owner of the land.

11. What was the land revenue rate in Gupta age?

- (a) Fourth part of the production
- (b) Sixth part of the production
- (c) Eighth part of the production
- (d) Half part of the production

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (b)

A person who used to cultivate on the official land of the ruler had to pay a part of crop-products as tax in Gupta period which was the sixth portion of the production. Land revenue is known as 'Udrang' and "Bhag" in Gupta inscriptions.

12. What is the land revenue rate in religious books?

- (a) 1/3 (b) 1/4
- (c) 1/6 (d) 1/8

40th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (c)

In every religious text, the land revenue rate is 1/6th of the produce.

13. Which type of land was called 'Aprahat'?

- (a) Without cultivated forest land.
- (b) Irrigated land.
- (c) Dense forest land.
- (d) Cultivated land.
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (a)

Uncultivable lands were called 'Aprahat'. It was a term of the revenue system in the Gupta period.

14. Chinese traveller 'Sungyun' was came to India in:

- (a) 515 AD to 520 AD (b) 525 AD to 529 AD
- (c) 545 AD to 552 AD (d) 592 AD to 597 AD
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (e)

Chinese traveller 'Sungyun' came to India in about 518 to 521 A.D. He collected texts of Buddha's preaching in his three years of travel.

15. The account of the Moroccan traveller Ibn Battuta is known as

- (a) Rihla (b) Subh-u'l-Asha
- (c) Tarikh-i-Rashidi (d) Riyaz-us-Salatin
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2018

Ans. (a)

Ibn Battuta was a Moroccan and Berber explorer. He is known for his extensive travels, accounts of which were published in the Rihla. Rihla was a travel book written by Ibn Battuta in Arabic. He came to India during the regime of Muhammad bin Tughlaq.

16. Which of the following philosophies of India propounded the atom theory?

- (a) Yoga (b) Nyaya
- (c) Sankhya (d) Vaisheshika
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (d)

Maharishi Kanada is associated with atom theory. He was a scientist & philosopher who founded Vaisheshika School of Indian Philosophy in which he gave the atomistic approach to physics and philosophy in Sanskrit.

17. Who has written the 'Harshacharita'?

- (a) Aryabhatta (b) Banabhatta
- (c) Vishnugupta (d) Parimalgupta

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (b)

Eminent author Banabhatta composed the text "Harshacharita". This is the major source of Pushyabhuti dynasty. It is a fable in which the author presents the description of his contemporary ruler and biographies of their ancestors.

18. Who laid the foundation of Vardhana Dynasty?

- (a) Pushyabhuti (b) Rajyavardhana
- (c) Adityavardhana (d) Prabhakarvardhana
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Re-Exam) (Pre)-2021

Ans. (a)

According to Banbhatt's composition 'Harshcharita' the establishment of Vardhan Dynasty was done by a person named Pushyabhuti, in Thaneshwar/Sthaneswar. Harshvardhan was the greatest ruler of this dynasty.

19. Poet Bana was inhabitant of –

- (a) Pataliputra (b) Thanesar
- (c) Bhojpur (d) None of the above

41st B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (d)

Banabhatta, the poet, was born in the village Prithikuta, on the bank of Son River in Aurangabad district (Present Bihar). The names of his father and mother were Chitrabhanu and Rajdevi respectively.

20. Which Chinese traveller visited India during Harshavardhana's rules?

- (a) Fa-Hien (b) Hiuen-Tsang
- (c) I-Tsing (d) Taranath

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (b)

The arrival of Hiuen-Tsang was the most important event of Harsha's period. He desired to visit the places related to Mahatma Buddha and study Buddhist texts, which were available in India. He departed for India in 629 A.D. from Changan, the capital of Tang Ruler. He wrote a book on his tour to India named 'Sei-Yu-Kei.'

21. The famous Chinese pilgrim Fa-Hien visited India during the reign of:

- (a) Chandragupta I (b) Chandragupta II
- (c) Ramagupta (d) Srigupta
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C (Pre.) 2017

Ans (b)

Fa-Hien visited India during the reign of Chandragupta-II.

22. Consider the following statements :

1. Fa-Hien was a Chinese pilgrim who visited India during the reign of Harsha.
2. Hiuen Tsang was a Chinese Buddhist monk who visited India during the reign of Chandragupta II.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) Only 1 (b) Only 2
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) None of the above

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (d)

Fa-Hien visited India during the reign of Chandragupta II while Hiuen-Tsang visited the court of Harshvardhana. Hence neither statement is correct.

23. During Hiuen-Tsang tour in India most famous city for the production of cotton clothes was:

- (a) Varanasi (b) Mathura
(c) Pataliputra (d) Kanchi

41st B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (b)

The traveller of China Hiuen-Tsang arrived in India during Harsha's period and stayed here. According to Hiuen-Tsang, Mathura was famous for the production of cotton textiles. He also mentioned that the reason for the prosperity of Thanesar was its trade. Ujjayini as well as Kannauj were economically prosperous too.

24. Chinese traveller Hiuen Tsang studied at the University of –

- (a) Taxila (b) Vikramshila
(c) Magadh (d) Nalanda

46th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (d)

The traveller from China, Hiuen Tsang arrived in India during Harsha's period and went to Nalanda University in 637 A.D. Acharya Sheelbhadra was the Vice-Chancellor of Nalanda University at that time. He learned Yogashashtra there for almost one and a half year. He also delivered a speech during his second visit to Nalanda University.

25. Chinese traveller I-tsing was on the tour of Bihar in about:

- (a) 405 A.D. (b) 635 A.D.
(c) 637 A.D. (d) None of the above

40th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (d)

With his desire to see the relics of Buddhism, Chinese traveller I-tsing (671-695 A.D.) with his 37 Buddhist associates decided to travel to Western countries. Later his associate left him, and he alone moved to India from Canton city. He came to India through western sea route and returned to China via Sumatra.

26. Nalanda University was destroyed by –

- (a) Muslims (b) Kushans

(c) Scythians

(d) Mughals

43rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (a)

Nalanda University attracted scholars and students from Tibet, China, Greece and Persia. It was ransacked and destroyed by the army of Bakhtiyar Khalji at the end of the twelfth century. It can be seen as the coup de grace (final blow) to the decline of Buddhism in India.

27. Nalanda Vihar was destroyed by :

- (a) Bakhtiyar Khalji
(b) Qutbuddin Aibak
(c) Muhammad Bin Tughlaq
(d) Alauddin Khalji
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

28. Who was the real founder of Turk rule in Bihar?

- (a) Malik Husarnuddin (b) Bakhtiyar Khalji
(c) Ibrahim (d) Dariya Khan Noohani
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Re-Exam) (Pre)-2021

Ans. (b)

Bakhtiyar Khalji captured entire Bihar between 1193 A.D. to 1203 A.D. He destroyed Nalanda and Vikramshila Vihar. Later control was also established over some parts of Bengal and Assam. Thus he was the real founder of Turkish power in Bihar.

29. How many rulers of Aryavarta have been mentioned in 21st line of Allahabad Pillar Inscription?

- (a) 6 (b) 7
(c) 8 (d) 9
(e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. Auditor 2021

Ans. (d)

Allahabad Pillar Inscription or the Prayaga Prashasti mentions Samudragupta conquering Nine kings during his second campaign of Aryavarta.

30. Who has argued that the Gupta and post-Gupta periods saw a decline in the money economy?

- (a) R.S. Tripathi
(b) R.S. Sharma
(c) Radha Kumud Mookerjee

- (d) D.C. Sircar
(e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. Auditor 2021

Ans. (b)

R.S. Sharma has argued that the Gupta and Post-Gupta period saw a decline in money economy. He points out that the Guptas issued many gold coins, but comparatively few silver and copper coins.

31. Who was the ruler of India during the 7th century CE known for his patronage of Buddhism and support for cultural activities?

- (a) Harsha
(b) Ashoka the Great
(c) Chandragupta Maurya
(d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

BPSC (Tre-3) {Class 6-8}–2024

Ans. (a)

Harsha, also known as Harshavardhana, was a notable Indian Emperor who ruled a significant portion of North India during the 7th century CE. Harsha was a devout Buddhist, and his military campaigns often incorporated a commitment to the spread and support of Buddhism. Despite his own faith, he practiced religious tolerance and was known for his benevolence towards other religious communities, including Hindus, Jains, and Buddhists.

Architecture in Ancient India

1. The associates of Khajuraho Temple Architecture were –

- (a) Chandela (b) Gurjara-Pratihara
(c) Chahamana (d) Paramara

43rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (a)

Khajuraho temple evidences the excellence of Chandela architecture. These temples are located in Chhatarpur district of Madhya Pradesh. They were built between 10th–12th century. Kandariya Mahadev temple is the best among these temples.

2. The attractive doors of the temples of South India are called-

- (a) Shikhar (Peak) (b) Gopuram
(c) Devalay (d) Mandapam
(e) None of the above/ More than one of the above

68th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (b)

The attractive gate of the temples of the south is called 'Gopuram'. The Dravidian style flourished during the rule of Pandyas and Cholas. In the Pandya period, the temples were small, but many ramparts were built around their courtyard. Their gateways, which were called 'Gopurams', were grand, spacious and richly ornamented with craftsmanship. The specialty of the Chola period architecture is not the temple, but the Gopuram.

South India (Chola, Chalukya, Pallava and Sangam Period)

1. Who established trade relations with Roman empire?

- (a) Kushanas
(b) Cheras
(c) Western Shakas
(d) Vakatakas
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Re-Exam) (Pre)-2021

Ans. (b)

India's trade with the Roman Empire started with the Chera Kingdom during the Sangam period. Many Roman things were found in Arikamedu (Puducherry).

2. Which medieval Indian empire was famous for elaborated local self-government?

- (a) Chalukya (b) Chola
(c) Solanki (d) Parmar
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (b)

A special feature of the Chola dynasty was the autonomy of village administration which was a speciality of them. The Chola village administration was very systematic and well-developed. In fact, the autonomous administration was implemented in the village only during the Chola era.

3. The Chola age was most famous for:

- (a) Village assemblies
(b) War with the Rashtrakutas
(c) Trade with Ceylon
(d) Advancement of Tamil culture
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C (Pre.) 2017

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

4. Who was the founder of Chola dynasty?
- (a) Vijayalaya (b) Karikal
(c) Aditya first (d) Rajaraja first
(e) None of the above/ More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (a)

The Chola Empire was founded by Vijayalaya, who was initially a feudatory chieftain of the Pallavas. He captured Tanjavur in 850 A.D. The Shiv temple of Tanjavur, Rajarajeswara or Brihadeeswara temple was built during the time of Rajaraja I.

5. Which of the following dynasties is not mentioned in Sangam literature?

- (a) Kadamb (b) Chera
(c) Chola (d) Pandya

41st B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (a)

The origin and elevation of Chola, Cheras and Pandyas are mentioned in Sangam Literature. Kadamb or any other dynasty is not mentioned in Sangam literature.

6. Why was 'Uraiyur' famous in Sangam Era?

- (a) An important trade centre of spices
(b) An important trade centre of cotton
(c) An important centre of foreign trade
(d) An important centre of domestic trade

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (b)

Uraiyur was a very significant town during Sangam Era, located on the bank of Cauvery River in Tiruchirappalli (Tamil Nadu). It was known as Koli and Varanam and was the major centre of cotton. It is mentioned in "Periplus of the Erythraean Sea."

Ancient Literature and Litterateur

1. Who of the following was the writer of Mudrarakshasa?

- (a) Aswaghosha (b) Vishakhadatta
(c) Kalidasa (d) Bhasa

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (b)

Mudrarakshasa written by Vishakhadatta is a drama in Sanskrit. Although written during the Gupta period, it describes how Chandragupta with the assistance of Kautilya overthrew the Nandas. It also gives a picture of the socio-economic condition under the Mauryas.

2. 'Kumarasambhava,' an epic poem was composed by –

- (a) Banabhatta (b) Chanda Bardai
(c) Harishena (d) Kalidasa

45th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (d)

The famous books of Kalidasa: - Abhigyanashakuntalam, Kumarsambhavam, Malavikagnimitram, Meghadutam etc.

3. What is the name of Kalhana's book?

- (a) Arthashastra (b) Indica
(c) Purana (d) Rajatarangini

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (d)

Rajatarangini was written by Kalhana.

4. Name the source that is silent about the trade routes of ancient India:

- (a) Sangam Sahitya (b) Milindpanho
(c) Jataka Tales (d) All of the above

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (a)

Sangam Sahitya is silent about the trade routes of ancient India.

5. The author of 'Swapnavasavadatta' is

- (a) Kalidasa (b) Bhasa
(c) Bhavabhuti (d) Rajshekhara

43rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (b)

'Swapnavasavadattam' is a Sanskrit play written by great poet Bhasa.

6. Which of the following Indian Philosophy has given the theory of atom?

- (a) Yoga (b) Justice
(c) Sankhya (d) Vaisheshik
(e) None of the above/ More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (d)

According to Vaisheshika philosophy, the universe is created from Atoms. Maharshi Kanad was the originator of this philosophy.

7. Who wrote the book "Kiratarjuniya"?

- (a) Bhatti (b) Shudrak
(c) Kalidasa (d) Bharavi

67th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (d)

The author of the book 'Kiratarjuniya' is Bharavi. The story of this book is taken from the Mahabharata. It describes the battle between Arjuna and Shiva in form of "Kirat".

8. The author of 'Prithviraj Raso' is –

- (a) Kalhana (b) Bilhana
(c) Jayanaka (d) Chand Bardai

43rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (d)

Prithviraj Raso describes the battles of Prithviraj Chauhan. It was written by Chand Bardai.

Pre-Medieval Period

1. Epigraphic records (Inscriptions) suggest that in ancient India, the rulers of Bihar had contact with –

- (a) Burma (b) Thailand
(c) Cambodia (d) Java-Sumatra

43rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (d)

The Pala king Devpala was Buddhist. He donated five villages at the request of Java king Balputradeva of Sailendra Dynasty for developing a Buddhist Vihar in Nalanda.

2. Consider the following statements regarding the Vikramshila University in Bihar :

1. It was located in the present-day Banka district of Bihar.
2. It was established by King Gopala I of the Pala dynasty.
3. The 'Vajrayana' sect of Buddhism flourished here.
4. Other subjects like Astronomy, Logic, Law, Grammar and Philosophy were also taught here.

Which of the above statements are incorrect ?

- (a) 2 and 3 (b) 1 and 4
(c) 1 and 2 (d) None of the above

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (c)

Vikramshila University is located in Bhagalpur and not in the Banka district. It was established by Dharmapala of Pal dynasty and not by Gopala I. Hence Statement 1 and 2 are incorrect. Rest are correct.

3. Which ruler of Bengal founded the ancient University called 'Vikramshila.'

- (a) Dharmapala (b) Gopala
(c) Devpala (d) Mahipala

43rd B. P.S.C. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (a)

King Dharmapala 770-810 A.D. of Pala dynasty established the Vikramshila University. After the downfall of Nalanda University. Vikramshila University was developed as the main centre for the Buddhist religion.

4. The Vikramshila University was established by

- (a) Gopala (b) Dharmapala
(c) Devapala (d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

68th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

5. The Huna King Toramana was defeated by the Aulikara King

- (a) Yasodharman
(b) Prakasadharmar
(c) Rajyavardhana
(d) Vishnuvardhana
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2018

Ans. (b)

Toramana was a Huna king who ruled in northern India. Sanjeli inscription of Toramana speaks of his conquest and control over Malwa and Gujarat. His territory also included Uttar Pradesh, Rajasthan and Kashmir. According to the Risthal inscription, discovered in 1983, Huna king Toramana was defeated by Aulikara king Prakashadharma of Malwa.

2. MEDIEVAL HISTORY OF INDIA

Muslim Invasion on India

1. Muhammad Ghori granted first Iqta in India to –

- (a) Tajuddin Yalduz (b) Qutbuddin Aibak
(c) Shamsuddin Iltutmish (d) Nazir-ud-din Qubacha

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (b)

Soon after the victories of Ghori, Iqta system was established in North India. In 1192 A.D., Muhammad Sam of Ghori (Muhammad Ghori) appointed Qutb-ud-Din-Aibak (Qutbuddin Aibak), as in charge of his Indian territories. He played an important role in the second battle of Tarain. Pleased with his works, Ghori appointed him the administrator of Kuhram and Samana. He had taken care of the administration of North Indian territories conquered by them as representative of Ghori till 1206. During this period, Aibak also expanded Turkish power in northern India.

Delhi Sultanate: Slave Dynasty

1. Who was the first ruler of the Slave Dynasty?

- (a) Iltutmish
- (b) Qutbuddin Aibak
- (c) Raziyya
- (d) Balban

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (b)

The first ruler of the Slave Dynasty (or named Gulam Dynasty) was Qutb-ud-Din Aibak who ruled from 1206 to 1210 A.D. He established his capital at Lahore. Though he was ugly in appearance, he was intelligent and impressive in behaviour. He was taken as a prisoner and sold to the Qazi of Nishapur named Fakhruddin as a slave in his childhood. He was taken care and provided with proper education and military training by the kind-hearted Qazi but soon after the death of the Qazi, his sons sold Aibak to Muhammad Ghori. He was well versed in Islamic theology, horse riding and swordsmanship. Owing to his skill and qualities, he soon attracted the attention of his master and was appointed commander of a troop. Shortly afterwards battles; he was promoted to the post of Amir-i- Akhur, the master of the royal stable. When Ghori invaded India, Aibak came with his master and provided him his active support during battles. The successes of his master by and large depended on his military skill. Ghori was immensely pleased with him, and he appointed him his governor of the Indian empire. In 1206 A.D., on his way to Ghazni, Ghori died. His empire was inherited by his slaves, as he had no son to succeed him. Aibak, who was a viceroy of his Indian Empire was invited by the Amirs of Lahore to assume the powers. He bestowed the title of Malik and Sipahsalar on himself. Muhammad Ghori had no male successor to inherit his empire; hence his nephew, Ghiyasuddin Mahmud ascended the throne of Ghori after his death in 1206 A.D.

2. "His theory of kingship was based on the principles of prestige, power and justice." Who said these words about Balban?

- (a) A. B. M. Habibullah
- (b) Zia-ud-din Barani
- (c) Stanley Lane-Poole
- (d) R. P. Tripathi
- (e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2022

Ans. (b)

Zia-ud-din Barani said about Balban "His theory of kingship was based on the principles of prestige, power and justice." It is noteworthy that Balban was a ruler of the Delhi Sultanate during the Mamluk dynasty (also known as the slave dyansty). He adopted the policy of 'blood and Iron'.

3. Which Sultan of Delhi Sultanate was known as 'Lakh Baksh'?

- (a) Qutub-ud-din Aibak
- (b) Balban
- (c) Raziya
- (d) Alauddin Khalji
- (e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. Assistant Audit Officer 2022

Ans. (a)

Sultan Qutub-ud-din Aibak was the first Muslim ruler of India who ruled from his capital in Lahore. He was known as Lal Baksh because of his generosity.

4. The Muslim ruler whose empire was regarded as a part of Dar-ul-Islam was

- (a) Balban
- (b) Razia
- (c) Iltutmish
- (d) Nasir-ud-Din
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Re-Exam) (Pre)-2021

Ans. (c)

During the period of Iltutmish, in 1229 A.D. the caliph of Baghdad gave Khillat to Iltutmish. Now the Sultanate was theoretically part of Dar-ul-Islam subject to the caliph of Baghdad.

5. What is 'Adhai Din ka Jhonpra'?

- (a) Mosque
- (b) Temple
- (c) Saint's hut
- (d) Tower

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (a)

Sultan Qutb-ud-Din Aibak also called "Lakh Baksh" was the first Muslim ruler of India who ruled from his capital in Lahore. He patronized scholars such as Hasan Nizami and Fakhra-i-Mudabbir, both of whom dedicated their works to Aibak. Aibak was the first Muslim ruler who settled in India and ruled unlike the earlier Muslims, who came and only raided and plundered. Though his tenure as a ruler was only four years, and most of them were spent in dealing with the revolts of nobles like Taj-ud-Din Ildiz, Nasir-ud-Din Qubachah and a few Hindu chiefs, he established a firm administrative system. He started the construction of Quwwat-ul-Islam mosque at Delhi and Adhai Din ka Jhonpda (Ajmer). He also laid the foundation of the Qutb Minar, which was completed by his successor Iltutmish. He was known as Lakh Baksh for his generosity. He never took the title of "Sultan". but according to the question option (a) is the correct answer.

6. The capital of Qutbuddin Aibak was:

- (a) Lahore (b) Delhi
(c) Ajmer (d) Lakhnauti

41st B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (a)

After the death of Muhammad Ghori in 1206, his General Qutbuddin Aibak, who was in charge of Lahore and north-Indian possessions was invited by Amirs of Lahore to assume the powers of Ghori. The capital of Qutbuddin Aibak was Lahore. Taj-ud-Din Yilduz, Governor of Kirman ascended the throne of Ghazni. It seems that Muhammad Ghori desired that Qutbuddin Aibak should succeed him in India. In his brief reign of four years (1206-10 A.D.), he moved his capital to Lahore to frustrate Yilduz's ambition of annexing Punjab. He strengthened his position by matrimonial alliances with influential rival Turkish Chief. Nasiruddin Qabacha of Multan refused to accept Qutbuddin as the ruler of the Delhi Sultanate. Due to this, Aibak always stayed in Lahore and never got the chance to move to Delhi.

7. The Qutub Minar was completed by-

- (a) Iltutmish (b) Qutbuddin Aibak
(c) Ulugh Khan (d) Razia Sultan
(e) None of the above/ More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (a)

The Qutub Minar was completed by the famous ruler Iltutmish.

8. Iltutmish appointed his first Subedar in Bihar to :

- (a) Aivaj (b) Nasiruddin Mahmud
(c) Alimardan (d) Malik - Jani

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (d)

In 1225 A.D., Iltutmish defeated Hisamuddin Awaz in mountains of Rajmahal near Teliyagarhi and annexed Bihar Shareef and Barh. Awaz had accepted the subordination of Iltutmish. Iltutmish had appointed Malik-Jani as the new Subedar of Bihar.

9. Who was the first Muslim ruler to formulate the 'Theory of Kingship' similar to the 'theory of divine right of the kings'?

- (a) Aibak (b) Iltutmish
(c) Balban (d) Alauddin
(e) None of the above/ More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C. (Pre.) 2017

Ans. (c)

Balban was the first ruler to propound the 'theory of Kingship' similar to the 'theory of divine right of the kings. He said, "Sultan is representative of God on earth and his place comes after Paigambar".

10. Which Sultan of Delhi introduced the practice of Sijda?

- (a) Kutub-ud-din Aibak (b) Balban
(c) Ala-ud-din Khalji (d) Muhammad bin Tuglaq
(e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. Auditor 2021

Ans. (b)

Balban made some rules and regulations for his court and strictly enforced them. He introduced the rituals of Sizdah (greeting lying on the ground) and Paibos (kissing the feet of the king).

11. Which Delhi Sultan is known for adopting the 'blood and iron' policy?

- (a) Iltutmish (b) Balban
(c) Ala-ud-Din Khalji (d) Muhammad bin Tughluq
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (b)

Balban was the first ruler to propound the 'Theory of Kingship' similar to the theory of divine right of the kings. He said, "Sultan is representative of God on earth and his place comes after Paigambar". It is said that he adopted the policy of 'Blood and Iron'.

12. Who among the following introduced the Persian festival Nowruz in India?

- (a) Firuz Shah Tughlaq (b) Alauddin Khilji
(c) Balban (d) Iltutmish

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (c)

Balban introduced the rituals of Sizdah (greeting lying on the ground) and Paibos (Kissing the feet of the king) in his court. He also introduced the rituals to celebrate the Persian festival Nowruz.

13. Who was the first Muslim conqueror of Bihar?

- (a) Malik Ibrahim
(b) Iltutmish
(c) Bakhtiyar Khalji
(d) Alimardan Khalji
(e) None of the above/ More than one of the above

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (c)

Ikhtiyaruddin Muhammad bin Bakhtiyar Khalji, a simple slave of Muhammad Ghori, conquered Bihar between 1193 A.D. to 1203 A.D. and captured the capital Odantapuri after destroying Nalanda and Vikramshila Vihara. He invaded Bengal around 1202-03 A.D. At that time the ruler there was Lakshmansen. He escaped without fighting. The Turkish army entered the capital Nadia and looted badly. The city surrendered in the absence of the king. Lakshmansen fled and took refuge in South Bengal and continued to rule there for some time. Famous Persian historian Minhajuddin Siraj in his book Tabaqat-i-Nasiri has described in detail about his attacks in Bihar.

14. Who among the following opposed the power of the Khalifa?

- (a) Iltutmish
- (b) Alauddin Khalji
- (c) Muhammad-bin-Tughluq
- (d) Balban
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Re-Exam) (Pre)-2021

Ans. (e)

Alternatively none of the Sultans opposed the power of the caliph. Iltutmish had obtained recognition from the Khalifa, but Sultan Ghiyasuddin of Bengal had also obtained recognition from the Khalifa. By attacking him, Iltutmish had in a way opposed the power of the Khalifa. Alauddin Khalji, Balban, and Muhammad Bin Tughlaq were practically independent rulers but none opposed the power of authority of the caliph. There was only Mubarak Khalji who himself took the title of Khalifatullah thus, he opposed the authority of the caliph.

15. Tughril Khan raised a standard of revolt during whose reign?

- (a) Balban
- (b) Alauddin Khalji
- (c) Feroz Tughluq
- (d) Khizr Khan
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Re-Exam) (Pre)-2021

Ans. (a)

Tughril Khan revolted during the time of Balban. This rebellion took place in protest against the appointment of Aamir Khan in Bengal. Over time the Tughril fled to fearing Balban's Bengal Campaign.

Khalji Dynasty

1. Who was deputed for the conquest of Dvarasamudra by Ala-ud-din Khalji ?

- (a) Alp Khan
- (b) Khizr Khan
- (c) Umar Khan
- (d) Malik Kafur
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2018

Ans. (d)

Malik Kafur was deputed for the conquest of Dvarasamudra by Ala-ud-din Khalji. In 1311 AD, Malik Kafur besieged the Hoysala capital Dvarasamudra and the defending ruler Veera Ballala III surrendered without much resistance. Ballala agreed to pay the Delhi Sultanate an annual tribute, and surrendered a great amount of wealth, elephants and horses.

2. "When he attained Kingship, he was fully independent of from rules and orders of Shariat." For which Sultan Barani made this statement?

- (a) Iltutmish
- (b) Balban
- (c) Alauddin Khalji
- (d) Muhammad Tughluq

46th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2004

Ans. (c)

Ziya-ud-din Barani made the above statement regarding Alauddin Khalji. Alauddin Khalji was the first king of Delhi, who established the control of the state over religion. In this context, he said explaining his policy "I don't know what is correct or incorrect by law? I only give a command which I understand suitable for the welfare of the state or special occasion, I don't know what will happen on the final day of justice." Alauddin had made alive the thought of Balban. He used to believe in the universality of the king who is only a representative of God on earth. He did not use to take the permission of Khalifa to expand his powers. That's why he never made a solicitation in front of Khalifa for recognition of his position. He called himself "Yamin-ul-Khilafat Nasiri Amir-ul-Mummin." Alauddin freed himself from the control of Ulemas.

3. "Thus to Ala-ud-din belongs the credit of being the first Turkish Sultan of Delhi to bring the church under the control of the state and to usher in factors that might make the state secular in theory." Who wrote these words?

- (a) Wolseley Haig
- (b) K. S. Lal
- (c) A. L. Srivastava
- (d) Zia-ud-din Barani
- (e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2022

Ans. (c)

A.L. Srivastava writes about Ala-ud-din Khalji that "Ala-ud-din was the first Turkish Sultan of Delhi to bring that church under the control of the state and to usher in factor that might make that stak secular in theory."

4. **Who reduced the Khuts and Muqaddams to such an extent that their wives served in the houses of Muslims?**

- (a) Balban (b) Ala-ud-din Khalji
(c) Muhammad bin Tuglaq (d) Ferozeshah Tuglaq
(e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. Auditor 2021

Ans. (b)

Allauddin Khalji took the authority of tax collection from traditional tax officers (Khutt, Mukaddam and Chaudhary). All their privileges were abolished and taxes were collected from them ruthlessly. Thus in the language of Barani, they were reduced to the lowest of low in village society and their women were forced to work in the houses of Muslims for wages.

5. **Who among army-commanders of Alauddin Khalji died fighting against Mongols?**

- (a) Zafar Khan (b) Nusrat Khan
(c) Alp Khan (d) Ulugh Khan

41st B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (a)

Zafar Khan, the famous army commander of Alauddin Khalji, died while fighting against the Mongols. He was an excellent and courageous commander of his time. Mongols were so impressed by the bravery of Zafar Khan and the persistence of Khalji's army that they backed down by 30 miles. The original name of Zafar Khan was Mian Yusuf Hizbaruddin.

6. **Padmini is associated with Ala-ud-Din's conquest of Chittor. She was the wife of**

- (a) Maharana Pratap Singh (b) Ranjit Singh
(c) Raja Man Singh (d) Rana Ratan Singh

43rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (d)

The story of Padmini is well depicted in 'Padmavat' written by Malik Muhammad Jayasi in 1540 A.D. According to this, Padmini was the wife of King Ratan Singh. Amir Khusrau mentioned the love story of Suleman and Queen Shaiba in his text and compared Alauddin with Suleman and Padmini with Shaiba. Probably presuming this, Malik Muhammad Jayasi composed Padmavat and the story of Rana Ratan Singh and Queen Padmavati.

7. **Who was the ruler of Devagiri at the time of Alauddin Khalji's invasion?**

- (a) Ramachandra Dev (b) Prataprudra Dev
(c) Malik Kafur (d) Rana Ratan Singh

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (a)

Ramchandra Dev was the ruler of Devagiri at the time of Alauddin Khalji's invasion. In 1296 A.D., the king of Devagiri, Ramchandra Dev after the successful invasion of Alauddin Khalji promised to send the revenue from Ellichpur every year, but during 1305-1306 AD, he did not send the tax to Delhi. Consequently, Alauddin sent an army under the leadership of Malik Kafur to attack Devagiri in 1307 A.D. King Ramchandra Dev was defeated and surrendered. Malik Kafur looted Devagiri and took Ramchandra Dev including his relatives to Delhi. Alauddin behaved with dignity with Ramchandra Dev and gave him the title of 'Rai Rayan' and sent him back to his state offering 1 lakh golden 'Tankas' and 'Navsari' district. Malik Kafur had also led a campaign against Shankar Dev, the son of Ramchandra in 1312 A.D.

8. **During the regime of which Sultan was the Khalisa land developed on a large scale?**

- (a) Ghiyasuddin Balban (b) Alauddin Khalji
(c) Muhammad-Bin-Tughluq (d) Firuz Shah Tughluq

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (b)

The main purpose of Alauddin behind the system of revenue and taxes system was to establish a powerful and autocratic state. He snatched all the lands from all those people who got the land as 'Milq' (Property given by the state, as prizes, Indarat, pension) and Waqf (land received in charity). Therefore, Khalisa land developed on a large scale.

9. **Who started Public Distribution System in Sultanate period?**

- (a) Ala-ud-din Khalji
(b) Sikandar Lodhi
(c) Muhammad bin Tughluq
(d) Firuz Shah Tughluq
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. Re-Exam (Pre) 2020

Ans (a)

The 'Public Distribution System' was introduced by Ala-ud-din Khalji during Sultanate period.

Tughluq Dynasty

1. Which one of the following Sultans provided employment to the unemployed?

- (a) Alauddin Khalji
- (b) Muhammad-Bin-Tughluq
- (c) Firuz Tughluq
- (d) Sher Shah Suri

45th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (c)

Firuz Shah Tughluq started some welfare programs for common people. He tried to solve the problem of unemployment by opening an office for appointment (employment office) and also appointed many qualified people by their qualifications and merits.

2. Which of the following Sultan had most numbers of slaves in his court?

- (a) Balban
- (b) Alauddin Khalji
- (c) Muhammad-Bin-Tughluq
- (d) Firuz Tughluq

45th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (d)

Firuz Shah Tughluq was fond of slaves. The number of his slaves reached up to one lakh eighty thousand. He established a separate department (Diwan-e-Bandgan) to take care of them. He kept his full attention about their education. Each slave was paid 10 to 100 Tankas and sometimes, they also got states. This hobby of Firuz proved detrimental to the state.

3. Which Delhi Sultan built the maximum number of canals?

- (a) Firuz Shah Tughluq (b) Iltutmish
- (c) Balban (d) Sikandar Lodi
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (a)

The reign of Firuz Shah Tughluq is famous for building the biggest network of canals for irrigation purposes. They were:- (1) Sutlej to Ghaggar (96 miles) (2) Yamuna to Hisar (150 miles), (3) Sirmor to Hansi, (4) Ghaggar to Firuzabad and (5) Yamuna to Firuzabad.

4. Which one of the following Sultans of Delhi introduced measures for improving the quality of fruits?

- (a) Muhammad-Bin-Tughluq (b) Firuz Tughluq

(c) Sikandar Lodi

(d) Sher Shah Suri

44th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (b)

Due to his interest in horticulture, Firuz planted 1200 new orchards near Delhi and also restored 30 old gardens of Alauddin. He also took measures to improve the quality of fruits in his orchards.

5. What was 'Dar-ul-Shafa' established by Firuz Tughluq?

- (a) An almshouse (b) A free hospital
- (c) A library (d) A guest house for pilgrims

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (b)

Firuz Tughluq opened charitable hospital known as 'Dar-ul-Shafa' and also placed qualified Hakeems in it.

6. Which Sultan of Delhi Sultanate established a charitable hospital named 'Dar-ul-Shifa'?

- (a) Iltutmish (b) Balban
- (c) Muhammad bin Tughluq (d) Firuz Shah Tughluq
- (e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. Assistant Audit Officer 2022

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of the above question.

7. Which one of the following dynasties ruled over India after the invasion of Timur?

- (a) Lodi Dynasty (b) Sayyid dynasty
- (c) Tughluq dynasty (d) Khalji dynasty

45th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (b)

The invasion of Timur (1398 A.D.) destroyed both Delhi Sultanate as well as the Tughluq dynasty. Tughluq dynasty came to an end in 1412 A.D., after that, Daulat Khan became the new Sultan of Delhi in 1413 A.D. However, Khizr Khan defeated him who was the Governor of Lahore, appointed by Timur. He founded the Sayyid dynasty in 1414 A.D.

Lodi Dynasty

1. Which of the following Sultans founded a town where now stands Agra?

- (a) Muhammad-Bin-Tughluq (b) Firuz Tughluq
- (c) Bahlul Lodi (d) Sikandar Lodi

44th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (d)

Nizam Khan, the third son of Bahlul Lodi, ascended the throne assuming the title of Sikandar Lodi on 17 July, 1489. Sikandar Lodi was the greatest among the three Lodi rulers. Sikandar Lodi is especially remembered for founding the city of Agra in 1504 A.D. with the purpose of controlling over the rulers of Rajasthan. His administration was noted for its efficiency. Roads were made safe and irrigational facilities were provided for the benefit of the peasantry. He knew Persian poetry. He used to write poems under the nickname 'Gulrukhi'. He was known to be a kind and generous ruler who cared for his subjects.

Vijayanagara Empire

1. Identify the first ruler of Vijayanagara who captured Goa from Bahamani's?

- (a) Hariharaa- I (b) Hariharaa- II
(c) Bukka- II (d) Devaraya- II

40th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (b)

After the death of Bukka in 1377 A.D., his son, Hariharaa- II ascended to the throne. He assumed the title of "Maharajadhiraja" and conquered the region of Canara, Mysore, and Kanchi, Trichanapali and collected tax from the king of Sri Lanka. His major achievement was winning the Belgaum and Goa from Bahamani. He was the devotee of Virupaksha form of Lord Shiva.

2. Who was the founder of Vijayanagara Empire?

- (a) Devaray (b) Krishnadevaray
(c) Harihara- Bukka (d) Vir Narasimharay
(e) None of the above/ More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (c)

The Vijayanagara Empire was established during the reign in the year 1336 A.D. by two brothers named Harihara and Bukka. The capital of this kingdom was Hampi, which was situated on the banks of the Tungabhadra River.

3. With whom the king of Vijayanagara, Krishnadeva Raya fought the battle of Golconda?

- (a) Quli Qutb Shah (b) QutbuddinAibak
(c) Ismail-Adil Khan (d) Gajapati

43rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (a)

The battle of Golconda was fought between the king of Vijayanagara, Krishnadeva Raya and the Sultan of Golconda, Quli Qutb Shah. Sultan Quli Qutb Shah founded the Qutb Shahi Dynasty in Golconda. Quli Qutb Shah expanded his kingdom by capturing forts at Warangal, Kondaveedu at a time when Krishnadeva Raya was busy fighting with the rulers of Orissa. Quli's campaign against Krishnadeva Raya continued, but finally, he was defeated by him.

4. Which among the following King's region Persian traveller 'Abdur Razzak' came to India?

- (a) Dev Rai I (b) Krishnadeva Raya I
(c) Dev Rai II (d) Krishna Rai II
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (c)

Persian ambassador Abdur Razzaq visited Vijayanagara during the reign of Devaraya- II (1422-46 A.D.). Devaraya- II belonged to Sangama dynasty.

5. Which famous war took place in 1565 A.D.?

- (a) Panipat I War (b) Panipat II War
(c) Khanwa War (d) Talikota War
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. Re-Exam (Pre) 2020

Ans. (d)

The battle of Talikota (1565 A.D.), a watershed battle, was fought between the Vijayanagara Empire and the Deccan Sultanates resulted in the defeat of Vijayanagara and ended weakening one of the greatest Indian empires originating from southern India before the Maratha Empire. Talikota is situated in Karnataka near Vijayapura city.

6. What was the chief characteristic of the financial system of Vijayanagara Empire?

- (a) Surplus rent (b) Land Revenue
(c) Income from seaports (d) Monetary system

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (b)

The Vijayanagara kings enjoyed a massive income from various sources like land revenue, wealth tax, trade tax, commercial tax, tax on industry, social and community tax and fine charged on crime. The main source of income was from land revenue which was fixed after the land was measured and categorized. The tax, namely 'Shisth' (Rai-Rekha) was the main source of income to the state. The revenue department was known as 'Athavane.'

7. The remains of Vijayanagara Empire are found in?

- (a) Bijapur (b) Golconda
(c) Hampi (d) Baroda
(e) None of the above/ More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C. (Pre.) 2017

Ans. (c)

The ruins of Hampi (situated in central Karnataka) represent the ancient capital of the Vijayanagara Empire. The Virupaksha temple, located in Hampi, was built during the Vijayanagara period. Hampi is a UNESCO world heritage site.

8. Who among the following famous rulers founded a suburban township of Nagalapuram, near Vijayanagara, after his mother's name?

- (a) Krishnadevaraya (b) Harihara
(c) Bukka (d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

68th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (a)

The suburban township of Nagalapuram, near Vijayanagara was founded by Krishnadevaraya of the Vijayanagara Empire in memory of his mother Nagala Devi.

Delhi Sultanate: Administration

1. During the Delhi Sultanate, the designation 'Muqaddam or Chaudhari' was used for

- (a) village headman (b) revenue officials
(c) village accountant (d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

68th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (a)

'Muqaddam or Chaudhari' was village headman and in this capacity only was the highest revenue authority in the village and not just any revenue official or village accountant.

2. 'Diwan-i-Arz' department was associated with:

- (a) Royal correspondence (b) Foreign
(c) Defence (d) Finance

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (c)

The correctly matched departments and their activities are as follows :

Diwan-i-Arz	-	Dealt with Military department
Diwan-i-Risalat	-	Dealt with religious issues/ matters/related to foreign matters.
Diwan-i-Insha	-	Dealt with State correspondence
Diwan-i-Wizarat	-	Dealt with financial matters

3. Which of the following indicates taxes levied on the land product?

- i. Kharaj ii. Khums
iii. Ushr iv. Muktai

Select your answer from the following codes –

- (a) only i (b) ii and iii
(c) i, ii and iii (d) i, iii, and iv

40th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (d)

In Islamic traditions, Khums refers to the historically required religious delegation of the Muslim army to pay one-fifth of the spoils of war, the booty collected from non-believers after a military campaign. This tax was paid to the caliph or sultan, representing the state of Islam. The rest of the others are taxes levied on the land product.

4. Zawabits were concerned with :

- (a) State laws
(b) Laws regulating mansab system
(c) Laws regulating mint house
(d) Agricultural taxes

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (a)

Zawabits were related to state laws in the administrative vocabulary of the Sultanate period.

5. Coins-Tanka, Shashgani and Jital of Sultanate period was made of which of the following metals-

- (a) Silver, Copper (b) Gold, Silver, Copper
(c) Silver, Zink, Copper (d) Gold, Zink, Copper

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (a)

Iltutmish was the first to issue regular currency and declare Delhi as the capital of his empire. He started the 'Tanka' and the 'Jital' coins made up of silver and copper respectively in the Sultanate period. Shashgani was also a silver coin. The ratio of tanka and jital was 1:48.

Delhi Sultanate: Art and Architecture

1. The famous Buland Darwaza at Fatehpur Sikri forms which entrance to the Jama Masjid?

- (a) Western (b) Eastern
(c) Southern (d) Northern
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2018

Ans. (c)

The Buland Darwaza is a fifteen story high gateway that acts as the southern entrance of the Fatehpur Sikri city. It is higher than the courtyard of the Jama Masjid. Buland Darwaza popularly known as the 'Gate of Magnificence' was built by the Akbar to commemorate his victory over Gujarat.

2. Which Sultan built Alai Darwaza?

- (a) Iltutmish (b) Balban
(c) Alauddin Khalji (d) Firuz Tughluq

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (c)

The 'Alai Darwaza is the main gate on the south of the Quwwat-ul-Islam Mosque at the Qutb Minar premises. It has a domed entrance which was constructed using red sandstone and is adorned with white marble. It was completed in 1311 A.D. by Turkish craftsmen. It is one of the first buildings in India in Islamic architectural style.

Delhi Sultanate: Literature

1. Who was the author of Tabaqat-i-Nasiri?

- (a) Shaikh Jamaluddin (b) Al-Biruni
(c) Minhaz-us-Siraj (d) Ziyauddin Barani

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (c)

The text 'Tabaqat-i-Nasiri' written by Minhaz-us-Siraj, was dedicated to Sultan Nasiruddin Mahmud. The text is divided into 23 volumes and was translated by H.G. Raverty into the English language. The text describes the victory of Muhammad Ghori over India.

2. The earliest description of Bakhtiyar Khalji's invasion of Bihar is in:

- (a) Tarikh-i-Hind (b) Tabaqat-i-Nasiri
(c) Tuj-ul-Maasir (d) Tarikh-i-Mubarak Shahi
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

64th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (b)

Tabaqat-i-Nasiri is a medieval text by Minhaj-i-Siraj. It is an important sourcebook for the reconstruction of the history of the foundation of Muslim rule in Bengal. Pieces of evidence in the literature suggest that in 1193, Nalanda University was sacked by Bakhtiyar Khalji a Turk. The Persian Historian Minhaj-i-Siraj in his chronicle Tabaqat-i-Nasiri reported that thousands of monks were burned alive and thousands beheaded as Khalji tried his best to uproot Buddhism.

3. Muhammad Ghori was defeated by the Chaulukyas of Gujarat in

- (a) 1192 AD (b) 1191 AD
(c) 1185 AD (d) 1178 AD
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2018

Ans. (d)

Muhammad Ghori was defeated in 1178 by Bhimdev Solanki II, the Chalukya vanshi king of Gujarat.

Delhi Sultanate : Miscellaneous

1. Which Sultan demanded half the crops on land after measurement as revenue?

- (a) Iltutmish (b) Balban
(c) Alauddin Khalji (d) Muhammad-Bin-Tughluq
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

64th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (c)

Mohammad-Bin-Tughluq is considered an ill-fated idealist owing to his ambitious schemes and novel experiments which ended in miserable failures because they were all far ahead of their time. To overcome financial difficulties, Muhammad-Bin-Tughluq increased the land revenue to half the produce on the farmers of Doab (land between Ganges and Yamuna rivers) but Demand was based on expected production while Alauddin Khalji had fixed the land revenue on the half of the produce of the land-based on measurement.

2. Who among the following rulers divided his troops into units of two hundred, two hundred fifty and five hundred?

- (a) Bahlul Lodi (b) Sikandar Shah
(c) Sher Shah (d) Islam Shah
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

64th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (d)

Islam Shah was the son of Sher Shah. He ruled over North India roughly for 8 years and died in 1553 AD. He divided his army battalions into the units of fifty, two hundred, two hundred fifty and five hundred.

3. Which city of India was called 'Shiraz-i-Mashriq' (Shiraz of the East) in the medieval age?

- (a) Agra (b) Delhi
(c) Lucknow (d) Jaunpur
(e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. Assistant Audit Officer 2022

Ans. (d)

The city of Jaunpur in India was called 'Shiraj-i-Mashriq' (Shiraz of the East) as it was a very important city for education and commerce in the region.

4. Who laid the foundation of new landed aristocracy in Bengal?

- (a) Murshid Quli Khan
- (b) Mir Jafar
- (c) Mir Qasim
- (d) Shah Alam
- (e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. Auditor 2021

Ans. (a)

Murshid Quli Khan, the Nawab of Bengal, replaced Mughal Jagirdari system of revenue with Maljasmani or Malzamini revenue system or Ijara system by which contracts were given for collection of revenue. Later, these contractors squeezed out Jagirdars and came to be known as Zamindars which formed a new landed aristocracy in Bengal.

Provincial Dynasty of North India and Deccan Province

1. Who was the founder of Bahamani Kingdom?

- (a) Alauddin Hasan
- (b) Firuz Shah
- (c) Mahmud Gaonwa
- (d) Asaf Khan
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (a)

Bahamani Kingdom was founded by Alauddin Hasan Gangu by revolting against the Delhi 'Sultanate'. In 1347, the successful revolt of the new nobles against Muhammad Tughluq resulted in the founding of the Bahamani Dynasty. After his coronation, he assumed the title of 'Abul Hasan Mujaffar Alauddin Bahman Shah'.

Bhakti and Sufi Movement

1. A common feature to all Bhakti Saints was that they –

- (a) Composed their verses in the language understood by their followers
- (b) Rejected the authority of the priestly class
- (c) Encouraged women to go to the temples
- (d) Encouraged idol worship

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (a)

The conduct of Bhakti saints was of a very high standard. Many of them visited the country and met many people having different views. They also contributed to the advancement of Hindi, Kannada, Punjabi, Bengali, Telugu, Tamil and other languages. The Saints of the Bhakti movement gave their verses in regional and local languages so that their followers could easily understand them. This was the main reason behind the development of local languages.

2. Which one of the following Sultans of Delhi was refused an audience by Nizamuddin Auliya?

- (a) Jalaluddin Khalji
- (b) Alauddin Khalji
- (c) Ghiyasuddin Tughluq
- (d) Muhammad-Bin-Tughluq

44th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (b)

Shaikh Nizamuddin Auliya saw the regime of more than seven Sultans, but he never visited their court. Sultan Jalaluddin tried to meet Nizamuddin Auliya through Amir Khusrau but when Nizamuddin Auliya heard that the Sultan was about to come, he moved to Ajodhan. When Alauddin asked him to meet, then Shaikh replied: "There are two doors in my home, if the Sultan comes from one door, I will go out by another." He was also known as 'Mehboob-e-Ilahi.'

3. In which Sufi order was Sufi Saint Sharfuddin Yahya Maneri associated?

- (a) Chishti
- (b) Qadiri
- (c) Firdausi
- (d) Suhrawardi
- (e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. Assistant Audit Officer 2022

Ans. (c)

Sufi Saint Sharfuddin Yahya Maneri was associated with Firdausi Sufi order of Bihar.

4. Shaikh Bahauddin Zakaria belonged to which sect?

- (a) Suhrawardi order
- (b) Rishi order
- (c) Chisti order
- (d) Firdausi order
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

64th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (a)

Shaikh Bahauddin Zakaria started Suhrawardi sect in India. Shaikh Sadr-ud-din Arif, Shaikh Rakh-ud-din Abul Fateh and Shaikh Jalaluddin Surkh were associated with this Sufi sect.

5. Who composed 'Barahmasa'?

- (a) Amir Khusrau (b) Imami
(c) Malik Muhammad Jayasi (d) Raskhan

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (c)

Barahmasa, Padmavat, Akharavat and Aakhri Kalaam are some of the texts written by Malik Muhammad Jayasi. Among his texts, Padmavat has an important place in Hindi literature. Barahmasa is a part of Padmavat.

Mughal Dynasty : Babur

1. The main reason for Babur's victory in the battle of Panipat was –

- (a) His horse riding force
(b) His skilled warfare
(c) Tulghuma system
(d) Internal disputes among Afghans

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (b)

The first battle of Panipat was fought between Babur and Ibrahim Lodi on 21 April, 1526. The main reason for Babur's victory in the battle of Panipat was his skilled warfare. The army of Babur was smaller than the army of Ibrahim Lodi, even then he won the battle with the help of his effective warfare policy. Babur noted, "Ibrahim Lodi was an inexperienced young man careless in his movements, who marched without order, halted or retired without method and engaged without foresight."

2. In which of the following battles are the main opponents not correctly stated?

- (a) Battle of Haldighati-Maharana Pratap and Akbar
(b) First Battle of Panipat-Babur and Ibrahim Lodi
(c) Second Battle of Panipat-Tipu Sultan and Marathas
(d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

68th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (c)

The Battle of Haldighati was fought on 18 June 1576 between forces of Mewar led by Maharana Pratap and forces of Mughals (Akbar) led by Man Singh I of Ambar. The First Battle of Panipat (1526) was fought between the invading forces of Babur and Ibrahim Lodi of Lodi Empire. The Second Battle of Panipat (1556) was fought between King of Delhi Hem Chandra Vikramaditya, popularly known as Hemu and army of Akbar.

3. In which language was Tuzuk-i-Baburi' written?

- (a) Persian (b) Arabic
(c) Turkish (d) Urdu

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (c)

The founder of the Mughal Empire, Zahiruddin Muhammad Babur wrote his memoirs (autobiography) 'Tuzuk-i-Baburi' also known as Baburnama written in Turkish language containing related events of his life.

4. Consider the following statements :

The arrival of Babur into India led to the

- 1. introduction of gunpowder in the subcontinent**
- 2. introduction of arch and dome in the region's architecture**
- 3. establishment of Timurid dynasty in the region**
- 4. introduction of cannons in warfare**

Which of the above statements are correct?

- (a) Only 1 and 2 (b) 1, 2 and 3
(c) 3 and 4 (d) None of the above

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (c)

Gunpowder entered India before Babur. It was used to demolish Fort's wall. But credit for using it in cannons and guns goes to Babur. Babur descended from Turk-Mongol conqueror Timur on his father's side and Genghis Khan on his mother's side. Babur, the eldest son of Umar Shaikh Mirza, was born on 14th February, 1483. He ascended the throne in Ferghana in June, 1494. His accession saw the beginning of Timurid dynasty in the region. He established the Mughal dynasty in India after the victory at Panipat in 1526. Arch and Dome were already introduced during the Sultanate period.

Humayun and Sher Shah

1. Who wrote Humayun Nama?

- (a) Babur (b) Humayun
(c) Gulbadan Begum (d) Jahangir

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (c)

Gulbadan Begum was the daughter of Babur. She was born in 1523 A.D. and died in 1603 A.D. She documented many historical events in her book 'Humayun Nama'. Akbar had great respect for her. Gulbadan Begum wrote that she had written the history of Babur and Humayun on the orders of Akbar. She described the battle between Humayun and Kamran in her book.

2. Arrange properly as per dates of four important battles fought by Humayun, the names of battlefields are given below –

- (a) Chausa, Devara, Kanauj, Sirhind
- (b) Devara, Kanauj, Chausa, Sirhind
- (c) Sirhind, Devara, Chausa, Kanauj
- (d) Devara, Chausa, Kanauj, Sirhind

41st B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (d)

The correct order of battles fought by Humayun is as follows- Devara, Chausa, Kanauj and Sirhind. Humayun defeated Afghan rebels on the banks of Gomati at Devara or Daurah in 1532 A.D. Sher Shah defeated Humayun in the Battle of Chausa on 26 June 1539 in which a water fetcher named Nizam saved his life. This victory against Humayun increased the prestige and power of Sher Shah. He read 'Khutba' by his name occupying the title of Sher Shah and engraved this on the coins.

On 17 May, 1540 Humayun was again defeated by Sher Shah in the Battle of Kanauj (Bilgram) and Humayun fled from one place to the other after this war. Humayun occupied Delhi again in the Battle of Sirhind on 22 June, 1555.

3. "No government not even the British has shown so much wisdom as this Pathan." Who wrote these words about Sher Shah Suri?

- (a) H. G. Keene
- (b) K. R. Qanungo
- (c) W. H. Moreland
- (d) V. A. Smith
- (e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2022

Ans. (a)

H.G. Keen writes about Sher Shah Suri "No government, not even the British has shown as much wisdom as this Pathan". In fact, this comment about Sher Shah Suri was made because in a very short time, he snatched the reins of power from the Mughals in India and took it into his own hands.

4. Which of the following rulers at first assumed the title of 'Hazrat-e-Ala' and afterward 'Sultan'?

- (a) Bahlul Lodi
- (b) Sikandar Lodi
- (c) Sher Shah Suri
- (d) Islam Shah Suri

44th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (c)

In 1534 A.D., Sher Khan assumed the title of 'Hazrat-e-Ala' after defeating the ruler of Bengal, Nusrat Shah. He assumed the royal title of 'Sher Shah' after defeating Humayun in the Battle of Chausa on June 26, 1539 and ordered to read Khutba by his name and the coins to be minted in his name.

5. Where is Sher Shah's tomb located ?

- (a) Sasaram
- (b) Maner
- (c) Sitamani
- (d) Pawapuri
- (e) None of the above/ More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (a)

Sher Shah's tomb is built on a high platform in the middle of a pond at a place called Sasaram in Rohtas district of Bihar.

6. When Humayun invaded Chunar Fort first time ?

- (a) 1532
- (b) 1531
- (c) 1533
- (d) 1536

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (a)

Humayun invaded Chunar Fort for the first time in 1532 A.D. Humayun besieged this fort for four months after that Sher Khan accepted his supremacy. In addition to this, he invaded Kalinjar in 1531 A.D. and annexed Raisina fort in 1532 A.D.

7. Who among the following made an offer to Humayun that he would surrender Bihar and pay an annual tribute of 10 lakh dinars if he was allowed to retain Bengal?

- (a) Bahadur Shah
- (b) Sher Khan
- (c) Bairam Khan
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

68th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (b)

Sher Khan made an offer to Mughal emperor Humayun that he would surrender Bihar and pay an annual tribute of about 10 lakh dinars if he was allowed to retain Bengal but Humayun declined the offer.

8. Who among the following has constructed mausoleum for his emperor husband ?

- (a) Shah Begum
- (b) Haji Begum
- (c) Mumtaz Mahal Begum
- (d) Nurnissa Begum

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (b)

Haji Begum constructed mausoleum for her husband Humayun at Delhi during 1565-72 A.D. as 'tomb of Humayun.' Mirak Mirza Ghiyath (Ghiyas), a Persian, was the architect, employed by Haji Begum for this tomb. It is the first dome mausoleum of India made up of white marble. A garden is surrounded outwards of the tomb.

9. Who among these rulers divided his troops into units of two hundred, two hundred and fifty and five hundred?

- (a) Bahlul Lodi
- (b) Sikandar Shah

- (c) Sher Shah (d) Islam Shah
(e) None of the above/ More than one of the above

64th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (e)

Islam Shah was the son of Sher Shah. Islam Shah ruled the whole of North India for about 8 years. He divided his troops into units of two hundred, two hundred fifty and five hundred. Probably this system of military division was prevalent even during the time of Sher Shah. It is to be known that the Bihar Public Service Commission has considered answer (e) to this question.

Akbar

- 1. Who was the commander of Rana Pratap's army in the Battle of Haldighati?**

- (a) Amar Singh (b) Man Singh
(c) Hakim Khan (d) Shakti Singh

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (c)

Hakim Khan Sur was the commander of Rana Pratap's army in the Battle of Haldighati. He was a Pathan adventurer, a member of the Sur dynasty who commanded an army of 5,000 Afghans in the battle of Haldighati on 18 June, 1576.

- 2. Yousuf Shah Chak, the last Muslim ruler of Kashmir valley, who was exiled to Bihar by the Mughal emperor Akbar, was buried in –**

- (a) Pataliputra (b) Rajgir
(c) Munger (d) Nalanda
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (d)

Yousuf Shah Chak was a ruler of Kashmir. Yousuf was exiled to Bihar by Mughal emperor Akbar. He died in Jagannath Puri (Odisha) and was buried in Biswak (Nalanda).

- 3. Who of the following Muslim rulers abolished the pilgrimage tax?**

- (a) Bahlul Lodi (b) Sher Shah
(c) Humayun (d) Akbar

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (d)

Akbar abolished Jizya, the pilgrimage tax and Slavery in 1564, 1563 & 1562 respectively. Under his liberal religious policy.

- 4. Zabti system was introduced by –**

- (a) Ghiyasuddin Tughluq (b) Sikandar Lodi
(c) Sher Shah (d) Akbar

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (d)

Zabti System was introduced for land revenue in the reign of Akbar which was based on schedules of Dustur-ul-Amal and Zabti Khasre for land survey and land revenue determination. Most of the area was based on this system.

- 5. Who promulgated Din-e-Elahi?**

- (a) Babar (b) Akbar
(c) Jahangir (d) Shah Jahan
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. Re-Exam (Pre) 2020

Ans. (b)

Akbar launched "Tauhid-i-Ilahi" or "Din-i-Ilahi" (Din-e-Elahi) in 1582 A.D. Din-i-Ilahi was a syncretic religion which intended to merge the best elements of all the religions of the community. Indeed, the prophet of this new sect was Abul Fazl. Among Hindus, only Birbal accepted Din-i-Ilahi. Raja Bhagawan Das and Man Singh bluntly refused to embrace Din-i-Ilahi.

- 6. European paintings were introduced in the court of :**

- (a) Humayun (b) Akbar
(c) Jahangir (d) Shah Jahan
(e) None of the above/ More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C. (Pre.) 2017

Ans. (b)

European paintings were introduced in the court of Akbar for first time.

- 7. 'Daswant and Basawan' famous painters were courtier of Mughal emperor :**

- (a) Akbar (b) Jahangir
(c) Shah Jahan (d) Aurangzeb
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (a)

Abul Fazal had listed 15 outstanding painters in his text Ain-i-Akbari-Daswant, Basawan, Keshav Lal, Mukund Miskin, Madhes, Jagan, Mahesh, Khemaran, Tara, Sanwal, Harivansh.

- 8. Who was the ruler of India when the English East India Company was formed?**

- (a) Aurangzeb (b) Akbar
(c) Jahangir (d) Humayun

(e) None of the above/ More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C. (Pre.) 2017

Ans. (b)

The English East India Company was formed in the year 1600 A.D. Elizabeth was the Empress of England and Akbar was emperor of India at that time.

9. Akbar merged Bengal and Bihar in his empire :

- (a) 1590 A.D. (b) 1575 A.D.
(c) 1576 A.D. (d) 1572 A.D.

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (c)

Daud Khan succeeded his father Suleman Karrani in 1572 A.D. after his death. Daud Khan invaded Patna Mughal fort after declaring himself an independent ruler. Akbar ordered Munim Khan to suppress this revolt and occupy Bihar. Munim Khan defeated Daud Khan in a battle and annexed Bihar in 1574 A.D. Daud fled away to Bengal after his defeat. On 12 July, 1576 Todarmal, defeated Daud. Thus, Akbar merged Bengal and Bihar in his empire in 1576 A.D.

10. Ain-e-Akbari was written by -

- (a) Abdul Qadir (b) Akbar
(c) Khwaja Nizamuddin (d) Abul Fazal
(e) None of the above/ More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (d)

Ain-e-Akbari is written by Abul Fazal one of the Navratnas of Akbar. This is the third part of the 'Akbar Nama' It contains the official account of Akbar's administration.

11. Tabaqat-i-Akbari, which has been sometimes considered more reliable than Abul Fazl's Akbarnama, was written by

- (a) Gulbadan Begum (b) Nizamuddin Ahmad
(c) Abdul Hamid Lahori (d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

68th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (b)

Khwaja Nizamuddin Ahmad wrote Tabaqat-i-Akbari. Gulbadan Begum wrote Humayun-Nama while Abdul Hamid Lahori wrote Padshahnama.

12. "After uniting India, he wanted to unite the Mid-East and Western Asia with him as a very important step towards the establishment of a world empire." R. P. Tripathi wrote it about which ruler of Mughal India?

- (a) Babur (b) Sher Shah Suri
(c) Akbar (d) Aurangzeb

(e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2022

Ans. (c)

R.P. Tripathi writes about Mughal Emperor Akbar that "After uniting India, he wanted to unite the Mid-East and Western Asia with him a very important step towards the establishment of a world empire."

Jahangir

1. Who introduced 'Do-aspa and Sih-aspa' system?

- (a) Akbar (b) Jahangir
(c) Shah Jahan (d) Aurangzeb

46th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2004

Ans. (b)

'Do-aspa and Sih-aspa' system was introduced by Jahangir. Under the provision of this system, Mansabdars had to maintain an excess number of soldiers without increment in rank (zat).

Do-aspa : In this system, Mansabdars had to maintain double horses in comparison to their 'Sawar' rank.

Sih-aspa : In this system, Mansabdars had to maintain a triple the number of horses in comparison to their 'Sawar' rank.

2. Whom of the following Englishmen did Jahangir respected with title 'English Khan'?

- (a) Hawkins (b) Sir Thomas Roe
(c) Edward Terry (d) None of the above

40th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (a)

Hawkins was the first English sent by English East India Company to visit the court of Jahangir in 1608 A.D. Jahangir was so much impressed by Hawkins that he gave him the title of 'English Khan' and also made him marry a lady from Armenia.

3. Itmad-ud-Daula's tomb at Agra was built by

- (a) Akbar (b) Jahangir
(c) Nur Jahan (d) Shah Jahan

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (c)

Tomb of Itmad-ud-Daula was built by Noorjahan (Nur Jahan) at Agra between 1622-1628 after the death of his father. This elegant monument is located on the bank of river Yamuna. The main mausoleum is built with white marble. Itmad-ud-Daula has a special place in the chronicles of both history as well as architecture. The monument is priceless because this is the first tomb in India that is entirely made up of marble. In spite of marble and inlay work, it was for the first time that a new style of ornamentation, Pietradura, was used.

4. During the time of which Mughal Emperor did Sir Thomas Roe come to India?

- (a) Babur (b) Akbar
(c) Jahangir (d) Shah Jahan
(e) None of the above/ More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (c)

Sir Thomas Roe reached Surat in September 1615 AD as an envoy of King James I of England, he attended the court of Mughal ruler Jahangir in Ajmer.

Shah Jahan

1. What was the root of the dispute between the Shah of Iran and Mughal rulers?

- (a) Kabul (b) Qandahar
(c) Kunduz (d) Ghazni

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (b)

Qandahar was the cause of dispute between the Shah of Iran and the Mughal rulers of Qandahar because it became an issue of prestige for Persians and Mughals. The expansion of colonialism of both the dynasties was mostly depended on suzerainty of Qandahar.

2. Who made the Red Fort in Delhi?

- (a) Akbar (b) Nur Jahan
(c) Jahangir (d) Shah Jahan

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (d)

Shah Jahan transferred his capital from Agra to Delhi and laid the foundations of Shahjahanabad in his name. Red Fort is an important monument of Shah Jahan. It is an irregular octagon with two long sides on the west and east and with two main gates, one on the west and the other on the south called Lahori and Delhi gates respectively. It is unique in architecture and glory.

3. Who among the following historians declared the regime of Shah Jahan to be the Golden Era of the Mughal period?

- (a) V.A. Smith
(b) J.N. Sarkar
(c) A.L. Srivastava
(d) None of the above

41st B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (c)

Dr. A.L. Srivastava wrote in his book “Mughalkaleen Bharat (1526-1803)” that the regime of Shah Jahan is the golden period in the medieval history of India. However, it is true only on the basis of art and especially architecture. J.N. Sarkar and V.A. Smith are not in favour to accept this fact, but R.S. Sharma also accepted this fact. Hence, option (c) is the correct answer.

Aurangzeb

1. Who was the first Mughal ruler who fought against the British?

- (a) Jahangir
(b) Aurangzeb
(c) Shah Jahan
(d) Bahadur Shah Zafar
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Re-Exam) (Pre)-2021

Ans. (b)

The first conflict between the Mughals and the British took place in 1686 A.D. during the reign of Aurangzeb. The Mughal governor Shaista Khan had driven the British out of Hooghly, including Jab Cherock.

2. The meaning of ‘Jihad’ carried on by Aurangzeb is –

- (a) Dar-ul-Harb (b) Dar-ul-Islam
(c) Holy War (d) Jizya

43rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (b)

Aurangzeb was a Sunni Muslim. Aurangzeb tried to enforce the Quranic law, according to which enjoins upon every pious muslim to carry on Jihad (holy wars) against non-Muslim lands (Dar-ul-Harb) till they are converted to Islam (Dar-ul-Islam).

3. Who wrote Alamgir-Nama?

- (a) Mirza Muhammad Kazim
(b) Muhammad Saqi Mustaid Khan
(c) Aqil Khan Razi
(d) Ishwar Das
(e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. Auditor 2021

Ans. (a)

Alamgir-nama, a history of first ten years of Aurangzeb's reign was compiled by Mirza Muhammad Kazim.

Mughal Administration

1. In the Mughal administration 'Muhtasib' was –

- (a) Military Officer
- (b) Head of Foreign Affairs
- (c) An Officer-in-Charge of public morals
- (d) Officer of Correspondence Department

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (c)

Muhtasib, the censor of public morals acted as police cum Judge in the observance of the law by the Muslims.

2. In medieval India, why was the mansabdari system introduced?

- (a) For revenue collection
- (b) Facilitating recruitment to the army
- (c) To establish religious harmony
- (d) Ensuring clean administration
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (d)

Akbar introduced a well-organised system in the military and civil service of the empire which came to be known as Mansabdari system. The main intention to introduce Mansabdari was to provide a clean and better administration.

3. 'Madad-i-Mash' indicates in Mughal administration –

- (a) Toll Tax
- (b) Revenue freeland granted to learned person
- (c) Pension provided to military officials
- (d) Cultivation Tax

46th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (b)

Sometimes, the Mughal administration issued grants as a Madad-i-Mash to pious or otherwise worthy recipients as charity. The spirit of composite culture and harmony was expressed in revenue-free grants (Madad-i-Mash), which the nobles extended to the support of saints, maintenance of religious institutions, religious places and upkeep of Mashaikhs, etc.

4. The meaning of word Bantai during Medieval period was?

- (a) Religious Tax
- (b) System of calculating revenue
- (c) Wealth tax
- (d) Property tax

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (b)

The meaning of word 'Bantai' during the medieval period was a system of calculating revenue in which real produce was distributed between state and peasants. Sher Shah Suri opted 3 systems for calculating revenue :

Nasq/Muktai/Kankut

Nakadi or Jabti

Galla Bakshi or Bantai

Bantai was of 3 types (i) Khet Bantai (ii) Lank Bantai (iii) Raasi Bantai.

Music and Paintings of Mughal Period

1. Who did illustrate "Dastan-e-Amir Hamza"?

- (a) Abdus Samad
- (b) Mansur
- (c) Mir Sayyid Ali
- (d) Abul Hasan

46th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2004

Ans. (a & c)

Most of the Mughals were renowned as great patrons of arts. The first endeavor was to complete the pictures of the earliest Mughal illustrated manuscript, the Dastan-e-Amir Hamza began in the period of Humayun. It took 15 years to finish under the supervision of Mir Sayyid Ali and then Abdus Samad more than 50 artists completed it.

2. Mughal painting reached its zenith under –

- (a) Jahangir
- (b) Humayun
- (c) Shah Jahan
- (d) Akbar
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (a)

Jahangir had an artistic inclination. During his reign, Mughal painting developed further as Jahangir was fascinated with art, science and architecture from a young age. He showed a leaning towards painting and had an atelier of his own. His interest in portraiture led to much development in this art form. The art of Mughal painting reached great heights during Jahangir's reign. His interest in painting also served his scientific interest in nature. Painter Ustad Mansur became one of the best artists to document the animals and plants which Jahangir either encountered on his military expeditions or received as donations. Jahangir maintained a huge aviary and kept a record of every specimen and organized experiments. He patronized the European and Persian arts.

3. Which Mughal ruler established Karkhanas for painting?

- (a) Humayun (b) Akbar
(c) Jahangir (d) Shah Jahan
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (b)

Akbar was very fond of painting and during his reign painting was organised as an imperial establishment or Karkhana called Tasvir Khana where the painters worked. So option (b) is correct option.

4. Arrange properly as per dates of four important battles fought by Humayun, the names of battlefields are given below –

- (a) Chausa, Devara, Kanauj, Sirhind
(b) Devara, Kanauj, Chausa, Sirhind
(c) Sirhind, Devara, Chausa, Kanauj
(d) Devara, Chausa, Kanauj, Sirhind

41st B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (d)

The correct order of battles fought by Humayun is as follows- Devara, Chausa, Kanauj and Sirhind. Humayun defeated Afghan rebels on the banks of Gomati at Devara or Daurah in 1532 A.D. Sher Shah defeated Humayun in the Battle of Chausa on 26 June 1539, in which a water fetcher named Nizam saved his life. This victory against Humayun increased the prestige and power of Sher Shah. He read 'Khutba' by his name occupying the title of Sher Shah and engraved this on the coins.

On 17 May, 1540 Humayun was again defeated by Sher Shah in the Battle of Kanauj (Bilgram) and Humayun fled from one place to the other after this war. Humayun occupied Delhi again in the Battle of Sirhind on 22 June, 1555.

Mughal Period : Miscellaneous

1. Which among the following ports was called Babul Makka (Gate of Makka) during the Mughal period?

- (a) Calicut (b) Surat
(c) Cambay (d) Broach

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (b)

During the Mughal period, pilgrims used to visit Mecca for Haj from Surat. Hence, Surat was known as 'Mecca dwar', 'Babul Mecca' (Gate of Mecca) and 'Meccabari'.

2. Which Sultan was reputed to be 'Akbar of Kashmir'?

- (a) Sultan Shamsuddin Shah
(b) Sultan Qutbuddin
(c) Sultan Sikandar
(d) Sultan Zainul Abidin
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

64th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (d)

Sultan Zainul Abidin on account of his liberal religious policies and social welfare works was called 'Akbar of Kashmir'.

3. Who stated that five thousand to twenty thousand men worked for forty years to build the palace of forty pillars at Allahabad in Akbar's time?

- (a) Manucci (b) Tavernier
(c) William Finch (d) Abdul Hamid Lahori
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

64th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (c)

According to William Finch, five thousand to twenty thousand men worked for forty years to build the palace of forty pillars at Allahabad (Prayagraj) in Akbar's tenure.

4. It was said about Mughal emperor Bahadur Shah Zafar that the extent of his empire was-

- (a) Chandni Chowk to Palam
(b) Delhi to Bihar
(c) Peshawar to Bihar
(d) Peshawar to Varanasi
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

64th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (*)

Not about Bahadur Shah Zafar but about Mughal ruler Shah Alam II, there was a famous saying in Persian language that Sultanat-e-Shah Alam, Az Dilli ta Palam i.e. during the period of Shah Alam, the Mughal Empire was shrinking from the Red Fort of Delhi. Palam was left till the village. Bihar Public Service Commission has cancelled this question.

Sikh Sect

1. Which Sikh Guru was born in Patna?

- (a) Nanak
(b) Tegh Bahadur
(c) Hargobind
(d) Gobind Singh

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (d)

Guru Gobind Singh was the tenth and the last Sikh Guru. He was born in 1666 A.D. in Patna (Bihar). He introduced 'Khalsa Panth' and consolidated the Sikh community as a warrior.

Maratha State and Confederacy

1. Where was the capital of Shivaji?

- (a) Raigarh (b) Sindhurg
(c) Poona (d) Kolhapur

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (a)

Shivaji was coronated in 1674 A.D. with the title of 'Chhatrapati' and made Raigarh his capital. Vishveshwar (Gaga Bhatt), the famous contemporary scholar of Benares (Banaras), coronated and declared him Kshatriya.

2. 'Ashta Pradhan' was helping in Administration of which ruler?

- (a) Babur (b) Akbar
(c) Aurangzeb (d) Shivaji
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. Re-Exam (Pre) 2020

Ans. (d)

'Ashta Pradhan' was a council of eight ministers constituted by Shivaji in Maratha administration.

The eight ministers were –

- (i) Peshwa- Prime Minister of King
(ii) Amatya or Mazumdar- Finance and Revenue Minister
(iii) Wakianavis/Mantri- Interior minister, managing internal affairs, especially intelligence and espionage.
(iv) Sachiv/Surnavis-Responsible for all correspondence.
(v) Sumant/Dabir- Foreign Minister
(vi) Senapati/Sar-i-Naubat - Maintenance of appointments, organization and food supply of military.
(vii) Pandit Rao- High Priest
(viii) Nyayadhish- Chief Justice

3. 'Ashta Pradhan' was a Council of Ministers

- (a) in the Gupta administration
(b) in the Chola administration
(c) in the Maratha administration
(d) in the Vijayanagara administration

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

4. Who established Ashta Pradhan?

- (a) Chandragupta (b) Ashoka
(c) Harshavardhana (d) Shivaji
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of the above question.

5. Saranzami system was related to –

- (a) Land revenue system of Maratha
(b) Taluqdari system
(c) Qutb Shahi administration
(d) None of the above

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (a)

Saranzami system was related to land revenue in the Maratha period. The land given under Saranzami system was provided for the livelihood of Maratha Jagirdar during the Maratha period.

Disintegration of the Mughal Empire

1. Who was the last Mughal Emperor to sit on Mayur Singhasan?

- (a) Shah Alam I (b) Muhammad Shah
(c) Bahadur Shah (d) Jahandar Shah

40th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (b)

Muhammad Shah (1719 - 1748 A.D.) was the last Mughal emperor to sit on Mayur Singhasan/ Takht-i-Taus during his reign. Nadir Shah attacked India in 1739 A.D. and defeated the Mughals in Karnal Battle. The contemporary historian Anand Ram Mukhlis wrote, "Nadir Shah took sixty thousand rupees, many thousands of gold coins, gold of one crore rupee, jewels of fifty crores, Kohinoor and Peacock throne with him to Iran".

2. Which of the following Mughal emperors was not allowed to enter into Delhi by Wazir Ghaziuddin?

- (a) Alamgir- II (b) Shah Alam- II
(c) Akbar- II (d) Bahadur Shah- II

44th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (b)

Shah Alam- II tenure was from 1759 to 1806 A.D. His real name was Ali Gauhar. He became the victim of conspiracies hatched at the royal court. He reached Delhi with the help of Marathas in 1772 A.D. During his rule only, English captured Delhi in 1803 A.D.

3. MODERN HISTORY OF INDIA

The Advent of European Companies

1. Who was the first Portuguese Viceroy in India?

- (a) Diaz (b) Vasco da Gama
(c) Almeida (d) Albuquerque

45th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (c)

Vasco da Gama arrived on western-coast port of Calicut in 1498 A.D. He discovered a new and all sea route to India and he was welcomed by Zamorin, the then king of Calicut. The voyage of Vasco da Gama opened the new trade dimensions of the Indo-Portuguese alliance. Vasco da Gama earned 60 times more profit in Europe by black pepper trade from India, which encouraged other Portuguese traders. The Portuguese merchants established their commercial firms in India at the ports of Calicut, Goa, Daman, Diu and Hooghly. Vasco da Gama revisited India in 1502. Francisco de Almeida came to India in 1505 as the first Portuguese Viceroy and Albuquerque came to India in 1509 after him as a new Viceroy. He annexed Goa in 1510 from Bijapur ruler Adil Shah. The Portuguese maintained Goa as the epicentre of their culture and entity.

2. Who used Hooghly as a base for piracy in the Bay of Bengal?

- (a) The Dutch (b) The French
(c) The Portuguese (d) The British
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (c)

The Portuguese used Hooghly as a base for piracy in the Bay of Bengal. In 1632, Qasim Khan who was the Governor of Bengal during Shahjahan's reign finally subdued and imprisoned thousands of Portuguese.

3. Dutch East India Company established its factory at Patna in which year?

- (a) 1601 (b) 1632
(c) 1774 (d) 1651
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (b)

Dutch East India Company established its factory at Patna in 1632 A.D., while it was closed in the same year. Although historian Om Prakash has given proofs for establishment of a Dutch factory in Patna in 1638 A.D. which was closed down the same year due to money problem.

4. Where in India did Britishers set up their first factory in 1613?

- (a) Goa (b) Hooghly in Bengal
(c) Amarkot (d) Surat

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (d)

Captain William Hawkins reached Mughal Court from Surat in 1609 but did not succeed in getting permission to set up a factory. Despite Portuguese antagonism, Captain Middleton landed at Sowley near Surat and succeeded in getting permission for trade with Mughal Governor in 1611. Captain Thomas Best dissolved the Portuguese monopoly with the victory of Surat port. Consequently, the British established a permanent factory in 1613 A.D. They expanded their trade to other parts of India and established cooperative factories in Ahmedabad, Burhanpur, Ajmer and Agra immediately.

5. Which of the British officials defeated Portuguese at Sowley?

- (a) William Hawkins (b) Thomas Best
(c) Thomas Roe (d) Josiah Child

44th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (b)

After defeating Portuguese at Sowley near Surat in 1612, English established their factor at Surat. Captain Thomas Best was responsible for this English win.

6. Which one of the following was the immediate cause of the First Carnatic War?

- (a) Anglo-French Rivalry
(b) Austrian War of Succession
(c) Issues of Carnatic Succession
(d) Capture of French ships by the British

44th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (d)

The First Carnatic War (1746-48 A.D.) was an offshoot of the Anglo-French rivalry in the Austrian War of Succession that took place in Europe in 1740 A.D. The British Captain Bernett captured some French ships which became the immediate cause of war. Nawab Anwaruddin sent an army under the command of Mahfooz Khan to besiege the French in Madras during the First Carnatic War. The French Army (under command of Captain Paradise) defeated Nawab's Army at the Battle of St. Thome near Adyar river. Treaty of Aix-Le-Chapelle (18 Oct, 1748) ended the War of Austrian succession and with it first Carnatic War ended and the Britishers reoccupied Madras. The first Carnatic War is memorable for War of St. Thome.

7. Identify the region from where Europeans got best shora (Saltpetre) and opium –

- (a) Bihar (b) Gujarat
(c) Bengal (d) Madras

40th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (a)

The Europeans obtained best shora (Saltpetre) and opium from Bihar.

8. During British rule which region of India was famous for the production of opium?

- (a) Bihar (b) Southern India
(c) Gujarat (d) Assam

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (a)

During British rule, the State of Bihar was famous for the production of opium.

East India Company and Nawabs of Bengal

1. Emperor Shah Alam- II gave the Diwani of Bengal - Bihar and Orissa to East India Company on:

- (a) 12 August, 1765 (b) 18 August, 1765
(c) 29 August, 1765 (d) 21 August, 1765

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (a)

As per the second Treaty of Allahabad (August, 1765), the Mughal Emperor Shah Alam-II was taken under the Company's protection and was to reside at Allahabad. He was assigned Allahabad and Kashi ceded by the Nawab of Oudh. The Emperor issued an order dated 12th August, 1765 granting Company the Diwani of Bengal, Bihar and Odisha. During this time Robert Clive was Governor of East India Company in Bengal. The emperor's order legalized the political authority of Company in Bengal and British rule expanded all over India including Delhi. Successors of Shah Alam-II i.e. Akbar-II (1806-37) and Bahadurshah-II (1837-57) became pensioners of East India Company.

2. Which treaty was signed after the Battle of Buxar?

- (a) The Treaty of Allahabad (b) The Treaty of Sugauli
(c) The Treaty of Bassein (d) The Treaty of Salbai

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (a)

After Battle of Buxar (1764), the Treaty of Allahabad (1765) was signed. As per the treaty East India Company got the Diwani of Bengal, Bihar and Odisha from Mughal emperor Shah Alam II who became protectee of company after this.

3. Who was the Commander-in-Chief of the English forces during the Buxar War?

- (a) Campbell (b) Holwell
(c) Munro (d) Neill
(e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. Assistant Audit Officer 2022

Ans. (c)

The Battle of Buxar was fought between 22 and 23 October 1764, between the forces under the command of the British East India Company, led by Hector Munro, and the combined armies of Balwant Singh (Raja of Benaras), Mir Qasim, Nawab of Bengal; Shuja-ud-Daula, the Nawab of Awadh; and Mughal Emperor Shah Alam II.

4. Who was appointed Deputy Diwan of Murshidabad by Robert Clive after the Allahabad Treaty?

- (a) Mohd. Raza Khan (b) Shitab Rai
(c) Rai Durlabh (d) Syed Ghulam Hussain

45th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (a)

According to the second Treaty of Allahabad (August, 1765), Mughal Emperor Shah Alam II was taken under the Company's protection and had to reside at Allahabad. Shah Alam II conferred Diwani (fiscal revenue collection authority) of Bengal, Bihar and Orissa to the Company by issuing 'Farman' on 12 August, 1765. In return, the company had to pay the emperor an annual sum of Rs 26 Lakhs as pension. At that time, the Company was neither interested in taking responsibility for tax revenue collection nor it was capable of doing so. Therefore, the Company appointed two Diwans- Mohammad Raza Khan for Bengal and Raja Shitab Rai for Bihar. Thus, all business of Diwani and Nizamat was conducted by Indians but authorized by the British Company.

5. The famous Battle of Wandiwash in 1760 was fought by the British against whom?

- (a) The French (b) Spain
(c) Mysore (d) Carnatic
(e) None of the above/ More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2020

Ans (a)

Battle of Wandiwash (January, 1760) :- It occurred between French and British. The French were defeated by the British. Sir Eyre Coote was the leader of the British Army while French Troops were led by Count de Lally.

6. Which city of Bihar was made capital in lieu of Murshidabad by Mir Qasim?

- (a) Patna (b) Darbhanga
(c) Sasaram (d) Munger
(e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. Assistant Audit Officer 2022

Ans. (d)

Mir Qasim was an efficient Nawab of Bengal. He transferred his capital from Murshidabad to Munger to secure himself from constant interference from Calcutta (British) and intrigues of Murshidabad.

Regional States : Punjab and Mysore

1. Lord Lytton is not associated with which of the following?

- (a) The Strachey Commission (b) The Arms Act
(c) The Vernacular Press Act (d) The Ilbert Bill

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (d)

Lord Lytton was an English politician who served as the Viceroy of India from 1876 to 1880. His tenure as Viceroy was marked by a controversial policy known as the Vernacular Press Act of 1878, which aimed to regulate the Indian vernacular press and limit its freedom of expression. The policies introduced included the Indian Arms Act of 1878, according to which, it was a criminal offense for Indians to carry arms without a license. The Act was discriminatory as it did not apply to the British, Anglo-Indians, Europeans, and certain government personnel. Famine Codes were given by the Famine Commission that was set up in 1878 under the Chairmanship of Sir Richard Strachey (Strachey Commission) during tenure of Lord Lytton only. The infamous 'Famine Codes', have been criticized for their handling of the 1876-1878 famine in India, which resulted in significant loss of life.

Ilbert bill on the other hand was introduced in 1883 by Lord Rippon that allowed Indian Judges and Magistrates to try British Offenders in criminal cases at district level.

2. Ranjeet Singh got famous Kohinoor diamond from-

- (a) Shah Shuja (b) Zaman Shah

- (c) Dost Mohammad (d) Sher Ali

41st B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (a)

Punjab was part the of Ahmad Shah Abdali's territory, but in 1773 A.D. after his death, most of the area of his empire was occupied by Sikh misls leaving Multan, Kashmir and some other smaller regions. Ranjit Singh got the opportunity to consolidate his empire as Afghans were engaged in internal fights. In 1803 AD, Shah Shuja (the grandson of Ahmad Shah Abdali) sat on the throne of Kabul but Shah Mahmud (brother of Shah Shuja) along with powerful Barekzay chieftain Fateh Khan and Dost Muhammad dethroned him and occupied Kashmir and Peshawar. On that occasion, Shah Shuja asked Ranjeet Singh for help and presented him Kohinoor Diamond.

3. Tipu Sultan set up his capital at –

- (a) Srirangapatnam (b) Mysore
(c) Bangalore (d) Coimbatore

38th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1992

Ans. (a)

Tipu Sultan set up his Capital at Srirangapatnam and was the founder member of 'Jacobin Club' and also planted "the tree of liberty" as a symbol of the alliance between France and Mysore in Srirangapatnam. He sent his delegates to maintain faithful relations with contemporary foreign states and get help against the British. He established embassies in foreign countries on the modern line.

4. Englishmen made the Treaty of Srirangapatnam with-

- (a) Hyder Ali (b) Dupleix
(c) Tipu Sultan (d) Nandraj

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (c)

Third Anglo-Mysore War (1790-92 A.D.) ended with the Treaty of Srirangapatnam (1792 A.D.). It was signed by Tipu Sultan and Cornwallis. According to the treaty, half of the territories of Tipu were snatched away from him and divided among Marathas, British, and Nizam. Tipu had to pay Rs. 3 crore as war indemnity to British as his two sons were kept hostage.

Governor/Governor General/Viceroy

1. Which of the following statements about Lord Mayo's Resolution of 1870 are correct?

1. It was the first step that bifurcated Central and Provincial finances.

2. **Provincial Governments were empowered to administer certain services.**
3. **It attempted to rectify existing imparity.**
4. **It focussed on the actual needs of the Provinces.**

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

- (a) Only 1 and 2 (b) Only 1, 3 and 4
(c) Only 2, 3 and 4 (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (d)

The Indian Council Act of 1861 implemented the strategy of legislative devolution, and the probable outcome of this was Mayo's Resolution of 1870, focusing on financial decentralization. The Imperial Government, prompted by administrative efficiency and financial constraints, opted to transfer the control of certain administrative departments - including education, medical services, and roads - to provincial governments. This marked the inception of local financial management. To ensure fiscal stability, provincial governments were granted the authority to rely on local taxation to balance their budgets. Lord Mayo's resolution had delineated - "Local interest, supervision, and care are necessary to success in the management of the funds devoted to education, sanitation, medical relief, and local public works. The operation of this resolution in its full meaning and integrity will afford opportunities for the development of self-government, for strengthening municipal institution, and for the association of Natives and Europeans to a greater extent than heretofore in the administration of affairs."

2. **Who was the first Governor General of India?**

- (a) Lord Mayo (b) Lord Lytton
(c) Lord Canning (d) Lord Dufferin
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. Re-Exam (Pre) 2020

Ans. (e)

By Charter Act of 1833 was an attempt by the British government to centralize the Indian administration. The Governor-General of Bengal was made governor-General of India by this Act. Lord William Bentick was appointed as a first Governor-General of India.

3. **In which year, first Census was introduced in India?**

- (a) 1872 (b) 1901
(c) 1911 (d) 1921
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Re-Exam) (Pre)-2021

Ans. (a)

The first census of the modern governance system during the British rule was done during the rule of Lord Mayo in 1872 A.D. but the serial assessment of the census. That is the first regular census in the year 1881 under the rule of Lord Ripon.

4. **Who said, "A single shelf of a good European library was worth the whole native literature of India and Arabia"?**

- (a) T.B. Macaulay (b) Dr. William Carey
(c) Lord Minto (d) Charles Grant
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2018

Ans. (a)

'A single shelf of a good European library was worth the whole native literature of India and Arabia' was told by T. B. Macauley who was critic against the orientalist methodology of reviving philosophy.

5. **Who among the following abolished 'Dual Government' system in Bengal ?**

- (a) Robert Clive (b) Lord Cornwallis
(c) Warren Hastings (d) None of the above

41st B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (c)

The court of directors decided in 1772 A.D. to abolish the dual government system in the tenure of Warren Hastings and ordered council of Calcutta and its chiefs to serve as Diwan and officiate the administration of Bengal, Bihar, and Orissa. Warren Hastings dismissed both the deputy Divans Muhammad Raza Khan and Raja Shitab Roy.

6. **The policy of 'Security Cell' is related to-**

- (a) Warren Hastings (b) Lord Dalhousie
(c) Henri Larins (d) Lord Hastings

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (a)

Warren Hastings and Wellesley were related to the security cell or Ring Fence policy. Warren Hastings waged war with Mysore and Marathas, in the spirit of achieving equal status with other Indian princely states. At this time the Company tried to form a buffer state around its state. Its purpose was only to protect our state or we can also say that protect the borders of our neighboring states so that our borders are safe. At that time the fear was mainly from Afghans and Marathas. Therefore, the Company took over the task of arranging the defence of Awadh on the condition that the Nawab of

Awadh should bear the burden of that expenditure and thus the defense of Awadh was the defense of Bengal. The arrival of Wellesley marked a change in the Company's relations with the Indian princely states. Wellesley's aimed to force the Indian princely states to depend on the Company for their defence. He tried to bring the Indian princely states under British political power and military protection. Following are the major British policies towards the princely states-

1. Company's struggle for equality with Indian princely states (1740–1765 A.D.)
2. 'Safety Cell' policy or Ring fence policy (1765-1813 A.D.)
3. Subordinate separation policy (1813-1857 A.D.)
4. Subordinate union policy (1858-1935 A.D.)
5. Policy of Union of Equals (1935-1947 A.D.)

7. **The dual system of governance in Bengal was enforced by :**

- (a) Warren Hastings
- (b) William Bentinck
- (c) Robert Clive
- (d) Lord Curzon
- (e) None of the above/ More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (c)

The system of dual government was introduced in Bengal by Robert Clive of British East India Company. It lasted from 1765 to 1772 A.D.

8. **Who is considered the Father of Diarchy?**

- (a) Lord Clive
- (b) Hector Munro
- (c) Lord Macaulay
- (d) Sir Lionel Curtis
- (e) None of the above / More than one of the above

64th B.P.S.C. (Pre)2018

Ans. (d)

Sir Lionel Curtis is considered the father of Diarchy. In this, the responsibility of Diwani and Wizarat (law and order) was separated.

9. **First Maratha Sardar to accept the subsidiary alliance of Lord Wellesley was-**

- (a) Peshwa Bajirao- II
- (b) Raghuji Bhosle
- (c) Daulat Rao Sciandia
- (d) None of the above

41st B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (a)

The subsidiary alliance system was introduced in India by Lord Wellesley. The main principles of a subsidiary alliance were –

1. An Indian ruler entering into a subsidiary alliance with the British had to accept British forces within his territory and also agree to pay for their maintenance.
2. The ruler would accept a British resident in his state.
3. An Indian ruler who entered into a subsidiary alliance would not enter into any further alliance with any other power.
4. The ruler would not employ any Europeans other than the British.
5. In case of a conflict with any other state, he would agree to the resolution decided by the British.
6. The ruler would acknowledge East India Company as the paramount power in India.
7. In return for the ruler accepting its conditions, the company undertook the protection of the state from external dangers and disorders.
8. If the Indian ruler failed to make the payments required by the alliance, then part of its territory was to be taken away as a penalty.

The Nizam of Hyderabad was the first to enter into such an alliance. The Nawab of Awadh was next to accept the alliance, and Maratha ruler Bajirao II (1802 A.D.) also accepted a subsidiary alliance. Several states like Hyderabad (1798 A.D.), Tanjore and Mysore (1799 A.D.), Awadh (1801 A.D.), Bhonsle (1803 A.D.), Sindhiya (1804 A.D.), Holkar (1818 A.D.) adopted this system.

10. **Under whose leadership was the suppression of Thugs achieved?**

- (a) Lord Clive
- (b) Captain Sleeman
- (c) Lord Minto
- (d) Alexander Burnes
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (b)

The thugs included the followers of both Hindu and Muslim religions. They used to worship Kali, Durga or Bhavani. They used to cut the head and offer it as a sacrifice in the feet of the goddess. Lord William appointed Captain Sleeman to take action against these thugs. He arrested 1562 thugs between 1826 to 1835 A.D., many of them were hanged, and rest of them were banished for a lifetime. By 1837 A.D., the organized thugs came to an end.

11. **Which of the following Princely States was not annexed by the British?**

- (a) Sind
- (b) Gwalior

- (c) Awadh (d) Satara
(e) None of the above/ More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C. (Pre.) 2017

Ans. (b)

The states annexed by the application of the Doctrine of Lapse under Lord Dalhousie were Satara (1848 A.D.), Jaitpur and Sambhalpur (1849 A.D.), Baghat (1850 A.D.), Udaipur (1852 A.D.), Jhansi (1854 A.D.) and Nagpur (1854 A.D.).

12. Sind was conquered and annexed by

- (a) Wellington (b) Sleeman
(c) Napier (d) Lawrence
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Re-Exam) (Pre) 2021

Ans. (c)

In 1843 A.D. after the Afghanistan war, British General Charles Napier merged Sindh with British India.

13. The first railway in India was laid down during the period of-

- (a) Lord Dalhousie (b) Lord Curzon
(c) Lord Wellesley (d) Lord Lytton

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (a)

The development of the railway line in India was an effective decision made by British Governor-General Lord Dalhousie. The first railway line was laid down from Mumbai to Thane in 1853 A.D. during the period of Lord Dalhousie. The main objective of the development of railways in India was to carry raw materials from internal parts of the country to the ports and carry army to remote areas, to crush the revolts.

14. Queen Victoria was appointed the Empress of India in –

- (a) 1858 (b) 1876
(c) 1877 (d) 1885

38th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1992

Ans. (c)

Queen Victoria was appointed the Empress of India in 1877 A.D.

15. The Viceroy who followed aggressive policy towards Afghanistan was

- (a) Lord Mayo
(b) Lord Lytton
(c) Lord Dufferin
(d) Lord Canning
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (b)

Lord Lytton, who remained Viceroy of India from 1876-1880 A.D. Whose aggressive policy of masterly inactivity towards Afghanistan was the result of second Anglo-Afghan War in 1878 A.D. He was criticized for his policy towards Afghanistan. This second Anglo-Afghan war fought during his tenure also proved to be very expensive.

16. Which among the following viceroy's period the title of 'Rai Bahadur' and 'Khan Bahadur' began to confer to Indian?

- (a) Lord Ripon (b) Lord Lytton
(c) Lord Mayo (d) Lord Dufferin
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (e)

During 1857 revolt, for suppressing the revolt native rulers Zamindars and other loyals were conferred with this title. There are shreds of evidence that this title was conferred in 1859 and 1860.

17. In 1902, Lord Curzon appointed the University Commission including two Indian members. Who were they?

- (a) Bal Gangadhar Tilak and Surendranath Banerjee
(b) Gopal Krishna Gokhale and Rashbehari Bose
(c) Syed Hussain Bilgrami and Surendranath Banerjee
(d) Syed Hussain Bilgrami & Justice Gurudas Banerjee
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. Re-Exam (Pre) 2020

Ans. (d)

The Indian University Commission was appointed in 1902 by the instruction of Lord Curzon. It was intended to make recommendations for the reforms in University education in India. The Commission was led by Law member Thomas Raleigh and included among its Indian members Syed Hussain Bilgrami & Justice Gurdas Banerjee.

18. In which year was the Indian Universities Act passed by Lord Curzon?

- (a) 1899 (b) 1901
(c) 1904 (d) 1906
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2018

Ans. (c)

The Indian Universities Act was passed in the year 1904 during the time of Lord Curzon. It was established by the recommendation of Releigh Commission.

19. Who established Imperial Cadet Corps?

- (a) Lord Minto (b) Lord Curzon
(c) Lord Lytton (d) Lord Ripon
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (b)

Imperial Cadet Corps was established after its approval from the Secretary of State for India in November 1901. It was formed under the direct surveillance of Lord Curzon. Major D.H. Cameron was its commandant and Maharaja Pratap Singh of Idar was made its honorary Commandant.

20. "In my belief, Congress is tottering to its fall and one of my great ambitions while in India is to assist it to a peaceful demise." Who wrote it?

- (a) Lord Lytton (b) Lord Dufferin
(c) Lord Curzon (d) Lord Minto
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (c)

Lord Curzon was full of missions, commissions and omissions. He refused to recognise India as a nation and insulted Indian nationalists by describing their activities as "Letting off of gas". In 1900 A.D. Curzon said- "My own belief is that the congress is tottering to its fall, and one of my great ambitions while in India is to assist it to a peaceful demise".

21. "The Muslims, if contented and satisfied, would become the greatest bulwark of British power in India." Who wrote it?

- (a) Herbert Risley (b) Lord Lytton
(c) W.W. Hunter (d) H.N. Brailsford
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (c)

W.W. Hunter, in his book 'The Indian Musalmans' wrote : "The Muslims, if contented and satisfied, would become the greatest bulwark of British power in India."

22. Who was the founder of Empire in India?

- (a) C. Sleman (b) Lord Minto
(c) Lord Clive (d) Lord Mayo
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. Re-Exam (Pre) 2020

Ans (c)

Robert Clive is widely considered the founder of British India. He arrived in Madras as a clerk for East India Company in 1744 A.D. Through his leadership he was able to consolidate Company's commercial & territorial position in India. In 1757 A.D. Company troops defeated nawab of Bengal in Plassey which led to the creation of British Raj in India.

23. Which Viceroy adopted an aggressive policy towards Afghanistan?

- (a) Lord Mayo (b) Lord Lytton
(c) Lord Dufferin (d) Lord Canning
(e) None of the above more than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (b)

In 1876 A.D., there was a change in the policy adopted towards Afghanistan when Lord Lytton came as Viceroy. In place of the policy of efficient indolence, progressive policy was being followed. In 1878, the Second Anglo-Afghan War started. In 1879 A.D., the treaty of Gandamak was done.

24. Who among the following said that "Congress is tottering to its fall and one of my great ambitions while in India is to assist it to a peaceful demise"?

- (a) Dufferin (b) Minto
(c) Curzon (d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

B.P.S.C. School Teacher (Class 9-10) 08-12-2023

Ans. (c)

Lord Curzon said that "Congress is tottering to its fall and one of my great ambitions while in India is to assist it to a peaceful demise". He was the Viceroy of India from 1899 to 1905.

Economic Impact of British

Rule on India

1. Who introduced the system of Mahalwari Settlement in Bengal?

- (a) Lord Hastings
(b) Lord Cornwallis
(c) Holt Mackenzie
(d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

68th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (c)

Mahalwari system was devised by Holt Mackenzie in 1822 in the Bengal Presidency. Under this system, the land revenue was collected from the farmers by treating whole village as a single unit called 'Mahal'. The revenue was not fixed but revised periodically.

(c) 1889

(d) 1900

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (a)

In 1793 A.D., Lord Cornwallis introduced permanent settlement which in turn provided many rights to landlords. By the 19th century, the demand for land increased and hence landlords increased the rent of the land which resulted in a revolt by peasants. During this time, the government of Bengal introduced the Bengal and Bihar Tenancy Act 1885, which described the rights of landlords and tenants.

2. Which compensation tax the indigo farmers were required to pay, if they desired exemption from indigo cultivation?

- (a) Batta (b) Jaziya
(c) Tawan (d) Nazrana
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2018

Ans. (c)

European planters holding thikadari leases from the big local zamindars forced the peasants to cultivate indigo on part of their Land at un- remunerative prices and by charging Sharahbeshi current enhancement) or Tawan (Lump sum Compensation) if the peasants wanted to be exempted from the obligation of the Indigo cultivation.

3. The 'Permanent Settlement' was made with –

- (a) Zamindars (b) Village communities
(c) Muqaddamas (d) Peasants

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (a)

The Permanent Settlement (1793 A.D.) introduced by Lord Cornwallis also known as Permanent Settlement of Bengal was an agreement between East India Company and Bengali Zamindars to fix revenues to be raised from the land.

4. Which one of the following is correct about the permanent settlement introduced in Bihar.

- (a) The Zamindars were deprived of the ownership of the land.
(b) The right of ownership of land was made hereditary and transferable for the Zamindars.
(c) Land revenue was constitutionalised
(d) Abolition of Zamindari

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (c)

In Bihar, the permanent settlement system ensured a fixed amount of revenue for the company.

5. Fill in the blank:

In the rights of the tenants on land in Bengal and Bihar were given by the Bengal Tenancy Act.

- (a) 1885 (b) 1886

6. The system, under which the peasant himself is the owner of the land and is held responsible for the payment of land revenue to the government is known as?

- (a) Zamindari system
(b) Ryotwari system
(c) Mahalwari system
(d) Dahsala system
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (b)

Under the Ryotwari system, the farmer himself is the owner of the land and the government is held responsible for the payment of land revenue.

7. The Ryotwari system was first implemented in –

- (a) Gujarat (b) Madras
(c) Bombay (d) Odisha
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (b)

The Ryotwari system was first implemented in Madras Presidency by Alexander Reed in 1792 A.D. in the Baramahal region of Tamil Nadu. This system was also implemented in Bombay Presidency. Thomas Munro is related to the Ryotwari system.

Revolt of 1857

1. When was the new Enfield Rifle with greased cartridges introduced in the British Indian Army?

- (a) November, 1856
(b) December, 1856
(c) January, 1857
(d) February, 1857

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (b)

The Company decided to use new Enfield Rifle instead of old Brown Bess gun in December, 1856. The training for the use of this rifle was organized in Dum Dum, Ambala, and Sialkot. The rifle needed an extraordinary kind of loading of a cartridge in the magazine and hence the soldiers while in the ensuing fight, had to bite off the outer covering of the cartridge while loading it down into the rifle's muzzle. The cartridge was rumoured to have been greased with animal fat (Pig fat and Cow fat). Army Commanders refused rumours without any cross-checking, but the soldiers were of the view that this was an intentional act of the British to besmirch their religion. This became the immediate cause first Independence Struggle of India in 1857.

2. Which of the following was not a reason for making the sepoys of the East India Company rebellious?

- (a) The efforts of the officers of the company to spread Christianity
- (b) The order to the sepoys to travel on ships
- (c) The stoppage of Bhatta
- (d) The inefficiency of the officers
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

64th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (d)

The inefficiency of the officers was not a cause for the sepoy Mutiny. The Indian Rebellion of 1857 occurred as a result of an accumulation of factors over time, rather than any single event, like an effort of officers to spread Christianity among the soldiers led to interference in the religious matters of the people. The order of the Company to the sepoys to travel on a ship was another reason as in Hinduism it was believed that travelling on the sea can devoid them of their religious status of being a Hindu. A more immediate cause of the sepoy's dissatisfaction was the recent order that they would not be given the foreign service allowance (Bhatta/Batta) when serving in Sindh or Punjab and rumours of the use of animal fat in the cartridges of the New Enfield Rifle.

3. Which of the following were the reasons for the failure of the Revolt of 1857?

- 1. The military superiority of the British
- 2. The rebels did not have a unified programme and ideology
- 3. There was a lack of support from all the sections of society

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

- (a) Only 1 and 2
- (b) Only 2 and 3

- (c) All of the above
- (d) None of the above

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

4. Where from the Revolution of 1857 started first?

- (a) Lucknow
- (b) Allahabad
- (c) Jhansi
- (d) Meerut
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. Re-Exam (Pre) 2020

Ans. (d)

The first war of Independence was started from Meerut. Sepoys refused to use the new rifle cartridges and revolted openly. They left Meerut and moved to Delhi. Major General William Hewitt had not tried to stop this rebellion. Lieutenant General George Dobson Precival Willoughby resisted, but he was defeated. Mughal Emperor Bahadur Shah Zafar was declared as Emperor of India. The success of Delhi revolt sensitized many parts of India and revolt spread over to the areas of Oudh (Awadh), Rohilkhand, Western Bihar, etc.

5. At Delhi, during the Revolt of 1857, the nominal and symbolic leadership belonged to the emperor Bahadur Shah, but the real command lay with a court of soldiers headed by

- (a) Nana Saheb
- (b) Bakht Khan
- (c) Hazrat Mahal
- (d) None of the above

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Ans. (b)

At Delhi, during the Revolt of 1857, the nominal and symbolic leadership belonged to the emperor Bahadur Shah, but the real command lay with a court of soldiers headed by General Bakht Khan.

6. Who was the English Officer-in- Charge of Delhi at the time of the Revolt of 1857?

- (a) General Hewett
- (b) Lieutenant Hodson
- (c) Lieutenant Willoughby
- (d) John Nicholson
- (e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. Auditor 2021

Ans. (e)

During the revolt of 1857, Bahadur Shah Zafar was the leader at Delhi. He was proclaimed Emperor of Hindustan on 11th May, 1857 by mutineers in Delhi. However Delhi was recaptured by 20 September, 1857 by General John Nicholson who also succumbed to his injuries on 23rd September, 1857. After that Lieutenant John Hodson captured the king and taken him as prisoner.

7. The first woman President of the Indian National Congress was

- (a) Sarojini Naidu (b) Annie Besant
- (c) Kasturba Gandhi (d) Aruna Asaf Ali
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (b)

Annie Besant was selected as the first woman president of the Indian National Congress in 1917.

8. Who was the first woman President of the Indian National Congress?

- (a) Kasturba Gandhi (b) Annie Besant
- (c) Kamala Nehru (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

B.P.S.C. School Teacher (Class 9-10) 07-12-2023

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

9. The female freedom fighter popularly known as the 'Grand Old Lady' of the Independence Movement was

- (a) Aruna Asaf Ali
- (b) Gulab Kaur
- (c) Bishni Devi Shah
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

B.P.S.C. PRT 2023 Shift I

Ans. (a)

Aruna Asaf Ali, popularly known as the Grand old lady of the Independence Movement was a fearless revolutionary from Punjab who played a significant role in the Quit India Movement.

10. Which of the following persons had participated actively in the Revolt of 1857?

- (a) Nana Saheb (Kanpur)
- (b) Begum Hazrat Mahal (Lucknow)
- (c) Maulavi Ahmadullah (Faizabad)
- (d) Begum Zeenat Mahal (Delhi)
- (e) None of the above/ More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (e)

1857 rebellion is also known as First War of Indian Independence. Most of the leaders & kings of that time participated in the war, like Rani Laxmi Bai of Jhansi, Tantia Tope, Nana Saheb of Kanpur, Begum Hazrat Mahal of Lucknow and many more.

11. The revolt of 1857 at Lucknow was led by :

- (a) Begum of Oudh (b) Taty Tope
- (c) Rani Lakshmibai (d) Nana Saheb

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (a)

The revolt was started on 30 May, 1857 in Oudh (Lucknow). The mutiny was led by Begum Hazrat Mahal. She crowned her minor son Birjis Qadir as royal heir and took charge of the affair of the state of Oudh. Later British General Campbell reannexed Lucknow with the help of Gorkha regiment on 21 March, 1858.

12. Where did Lord Sinha resign from the post of Governor in 1921?

- (a) Bihar-Odisha (b) Bengal
- (c) Punjab (d) Madras

53th to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (a)

Satyendra Prasanna Sinha was born on March 24, 1863 in Raipur, Birbhum, in Bengal Presidency. He was the first Indian to be appointed Advocate General of Bengal in the year 1905 A.D. He was the first Indian to be inducted as a legal member of the Viceroy's Council, Appointed as the Governor of Bihar and Orissa in the year 1920, the first Indian to hold a high post in the administration. Due to health reasons, he resigned from his post in the year 1921. He died on March 4, 1928.

13. Who spearheaded the 1857 Revolt in Bihar ?

- (a) Nana Saheb (b) Taty Tope
- (c) Kunwar Singh (d) Maulavi Ahmadullah
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (c)

Kunwar Singh was one of the most important freedom fighters in the Sepoy Mutiny of 1857. Kunwar Singh was born in Jagdishpur in the Shahabad (now in Bhojpur District) of Bihar. He belonged to Arrah in Bihar during the mutiny. When the people of all parts of India rose against British authority in 1857, Babu Kunwar Singh was nearly eighty years old. In that age, he fought against the English East India Company. Despite his age and failing health, Kunwar Singh plunged into the thick of it and battled against the British forces with grim determination and undaunted courage. In Bihar, Kunwar Singh was the Leader against the British. He assumed command of the soldiers who had revolted at Danapur on 25th July, 1857. Two days later he occupied Arrah, the district headquarters. Major Vincent Eyre relieved

the town on 3rd August, defeated Kunwar Singh's force and destroyed Jagdishpur. Kunwar Singh left his ancestral village and reached Lucknow in December 1857. In March 1858, he occupied Azamgarh. However, he had to leave the place soon. He was pursued by Brigadier Douglas, and he retreated towards his home in Bihar. On 23 April, 1858 Kunwar Singh had a victory near Jagdishpur over the force led by Captain Le Grand, but on 26 April, 1858 the following day he died in his village. The mantle of the old chief now fell on his brother Amar Singh who, despite heavy odds, continued the struggle and for a considerable time ran a parallel government in the district of Shahabad (Now Bhojpur). In October 1859 Amar Singh joined the rebel leaders in the Nepal Terai.

14. Where did Kunwar Singh join the Rebellion of 1857 against the British?

- (a) Arrah (b) Patna
(c) Bettiah (d) Varanasi
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

64th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (a)

According to BPSC the correct answer is option (b) which is wrong. For the detailed explanation refer to the above question.

15. Who said, "Wherever I am, there is Jagdishpur"?

- (a) Amar Singh (b) Jhansi ki Rani
(c) Kunwar Singh (d) General Lloyd
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2018

Ans. (c)

Kunwar Singh said "Wherever I am, there is Jagdishpur". He was a leader and military commander during the Indian Rebellion of 1857.

16. Who was the leader of revolutionaries in Bihar during the Revolt of 1857?

- (a) Namdar Khan (b) Babu Kunwar Singh
(c) Birsa Munda (d) Shankar Shah
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

17. Who led the Revolt of 1857 in Bihar?

- (a) Khan Bahadur Khan (b) Kunwar Singh

(c) Taty Tope

(d) Rani Ramkunvari

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

45th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

18. Who was the commander of the British army sent against Kunwar Singh during the 1857 Revolt?

- (a) General Hewitt (b) Sir Colin Campbell
(c) Sir Hugh Rose (d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

B.P.S.C. Headmaster 07-12-2023

Ans. (e)

The rebellion in Bihar was led by Babu Kunwar Singh. He was nearly 80 when he took charge of the sepoys who were placed at Danapur on 25th July, 1857. Singh and his troops laid an attack on the district headquarters at Arrah. He held the fort for 7 days when British Officer Major Vincent Eyre took Arrah back.

19. The Mutiny of 1857 at Patna was led by a dynamic old person known as:

- (a) Hyder Ali Khan (b) Rajput Kunwar Singh
(c) Judhar Singh (d) Kusal Singh

43rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (b)

The mutiny of 1857 at Patna was led by Zamindar Kunwar Singh. He lost his Zamindari due to British policies, as a result, he participated in 1857 revolt.

20. The centre of 1857 revolt in Bihar from 15th July, 1857 to 20th January, 1858 was:

- (a) Rampur (b) Hamirpur
(c) Dheerpur (d) Jagdishpur

43rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (d)

The centre of 1857 revolt was Jagdishpur in Bihar where Zamindar Kunwar Singh led and established his own government by deposing British Government. Bihar revolt was suppressed by Commissioner of Patna William Taylor and Major Vincent Eyer.

21. Which person of Jagdishpur took the lead of revolutionaries during the revolt of 1857 A.D.

- (a) Kunwar Singh (b) Chandra Shekhar

- (c) Tirath Singh (d) Ram Singh

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

22. The king of Jagdishpur was

- (a) Nana Saheb (b) Taty Tope
(c) Lakshmi Bai (d) Kunwar Singh

43rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of the above question.

23. One of the leaders of the Revolt of 1857 AD, Kunwar Singh was related to which place?

- (a) Gwalior (b) Jagdishpur
(c) Jhansi (d) Meerut
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

24. Who of the following was the bitterest enemy of the British during the Revolt of 1857?

- (a) Maulavi Ahmadullah Shah
(b) Maulavi Imadadullah
(c) Maulana Fazi-i-Haq Khairabadi
(d) Nawab Liaquat Ali

45th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (a)

Maulavi Ahmadullah Shah was the bitterest enemy of Britishers. He led the 1857 revolt in Faizabad. He was basically from Arkot (Tamil Nadu), but later he resided in Faizabad (Now Ayodhya). The British considered him a worthy enemy and a great warrior in following words "as a man of great abilities of undaunted courage, of stern determination and by far the best soldiers among the rebels".

25. The Revolt of 1857 was witnessed by the poet –

- (a) Mir Taqi Mir (b) Zauq
(c) Ghalib (d) Iqbal

45th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (c)

Mirza Ghalib was a poet who witnessed the revolt of 1857.

26. Which of the following groups did not participate in the revolt of 1857?

1. Agricultural Labour 2. Sahukar
3. Farmers 4. Landlords

Select your answer from the following codes :

- (a) Only 1 (b) 1 and 2
(c) Only 2 (d) 2 and 4

40th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (d)

The revolt of 1857 was widespread and this rebellion had the popular support of the public. But it was suppressed to a greater extent. It was spread in limited areas. The entire South India, Punjab and the territory towards its north and west Rajasthan, Gujarat and Madhya Pradesh remained out from the revolt. Many native rulers like the rulers of Patiala, Jind, Gwalior, Hyderabad, Sikhs of Punjab helped the British in suppressing the revolt by all possible means. The money lenders and merchants were also against the war as it was against their economic benefits. The educated Indians and the middle class also did not support the revolt. On the contrary, their feelings were against it.

27. The Phulka Rebellion of 1816 in Punjab was led by

- (a) Kharak Singh (b) Banda Singh Bahadur
(c) Bhagat Singh (d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

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Ans. (e)

None of the provided options accurately represent the leader of the Phulka Rebellion of 1816 in Punjab. As such option '(e) – None of the above ' is the correct answer.

28. Who among the following did not rebel against the British East India Company's control over them?

- (a) Raja of Vijayanagar
(b) Nizam of Hyderabad
(c) Polygar of Tamil Nadu
(d) Dewan Velu Thampi of Travancore
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

64th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (b)

All of the above (Raja of Vijayanagar, Polygar of Tamil Nadu and Dewan Velu Thampi of Travancore) except the Nizam of Hyderabad rebelled against the British East India Company's control over them.

29. Which part of Bihar was unaffected with the revolt of 1857?

- (i) Danapur (ii) Patna
(iii) Arrah (iv) Muzaffarpur
(v) Munger

Choose the correct answer from the code given below:

- (a) iv and v (b) Only v
(c) Only iv (d) iii, iv and v

41st B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (b)

Arrah, Danapur, Gaya, Patna, Muzaffarpur and Bhojpur were major centres of revolt in Bihar while the region of Munger was unaffected from the revolt of 1857.

30. Who was the Governor-General of India in 1857?

- (a) Wellesley (b) Dalhousie
(c) Canning (d) Minto

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (c)

Lord Canning was Governor General of India during 1857 revolt. Lord Canning was last Governor General of the Company in India and the first Viceroy appointed by British Crown. Indian High Court Act 1861 introduced judicial reforms and established High Court in Bombay, Calcutta, and Madras in the tenure of Canning. In the field of social, reform, Widow Remarriage Act, 1856 was passed during the tenure of Lord Canning.

31. What was the main cause of the failure of the revolt of 1857?

- (a) Lack of Hindu-Muslim unity
(b) Lack of common strategy and central organization
(c) Its effect was within a limited area
(d) Non-participations of Landlords

41st B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (b)

The revolt of 1857 failed due to lack of a common strategy and central organization. This was one of the major reasons of the failure of the revolt of 1857. All the groups participated in this revolt for their interests. There was no feeling of nationalism behind the mutiny and lack of clear vision.

32. Consider :

Assertion (A) : The first war of Independence in 1857 failed to secure freedom from the British Government.

Reason (R) : The leadership of Bahadur Shah Zafar did not have popular support and most of the Indian rulers of important States shied away from the struggle.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
(b) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
(c) (A) is true, and (R) is false.
(d) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (a)

Both (A) and (R) are true, and R is the correct explanation of A. There were various reasons for the failure of the First War of Independence in 1857, but the most important reason was the support of native kings of major territories to the British.

33. Who called the revolt of 1857 a conspiracy?

- (a) Sir James Outram and W. Taylor
(b) Sir John K.
(c) Sir John Lawrence
(d) T.R. Homes

40th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (a)

Sir James Outram and W. Taylor observed that the revolt of 1857 was the result of a Hindu-Muslim conspiracy. Outram observed that it was a Muslim conspiracy that took advantage of Hindu grievances. According to John Celey, it was a 'Sepoy Mutiny' while J.R. Holmes expressed that it was a conflict between civilization and barbarism.

34. When did Queen Victoria declare the taking over of Indian Administration under British crown?

- (a) 1 Nov. 1858 (b) 31 Dec. 1857
(c) 6 Jan. 1958 (d) 17 Nov. 1859

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (a)

In the aftermath of 1857 revolt, East India Company's rule ended in India and the reign was handed over to Queen Victoria by a proclamation announced on November 1, 1858. She assumed the responsibility of the Indian administration in her hand. Hence, the option (a) is correct.

35. Queen Victoria's Proclamation was issued on which of the following dates?

- (a) 1 November, 1857
(b) 27 March, 1858
(c) 1 November, 1858
(d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

B.P.S.C. School Teacher (Class 11-12) 15-12-2023

Ans. (c)

Queen Victoria's proclamation, made on Nov. 1, 1858 was a milestone in the history of modern India as it marked the end of British East India Company's Rule and the beginning of British Crown's administration in India. The Queen's proclamation is also known as "Magna Carta of the People of India".

36. Which one of the following commissions is associated with the Army Reorganization after the suppression of the Revolt of 1857?

- (a) Public Service Commission
- (b) Peel Commission
- (c) Hunter Commission
- (d) Simon Commission

45th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (b)

Peel Commission is associated with the army reorganization after the suppression of the Revolt of 1857.

37. After the revolt of 1857, the British recruited the Soldiers from the

- (a) Brahmins of U.P. & Bihar
- (b) Bengalis and Oriyas from the East
- (c) Gurkhas, Sikhs, and Punjabis in the North
- (d) Madras presidency and Marathas

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (c)

After the revolt of 1857, the British recruited the soldiers from the Gurkhas, Sikhs, and Punjabis in the North. In the enhancement of revolt of 1857, the soldiers from Uttar Pradesh and Bihar played an important role, so the British government became suspicious about them. During the revolt, 60% of soldiers of Bengal Army were from Oudh and north-west regions of Uttar Pradesh. The Indian army was responsible for mutiny 1857 and on 1 Nov 1858 Queen Victoria declared reorganisation of the army on the basis of separation and conflict policy.

38. Which of the following statement is correct?

- (a) In 1857 the Maharajas of Darbhanga, Dumraon and Hatwa and their fellow landlords helped the British with men and money
- (b) In 1857 the Maharajas of Darbhanga, Dumraon and Hatwa and their fellow landlords helped the British with men, not money
- (c) In 1857 the Maharajas of Darbhanga, Dumraon and Hatwa and their fellow landlords helped the British with money not from men

- (d) In 1857, the Maharajas of Darbhanga, Dumraon and Hatwa and their fellow landlords opposed the British.

B.P.S.C. 56th to 59th (Pre) 2015

Ans. (a)

In the freedom struggle of 1857, some prominent landlords of Bihar had given great help to the British both in terms of money and people. The landlords of Darbhanga, Dumraon and Hatwa were included in the landlords who provided this kind of help to the British.

39. The Uprising of 1857 was described as the 'First Indian War of Independence'?

- (a) V.D. Savarkar
- (b) Bal Gangadhar Tilak
- (c) R. C. Mazumdar
- (d) Dadabhai Naoroji
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (a)

V. D. Savarkar in his book 'Indian war of Independence 1857' termed the rebellion of 1857 as a planned freedom struggle / first Indian freedom struggle.

Other Civil Uprisings

1. The Tana Bhagat Movement, a nonviolent movement against British rule, originated among the tribal communities of which Indian State?

- (a) Uttar Pradesh
- (b) Kerala
- (c) Jharkhand
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

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Ans. (c)

Tana Bhagat Movement (1914-1920) was a movement in Chhotanagpur area of British India against the policies of the local British authorities and exploitative business practices of local zamindars, mostly by Oraon people. The Tana Bhagat movement was a transition period in which the background for the third phase of nationalist tribal movements in Jharkhand under Gandhian leadership was laid down.

2. The Indigo Rebellion was about:

- (a) the peasant not wanting to grow indigo but being forced
- (b) the peasant wanting to grow indigo but being forced not to
- (c) the peasant not wanting to grow indigo but being forced to grow at a price that was unacceptable
- (d) a protest movement that carried an indigo-coloured flag

(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

64th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (c)

The Indigo Revolt (1859-60 A.D.) took place in Bengal immediately after the revolt of 1857. **Sanyasi Rebellion** occurred in 1763-1800 A.D., **Santhal Rebellion** occurred in 1855-56 A.D., and **Pabna** uprising took place in 1873-76 A.D. Indigo Revolt began from Govindpur village of Nadia district in West Bengal led by two former employees of indigo producers. Digambar Viswas and Vishnu Viswas organized the peasants into a counterforce and refused to sow indigo. This indigo revolt of Bengal was directed against British planters who forced peasants to take advances and sign fraudulent contracts which forced the peasants to grow Indigo under terms that were least profitable to them. In September, 1859 all the cultivators revolted against the landlords. The agitation spread in regions like Nadia, Pabna, Khulna, Dhaka, Malda, Dinajpur, etc. All Indigo factories were shut down due to this strike. The intellectual class of Bengal expressed support to the Movement by their articles and rallies. The editor of "Hindu Patriot" Harishchandra Mukherjee played a significant role in this agitation. This revolt was vividly portrayed by Dinbandhu Mitra in his play Neel Darpan.

3. **Who wrote the play Neel Darpan describing the plight of the Indigo cultivators of Bengal and Bihar?**

- (a) Mahatma Gandhi (b) Acharya Kripalani
(c) Dinabandhu Mitra (d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

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Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

4. **Who is the author of 'Neel Darpan' a book written on the miserable condition of indigo farmers?**

- (a) Bankim Chandra Chatterji
(b) Dinbandhu Mitra
(c) Sharat Chandra Chatterji
(d) Rabindranath Tagore

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2020

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

5. **In which month of 1918 was the 'Champaran Agrarian Act' passed against the European indigo planters?**

- (a) February (b) May

(c) November

(d) More than one of the above

(e) None of the above

B.P.S.C. PRT 2023 Shift I

Ans. (e)

In 1918 was the Champaran Agrarian Act in Bihar and Odisha Legislative Council. The Scourge of Coercive Indigo plantation passed into history.

6. **Who was the most bitter critic of Sir Syed Ahmed Khan?**

- (a) Jamaluddin Afghani (b) C.F. Andrews
(c) Moulvi Zakaullah (d) Shibli Nomani
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2018

Ans. (a)

Jamaluddin Afghani was the most bitter critic of Sir Syed Ahmed Khan. Jamaluddin Afghani is one of the founders of Islamic Modernism as well as an advocate of Pan-Islamic Unity in India against the British.

7. **What was the purpose of Barhiyataal resistance in Munger?**

- (a) Demand of Bakast land restoration
(b) Muslim peasants may not be exploited
(c) Abolishment of Zamindari custom
(d) Beginning of class struggle

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (a)

The main purpose of Barhiyataal revolt was the demand for restoration of Bakasht Land.

8. **Kuka Movement was organized by –**

- (a) Guru Ram Das
(b) Guru Nanak
(c) Guru Ram Singh
(d) Guru Gobind Singh

45th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (c)

Kuka Movement was similar to the Wahabi Movement. Both movements began as religious revolt but converted into a political movement, which had a general ideology of removal of British rule from India. In Western Punjab, Kuka Movement was initiated by Bhagat Jawahar Mal in 1840s who was known as Sian Sahib. The origin of the Kuka Movement had its roots in the religious purification of the Sikhism. The leader of Kuka Movement, Ram Singh, was expelled to Rangoon in 1872 where he died in 1885.

9. Who founded the 'Pagal Panth'?

- (a) Bulleh Shah
- (b) Karam Shah
- (c) Yaduvendra Singh
- (d) Swami Shajananda

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (b)

The Pagalpanthi rebellion was indeed a rebellion of Garos Pagalpanth which was a quasi-religious community/sect which was introduced by Karam Shah of North Bengal. Son of Karam Shah and successor Titu Meer was inspired by religious and political purposes. Titu Meer and Shah led these people to uphold the religion and rights of the peasants in Bengal. He captured Sherpur in 1825 and became king. He appointed a judge, a magistrate and a collector to control administration.

10. Who were the Faraizis?

- (a) Followers of Haji Shariatullah
- (b) Followers of Dadu
- (c) Followers of the Arya Samaj
- (d) Followers of the Muslim League

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (a)

This sect was founded by Haji Shariatullah in Faridpur of Bengal. They advocated the radical changes in a religious, political and social phenomenon. Son of Haji Shariatullah, Dadu Miyan led the rebellion against British and this movement later merged with Wahabis after the death of Dadu Miyan.

11. Who began the 'Faraiji Movement'?

- (a) Haji Shariatullah
- (b) Syed Ahmed
- (c) Salimullah
- (d) M.A. Jinnah
- (e) None of the above / More than one of the above

64th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

12. Taiyuni Movement began in opposition of the Faraizi Movement at Dhaka in 1893 was started by

- (a) Syed Amir Ali of Calcutta
- (b) Sir Syed Ahmed of Aligarh
- (c) Hasan Imam of Patna
- (d) Keramat Ali of Jaunpur
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2018

Ans. (d)

Taiyuni Movement began in opposition to the Faraizi Movement at Dhaka in 1893 and was started by Keramat Ali of Jaunpur. Keramat Ali was a nineteenth-century Indian Muslim and Social reformer. He played a major role in propagating to the masses of Bengal and Assam.

13. Who founded Ramosi Krishak Jatha in Maharashtra?

- (a) Justice Ranade
- (b) Gopal Krishna Gokhale
- (c) Vasudeo Balwant Phadke
- (d) Jyotiba Phule

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (c)

Ramosi Krishak Jatha was founded by Vasudeo Balwant Phadke. He organised the people of Ramosi tribes and converted them into a combat force. He was arrested and sentenced to life and died in 1883 A.D. due to hunger strike against colonial rule in Kaala Pani.

14. The correct geographical location for the Ramosi Uprising was –

- (a) Western India
- (b) Eastern Ghats
- (c) Eastern India
- (d) Western Ghats

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (d)

The Ramosi hill tribes in the Western Ghats resented British rule and the British pattern of administration. In 1822, under Chittur Singh, they revolted and plundered the country around Satara. There were revolts again during 1825-26 and the area remained disturbed till 1831-32.

15. Trace the tribe that rebelled against Britishers because human sacrifice system was banned –

- (a) Kuki
- (b) Khond
- (c) Oraon
- (d) Naxda

40th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (b)

The Khond was an aboriginal tribe that was stretched from Bengal to Tamil Nadu covering central provinces. They revolted against-British from 1846 to 1855 A.D. The people of Khond tribe were led by Chakra Bisoi. The main reason for the revolt was stopping the Mariah system (traditional human sacrifice practised by Khonds), the introduction of the new taxes by the British Government rule, etc.

16. Kol Mutiny of 1831 under Buddho Bhagat took place in which of the following regions?

- (a) Kutch
- (b) Singhbhum

- (c) Western Ghats (d) Satara
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (b)

Kols are the inhabitants of Chhotanagpur. This area covered Ranchi, East and West Singhbhum, Hazaribagh, Palamu & western part of Manbhum. With the application of new land laws, outsiders like Hindu, Sikh, Muslim farmers & money lenders etc. started coming into these tribals' areas in 1831. This led to massive exploitation of tribes. In 1831, under the leadership of Buddho Bhagat, Kol rebels, revolted and killed about thousand outsiders, only after large-scale military operations order could be restored.

17. The Waghera Uprising happened in –

- (a) Surat (b) Poona
(c) Calicut (d) Baroda

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (d)

The Gaekwad of Baroda supported by the British Government compelled the Waghera Chief to take up arms. The Wagheras attacked British territory during 1818-19 A.D. A peace treaty concluded the revolt in November 1820.

18. When did Chhotanagpur Tribal Revolt occur?

- (a) 1807-1808 (b) 1820
(c) 1858-1859 (d) 1889

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (*)

There was no revolt named Chhotanagpur Tribal revolt. But there were many revolts at a different period like Chero revolt (1800), Kol revolt (1831-32), Santhal revolt (1855-56) and Munda revolt (1899-1900). If Ho revolt (1820-21) is considered then option (b) is the correct answer.

19. Who were the leaders of Santhal Revolt?

- (a) Jara Bhagat and Balaram Bhagat
(b) Sidhu and Kanhu
(c) Gauraks hni Bhagat and Keshav Chandra Roy
(d) Shambh math Pal and Korra Mallaya
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Re-Exam) (Pre) 2021

Ans. (b)

In the Santhal Rebellion in 1855-56, Sidhu, Kanhu, Chand, Bhairav etc. had a major role. The rebellious Santhals assembled and raised their arms against the British revenue system.

20. Who took the led the Santhal rebellion in 1855?

- (a) Sido and Kanhu
(b) Budhu Bhagat and Teja Bhagat
(c) Mulu Manek and Jodha Manek
(d) Madari Pasi and Sahdev
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

21. Which among the following year 'Santhal revolt' was occurred?

- (a) 1831-32 AD
(b) 1844-46 AD
(c) 1851-52 AD
(d) 1855-56 AD
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of the above question.

22. Which British Commander was defeated by the Santhals in 1855?

- (a) Captain Nek Feville (b) Lt. Bastain
(c) Major Burrough (d) Colonel White

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (c)

The rebels did not have many grievances against the 'Whites' or 'Sahibs.' Their main enemy was the 'Dikus' (government officers). Ten thousand Santhals assembled in the field of Bhognadih on 30th June, 1855, and unanimously passed a resolution to fight the corrupt Government officials, the "Dikus." The Dikus had betrayed them, forced them to slavery and abused their women; they had no choice but to fight them. They assembled under their leaders Sidhu, Kanu, Chand, Bhairav and pledged to fight till their independence. A small contingent of force under Major Burrough was called to suppress the rebels, but he met tremendous resistance and was defeated at Pirpainati. The victory of the Santhals over the almighty British further fuelled the rebellion and it spread like wildfire.

23. Mundas raised revolt in –

- (a) 1885 (b) 1888
(c) 1890 (d) 1895

45th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (*)

One of the prominent revolts of the nineteenth century in the Indian subcontinent was the Munda Rebellion. This rebellion was led by Birsa Munda in the South of Ranchi in the year 1899. Traditionally, the Mundas enjoyed the system known as the Khuntkatti which meant the original clearer of the forest. However, over time, the Mundas realized that this system of Khuntkatti was being corroded by the jaghirdars and thikedars who came as moneylenders and traders. In the year 1895, Birsa declared himself as the prophet. This movement was popularly known as Sardari Ladai because Munda Sardar struggled for their traditions for thirty years. Birsa Munda was arrested in 1900, and later died in jail.

24. Birsa Munda was considered by his followers as the incarnation of

- (a) Sing Bonga
- (b) Dharti Abba
- (c) Mago Manki
- (d) Bir Sing
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2018

Ans. (b)

Birsa Munda was an Indian tribal freedom fighter, who belonged to the Munda tribe and was behind the best known Millenarian Movement of Indian that rose in the tribal belt of Bihar and Jharkhand. He became a legend during his life-time and was called "Dharti Abba" (father of the earth) and was worshipped as 'Birsa Bhagwan'.

25. Ulgulan Revolt was related to –

- (a) Santhal
- (b) Kachha Nagh
- (c) Kol
- (d) Birsa Munda

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (d)

Munda Rebellion was one of the prominent 19th Century tribal rebellions in the subcontinent. Birsa Munda led this movement in the region south of Ranchi in 1899-1900. The Ulgulan, meaning 'Great Tumult,' sought to establish an independent Munda Raj. The Mundas traditionally enjoyed a preferential rent rate as the Khuntkatti or the original clearer of the forest. But in the course of the 19th century, they had seen this Khuntkatti land system being eroded by the jaghirdars and thikedars coming as merchants and moneylenders. In 1895, Birsa claiming to have seen a vision of God, proclaimed himself a prophet with miraculous healing powers. Thousands flocked to hear the 'new word' of Birsa with its prophecy of an imminent deluge. The new prophet became a critic of the traditional tribal customs, religious beliefs, and practices. He called upon the Mundas

to fight against superstition, give up animal sacrifice, stop taking intoxicants, to wear the sacred thread and retain the tribal tradition of worship in the Sarna or the sacred grove. It was essentially a revivalist movement, which sought to purge Munda society of all foreign elements and restore its pristine character. Christianity influenced the movement as well and it used both Hindu-Christian idioms to create the Munda ideology and worldview. When this rebellion reached its Peak in 1899 A.D., it was called the 'Ulgulan'. On Christmas Eve 1899, the Mundas shot arrows and tried to burn down Churches over an area covering six police stations in the districts of Ranchi and Singhbhum (Now East and West Singhbhum). Next, in January 1900, the police stations were targeted and there were rumours that Birsa's followers would attack Ranchi on 8th January, leading to panic there. However, on 9th January, the rebels were defeated. Birsa was captured and died in jail. Nearly 350 Mundas were put on trial, and three of them were hanged and 44 transported for life.

26. Who was the leader of Munda rebellion?

- (a) Birsa
- (b) Kanhu
- (c) Tilak Manjhi
- (d) Siddhu

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

27. Birsa Munda was in favour of

- (a) Jharkhand
- (b) Uttaranchal
- (c) Chhattisgarh
- (d) None of these

44th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (d)

One of the prominent revolts of the nineteenth century in the Indian subcontinent was the Munda Rebellion. This rebellion was led by Birsa Munda in Ranchi in the year 1899-1900. The "Great Tumult" aimed to establish independent Munda Raj but he was not in favour of the establishment of an individual state. There were two reasons for the revitalization of the movement. One was agrarian discontent and the other was the advent of Christianity. The movement aimed to reconstruct the tribal society from disintegration which was staring in its face due to the stress and strains of the colonial rule.

28. Who was the leader of Munda revolution of 1899-1900 AD?

- (a) Sidhu
- (b) Budha Bhagat
- (c) Birsa Munda
- (d) Shambhudan

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

29. Who was the leader of Munda Revolt?

- (a) Siddhu (b) Birsa
- (c) Kanhu (d) Tilka Manjhi
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. Re-Exam (Pre) 2020

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

30. Which was the working area of Birsa Munda?

- (a) Champaran (b) Ranchi
- (c) Balia (d) Alipur

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (b)

The working region of Birsa Munda was expanded from Ranchi to Bhagalpur. The major objectives of Birsa were to introduce social reforms in tribal and keep away from British Rule. Birsa criticized the traditional tribal customs, beliefs and practices. He encouraged the Mundas to fight against superstitions, renounce animal sacrifices, stop taking intoxicants, wear the sacred thread, and continue the traditional tribal worship in the sacred grove. The British crushed this great movement.

31. In which year the Chauri Revolt of Bihar took place?

- (a) 1832 (b) 1842
- (c) 1798 (d) 1784
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Re-Exam) (Pre) 2021

Ans. (e)

There is no mention of Chauri rebellion in Bihar in any certified source. Probably here the commission wants to ask about the 'Chuar Revolt'. It is known that the Chuar rebellion took place on a large scale in 1766-71, 1798-99 and 1832-33 in the then Bengal, Bihar (Present day West Bengal and Jharkhand). Thus the answer to this question can be option (a).

32. In which territory did tribals rebel against the British?

- (a) Bihar
- (b) Punjab
- (c) Sindh
- (d) Kathiawar
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

64th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (a)

The 'Munda' and 'Ho' tribes (1820-21 A.D.) of Chhotanagpur region (part of the Bihar) challenged the British army in 1831 A.D. The region was in a state of disharmony till 1837 A.D.

33. The Hoz revolt took place during –

- (a) 1620 - 21 (b) 1720 - 21
- (c) 1820 - 21 (d) 1920 - 21

43rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (c)

Hoz or Ho revolt took place in 1820-21 the centre of which was located in Santhal Pargana of Jharkhand.

34. The Moplah Rebellion of 1921 broke out in -

- (a) Assam (b) Kerala
- (c) Punjab (d) Bengal
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (b)

Moplah revolt occurred in 1921 in Malabar of Kerala. Pabna revolt from 1873-76 in Bengal, Eka movement in 1921-22 in Oudh (Awadh) and Munda Rebellion under Birsa Munda took place in 1899-1900 in Bihar (now Jharkhand).

35. The immediate cause of the Deccan Riots of 1875 was:

- (a) The shadow of a famine
- (b) High interest rates charged by Mahajans
- (c) High land revenue rates
- (d) Protest against imposition
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

64th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (e)

The immediate cause of the Deccan Riots of 1875 was the shadow of famine and high interest rate charged by Mahajans.

36. Moplah revolt of 1921 took place in:

- (a) Kashmir
- (b) Punjab
- (c) Kerala
- (d) Assam

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (c)

Moplah revolt occurred in the Malabar region of Kerala in 1921. Most of the local tenants were Muslims while landlords were Hindu. The movement was against the exploitations of landlords.

Development of Education in Modern India

1. Consider the following statements regarding Wood's Dispatch of 1854 :

1. It recommended English as the medium of instruction for higher studies.
2. It laid stress on female education and vocational training.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) Only 1 (b) Only 2
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (c)

Wood's Dispatch was issued on 19 July, 1854 with Sir Charles Wood as the President of the Board of Control. It recommended English as the medium of instruction for higher studies and also emphasised the government should support education for women.

2. In which year Mohammedan Anglo-Oriental College at Aligarh was established?

- (a) 1870 (b) 1880
(c) 1890 (d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

B.P.S.C. School Teacher (Class 9-10) 07-12-2023

Ans. (e)

In 1877, Sir Syed Founded the Muhammadan Anglo-Oriental College in Aligarh and patterned the college after Oxford and Cambridge University which he had visited on a trip to England. It was one of the first purely residential educational institutions set up either by the government or the public in India. By 1920, the college was transformed into the Aligarh Muslim University.

3. When was the National Council of Education established?

- (a) 15th August, 1903 (b) 15th August, 1904
(c) 15th August, 1905 (d) 15th August, 1906

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (d)

The citizens of Rangpur held a conference on 16 November, 1905. In 1905, the Rangpur National School was started with the objective of imparting indigenous education both general and technical to Indians. The birth of the National school sparked off the movement culminating in the formation of the National Council of Education (NCE) Bengal on 15th August, 1906.

4. When did the British Government appoint Sadler University Commission for reforms in education :

- (a) 1919 (b) 1917
(c) 1921 (d) 1896

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (b)

Sadler Commission (Calcutta University Commission) was related to education. In 1917, the Government of India appointed a commission to study and report on the problems of Calcutta University. Dr. M.E. Sadler, Vice-Chancellor of the University of Leeds, was appointed its Chairman. The commission included two Indian members, namely Sir Ashutosh Mukherjee and Dr. Zia-ud-din Ahmad. The Sadler Commission held the view that the improvement of secondary education was a necessary condition for the improvement of University education. It strongly criticized the University Act, 1904 and reported that there is no proper coordination between colleges and universities.

5. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

- (a) Raja Rammohan Roy was the pioneer of modern education.
(b) Swami Dayanand proclaimed India for Indians.
(c) Vivekananda participated in the Parliament of World Religions.
(d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

B.P.S.C. School Teacher (Class 11-12) 15-12-2023

Ans. (d)

Raja Rammohan Roy made outstanding contributions to India's educational system. Many English-language schools were established by him to reform the educational system. Arya Samaj movement for instilling pride of their religion and self confidence in themselves, paved way for the rise of a national movement against the British rule in India. Mrs. Annie Besant of the Theosophical Society said, "It was Dayanand Saraswati who first proclaimed that India was for the Indians". Swami Vivekananda is best known in the United States for his groundbreaking speech to the 1893 World's Parliament of Religions in which he introduced Hinduism to America and called for religious tolerance and an end to fanaticism. Hence, option (d) is the correct answer.

6. Which of the following Indians qualified Indian Civil Service Exam for the first time in 1863?

- (a) Debendranath Thakur
(b) Satyendranath Thakur
(c) Surendranath Banerjee

- (d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

B.P.S.C. School Teacher (Class 9-10) 07-12-2023

Ans. (b)

In 1864, the first Indian, Shri Satyendra Nath Tagore (also spelled as Thakur) brother of Shri Rabindranath Tagore qualified the Indian Civil Service Exam. A Civil Service Commission was set up in 1854 in London and competitive examinations were started in 1855.

7. In 1890, the first woman graduate of Calcutta University, addressed the Congress session was

- (a) Kadambini Ganguly (b) Sarojini Naidu
(c) Annie Besant (d) None of the above

BPSC Agriculture Department-2024

Ans. (a)

In 1890, Kadambini Ganguly, the first woman graduate of Calcutta University, addressed the Congress session, which symbolised the commitment of the freedom struggle to give the women of India their due status in national life.

8. The spiritual side of nationalism was voiced by–

- (a) Raja Ram Mohan Roy
(b) Swami Shraddhanand
(c) Swami Vivekananda
(d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

BPSC (Tre-3) {Class 9-10}–2024

Ans. (c)

Swami Vivekananda's nationalism is associated with spiritualism. He linked India's regeneration to her age-old tradition of spiritual goal. His Nationalism is based on Humanism and Universalism the two cardinal features of Indian Spritual Culture. He taught people to get rid first of self-inflicted bondage and resultant miseries.

9. National Library of India started its journey with the opening of–

- (a) Calcutta Public Library in March 1838
(b) Calcutta Public Library in March 1837
(c) Calcutta Public Library in March 1836
(d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

BPSC (Tre-3) {Class 6-8}–2024

Ans. (c)

National Library was accorded a special status of an Institution of National Importance in the Article 62 in the 7th Schedule of the Constitution of India and was opened to Public on 1st February 1953. The Origins of the National Library, Kolkata begins with the establishment of Calcutta Public Library on 21st March 1836.

Development of Press in Modern India

1. Who founded the newspaper “ The Hindu” in 1878, which became influential in shaping public opinion during the Indian national movement?

- (a) Viraraghavachariar (b) G. Subramania Iyer
(c) Mahatma Gandhi (d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

BPSC (Tre-3) {Class 6-8}–2024

Ans. (b)

The Hindu newspaper was founded in 1878 by G. Subramania Iyer in Chennai (then Madras), India. The newspaper played a significant role in shaping public opinion during the Indian National Movement, as it provided a platform for discussions and debates on issues related to the independence struggle.

2. Who was related to the publishing of a weekly Hindi journal, Hunkar ?

- (a) Yamuna Karjee (b) Rahul Sankrityayan
(c) Sahajanand Saraswati (d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

B.P.S.C. PRT 2023 Shift I

Ans. (c)

Hunkar was the weekly Hindi journal was published by Swami Sahajanand Saraswati. It was published in 1940. Hunkar later became the mouthpiece of the peasant movement and the agrarian movement in Bihar.

3. Who among the following repealed the Vernacular Press Act of 1878?

- (a) Lord Ripon (b) Lord Lytton
(c) Lord Curzon (d) Lord Minto

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (a)

Lord Lytton (1876-1880 A.D.) passed the Vernacular Press Act in 1878 A.D. By this Act, the Magistrate of the districts was empowered without the prior permission of the Government to call upon a publisher of any kind to enter into a bond, undertaking not to publish anything which might “rouse” feelings of disaffection against the Government. The Magistrate was also authorized to deposit security, which could be confiscated if the publisher violated the bond. If a publisher repeated the violation, their press could be seized. Thus, the Vernacular Press Act of 1878 gagged the press and the result was some proceedings against some vernacular press people. There was a popular protest against this Act. This Act was later repealed by Lord Ripon in 1882 A.D.

4. Which of the following statements about the Vernacular Press Act is/are correct?

1. It was enacted by Lord Lytton.
2. It came to be known as a 'Gagging Act'.
3. The Act was repealed by Lord Ripon.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

- (a) Only 1 and 2 (b) Only 2 and 3
(c) Only 1 (d) 1, 2 and 3

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of the above question.

5. Who in America started to issue newspaper 'The Free Hindustan'?

- (a) Ram Nath Puri (b) G.D. Kumar
(c) Lala Hardayal (d) Tarak Nath Das

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (d)

Tarak Nath Das started to issue the newspaper 'The Free Hindustan' in America.

6. Who founded the 'Amrit Bazar Patrika'?

- (a) Harish Chandra Mukherjee
(b) S.N. Banerjee
(c) Girish Chandra Ghosh
(d) Shishir Kumar Ghose

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005
B.P.S.C. Auditor 2021

Ans. (d)

Shishir Kumar Ghose founded 'Amrit Bazar Patrika' in 1868 A.D. in Calcutta. It was primarily published in the Bengali language. In 1878, it was converted to English to avoid the Native Language Press Act (Vernacular Press Act). Girish Chandra Ghosh started publishing 'Bengali' in 1862 which was overtaken by S.N. Banerjee in 1879. 'Hindoo Patriot' was also started by Girish Chandra Ghosh. Later Harishchandra Mukherjee became its editor.

7. Which of the following papers was essentially the mouthpiece of the policies of liberals?

- (a) New India (b) Leader
(c) Young India (d) Free Press Journal

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (b)

'Free Press Journal' was a news agency. Young India was published by M.K. Gandhi. Liberals used to preach their policies through a newspaper named 'Leader.' New India was published by Annie Besant.

8. Which journal was not associated with revolutionary activities?

- (a) Sandhya (b) Yugantar
(c) Gadar (d) Young India
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (d)

Young India was not associated with revolutionary activities. Young India was a journal published by Mahatma Gandhi. He used young India to spread his unique ideology and thoughts regarding the use of non-violence. Ghadar (Gadar) was a weekly newspaper published by a revolutionary group (Ghadar Party) with its headquarters at San- Francisco. The newspapers and journals advocating revolutionary terrorism included Sandhya and Yugantar in Bengal, and Kal in Maharashtra.

9. Which of the following newspapers used to be published from Patna?

- (a) Indian Nation
(b) Punjab Kesari
(c) Prabhakar
(d) Dawn

45th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (a)

The King of Darbhanga, Kameshwar Singh founded 'The Indian Nation' published from Patna in 1931 A.D.

10. From the options given below, find the correct combination of the names of editors of the nationalist newspapers The Hindu, Kesari, Bengalee, Hindustani, Sudharak:

- (a) Surendra Nath Banerjee, G. Subramania Iyer, Bal Gangadhar Tilak, Ganga Prasad Verma, Gopal Krishna Gokhale
(b) Bal Gangadhar Tilak, G. Subramania Iyer, Surendra Nath Banerjee, Ganga Prasad Verma, Gopal Krishna Gokhale
(c) G. Subramania Iyer, Bal Gangadhar Tilak, Ganga Prasad Verma, Gopal Krishna Gokhale, Surendra Nath Banerjee
(d) G. Subramania Iyer, Bal Gangadhar Tilak, Surendra Nath Banerjee, Ganga Prasad Verma, Gopal Krishna Gokhale
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

64th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (d)

Newspaper	Editor
The Hindu	G. Subramania Iyer
Kesari	Bal Gangadhar Tilak
Bengalee	Surendranath Banerjee
Hindustani	Ganga Prasad Verma
Sudharak	Gopal Krishna Gokhale

11. Which of the following was not a 'nationalist' newspaper?

- (a) The Hindu (b) Bengalee
(c) The Mahratta (d) The Times of India
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

64th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (d)

'The Times of India' was not a nationalist newspaper. 'The Hindu,' 'Bengalee' and 'The Mahratta' were nationalist newspapers as they promoted nationalism through their writings.

12. The nationalist daily newspaper, The Indian Nation started its publication in

- (a) 1930 (b) 1931
(c) 1940 (d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

B.P.S.C. School Teacher (Class 6-8) 10-12-2023

Ans. (b)

The nationalist daily newspaper, The Indian Nation started its publication in 1931.

13. Which newspaper propagated strong nationalist views during India's freedom struggle?

- (a) Pioneer (b) Amrit Bazar Patrika
(c) Statesman (d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

BPSC (Tre-3) {Class 9-10}-2024

Ans. (b)

The rise of Indian Nationalist movement was accompanied by the Flowering of the Vernacular press which acted as a national servant, propagator, and weapon for the liberation of the country from British.

The press acted as an effective medium that helped share common ideas and ideologies with the masses. The most powerful newspaper that emerged for the propagation of national awakening against Colonial Rule were, Sudharak, Kesari, Maratha, Navjeevan, Swadeshmitran, Amrit Bazar Patrika, Hindustan, Mathurabhumi and many others.

Socio-Religious Movements

1. Which category of population was primarily attracted by Religious reform movements of the nineteenth century?

- (i) Intellectuals (ii) Urban upper castes
(iii) Poor ordinariness class (iv) Liberal princes

Choose your answer from given code :

- (a) Only i (b) i and ii
(c) i, ii and iii (d) i, ii and iv

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (d)

19th century religious and social reforms movement has a special place in the modern history of India. The movement mostly affected the intellectuals and the middle-class people. Poor ordinary classes were almost out of these movements. Intellectuals, urban upper castes, and liberal princes were mostly affected by this movement.

2. Who was the father of the Indian Renaissance movement?

- (a) Bal Gangadhar Tilak (b) Dayanand Saraswati
(c) Shradhdhanand (d) Raja Ram Mohan Roy

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (d)

Raja Ram Mohan Roy was the first Indian who started a movement against prevailing evils in the Indian society. Due to his innovative ideas, the nineteenth century of India saw the emergence of the Renaissance. Raja Ram Mohan Roy was also known as 'Father of the Indian Renaissance', 'Paigambar of Indian Nationalism,' 'Bridge between past and future,' 'Father of Modern India,' 'First Modern Man' and 'Yugadoot.'

3. Who among the following was the founder of Atmiya Sabha?

- (a) Raja Ram Mohan Roy (b) Swami Dayanand Saraswati
(c) Swami Vivekanand (d) Aurobindo Ghosh

41st B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (a)

In 1815 A.D., Raja Ram Mohan Roy founded Atmiya Sabha to propagate monotheistic Hindu religion. It tried to initiate social and religious reforms in society. Raja Ram Mohan Roy also founded the Brahmo Sabha, an important socio-religious reform movement in Bengal in 1828 A.D., later known as 'Brahmo Samaj.' Devendranath Tagore founded 'Tatvabodhini Sabha' in 1839 A.D. to propagate the ideas of Raja Ram Mohan Roy. 'Atmiya Sabha' was the first society founded by Raja Ram Mohan Roy.

4. **Brahmo Samaj was founded in the year of-**

- (a) 1827
- (b) 1829
- (c) 1831
- (d) 1843

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

41st B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (*)

Raja Ram Mohan Roy founded Brahmo Sabha on August 20, 1828, which was later called Brahmo Samaj. This society denied idolatry and preached universal worship. It was a community of people who believed in the unity of God and lived apart from idolatry. There was no place for social customs and rituals in this new religion. Brahmo Samaj emphasized humanity without considering the colour and character of the people.

5. **The best representative of Neo-Hindustan in the second half of the nineteenth century was –**

- (a) Ramkrishna Paramhans
- (b) Swami Vivekanand
- (c) Bankim Chandra Chatterji
- (d) Raja Ram Mohan Roy

41st B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (b)

Swami Vivekanand (1863-1902) was credited with interpreting the teachings of Ramakrishna Paramhans. He described these teachings in simple language. Swami Vivekananda emerged as the advocate of Neo-Hinduism. In 1893, he went to Chicago, where he delivered his famous speech in 'World Parliament of Religions.' In his speech, Vivekanand gave a short introduction of Hinduism and spoke on "The meaning of the Hindu religion." After that, he visited America and England and promoted Hinduism. According to him, the Hindu religion was restricted up to food only. He was quite displeased with the silence of religion on the exploitation of the poor by the wealthy. Vivekanand never used to give political messages but still he brought the spirit of self-dignity among the new generation through his articles and speeches. He was a staunch patriot. Subhas Chandra Bose said about him, 'so far as Bengal is concerned, Swami Vivekananda may be regarded as the spiritual father of the modern nationalist movement'.

6. **Who among the following participated in the parliament of Religions held at Chicago in 1893?**

- (a) Dayananda Saraswati
- (b) Swami Vivekananda

(c) Mahatma Gandhi

(d) Raja Ram Mohan Roy

(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

7. **Swami Vivekananda established Ramakrishna Mission in the year:**

- (a) 1861
- (b) 1891
- (c) 1893
- (d) 1897

41st B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (d)

Ramakrishna Mission was founded in the year 1897 A.D. in the name of Sri Ramakrishna Paramhansa, by his illustrious disciple Swami Vivekananda (1863-1902) with the twin ideals "For one's liberation and the welfare of the world at large" with its Headquarters at Belur in Howrah (West Bengal) and Khatyari in Almora (Uttarakhand). It conducted various socio-religious activities through its branches spread all over the world in various fields such as education, health, the welfare of the poor, relief and rehabilitation, arts and culture, morality, ethics and spirituality irrespective of caste, creed and religion. It was the last famous religious movement of nineteenth century which aimed at the harmony of religions, harmony of the East and the West, harmony of the ancient and the modern, spiritual fulfillment, all-round development of human faculties, social equality and peace for all humanity without any distinctions of creed, caste, race or nationality.

8. **Who was Sharadamani?**

- (a) Wife of Raja Ram Mohan Roy
- (b) Wife of Ramakrishna Paramahansa
- (c) Mother of Vivekananda
- (d) Daughter of Keshab Chandra Sen.

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (b)

Sharadmani Mukhopadhyaya, who is also known as Sharada Devi, was married to Ramkrishna Paramhansa at the early age of five in 1859 A.D.

9. **Dayanand Saraswati founded –**

- (a) Brahmo Samaj
- (b) Arya Samaj
- (c) Prarthana Samaj
- (d) Bahujan Samaj

43rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (b)

Swami Dayanand Saraswati founded the Arya Samaj (an organization) on April, 1875, in Mumbai with the aim to promote noble ideas which were universally true for all mankind. In 1877, the headquarter of Arya Samaj was established in Lahore. The Arya Samaj advocate peaceful and progressive human living. Swami used Arya Samaj as a platform to launch his campaign against social evils that were prevalent in Hindu society at that time. Swami Dayanand Saraswati opposed many oppressed practices of Hindu tradition and insisted upon 'let's go back to Vedas.' He worked for abolishing several social stigmas such as child marriage and casteism.

10. Who established the 'Arya Samaj'?

- (a) Ranade (b) Dayanand
- (c) Dayananda Saraswati (d) Swami Vivekananda
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. Re-Exam (Pre) 2020

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

11. Who among the following gave the slogan, 'India for the Indians'?

- (a) Swami Vivekananda
- (b) Swami Dayananda Saraswati
- (c) Pt. Ishwar Chandra
- (d) H.N. Kunzru
- (e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. Assistant Audit Officer 2022

Ans. (b)

Swami Dayanand Saraswati believed that Britishers were deliberately trying to submerge Indian national identity in the ideas of British culture. That is why he said 'India for Indians'.

12. 'Satyarth Prakash' was written by –

- (a) Raja Ram Mohan Roy
- (b) Mahatma Gandhi
- (c) Swami Vivekanand
- (d) Swami Dayanand Saraswati

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (d)

The Satyarth Prakash (The Light of Truth) is the masterpiece of Swami Dayanand Saraswati written in 1875 A.D. Some call it Magnum Opus. Swami Dayanand Saraswati's original name was Mool Shankar Tiwari. He was born in 1824 in Tankara, Gujarat in a rich Brahmin family. Arya Samaj is .

a Hindu reform movement, founded by Swami Dayanand Saraswati in the year 1875. Swami Dayanand had unfurled the flag in 1867 known as 'Pakhand Khandini Pataka' on the bank of Ganga River to enlighten the common man against the superstitions and other bad rituals that were prevailing at that time. He denied the authenticity of Puranas as he believed that they were responsible for idolatry in Hinduism

13. Identify the correct combination from the options given below for Prarthana Samaj, Young India, Lokahitavadi, Satyashodhak Samaj, Rehnumai Mazdayasan Sabha:

- (a) Gopal Hari Deshmukh, Atmaram Pandurang, Mohandas Karamchand Gandhi, Jyotiba Phule, Naoroji Furdunji.
- (b) Atmaram Pandurang, Mohandas Karamchand Gandhi, Gopal Hari Deshmukh, Jyotiba Phule, Naoroji Furdunji
- (c) Atmaram Pandurang, Jyotiba Phule, Mohandas Karamchand Gandhi, Gopal Hari Deshmukh, Naoroji Furdunji.
- (d) Naoroji Furdunji, Atmaram Pandurang, Mohandas Karamchand Gandhi, Gopal Hari Deshmukh, Jyotiba Phule.
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

64th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (b)

Prarthana Samaj was a movement for religious and social reform in Bombay based on earlier reforms movements. It was founded by Atmaram Pandurang in 1867. Young India was a weekly paper or journal in English published by Mohandas Karamchand Gandhi.

Gopal Hari Deshmukh was an Indian activist, thinker, social reformer and writer from Maharashtra. He was popularly known as Lokahitvadi.

Satya Shodhak Samaj was founded by Jyotiba Phule in Pune in 1873.

Rehnumai Mazdayasan Sabha started in 1851 by Naoroji Furdunji and others was a Parsi religious Reform Association.

14. Who was the founder of 'Prarthana Samaj'?

- (a) Atmaram Panduranga (b) Tilak
- (c) Annie Besant (d) Rasbihari Ghose

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

15. Which social reformer was called Lokhitwadi?

- (a) M. G. Ranade (b) G. K. Gokhale
(c) G. H. Deshmukh (d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

B.P.S.C. School Teacher (Class 9-10) 07-12-2023

Ans. (c)

Gopal Hari Deshmukh, also known as 'Lokhitawadi', was a writer and social reformer from Maharashtra. Deshmukh began writing articles aimed at social reform in Maharashtra, under the name 'Lokhitawadi' for the weekly Prabhakar. He took a leadership role in founding Gyan Prakash, Indu Prakash and Lokhitwadi periodicals in Maharashtra.

16. In 1873 who founded Satya Shodhak Samaj?

- (a) Gopal Krishna Gokhale (b) Jyotiba Phule
(c) Shiv Nath Shastri (d) None of the above

40th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (b)

Satya Shodhak Samaj was founded by Jyotiba Phule in 1873 A.D. He was born in 1827 A.D. He operated a powerful movement of non-Brahmins. The main objectives of the Samaj were to redeem the Shudras from the influence of Brahmanical scriptures and make them conscious of their human rights and liberate them from mental and religious slavery. He also wrote a book 'Gulamgiri' published in 1873 A.D.

17. 'Satya Shodhak Samaj' was founded by

- (a) Dayanand Saraswati
(b) Jyotiba Phule
(c) Gandhiji
(d) Dr. Baba Saheb Ambedkar
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

18. Who declared 'Sati' illegal?

- (a) Warren Hastings (b) William Bentinck
(c) Cornwallis (d) Curzon
(e) None of the above/ More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C. (Pre.) 2017

Ans. (b)

Raja Ram Mohan Roy strongly opposed Sati system. He appealed to William Bentinck, then Governor General of Bengal to ban sati practice in British India and Sati System was banned under provision 17 rule of The Bengal sati regulation 1829, and ordered the court to file a case as culpable Homicide and punish them.

19. When was the Prohibition of Sati Act passed in India?

- (a) 1828 (b) 1829
(c) 1831 (d) 1836
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

64th B.P.S.C. CDPO 2018

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

20. Which of the following inscriptions mentions the instance of widow - burning?

- (a) Eran Stone Inscription of Samudragupta
(b) Eran Pillar Inscription of Budhagupta
(c) Eran Pillar Inscription of Bhanugupta
(d) Eran Boar Inscription of Toramana
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

64th B.P.S.C. CDPO 2018

Ans. (c)

The first epigraphic evidence of Sati has been found in the Eran Pillar Inscription of Bhanugupta, Madhya Pradesh.

21. Which of the following were the social reforms introduced by William Bentinck?

1. Abolition of Sati
2. Abolition of slavery
3. Removal of disabilities due to change of religion
4. Suppression of the organized bands of Thugs.

Choose the correct answer from the codes given below.

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 1, 3 and 4 only
(c) 1, 2 and 4 only (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Re-Exam) (Pre)-2021

Ans. (e)

Lord William Bentinck became the Governor General of Bengal presidency in 1828 AD. He became the Governor General of India in 1834 A.D. In 1829, he declared the 'Practice of Sati' as a crime and abolished it. Bentick tried to suppress them by running a campaign against the gang of thugs. Bentick also worked on education and freedom of the press. In 1835 he returned to England. Slavery was abolished in India in 1843 A.D. and the provision of disqualification due to change of religion was abolished in 1850 A.D. Hence statements (1) and (4) are correct so option (e) will be the answer.

22. Who is credited with the suppression of Thugs in India?

- (a) Earl of Dalhousie (b) Charles Metcalfe
(c) W.T. Denison (d) W.H. Sleeman

(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2018

Ans. (d)

In Suppression of Thugs, along with William Bentinck, one more name is cherished. This able officer was William Henry Sleeman. Initially he was a soldier and later became the administrator. In 1835 the 'Thuggee and Dacority Dept' was created by William Bentinck and William Henry Sleeman was made its Superintendent.

23. Who founded the 'Theosophical Society'?

- (a) Madame H.P. Blavatsky
- (b) Raja Ram Mohan Roy
- (c) Mahatma Gandhi
- (d) Swami Vivekananda

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (a)

The Theosophical Society was founded in the year 1875 A.D. in New York City by Russian (Now Ukrainian) noblewoman Helena Petrovna Blavatsky and American Colonel Henry Steel Alcott, along with attorney William Quan Judge and some other individuals. In 1879 A.D., the principal founders, Madam H.P. Blavatsky and Col. Alcott arrived in India where the Society spread rapidly. In 1882 A.D., they established the Society's International Headquarter in Adyar, a Subas of Madras (currently Chennai). Brahmo Sabha was founded by Raja Ram Mohan Roy in 1828 A.D. and Ramkrishna Mission was founded by Swami Vivekananda in 1897 A.D. Thus, option (a) is correct.

24. Who demanded the right to enter temples that caused a terrible riot in Tirunelveli in 1899?

- (a) Okalinga
- (b) Nadars
- (c) Mahar
- (d) Pali

40th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (b)

Nadars demanded the right to enter temples in 1899 A.D. which caused a terrible riot in Tirunelveli district Tamil Nadu.

25. The women's movement in India started largely under the inspiration of :

- (a) Padmabai Ranaday
- (b) Annie Besant
- (c) Sarojini Naidu
- (d) Jyotiba Phule

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (d)

The Women's Movement in India started largely under inspirations of Jyotiba Phule. He used to believe that social evils could be eliminated only after uplifting the women and Dalits. He opened the first school for girls in India in 1848 A.D. Ramabai Ranade was the inspiration of the Women's Movement in Modern India. She was the wife of Mahadev Govind Ranade. She founded an organization 'Seva Sadan'. If Ramabai is mentioned in the given options, then it will be the correct answer. This was the reason that the Bihar Public Service Commission did not consider any option as correct and starred the question.

Political Organisations

Established Before Congress

1. Who was the founder of the Indian Association?

- (a) Dadabhai Naoroji
- (b) Bal Gangadhar Tilak
- (c) A.O. Hume
- (d) Surendra Nath Banerjee

45th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (d)

The Indian Association was founded by Surendra Nath Banerjee with the cooperation of Anand Mohan Bose in Calcutta, on 26 July 1876. This was the most significant political association among all contemporary nationalist organizations prior to the Indian National Congress. Indian Association preferred middle class than landlords.

2. Who established Indian Association in 1876?

- (a) Surendra Nath Banerjee
- (b) Chittaranjan Das
- (c) W. C. Banerjee
- (d) Arvind Ghosh
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

3. The most important of the pre-Congress Nationalist Organization was the

- (a) Bengal British India Society
- (b) East India Association
- (c) Young Bengal Association
- (d) Indian Association of Calcutta

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of the above question.

4. Which among the following year Surendra Nath Banerjee was eliminated from Indian Civil Services?

- (a) 1874 AD (b) 1877 AD
(c) 1885 AD (d) 1892 AD
(e) None of the above/ More than one of the above

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (a)

Surendra Nath Banerjee was dismissed from Civil Services in the year 1874 A.D. for making a minor judicial error.

5. Who was the first Indian to resist the political reforms?

- (a) Dadabhai Naoroji (b) Surendra Nath
(c) Ram Mohan Roy (d) Bal Gangadhar Tilak

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (c)

Raja Ram Mohan Roy was the first Indian to resist for political reforms. He writes about Human Rights, and development of democratic values. According to Bipin Chandra Pal, Ram Mohan Roy was first Indian Political Reformer. Although, some historians gave this credit to Surendra Nath Banerjee.

6. The Madras Mahajan Sabha was established in the year-

- (a) 1880 (b) 1881
(c) 1882 (d) 1883

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (*)

Madras Mahajan Sabha : May, 1884 founded by S. Ramaswami Mudaliar, G. Subramanian, P. Anand Charlu and M.V. Raghavachari.

7. Poona Sarvajanik Sabha was founded in:

- (a) 1858 by Mahadev Govind Ranade
(b) 1870 by Mahadev Govind Ranade
(c) 1870 by Pandita Ramabai Ranade
(d) 1870 by Surendra Nath Banerjee
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. Re-Exam (Pre) 2020

Ans. (b)

Poona Sarvajanik Sabha was a socio-political organization that started as mediating body between the British Indian government and the people of India. It was established by Mahadev Govind Ranade in 1870 A.D.

8. Which of the following was not objective of the Indian National Congress as pointed out by W.C. Banerjee in 1885?

- (a) To promote contact and friendship among the protectors of the interests of the country.

(b) To promote the feeling of nationalism among fellow countrymen by removing the feeling of casteism, communalism and regional biases.

(c) To express the viewpoint on the necessary social issues with due consent of the educated class.

(d) To determine on which direction and on which basis the work has to be done in the coming years for the Indian public interest.

(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. Re-Exam (Pre) 2020

Ans. (e)

Promoting contact & friendship among national workers of all parts of India, promoting feelings of nationalism, removing feeling of casteism, expressing viewpoint on social issues determining direction of country were objective of congress. Hence, option (e) is correct.

9. Bombay Presidency Association was established by -

- (a) Pherozeshah Mehta (b) K. T. Tailang
(c) W.C. Banerjee (d) Tayabjee

(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C. (Pre.) 2017

Ans. (e)

The Bombay Presidency Association was founded by Firoz Shah Mehta, Badruddin Tyabji, K.T. Telang, etc.

Indian National Congress

1. Indian National Congress was established by-

- (a) A.O. Hume (b) Surendra Nath Banerjee
(c) W.C. Banerjee (d) Anne Besant

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (a)

Allan Octavian Hume (A.O. Hume) was a retired British officer of Indian Civil Service. In 1884 A.D., he established the Indian National Union. After visiting Kolkata, Mumbai and Madras, Hume took the initiative to organize the first Indian National Union to meet in Poona. Its objective was to obtain a share in Government for educated Indians, and to create a platform for civil and political dialogue between educated Indians in British Raj. The first meeting was scheduled to be held in Poona, but due to an outbreak of Cholera, it was shifted to Gokuldas Tejpal Sanskrit Vidyalaya in Bombay. The first session of Indian National Union was held on 28-30 December, 1885. In this session on the advice of Dadabhai Naoroji, the organization was renamed as 'Indian National Congress.'

2. The Indian National Congress was founded by-

- (a) A. O. Hume (b) Mahatma Gandhi
(c) Satchidanand Sinha (d) None of these

44th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

3. Who was the founder of the Indian National Congress?

- (a) William Adam (b) A. O. Hume
(c) Rash Behari Bose (d) Motilal Nehru
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

4. The founder of the Indian National Congress was a :

- (a) Civil Servant (b) Scientist
(c) Social Worker (d) Commander

43rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

5. When was Indian National Congress set up?

- (a) in 1885 (b) in 1886
(c) in 1887 (d) in 1888

43rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (a)

Indian National Congress was founded in 1885 by A.O. Hume, who was a retired civilian officer. The first session of the Indian National Congress was held in Bombay during 28-30 December, 1885 at Gokuldas Tejpal Sanskrit College with 72 representative delegates in attendance. Hume assumed office as the General Secretary and Womesh Chandra Bannerjee was elected as president.

6. How many representatives took part in the First Session of the Indian National Congress?

- (a) 52 (b) 62
(c) 72 (d) 82

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

7. The first conference of Indian National Congress held at-

- (a) Kolkata (b) Lahore
(c) Mumbai (d) Pune

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

8. Who was the first Muslim President of the Indian National Congress?

- (a) R. A. Kidwai (b) Badruddin Tyabji
(c) Hakim Ajmal Khan (d) Zakir Husain
(e) None of the above / More than one of the above

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Ans. (b)

Badruddin Tyabji was the first Muslim President of Indian National Congress elected in 1887 at Madras session held on 27-30 December. He was elected as the President of the third session.

9. The precursor of Indian National Congress was :

- (a) British Indian Association
(b) Indian Association
(c) Indian National Union
(d) Indian League
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (c)

Indian National Union was formed in 1884. Its first session was organised in 1885, December 28-30. This conference was later renamed as Indian National Congress.

10. How many Muslim delegates participated in the Second Convention of the Indian National Congress?

- (a) 2 (b) 33
(c) 30 (d) 41
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. Re-Exam (Pre) 2020

Ans. (b)

The second session of Congress took place at Calcutta in 1886 A.D. under the presidency of Dadabhai Naoroji. 33 Muslim delegates were present in this session.

11. The second session of the Indian National Congress was presided over by-

- (a) Ganesh Agarkar (b) Surendra Nath Banerjee
(c) Dadabhai Naoroji (d) Pherozeshah Mehta

45th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (c)

The second session of the Indian National Congress was held in Calcutta in 1886 A.D., presided over by Dadabhai Naoroji.

12. Who was the Second Muslim President of the Indian National Congress?

- (a) Abul Kalam Azad (b) Zakir Hussain

- (c) Rahimtulla M. Sayani (d) Badruddin Tyabji
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. Re-Exam (Pre) 2020

Ans. (c)

Second Muslim President of the Indian National Congress was Rahimtulla M. Sayani. He was president in 1896 Calcutta session.

13. Who was the first woman President of the Indian National Congress ?

- (a) Kasturba Gandhi (b) Mrs. Annie Besant
(c) Sarojini Naidu (d) Bhakti Laxmi Desai
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (b)

Annie Besant was a prominent Anglo-Irish nationalist lady. She became a prominent leader of the Theosophical Society during 1907-1933. She constituted 'Home Rule League' in 1916 and became the first female President of Indian National Congress in 1917.

14. Who was the first Indian woman President of the Indian National Congress?

- (a) Mrs. Annie Besant (b) Sucheta Kriplani
(c) Sarojini Naidu (d) Indira Gandhi

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (c)

Sarojini Naidu was an eminent poetess and nationalist leader. She became the first Indian women President of Indian National Congress in the 40th annual session of INC held at Kanpur in 1925. She was a loyal and trustful colleague of Gandhiji. She was the first Indian woman who became the Governor of Uttar Pradesh in 1947-49.

15. At which place was the 27th Session of the Indian National Congress held?

- (a) Bhagalpur (b) Patna
(c) Ranchi (d) Bankipur

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (d)

In 1912, Indian National Congress held its 27th session at Bankipur (Patna) under the Presidency of R.N. Mudholkar. In this session, A.O. Hume was called the father of the Indian National Congress.

16. At which of the following Sessions of the Indian National Congress did the Champaran trouble come up for discussion?

- (a) Calcutta, 1911 (b) Patna, 1912

- (c) Ramgarh, 1940 (d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

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Ans. (e)

During the 31st session of the Congress in Lucknow in 1916, Gandhiji met Rajkumar Shukla, a representative of farmers from Champaran, who invited him to come and see for himself the miseries of the indigo ryots.

17. Who said, "Swaraj is my birthright and I shall have it"?

- (a) Bipin Chandra Pal (b) Aurobindo Ghosh
(c) Bal Gangadhar Tilak (d) Subhash Chandra Bose
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (c)

Tilak proclaimed vigorously "Swaraj is my birthright, I shall have it" in the Lucknow session of INC, 1916. Extremists joined Congress again in this session and "Lucknow Pact" was signed by the efforts of Bal Gangadhar Tilak and Annie Besant and M.A. Jinnah. It is famous as 'Congress-League Agreement' also.

18. "Swaraj is my birthright and I will have it." This statement is concerned with-

- (a) Lala Lajpat Rai (b) Mahatma Gandhi
(c) Bal Gangadhar Tilak (d) Subhash Chandra Bose

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

46th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

19. Who said, "Swaraj is my birthright, I will have it"?

- (a) M.K. Gandhi (b) Jawaharlal Nehru
(c) Bal Gangadhar Tilak (d) Bhagat Singh

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

20. Who said, "The basic cause of problems facing Bharat is the neglect of its national identity"?

- (a) Deen Dayal Upadhyay
(b) Keshav Baliram Hedgewar
(c) Madhav Sadashiv Golwalkar
(d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

B.P.S.C. PRT 2023 Shift I

Ans. (a)

Pt. Deen Dayal Upadhyay said that 'the basic cause of problems facing Bharat is the neglect of its national identity' opportunism has shaken the confidence of people in politics. Deen Dayal Upadhyay is an Indian politician and leader of the Bharatiya Jan Sangh.

21. The Lucknow Pact took place in

- (a) 1915 (b) 1916
- (c) 1917 (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

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Ans. (b)

Lucknow Pact, (December, 1916), an agreement made by the Indian National Congress headed by Maratha leader Bal Gangadhar Tilak and the All-India Muslim League, led by Muhammad Ali Jinnah; it was adopted by the Congress at its Lucknow session on December 29 and by the league on December 31, 1916.

22. "Remember once again, now that this flag is unfurled, it must not be lowered as long as a single Indian, man, woman, or child lives in India." Who said this?

- (a) Gandhi in Gujarat
- (b) Jawaharlal Nehru in Lahore
- (c) S.N. Banerjee in Bengal
- (d) Subhas Chandra Bose in Singapore
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2018

Ans. (b)

In the year 1929, Jawahar Lal Nehru hoisted the tricolour flag of India upon the bank of Ravi river in Lahore. He said that 'Remember once again, now that this flag is unfurled, it must not be lowered as long as a single Indian, man, woman or child lives in India'.

23. Who said that "Congress Movement was neither inspired by the people, nor devised or planned by them"?

- (a) Lord Dufferin (b) Sir Syed Ahmed
- (c) Lord Curzon (d) Lala Lajpat Rai

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (d)

In an Article, Lala Lajpat Rai wrote that "Congress movement was neither inspired by the people nor advised or planned by them."

24. Who was the President of the Patna Session of Indian National Congress held in 1912?

- (a) R. N. Mudholkar

- (b) A. C. Majumdar
- (c) Madan Mohan Malaviya
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

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Ans. (a)

In the year 1912, Indian National Congress held its 27th session at Bankipore, Patna under the presidency of Rao Bahadur Raghunath Narasinha Mudholkar from Amravati of Central Provinces and Berar. (The Indian National Congress was founded in 1885) after the party's foundation, Womesh Chunder Banerjee became its first president.

25. Who was the President of Gaya Session of the Indian National Congress held in 1922?

- (a) Chittaranjan Das (b) S.N. Banerjee
- (c) Dr. Rajendra Prasad (d) Hakim Ajmal Khan

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (a)

Chittaranjan Das was the President of Gaya Session of Indian National Congress held in 1922. He was an eminent lawyer who distinguished himself by successfully defending Aurobindo Ghosh in famous Alipore Bomb Case. Along with Motilal Nehru, he formed the Swaraj Party within the INC, with the declared policy of entering the councils and disrupting their functioning. He is also known as Deshbandhu.

26. Who was the President of Gaya Session of the Indian National Congress held in 1922 AD?

- (a) Chittaranjan Das
- (b) Hakim Ajmal Khan
- (c) Mahatma Gandhi
- (d) Maulana Abul Kalam Azad
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

27. Which tribe of Bihar attended Gaya Session of Congress?

- (a) Oraon
- (b) Santhal
- (c) Sannyasi
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

B.P.S.C. PRT 2023 Shift I

Ans. (a)

Oraon tribe of Bihar attended the Gaya Session of Congress. C.R. Das the president of the Gaya Congress Session other delegates like Motilal Nehru, Hakim Ajmal Khan and J.M. Sen Gupta also arrived at the Venue.

28. Subhas Chandra Bose became the President of the Indian National Congress in Tripuri Session by defeating

- (a) Pattabhi Sitaramayya (b) Rash Behari Bose
(c) Jawaharlal Nehru (d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

B.P.S.C. PRT 2023 Shift II

Ans. (a)

In year 1939 Tripuri Session Subhash Chandra Bose won the elections for the Indian National Congress (INC) President at Tripuri Session by defeating Pattabhi Sitaramayya.

29. Which Raja rendered a very valuable assistance to the Indian National Congress for holding its Fourth Session at Allahabad in 1888?

- (a) Raja of Bhinga (b) Raja of Benares
(c) Raja of Darbhanga (d) Raja of Jagdishpur
(e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2022

Ans. (c)

In the year 1888 AD, during the fourth session of the Indian National Congress held in Allahabad, the King of Darbhanga provided invaluable assistance towards the successful conclusion of this session.

Moderates and Extremists in Congress

1. Sardar Udham Singh killed whom?

- (a) General Dyer (b) Curzon Wylie
(c) Michael O'Dwyer (d) Saunders
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Re-Exam) (Pre) 2021

Ans. (c)

Sardar Udham Singh killed Michael O'Dwyer (Dyer). Udham Singh marched to London and killed Lieutenant Governor Michael O'Dwyer, indirectly responsible for the Jallianwala Bagh Massacre, in March 1940.

2. The protest method of moderate leaders of the Congress was?

- (a) Non-Co-operation (b) Constitutional agitation

- (c) Passive resistance (d) Civil disobedience

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (b)

The methods employed by the two groups (Moderates and Extremists) of Congress were different in their tempo and approach. Congress split into two different groups at the Surat Session of Congress in 1907. While the moderates had infinite faith in the efficacy of Constitutional agitation and in appealing to the British sense of justice and fair play, in holding an annual conference, making speeches, passing elaborate resolutions and sending deputations to England. The Extremists had no faith in the benevolence of British public or Parliament, nor were they convinced of the efficacy of merely holding conferences. Extremists had faith in the concept of passive resistance.

3. Most of the moderate leader hailed from :

- (a) Rural areas (b) Urban areas
(c) Both rural and urban area (d) Punjab

43rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (b)

During the era of liberal politics Dadabhai Naoroji, Firoz Shah Mehta, Dinshaw Wacha, Womesh Chandra Banerjee and Surendra Nath Banerjee were the moderate leaders who hailed from urban areas. The domination of prosperous and middle-class scholars like barristers, doctors, engineers, journalists and literary people was found during this period. The title and high designation charmed them. These representatives of Congress hailed from metropolitan cities and had no connection with common people.

4. Which one of the following was not an extremist?

- (a) Bal Gangadhar Tilak (b) Madan Lal
(c) Udham Singh (d) G.K. Gokhale

44th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (d)

Gopal Krishna Gokhale was a prominent social reformer of India who founded an organization to work for the relief of underprivileged. He led the moderate nationalists in the early years of the Indian Independence Movement. As an influential and respected member of the Indian National Congress, the leading Nationalist organization in the pre-independent India, Gokhale advocated moderate and Constitutional methods of agitation and gradual reform.

5. Who established the 'Servants of India Society'?

- (a) Lala Lajpat Rai (b) Bipin Chandra Pal
(c) Gopal Krishna Gokhale (d) Bhagat Singh

(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (c)

Gopal Krishna Gokhale was one of the social and political leaders during the Indian Independence Movement against the British rule in India. He was a senior leader of INC, and the founder of the Servants of India Society. He was not a leader of extreme nationalism.

6. Indian National Movement came to be dominated by the extremists after –

- (a) 1906 (b) 1909
(c) 1914 (d) 1919

43rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (a)

After the year 1906, the effect of extremism had increased on the Indian National Movement. The Congress split at Surat came in December 1907, around the time when revolutionary terrorism had gained momentum. The extremists were aggressive nationalist members of Indian National Congress. The important extremist leaders were Lala Lajpat Rai, Bal Gangadhar Tilak, Bipin Chandra Pal and Aurobindo Ghosh. Tilak announced that “Swaraj is my birthright and I shall have it”.

7. Which one of the following leaders belonged to the Extremist wing of the Congress?

- (a) Aurobindo Ghosh (b) Dadabhai Naoroji
(c) G.K. Gokhale (d) S.N. Banerjee

45th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (a)

Aurobindo Ghosh was an extremist of Congress. He was one of the four pillars (Lal, Bal, Pal, Ghosh) of extremists. He was arrested in 1908 by British Police in Maniktalla Garden raid. He got the punishment of one-year imprisonment, but he was released due to the lack of evidence. Finally, he became sage secluded himself from revolutionary activities and moved to Pondicherry.

8. Who among the following was not known as a moderate in the National Movement?

- (a) Bal Gangadhar Tilak (b) Dadabhai Naoroji
(c) M.G. Ranade (d) Gopal Krishna Gokhale

45th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

9. Who is popularly known as ‘Sher-e-Punjab’?

- (a) Rajguru (b) Bhagat Singh

(c) Lala Lajpat Rai

(d) Udham Singh

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (c)

Lala Lajpat Rai was known as Sher-e-Punjab. He was extremist representative of Punjab in Congress. He is known as ‘Punjab Kesari’. Lala Lajpat Rai, Bal Gangadhar Tilak and Bipin Chandra Pal named as “Lal-Bal-Pal.”

10. In 1908, Bal Gangadhar Tilak was imprisoned for –

- (a) 5 years (b) 6 years
(c) 7 years (d) 8 years

43rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (b)

In 1908, Tilak was sentenced to 6 years imprisonment due to the publication of some seditious articles in his publication 'The Kesari'. He was deported to Burma and kept in Mandalay Jail.

11. Who has said about Bengal Partition, "The partition announcement fell like a bomb shell"?

- (a) Surendra Nath Banerjee
(b) Gopal Krishna Gokhale
(c) Bipin Chandra Pal
(d) Chittaranjan Das
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Re-Exam) (Pre) 2021

Ans. (a)

Regarding the partition of Bengal, Surendranath Banerjee had said, "Partition fell on us like a bomb". Partition of Bengal happened in time of Lord Curzon.

12. Bal Gangadhar Tilak came to be known as 'Lokmanya Tilak' when –

- (a) He became a popular teacher.
(b) He started a popular newspaper.
(c) The government accused him in the Rand Murder Case.
(d) He started the Shivaji and Ganpati festivals.
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above.

64th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (e)

British government made Bal Gangadhar Tilak accused in the Rand murder case who was an assistant collector. Tilak was convicted and sentenced to 18 months of rigorous imprisonment. He already became a national hero when he came out of jail. Hence many incidents were responsible for Tilak becoming 'Lokmanya' Tilak.

Revolutionary Movements in India

1. Who founded Abhinav Bharat Society in 1906 in London?

- (a) Vinayak Damodar Savarkar
- (b) Shyamji Krishna Varma
- (c) Sohan Singh
- (d) P.N. Bapat
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. Re-Exam (Pre) 2020

Ans. (a)

In 1906, Abhinav Bharat Society was a secret society founded by Vinayak Damodar Savarkar in London.

2. Who is associated with 'Abhinav Bharat'?

- (a) V.D. Savarkar
- (b) C.R. Das
- (c) B.G. Tilak
- (d) S.C. Bose

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (a)

Abhinav Bharat Society (Young India Society) was an Indian Independence Secret Society founded by Vinayak Damodar Savarkar and his brother Ganesh Damodar Savarkar.

3. Who established a branch of Anushilan Samiti at Patna in 1913?

- (a) Rewati Nag
- (b) Yadunath Sarkar
- (c) Sachindra Nath Sanyal
- (d) Mazharul Haque
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (c)

Anushilan Samiti was a revolutionary organisation which belived in the path of violence. Sachindra Nath Sanyal established a branch of it in 1913 at Patna.

4. The 'Anushilan Samiti' was –

- (a) dedicated to the upliftment of women
- (b) promoting widow remarriage
- (c) interested in labour welfare
- (d) a revolutionary organization

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (d)

Barindra Ghosh was a younger brother of Sri Aurobindo Ghosh. Barindra was influenced by Aurobindo and joined revolutionary movement. In the year 1905, he wrote Pamphlet "Bhawani Mandir" about the detailed description for the formation of a centre for organizing revolutionary works and is credited for spreading revolutionary ideas in Bengal along with Bhupendra Nath Dutt. Their activities led to the formation of Anushilan Samiti, a revolutionary organization.

5. Who was the founder of Swadesh Bandhav Samiti?

- (a) Ashwini Kumar Dutta
- (b) P. B. Das
- (c) Prafulla Chaki
- (d) V. D. Savarkar
- (E) None of the above/More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. Assistant Audit Officer 2022

Ans. (a)

Ashwini Kumar Dutta was a freedom fighter from Barisal district of East Bengal which is now in Bangladesh. He founded Swadesh Bandhav Samiti with a vision of promoting locally made products and boycotting foreign goods.

6. When did the attempt of murder of Kingsford was made at Mujaffarpur?

- (a) 1908
- (b) 1909
- (c) 1907
- (d) 1911

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (a)

Khudiram Bose and Prafulla Chaki went to Muzaffarpur Bihar to assassinate Kingsford, Calcutta Presidency Magistrate. Khudiram Bose and Prafulla Chaki watched the usual movements of Kingsford and prepared a plan to kill him. On the evening of April 30, 1908, the duo waited in front of the gate of European club for the carriage of Kingsford to come. When a vehicle came out of the gate, they threw bombs and blew up the carriage. Unfortunately, the vehicle was not carrying Kingsford and instead, two innocent British ladies- Mrs. and Miss Kennedy (the wife and daughter of barrister Pringle Kennedy) were killed. The revolutionary duo fled. Prafulla committed suicide when cornered by police at the Samastipur Railway station. Khudiram was later arrested and hanged.

7. Who among the following was hanged on the charge of Muzaffarpur Bomb Case?

- (a) Prafulla Chaki
- (b) Batukeshwar Dutt
- (c) Rajguru
- (d) Rajendra Lahiri
- (e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. Assistant Audit Officer 2022

Ans. (e)

See the above question's explanation.

8. In which place Khudiram Bose tried to kill Kingsford?

- (a) Patna
- (b) Darbhanga
- (c) Muzaffarpur
- (d) Gaya
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Re-Exam) (Pre) 2021

Ans. (c)

On April 30, 1908 Khudiran Bose and Prafulla Chaki threw a bomb at kingsford in Muzaffarpur.

9. Who was given life punishment for the murder of Colonel Wylie?

- (a) Madan Lal Dhirga
- (b) Udham Singh
- (c) Bhagat Singh
- (d) Manmathanath
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C (Pre) 2017

Ans. (a)

Sir William Hutt Curzon Wylie was a British Indian army officer. He was assassinated on 1 July, 1909 in London by Madan Lal Dhirga.

10. Who assassinated Sir Curzon-Wylie in London?

- (a) V.D. Savarkar
- (b) Udham Singh
- (c) Madan Lal Dhirga
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

B.P.S.C (Tre-3) {Class 1-5}-2024

Ans. (c)

On July 1, 1909, Madan Lal Dhirga assassinated Sir William Hutt Curzon Wylie, a retired British Indian Army officer and a prominent official, during a public meeting in London's Imperial Institute. During the trial, he claimed that he had murdered Curzon-Wylie as a patriotic act and in revenge for the inhumane killings of Indians by the British Government in India. He was found guilty and sentenced to death and was hanged to death on August 17, 1909, at the age of only 24.

11. The Non-Cooperation Movement was suspended in

- (a) 1921
- (b) 1922
- (c) 1923
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

B.P.S.C. Headmaster 07-12-2023

Ans. (b)

In 1922, Mahatma Gandhi decided to withdraw the Non-Cooperation Movement. He felt that the movement was turning violent in many places, and Satyagrahis needed to be properly trained before the movement. On 4th Feb. of 1922, the protest became violent when protesting people set fire a police station, burning 23 policemen alive.

12. Which year 'Hindustan Republican Association' was set up –

- (a) 1920
- (b) 1924
- (c) 1928
- (d) 1930

40th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (b)

The revolutionaries were in disillusion in Northern India due to the sudden suspension of the Non-Cooperation Movement. They met in Kanpur in October, 1924 and founded the Hindustan Republican Association under the leadership of Sachindranath Sanyal (President) and other associates viz Ramprasad Bismil, Jogesh Chatterjee, Chandra-Shekhar Azad, etc.

13. Who penned the following lines?

"Sarfarooshi ki tamanna ab hamare dil me hai
Dekhna hai zor kitna baju-e-qatil me hai".

- (a) Bismil
- (b) Rajguru
- (c) Bhagat Singh
- (d) Azad

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (a)

"Sarfarooshi ki tamanna ab hamare dil me hai Dekhna hai zor kitna baju-e-qatil me hai" is a patriotic poem written by Bismil Azimabadi. His Original name was Saiyed Shah Muhammad Hasan. He was born in 1901. This gazal was published in the "Sabah" Magzine of Qazi Abdul Gaffar in 1922.

14. Who is the author of the popular song, Sarfarooshi Ki Tamanna Ab Hamare Dil Mein Hai?

- (a) Surya Sen
- (b) Chandra Shekhar Azad
- (c) Sardar Bhagat Singh
- (d) Ram Prasad Bismil
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (e)

See the explanation of the above question.

15. Which revolutionaries were hanged in the 'Kakori Train Robbery Case'?

- (a) Ram Prasad Bismil and Ashfaqualla
- (b) Veer Savarkar and Vasudev Chapekar
- (c) Prafulla Chandra Chaki and Khudiram Bose
- (d) Surya Sen and Udham Singh
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (a)

Shachindra Nath Sanyal, Ram Prasad 'Bismil' and Chandra Shekhar Azad established revolutionary institution-Hindustan Republican Association in October, 1924. The treasury of Government was looted by this organization at Kakori, a place in Lucknow-Saharanpur section of the northern railway, on 9 August, 1925. This incident is known as Kakori

Conspiracy (Kakori Train action). 43 revolutionaries were arrested in which Ram Prasad Bismil, Ashfaqulla, Roshan Singh and Rajendra Lahiri were hanged while Azad escaped. Azad was the only member of HRA who was never arrested by the British Government.

16. Who among the following was not associated with the Kakori train robbery case?"

- (a) Ram Prasad Bismil (b) Ashfaqulla Khan
(c) Roshan Singh (d) Sukhdev
(e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. Auditor 2021

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of the above question.

17. How old was Bhagat Singh when he threw a bomb in the assembly in protest against the government?

- (a) 21 years
(b) A little more than 21 years
(c) 25 years
(d) A little more than 25 years
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

64th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (b)

Bhagat Singh was a prominent freedom fighter of India. He was born in September, 1907. Bhagat Singh and Batukeshwar Dutt, on 8th April, 1929, threw a bomb in the Central Legislative Assembly. Thus, at that time, his age was a little more than 21 years. He was hanged on 23 March, 1931.

18. One of the founder leaders of Hindustan Socialist Republican Army was-

- (a) B.R. Ambedkar (b) Bhagat Singh
(c) Subhash Chandra Bose (d) Jai Prakash Narayan

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (b)

Vijay Kumar Singh, Shiv Verma, Jai Dev Kapoor, Bhagat Singh, Bhagwati Charan Vohra and the Sukhdev under the leadership of Chandra Shekhar Azad reorganized the HRA in September, 1928 at Feroz Shah Kotla Delhi. They changed the name of HRA and the new organization named HSRA (Hindustan Socialist Republican Association) came into existence.

19. Who gave the 'Inquilab Zindabad' slogan?

- (a) Iqbal (b) M.K. Gandhi
(c) Bhagat Singh (d) S.C. Bose

45th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (c)

The slogan of Inquilab Zindabad was written by Maulavi Hasrat Mohani. Bhagat Singh used the slogan for the first time and made it popular among the freedom fighters and the people of pre-independence India.

20. Bhagat Singh, Rajguru, and Sukhdev were executed on –

- (a) 23 March, 1931 (b) 23 March, 1932
(c) 23 March, 1933 (d) 23 March, 1934

45th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (a)

In order to protest against Act, Bhagat Singh and his friends including Batukeshwar Dutt carried out a plan to use low-intensity bomb inside the assembly hall on 8th April, 1929 and at the same time ensured that there were no deaths. Immediately after the bombing, Bhagat Singh, and his friends voluntarily surrendered and were taken to trial. They were charged with attempt to murder. Bhagat Singh along with Rajguru and Sukhdev were executed on 23 March, 1931.

21. The Chittagong Armoury Raid had been planned by :

- (a) Surya Sen (b) Chandan Dutta
(c) Vidhan Ghosh (d) Jatin Das
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2021

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (a)

Chittagong armoury raid was an attempt to raid the armoury of the police and auxiliary forces at Chittagong in Bengal. It was organised by Surya Sen who was also famous by the name of "Master Da". The Indian Republican Army (IRA) was established by Surya Sen in Bengal and on 18th April, 1930, the plan was put into implementation by the members of IRA namely Ganesh Ghosh, Lokenath, Nirmal Sen, Ambika Chakrobarty, Subodh Roy, Kalpana Dutt, Anand Gupta, Tegrabal etc. including Surya Sen. Struggle took place on 22nd April, 1930 between Government forces and members of IRA in which 80 soldiers and 12 revolutionaries were killed. On 16 February, 1933, Surya Sen was arrested and put to legal proceedings and ultimately hanged on 12th January, 1934.

22. Who organized Chittagong Armoury Raid?

- (a) Rajguru (b) Surya Sen
(c) Prafulla Chaki (d) Amir Chand
(e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. Assistant Audit Officer 2022

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

23. Who propounded the doctrine of 'Passive Resistance'?

- (a) Mahatma Gandhi (b) Bipin Chandra Pal
(c) Bal Gangadhar Tilak (d) Aurobindo Ghosh

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (d)

The principle of "Passive Resistance" was propounded by Aurobindo Ghosh in his book "Vande Mataram". He was of the view that Britishers must immediately leave India. Indians must continue to protest until they leave India.

24. Who founded the "Revolutionary Society" in 1904, which aimed at armed revolution against British rule?

- (a) Lala Hardayal
(b) Vinayak Damodar Savarkar
(c) Bipin Chandra Pal
(d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

BPSC (Tre-3) {Class 6-8}–2024

Ans. (b)

In 1904, V D Savarkar organized a secret society of revolutionaries called Abhinav Bharat. This society aimed to fight against British colonial rule and work towards the liberation of India. The Abhinav Bharat was a radical organization that believed in armed revolution as the means to achieve independence.

Revolutionary Activities

Outside India

1. What was the slogan of the Bolsheviks during the 1917 Revolution?

- (a) "Workers of the World, Unite!"
(b) "Liberty, Equality, Fraternity"
(c) "Peace, Land, Bread"
(d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

BPSC (Tre-3) {Class 6-8}–2024

Ans. (c)

The Bolsheviks were a Communist Party. They were against capitalism and wanted to convert Russia into a socialist country as a means to eliminate what they called the capitalist crisis. The slogan of the Bolshevik leaders in 1917 was Peace, Land, and Bread.

2. Who was the founder of the 'India House' in London?

- (a) Shyamji Krishnavarma (b) Rash Behari Bose
(c) Ramchandra (d) Taraknath Das

(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (a)

In February 1905 at London, Shyamji Krishna Verma established the Indian Home Rule Society. He also established the "India House" in London. The aim of this society was to establish self-rule by intimidating the British Government. From here, a newspaper 'The Indian Sociologist' was started. Shyamji departed from London for Paris due to over activeness of Government machinery and later to Geneva.

3. Ghadar Party was established in the year :

- (a) 1907 (b) 1913
(c) 1917 (d) 1920

41st B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (b)

Ghadar Party was established on 21st April, 1913 to fight for the independence of India from British. It was formed by the immigrant Indians who settled in USA & Canada. It was Headquartered in San Francisco, USA. Lala Hardayal was its founder with Sohan Singh Bakhna as President. Ramchandra, Barkatullah, Rashbehari Bose, Raja Mahendra Pratap, Abul Rehman, Madam Bhikaji Kama, Parmanand, Kartar Singh Sarabha & Pt. Kanshiram were other important members.

4. Where was the Ghadar Party established?

- (a) Germany (b) United States of America
(c) France (d) England
(e) None of the above / More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

5. What was the cause of outbreak of Ghadar Revolution –

- (a) Arresting of Lala Hardayal
(b) Kamagatamaru incident
(c) Beginning of first World War
(d) Hanging of Kartar Singh Sarabha

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (c)

After the decline of Swadeshi Movement, torchbearers of Nationalism also became inactive. In 1914, when sudden 1st World War broke out, this incident was taken as advantage by the Indian Nationalist. During that time, the concept was famous that "Any distress on England is an advantage for Indians and it should be taken as a chance." In North America Ghadar revolutionaries and in India, Lokmanya Tilak, Annie Besant with their Swadeshi organizations took advantage of such opportunity. Ghadar revolutionaries through the armed struggle, tried to overthrow the British rule.

6. Which of the following was formed under the influence of Russian Revolution and USSR?

- (a) The Communist Party of Great Britain
- (b) The Conference of the Peoples of the East (1920)
- (c) The Comintern
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

B.P.S.C. PRT 2023 Shift I

Ans. (d)

The Communist Party of Great Britain was the Largest Communist Organisation in Britain. Founded in year 1920. The Conference of the people of the East was a Multinational Conference held in 1920 by Communist International in Baku and the Communist International (Comintern) it also known as the Third International Organisation founded in 1919 they are formed under the influence of Russian Revolution and USSR.

7. Interim government under the leadership of Raja Mahendra Pratap Singh was founded in Kabul with the support of Germany during the :

- (a) Ghadar Movement (b) Swadeshi Movement
- (c) Second World War (d) Home Rule Movement
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. Re-Exam (Pre) 2020

Ans. (e)

During the World War-I, Raja Mahendra Pratap established the first provisional Government of India at Kabul in Afghanistan in 1915. In this Government Raja himself became President, and his associate Maulavi Barkatullah worked as Prime Minister. Germany and Russia gave recognition to this Government.

8. Who is regarded as the “Mother of Indian Revolution”:

- (a) Annie Besant (b) Sarojini Naidu
- (c) Rama Bai (d) Bhikaji Rustam Cama

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (d)

Bhikaji Rustam Cama was an Indian freedom fighter and political activist. She was born to an extremely wealthy Parsi business family. She led the revolutionary movement from America and Europe for India's freedom. At the International Socialist Congress held at Stuttgart (Germany) in 1907, she unfurled the first version of the Indian National Flag. She designed this flag. She struggled with her full strength for Indian freedom and worked for it at least 30 years residing in Paris. In 1936 she returned to Mumbai at the age of 75 and the same year, she died. She was popularly known as “Mother of Indian Revolution”.

9. Who is regarded as "the Mother of Indian Revolution"?

- (a) Mrs. Annie Besant
- (b) Snehlata Wadekar
- (c) Sarojini Naidu
- (d) Madam Bhikhaji Rustam Cama
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of the above question.

10. Where did Madam Cama unfurl India's tricolour flag of freedom?

- (a) Paris (b) London
- (c) Stuttgart (d) Geneva
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

11. Where did Madam Cama hoist the first tricolour flag in 1907?

- (a) London (b) Paris
- (c) Moscow (d) Stuttgart

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (d)

Madam Bhikaji Rustam Cama was born on 24th September, 1861. Her parents were Parsi. Sorabji Patel was her father. She was married to Rustam K.R. Cama. He was an advocate and social activist. Madam Cama worked as a personal secretary of Dada Bhai Naoroji, the great leader of Indian National Movement. After some period she associated herself with the Freedom Movement when she came into the contact of European scholars and students. She first unfurled the National Flag at International Socialist Congress on 22nd August, 1907 in Germany's Stuttgart.

Partition of Bengal and Swadeshi Movement

1. The Swadeshi and Boycott were adopted as the methods of struggle for the first time during the

- (a) Home Rule Movement
- (b) visit of the Simon Commission to India
- (c) Partition of Bengal
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

68th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (c)

Swadeshi and Boycott were adopted as the methods of struggle for the first time during the Bengal Partition. After the formal proclamation of partition of Bengal on 20 July, 1905 by Lord Curzon, Swadeshi movement was formally started on 7 August, 1905 with the passing of the 'Boycott' resolution in a meeting at Calcutta townhall.

2. In which place was the organization named 'Golden League' formed to work for boycott and the Swadeshi Movement?

- (a) Patna (b) Muzaffarpur
(c) Ranchi (d) Deoghar
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2018

Ans. (d)

In year 1904 'The Golden League' was established at Deoghar and with objective of boycotting British and advancing the Swadeshi Movement in Bihar.

3. The Declaration of Partition of Bengal was done -:

- (a) 19th July, 1905 (b) 7th August, 1905
(c) 15th August, 1905 (d) 16th October, 1905
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C. (Pre.) 2017

Ans. (a)

The decision to Partition of Bengal was announced on 20th July 1905 by British India government, but its date has also been given by some prominent authors as July 19, 1905.

4. Which movement started after the Partition of Bengal?

- (a) Civil Disobedience
(b) Swadeshi Movement
(c) Quit India Movement
(d) Non-Cooperation Movement

59th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (b)

Swadeshi movement started after partition of Bengal. It was complementary to Boycott Movement of foreign goods.

5. The Swadeshi Movement took place in India during -:

- (a) The Champaran Satyagraha of Gandhiji
(b) The Anti-Bengal partition agitation
(c) The protest against the Rowlatt Act
(d) The Non-Cooperation Movement
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C. (Pre.) 2017

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

6. Which of the following was the major demand of peasants participating in Non-Cooperation Movement?

- (a) Reduction of revenue
(b) Abolition of beggar
(c) Open the entry of peasants in the forest areas to graze their cattles, collect fuel wood and fruits
(d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

B.P.S.C. PRT 2023 Shift I

Ans. (d)

Demand of peasant participation in Non-Cooperation Movement—

- Large participation by the peasants in this movement.
- Reduction of Revenue, abolition of begar and social boycotts of oppressive landlords.
- Open the entry of peasants in the forest area to graze their cattle, and collect fuel wood and fruits.

7. Name the Viceroy of India concerned with Bengal partition –

- (a) Lord Hardinge (b) Lord Curzon
(c) Lord Lytton (d) Lord Minto

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (b)

The partition of Bengal was announced on July 20, 1905, by the then Viceroy of India, Lord Curzon (1899-1905) and came into effect on October 16, 1905. Later on, the decision of partition of Bengal was suspended during Delhi Darbar.

8. Which movement was started as a reaction to the Partition of Bengal?

- (a) Non-Cooperation Movement
(b) Civil Disobedience Movement
(c) Swadeshi Movement
(d) Purna Swaraj Movement
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (c)

The partition of Bengal in 1905 led to Swadeshi and Boycott Movement. Swadeshi Movement was complementary to 'Boycott Movement.' With the boycott of foreign goods, the use of 'Swadeshi' or indigenous goods increased. 'Swadeshi' was not altogether a noble idea. The movement spread to all classes and groups of people, including women and children, school and college students. This made the British to reverse the order of partition of Bengal. The boycott and Swadeshi Movements helped in the establishment of Swadeshi industries - textile mills, banks, chemical works and insurance companies. Swadeshi Stores were opened. National education and Indian languages were encouraged.

9. Bengal was partitioned in 1905, but due to opposition it was again divided in –

- (a) 1906 (b) 1916
(c) 1911 (d) 1909

46th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (c)

A ceremonial welcome was organized on the arrival of King George V and Queen Mary at the Delhi Durbar in 1911, where they were presented to an assembled audience of Indian dignitaries and princes as the Emperor and Empress of India on 12 December, 1911. During Delhi Darbar on December 12, 1911, the George abolished the partition of Bengal and declared the transfer of the Indian capital from Calcutta to Delhi. As declared, Bengal was reorganized as the new province. Orissa and Bihar were separated from Bengal.

10. In which year partition of Bengal made by Lord Curzon was cancelled ?

- (a) 1911 (b) 1904
(c) 1906 (d) 1907

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

11. Which of the following classes was mainly unaffected of Swadeshi Movement of 1905?

- (i) Women (ii) Farmers
(iii) Muslim (iv) Intellectuals

Select your answer to the following codes –

- (a) i and ii (b) i, ii and iii
(c) ii and iii (d) i and ii

40th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (c)

On 20 July, 1905, Curzon issued an order of partitioning of Bengal. On 7 August, 1905, one of the first mass protests was organized in Calcutta's Town Hall, which was known as 'Swadeshi Movement'. From this Movement, people started opposing the British office, institute, and boycott foreign goods. A remarkable aspect of the Swadeshi Movement was seen in the active participation of women. To collect the public support, Aswani Kumar Dutt organized the committee which is known as (Swadesh Bandha's Society). Lala Lajpat Rai and Aurobindo Ghosh played leading role in the fabrication of the Movement's character. In this Movement, women actively participated but farmers and Muslim were not involved in this Movement. They separated themselves from this Movement. Thus, option (c) is the correct answer.

Congress: Benaras, Culcutta, and Surat Session

1. Which of the following leaders presided over the Congress Session at Calcutta in 1906?

- (a) B.G. Tilak (b) G.K. Gokhale
(c) Aurobindo Ghosh (d) Dadabhai Naoroji

44th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (d)

In 1906, Congress was in real danger of splitting into two groups. The extremists were more popular than the moderates. Before this session, the extremists would have taken over Congress had they elected a leader among them. But it was not done. The moderates were politically intelligent. In 1906, the session at Calcutta was presided over by Dadabhai Naoroji. The moderates had chosen Naoroji to preside Congress. Naoroji, 'the Grand old man of India,' was respected by the moderates and extremists alike. In this session, the Congress adopted Swaraj as the goal of Indian people. Moderates toned down the resolution in a compromised state and made it self-Government meant obtaining the self-governing British colonies.

2. Congress passed the 'Swaraj' resolution in the year 1905. The purpose of the resolution was-

- (a) right to make a constitution for themselves but it was not done
(b) to secure self-rule
(c) responsible Government
(d) self-Government

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (*)

The Indian National Congress took up the Swaraj call in its Benaras Session, 1905 and later in 1906 Calcutta session it was fully passed. The main purpose of the resolution was "to serve self-rule" and boycott British products and the revival of domestic products and production process of Indian industrialization and better education policy for India.

3. At the Calcutta Session of the Indian National Congress (INC) held in 1906, the Flag of Swaraj for India was unfurled by

- (a) G. K. Gokhale (b) A. O. Hume
(c) Dadabhai Naoroji (d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

68th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (c)

At the Calcutta Session of the Indian National Congress (INC) held in 1906, the flag of Swaraj for India was unfurled by president of session Dadabhai Naoroji.

4. First Indian elected to the British House of Commons was Dadabhai Naoroji who contested on the ticket of:

- (a) Liberal Party (b) Labour Party
(c) Conservative Party (d) Communist Party
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (a)

Dadabhai Naoroji (4 September, 1825-30 June, 1917) known as the Grand Old Man of India, was Parsi intellectual educationist and an early Indian political and social leader. He was first Asian elected to the British House of Commons. In 1892 as a liberal party Member from Finsbury central constituency in the United Kingdom. He was elected as the President of (INC) in 1886, 1893, and 1906. C.Y. Chintamani, Indian editor Journalist, liberal politician, told about Dadabhai Naoroji that "Many intelligent and selfless leader had embellished for the people of India, but in his era, no one was as the Dadabhai Naoroji." On the other hand, Gokhale said that "if there is a God somewhere, he is Dadabhai Naoroji.

5. The process of a split in the Congress in the early years of the twentieth century began over –

- (a) Strategies of the Congress Movement
(b) Objectives of the Congress
(c) Participation of the people in the Congress Movement
(d) All of the above

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (d)

Surat Split is mainly known for separation of Congress party into moderates and extremists at the Surat Session of Congress on December, 1907. The process of a split in the Congress in the early years of the twentieth century began over strategies of the Congress movement, objectives of the Congress (moderates & extremists) and participation of the people in the Congress movement.

Formation of Muslim League (1906)

1. Who among the following was the founder of All India Muslim League?

- (a) Sir Saiyed Ahmad Khan (b) Sir Mohammad Iqbal
(c) Agha Khan (d) Nawab Salimullah Khan

41st B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (d)

Agha Khan III was a founding member and first President of the All India Muslim League. His goal was the advancement of the Muslim agenda and protection of Muslim rights in India. In 1906, the meeting was organized during the Dhaka session which is known as All India Muhammadan Educational Conference. The founding meeting was hosted by Nawab Salimullah Khan. Nawab Waqar-ul-Mulk and Nawab Muhasan-ul-Mulk both were jointly appointed as the secretary of the Muhammadan Educational Conference. Lucknow was the headquarter of Muslim League, and Agha Khan was its first President. Founder member were –

1. Salimullah Khan
2. Agha Khan III
3. Muhsin-ul-Mulk

But in option, two of the above names are given. Therefore, priority will be given to Salimullah Khan as the founder of the All India Muslim League.

2. Who was not among the founders of the All India Muslim League?

- (a) M. A. Jinnah (b) Aga Khan
(c) Nawab Salimullah (d) Nawab Mohsin-ul-Mulk
(E) None of the above/More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. Assistant Audit Officer 2022

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

3. The Muslim deputation met Minto in 1906 at Shimla and pleaded for –

- (a) Separate electorate for Muslims
(b) A composite electorate
(c) Higher representation to the Hindus
(d) Special representation to Muslim by nomination

46th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2004

Ans. (a)

Shimla Deputation organized by the Indian Muslim leader Agha Khan met the Viceroy Lord Minto at Shimla on 1 October, 1906. The aim of the deputation was to win the sympathy of the British Rule on matters relating to their interest. Therefore to safeguard their interests, the Muslim leaders drew up a plan of separate electorate for their community.

4. The Muslim League started its annual convention on regular basis from :

- (a) 1916 AD (b) 1919 AD
(c) 1924 AD (d) 1925 AD
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. Re-Exam (Pre) 2020

Ans. (e)

All India Muslim League was established in 1906 at Dhaka. Nawab of Dhaka Salimullah was his founder. Its annual session was held in Karachi in 1907 and then in 1908 in Amritsar. After this, its session have occurred erratically in different parts of country. However BPSC has accepted option (d) as correct answer which is not correct.

5. Who propounded the two-nation theory prior to the Pakistan Resolution of the Muslim League?

- (a) Sir Syed Ahmed Khan (b) Muhammad Iqbal
(c) Liaquat Ali Khan (d) M. A. Jinnah
(e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. Assistant Audit Officer 2022

Ans. (a)

In Lahore session of March, 1940 of Muslim League, the two-nation theory was adopted which is founding principle of the Pakistan Movement. However, Poet & Scholar Md. Iqbal talked about separate homeland for Muslims in 1930 and even before him Sir Syed Ahmed Khan talked about same due to which Sir Syed Ahmed Khan is considered the Architect of the two-nation theory.

Morley-Minto Reforms

1. Whom did Rajendra Prasad consider as the father of Pakistan?

- (a) Md. Jinnah (b) Lord Mountbatten
(c) Lord Minto (d) Liaquat Ali Khan
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C. (Pre.) 2017

Ans. (c)

Lord Minto was part of the Minto-Morley reforms of 1909 which introduced communal electorate in India and thus sowed the seeds of partition of India. Rajendra Prasad thus rightly considered him as Father of Pakistan.

Delhi Durbar and Change of Capital

1. Bihar became a separate state during the British rule in the year :

- (a) 1905 (b) 1912
(c) 1936 (d) 1946

44th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (b)

In December, 1911, the imperial court (Delhi Durbar) was organized for greeting on the arrival of British King George V and Queen Mary to India. British emperor proclaimed cancellation of Bengal partition in Delhi Durbar as well as separated Bihar and Orissa from Bengal. In 1912, Bihar and Orissa were separated from Bengal and organised in administrative units.

Lucknow Session of Congress

(The Lucknow Pact)

Home Rule League Movement

1. Who earned the title of 'Recruiting Sergeant of the British' for his support to the government during the First World War?

- (a) Motilal Nehru (b) Mahatma Gandhi
(c) Gopal Krishna Gokhale (d) Madan Mohan Malaviya
(e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2022

Ans. (b)

During the first World War Mahatma Gandhi decided to support the British government in India because he hoped that after the end of the war, the British government would grant self-rule to Indians. It was due to this support that he was called the 'Recruiting Sergeant of the British'.

2. Who among the following did not contribute to Home Rule League?

- (a) Bal Gangadhar Tilak (b) Annie Besant
(c) S. Subramaniam Iyer (d) T.S. Alcott

40th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (d)

T.S. Alcott was not associated with Home Rule League but was related to Theosophical Society. Tilak started Indian Home Rule League in April, 1916 and on the other hand, Annie Besant started Home Rule League in September, 1916. S. Subramaniam Iyer was also associated with the Home Rule League of Annie Besant.

3. In which conference could the Home-Rule supporters demonstrate their political power successfully?

- (a) Lucknow Conference of Congress in 1916
(b) All India Trade Union Conference held at Bombay in 1920
(c) First U.P. Farmers Association held in 1918.
(d) Joint A.I.T.U.C and N.T.U. Sabha at Nagpur in 1938.

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (a)

The Lucknow Session of Congress in December 1916 presented the Home Rule Leagues with the long-awaited opportunity for demonstrating their strength. Tilak's Home Rule League established a tradition to which Congress was pinned for many years.

4. Home Rule Movement was symbol of starting a new phase of freedom movement in India because :

- (a) It put a perfect project for the self-Government before the nation
- (b) Leadership of the movement came in the hands of Gandhiji
- (c) Hindus and Muslims started to struggle jointly
- (d) It established co-ordination between extremists and moderates

41st B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (a)

It is true that Home Rule Movement was a symbol of starting a new phase of Freedom Movement in India because it put a perfect picture of the self-governance before the Nation. The object of this Home Rule League was to attain Home-Rule or Self-Governance within the British Empire by all Constitutional means and to educate and organize public opinion in the Country towards the attainment of the same. Both Tilak and Besant toured all over the country and carried out the message of the Home Rule among the masses. Thus, the Home Rule Movement became a powerful Movement during the First World War. The Movement aimed at self-Government to be granted to India within the British dominions during the war. It was within Constitutional limits.

5. Consider the following events during India's Freedom Struggle :

- 1. Home Rule Movement 2. Surat Split**
3. Kheda Satyagraha 4. Minto-Morley Reforms

Which of the following is the correct chronological order of the events given above?

- (a) 1-3-2-4 (b) 2-4-1-3
- (c) 1-4-2-3 (d) 2-3-1-4

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (b)

Surat Split	—	1907
Minto-Morley Reforms	—	1909
Home Rule Movement	—	1916
Kheda Satyagrah	—	1918

Gandhi and his Early Movements

1. In which of the following colleges, Gandhiji studied?

- (a) Samaldas College, Bhavnagar
- (b) Dharmendrasinhji College, Rajkot
- (c) Gujarat College, Ahmedabad
- (d) Bahauddin College, Junagadh
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2020

Ans (a)

Gandhiji studied in Samaldas Arts College, Bhavnagar during the year of 1885.

2. To sort out whose legal problem was Mahatma Gandhi invited in South Africa in 1893?

- (a) Sheikh Abdullah of Kashmir
- (b) Titu Mir of Bengal
- (c) Imdad Imam of Bihar
- (d) Dada Abdullah of Gujarat
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2018

Ans. (d)

Gandhi arrived Durban, in 1893 to serve as legal counsel to a Dada Abdullah of Gujarat.

3. Which of the following was Gandhiji's first Satyagraha Movement in India in which he used Civil Disobedience?

- (a) Champaran (b) Kheda
- (c) Ahmedabad (d) Rowlatt Satyagraha
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (a)

Champaran Satyagraha of 1917 was the first Civil Disobedience Movement led by Gandhiji in India. In 1917, in the Champaran (Bihar), farmers were protesting against having to grow indigo with barely any payment for it from British. On the invitation of Raj Kumar Shukla, Gandhiji went there and started non-violent protest against this, which eventually led to acceptance of the demands of farmers. This was the first victory of Satyagraha.

4. Which of the following was the first Satyagraha of Mahatma Gandhi in India?

- (a) Ahmedabad (b) Bardoli
- (c) Champaran (d) Individual

64th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

5. In response to the mass agitation of the Champaran Movement, the British Government took which step to address the issue?

- (a) Appointed Mahatma Gandhi as the Governor of Champaran
- (b) Enforced strict curfew and imposed Martial Law in the region
- (c) Instituted the Champaran Agrarian Committee
- (d) Declared Champaran as an independent State

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (c)

To find a solution for the Champaran movement (1917), the British government set up the Champaran Agrarian Committee to look into the grievances of the peasants.

6. Who saved the life of Gandhiji during Champaran Satyagraha?

- (a) Ravindra Pathak
- (b) Batak Mian
- (c) Hamid Ansari
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

68th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (b)

Batak Mian was a cook for a British manager of an Indigo plantation in Bihar known as Erwin in popular memory. During Champaran Satyagrah he invited Gandhiji for dinner and coerced Batak Mian to poison Gandhi through food. But Batak Mian while serving food to Gandhiji, broke down and told Gandhiji about the poison and Gandhiji escaped unhurt. This story was corroborated by Dr. Rajendra Prasad in one of his speeches given in 1950s at Motihari which is mentioned in Delhi University Professor Dr. Girish Mishra's article "Gandhi's Champaran Struggle" published in The Mainstream.

7. The cook from Bihar who saved Mahatma Gandhi's life from a murder attempt by food poisoning in 1917 was

- (a) Muzaffar Ahmad
- (b) Batak Mian
- (c) Mir Bakawal
- (d) None of them

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

8. In which of the following movements did Mahatma Gandhi make the first use of the hunger strike as a weapon?

- (a) Non-Cooperation Movement
- (b) Bardoli Satyagraha
- (c) Ahmedabad Strike
- (d) Rowlatt Satyagraha

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (c)

In year 1918, Gandhiji joined the Ahmedabad strike on the issue of plague bonus of labourers of Ahmedabad cotton mill on strike. And here for the first time he started the hunger strike.

9. Who was the secretary of Mahatma Gandhi during Noakhali?

- (a) Nirmal Kumar Bose
- (b) Mahadeo Desai
- (c) Pyare Lal
- (d) Ballabh Bhai Patel

41st B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (c)

Pyare Lal was the secretary of Mahatma Gandhi during the Noakhali period. His sister Dr. Susheela Naiyar was the personal doctor of Mahatma Gandhi. Pyare Lal also played a significant role in Dandi March.

10. In which of the following Satyagraha movements, did Gandhiji not participate directly?

- (a) Rajkot Satyagraha
- (b) Khera Satyagraha
- (c) Vaikom Satyagraha
- (d) Non-cooperation movement

41st B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (c)

Gandhi did not participate in Vaikom Satyagraha directly. While Rajkot Satyagraha, Khera Satyagraha, and Non-cooperation Movement were led by Gandhiji. He agreed to settle an agreement with the ruler of Rajkot by mediation with Viceroy after 4 day hunger strike in reference to Rajkot Satyagraha.

11. Who among the following capitalists served as an AICC treasurer for many years and went to jail in 1930?

- (a) G. D. Birla
- (b) Jammalal Bajaj
- (c) J. R. D. Tata
- (d) Balchand Hirachand

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (b)

Jammalal Bajaj was unique among capitalists as he was a full-time Congress activist (he served as an AICC treasurer for many years and went to jail in 1923 and 1930). Balchand Hirachand urged fellow businessmen in a letter to the FICCI in April, 1930 to give up the policy of sitting on the fence and throw in their lot with those that were fighting for Swaraj. In May, 1930, FICCI also decided to boycott the Round Table Conference as long as Gandhiji stayed away from it and the Viceroy made a definite promise regarding the dominion status.

12. Gandhi's close English compatriot during the freedom movement was :

- (a) Thomas Moore
- (b) A. O. Hume
- (c) Charles Andrews
- (d) William Wavell

46th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2004

Ans. (c)

Charles Andrews (Deenbandhu Andrews) was Professor at St. Stephan's College Delhi. He had affection for Indians and also wanted to be an Indian. He was very close to Rabindranath Tagore, Gopal Krishna Gokhale, and Mahatma Gandhi. He lived with Gandhiji in Phoenix Farm. Gandhiji gave the title of Deen Bandhu for his love and care to poor. Andrews also became President of All India Trade Union Congress in February 1925 to 1927. He accompanied Gandhi as an associate to Round Table Conference in London.

13. Who was the 'political guru' of Mahatma Gandhi?

- (a) Dadabhai Naoroji
- (b) M. G. Ranade
- (c) Surendranath Banerjee
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

B.P.S.C. Headmaster 07-12-2023

Ans. (e)

Gopal Krishna Gokhale is the political guru of Mahatma Gandhi. This is because, after Mahatma Gandhi's return from South Africa, Gopal Krishna Gokhale was the person who guided him with his immense knowledge about Indian issues. Due to his encouragement and advice, Mr. Gandhi visited the country to understand the miserable life of the people.

14. Who participated in 'Satyagraha' started by Gandhiji at Ahmedabad in 1917-18?

- (a) Cultivators class
- (b) Industrial workers
- (c) Public
- (d) Middle Class

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (b)

Gandhiji's first great experiment in Satyagraha happened in 1917, in Champaran (Bihar). Gandhiji's next activity was in 1918 at Ahmedabad where agitation was going on between the industrial workers and the owners of a cotton textile mill for the Plague bonus. While Gandhiji was negotiating with the mill owners, he advised the workers to go on strike and to demand increase in Plague Bonus. Having advised the strikers to depend upon their conscience, Gandhiji himself went on a "fast unto death" to strengthen the workers resolved to continue the strike. The mill owners gave up, and a settlement was reached after 21 days of the strike. The mill owners agreed to submit the whole issue to a tribunal. The strike was withdrawn and later awarded the 35% Bonus that the workers had demanded. Ambalal Sarabhai's sister, Anasuya Behn, was one of the main lieutenants of Gandhi in this struggle in which her brother and Gandhiji's friend were one of the main advisories.

15. Who drew Gandhiji's attention to the plight of indigo peasants in Champaran?

- (a) Rajendra Prasad
- (b) Anugrah Narayan Sinha
- (c) Acharya Kripalani
- (d) Raj Kumar Shukla
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (d)

The story of Champaran began in the early 19th century when European planters had involved the cultivators in agreements that forced them to cultivate Indigo on 3/20th of their land (Tinkathia System). Towards the end of 19th century, German synthetic dyes forced Indigo out of the market and the European planters of Champaran, to remove the obligation of cultivating Indigo on the cultivators tried to secure enhancements in rents and other illegal dues as a price for the release. Resistance surfaced in 1908, but momentum came when Rajkumar Shukla (a local man) decided to follow Gandhiji and persuaded him to come to Champaran and investigate the problem.

16. How much part of the land was kept in trust for the cultivation of indigo in Bihar under Tinkathiya system?

- (a) 01/10
- (b) 01/03
- (c) 03/20
- (d) 03/25
- (e) None of the above / More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

17. At which place of Bihar, Gandhiji started Satyagraha movement for the first time in India :

- (a) Patna
- (b) Gaya
- (c) Madhubani
- (d) Champaran

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of the above question.

18. The Champaran Movement was basically against:

- (a) Land revenue
- (b) Cash crops
- (c) Agricultural policies of the British Government
- (d) Land grants
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. Re-Exam (Pre) 2020

Ans. (b)

The Champaran Movement (1917) was started mainly as a protest against cash crops.

19. **Champaran Satyagraha was related to :**

- (a) Ezaredari (b) Tinkathia
(c) Jenmis (d) None

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

20. **Who drew Mahatma Gandhi's attention towards the exploitation of the peasants by the European Indigo planters?**

- (a) Baba Ram Chandra
(b) Raj Kumar Shukla
(c) Swami Sahajananda Saraswati
(d) Sri Krishna Sinha
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (b)

Rajkumar Shukla decided to follow Gandhiji and persuaded him to come to Champaran and investigate the problem. Acharya J.B. Kripalani was one of the Mahatma Gandhi's colleagues in his Champaran investigation. Rajendra Prasad, Mahadev Desai, C.F. Andrews, Dr. Anugrah Narayan Sinha, Raj Kishor Prasad, H.S. Polak were Gandhi's colleagues in his Champaran Movement.

21. **Who invited Gandhiji Champaran?**

- (a) Rajendra Prasad (b) Raj Kumar Shukla
(c) Mazharul Haq (d) Krishna Sahay
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

64th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (b)

Rajkumar Shukla requested Mahatma Gandhi to visit Champaran meeting him in Lucknow.

22. **Who decided to persuade Gandhiji to come to Champaran?**

- (a) S. N. Sinha
(b) Raj Kumar Shukla
(c) Surendranath Banerjee
(d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

B.P.S.C. Headmaster 07-12-2023

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

23. **Who invited Gandhiji to come Champaran?**

- (a) Rajkumar Shukla (b) Rajendra Prasad
(c) Jayaprakash Narayan (d) Krishna Sahai

(e) None of the above More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

24. **The person not connected with Champaran movement was-**

- (a) Rajendra Prasad (b) Anugrah Narayan Sinha
(c) J.B. Kripalani (d) Jai Prakash Narayan

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (d)

Jai Prakash Narayan was not associated with Champaran Movement, while other names given in options were associated with Champaran Movement.

25. **Who is not related to the Champaran Satyagraha of 1917?**

- (a) J. B. Kriplani (b) Rajkumar Shukla
(c) Rajendra Prasad (d) Ram Manohar Lohia
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (d)

Ram Manohar Lohia was not related to the Champaran movement.

26. **In which Farmers' Movement did Mahatma Gandhi participate first of all?**

- (a) Khera (b) Champaran
(c) Bardoli (d) Baroda

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (b)

Gandhi, the exponent of the Satyagraha Movement, staged his first Satyagraha in Champaran, Bihar in 1917. The poor peasants, the indigo planters of the district, invited Gandhi to come there to see the grievances of the much-exploited peasants. Gandhiji returned from South Africa in 1915, and in 1917 he launched his first successful Satyagraha in Champaran on the request of Rajkumar Shukla.

27. **At which place in Bihar Gandhiji had his first Satyagraha?**

- (a) Champaran (b) Chhapra
(c) Bettiah (d) Patna

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

28. **Who was the National Leader of Champaran Indigo movement?**

- (a) Mahatma Gandhi (b) Birsa Munda

- (c) Baba Ramchandra (d) Ram Singh

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (a)

The national leader of Champaran Indigo Movement was Mahatma Gandhi.

29. "He was a great unifier in India who taught us not only bare tolerance of others but the willing acceptance of them as our friends and comrades in common undertakings" who said it?

- (a) Subhash Chandra Bose
(b) Balgangadhar Tilak
(c) Rajendra Prasad
(d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

BPSC (Tre-3) {Class 9-10}-2024

Ans. (e)

The line in tribute to Mahatma Gandhi "He was a great unifier in India who fought us not only bare tolerance of others but the willing acceptance of them as our friends and comrades in common undertakings" was said by Pandit Jawahar Lal Nehru.

Peasant Movement and Kisan Sabha

1. 'Nai-Dhobi Band' was a form of Social boycott in 1919 which—

- (a) was started by the farmers of Pratapgarh district
(b) was a movement started by saints for the emancipation of the people lower classes
(c) was a step against contractors of lower castes by landlords
(d) was a movement against contractors by lower castes

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (a)

Towards the end of 1919, the first signs of grass-roots peasant activity were evident in the reports of a Nai-Dhobi Band (a form of social boycott) in an estate of Pratapgarh district. In the summer of 1920 in the villages of Taluqdari Oudh, Kisan meetings called by village panchayats became frequent. The names of Jhinguri Singh and Durgapal Singh were associated with this development. But soon another leader became famous by the name of Baba Ramchandra, who not only emerged as the leader but also played an important role in the Movement.

Baba Ramchandra, a Brahmin from Maharashtra, was a wanderer who had left home at the age of thirteen.

In the middle of 1920, he emerged as a leader of the peasants of Awadh and soon demonstrated considerable leadership and organizational capacities. His efforts helped to form 'Awadh Kisan Sabha' in 1920.

2. The Sarabandi Campaign of 1922 was led by

- (a) Chittaranjan Das (b) Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel
(c) Rajendra Prasad (d) Lala Lajpat Rai
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (b)

The Sarabandi (No tax) campaign of 1922 was led by Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel.

3. Swami Sahajananda was related to which of the following?

- (a) Tribal Movement in Bihar
(b) Labour Movement in Bihar
(c) Peasant Movement in Bihar
(d) Caste Movement in Bihar
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (c)

Swami Sahajanand was related to peasant movement in Bihar. During the decade of 1930, Swami Sahajanand was closely associated with the Kisan Sabha Movement. The Bihar Kisan Sabha was founded by Swami Sahajanand Saraswati, and he was elected as the President of first All India Kisan Sabha Conference held at Lucknow in 1936.

4. What was the aim of Eka Movement in Oudh?

- (a) To stop to give rent to the Government
(b) To protect the rights of landlords
(c) End of satyagraha
(d) Transformation of rent into cash.

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (d)

The grassroots leadership of the Eka Movement was Madari Pasi and other low-caste leaders and many small Zamindars. Towards the end of 1921, peasant discontent resurfaced in some northern districts of the United Provinces—Hardoi, Barabanki, Bahraich, Sitapur etc. The issues involved were:
(i) High rents—50 percent higher than the recorded rates;
(ii) Oppression by Thikedars in charge of revenue collection; and
(iii) The practice of share-rents.
The meetings of the Eka or the Unity Movement involved

a symbolic religious ritual in which the assembled peasants vowed that they would:

- i. Pay only the recorded rent but would pay it on time;
- ii. Not leave when evicted;
- iii. Refuse to do forced labour;
- iv. No help to the criminals;
- v. Abide by Panchayat decisions.

By March 1922, however, severe repression on the part of the authorities succeeded in bringing the Eka Movement to its end.

5. 'Eka Movement' was launched in the rural areas of which region?

- (a) Bihar
- (b) Punjab
- (c) Bengal
- (d) Awadh
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2018

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of the above question.

6. Who presided over the first session of All India Kisan Sabha?

- (a) Swami Sahajanand
- (b) Indulal Yagnik
- (c) N.N. Ranga
- (d) P.C. Joshi

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (a)

All India Kisan Sabha was founded in Lucknow in April, 1936 with Swami Sahajanand Saraswati as the President and N.G. Ranga as the general secretary. Later, it was renamed All India Kisan Sabha. A Kisan manifesto was issued and started a periodical session under Indulal Yagnik. The Bihar Kisan Sabha was founded by Swami Sahajanand Saraswati. The All India Kisan Sabha and the Congress held their second session in Faizpur in 1936. The Congress manifesto (especially the agrarian policy) for the 1937 provincial elections was strongly influenced by the All India Kisan Sabha's agenda.

7. Swami Sahajanand Saraswati published a journal named :-

- (a) Jankranti
- (b) Hunkar
- (c) Krishak Samachar
- (d) Vidrohi
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C. (Pre.) 2017

Ans. (b)

Swami Sahajanand Saraswati (1889-1950) was a Sanyasi and a prominent farmers' right activist. He was also an Indian freedom fighter. He was a forceful writer and ran the Hindi weekly Hunkar from Patna.

8. Akhil Bhartiya Kisan Congress was founded in:

- (a) 1936 AD
- (b) 1939 AD
- (c) 1942 AD
- (d) 1945 AD
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above.

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (a)

The first meeting of All India Kisan Sabha was held in April 1936 in Lucknow. It was presided over by Swami Sahajanand Saraswati. This meeting was addressed by Jawahar Lal Nehru also. In this meeting, Swami Sahajanand Saraswati was chosen as the President and N.G. Ranga was the secretary of All India Kisan Sabha.

9. Who was elected the first President of All India Kisan Sabha at Lucknow in 1936?

- (a) N.G. Ranga
- (b) E.M.S. Namboodripad
- (c) Swami Sahajanand Saraswati
- (d) Acharya Narendra Dev
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above.

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

10. Where was the first All India Kisan Maha Sabha formed?

- (a) Allahabad
- (b) Kolkata
- (c) Lucknow
- (d) Patna

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

11. Swami Sahajanand was related with –

- (a) Tribal Movement in Bihar
- (b) Caste Movement in Bihar
- (c) Farmers Movement in Bihar
- (d) Labour Movement in Bihar

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (c)

Swami Sahajanand Saraswati founded Bihar Provincial Kisan Sabha and also became the President of All India Kisan Sabha. He was related to the farmer's Movement in Bihar. Here, Sahajanand Saraswati was joined by Karyanand Sharma, Yadunandan Sharma, Rahul Sankritayan, Panchanan Sharma, Jamun Karjiti, etc. In 1935, the Provincial Kisan Sabha adopted the anti-zamindari slogan. The Provincial Kisan Sabha developed a rift with the Congress over 'Bakasht land' issue because of an unfavourable Government resolution which was not acceptable by the Sabha. Swami Sahajanand came to be addressed as 'Kisan Pran' (Life of Kisans) by his Kisan Sabha followers.

12. Who was connected with the Bihar Kisan Sabha?

- (a) Swami Sahajanand
- (b) Karyananda Sharma
- (c) Rahul Sankrityayan
- (d) Yadunandan Sharma
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

64th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (e)

Peasant Movement in Bihar was started under the leadership of Swami Sahajanand Saraswati. He founded Bihar Kisan Sabha in 1929. He was helped by Karyanand Sharma, Rahul Sankrityan, Panchanan Sharma, Yadunandan Sharma and many other communist leaders to bring that movement to village level.

13. Who formed Bihar Provincial Kisan Sabha?

- (a) Swami Sahajanand Saraswati
- (b) Ram Sundar Singh
- (c) Ganga Sharan Sinha
- (d) Ramanand Mishra
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

14. The Tebhaga Movement was started in 1946 from Bengal under the leadership of :

- (a) Muslim League
- (b) Kisan Sabha
- (c) Indian National Congress
- (d) Trade Union
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. Re-Exam (Pre) 2020

Ans (b)

Tebhaga movement was peasant agitation started in Bengal in 1946 by Kisan Sabha.

At that time sharecroppers had Contracted to give half of their harvest to the landlords. The demand of Tebhaga (sharing by third) movement was to reduce the landlord share to one-third.

15. Swami Sahajananda Saraswati formed the All India United Kisan Sabha with the demand for the 'nationalization of land and waterways' :

- (a) Just before his death
- (b) At a very young age
- (c) In the 1930s
- (d) In the 1920s

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (a)

Swami Sahajananda Saraswati formed the All India United Kisan Sabha with the demand for the 'Nationalization of land and waterways' just before his death (his death in 1950). The All India Kisan Sabha was formed in April, 1936 at Lucknow with Swami Sahajanand as President. Sahajanand just before his death focused on the future Peasant Movement by forming an All-India United Kisan Sabha (AIUKS) whose basic demand was the Nationalization of land and waterways and all sources of energy and wealth.

16. Who was associated with Kisan Movement in Bihar?

- (a) Rajendra Prasad
- (b) C.R. Das
- (c) Motilal Nehru
- (d) Bhagat Singh

44th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (a)

In the context of the question, Dr. Rajendra Prasad was associated with the Kisan Movement in Bihar. He was the President of the Constituent Assembly. After the commencement of the Constitution, he became the first President of India.

17. The Congress took a critical stand over the Montford Reforms in 1918, which led to break up with the old moderate remnants (Sapru, Jayakar and Chintamani) who formed the

- (a) Indian National Liberal Federation
- (b) Servants of India Society
- (c) Swaraj Party
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

68th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (a)

When the Montford Reforms report was made public in 1918, congress got divided over it. The moderates accepted it while extremists opposed it. This resulted in a schism in the Congress with moderate leaders forming the 'Indian National Liberal Federation' in the year 1918. The party was founded by Surendra Nath Banerjee, and T.B. Sapru, V.S. Srinivas Sastri and M.R. Jayakar were among its prominent leaders.

Trade Union and Communist Party

1. Who was the first President of All India Trade Union Congress?

- (a) B.T. Ranade
- (b) Satya Bhakta
- (c) Lala Lajpat Rai
- (d) N.M. Joshi

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (c)

The All India Trade Union Congress (AITUC) was founded in Bombay on October 31, 1920 by N. M. Joshi with Lala Lajpat Rai as its first President, Joseph Baptista as Vice President and Diwan Chaman Lal Bajaj as General Secretary. The motive behind its formation was the establishment of the International Labour Union in 1919.

2. When was All India Trade Union Congress established in Bombay?

- (a) 1920 (b) 1925
(c) 1929 (d) 1935

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

3. Who was the first Indian to be the member of Communist International?

- (a) M.N. Roy (b) Muzaffar Ahmad
(c) S.A. Dange (d) None of the above

40th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (a)

The Communist International was founded in 1919 by Vladimir Ilyich Lenin and Russian Party (Bolshevik). M.N. Roy visited Moscow on the invitation of Vladimir Lenin and became a member of Communist International. He was the first Indian to be the member of the Communist International.

4. The Revolutionary phase of the trade union movement in India was :

- (a) 1939-45 (b) 1926-39
(c) 1918-26 (d) 1914-18

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (b)

The revolutionary phase of the Trade Union Movement in India is considered from 1926 to 1939. M. N. Roy, Muzaffar Ahmad, Shripad Amrit Dange, Shauqat Usmani, etc. were the main leaders during its militant phase.

Rowlatt Act and Jallianwala Bagh Massacre (1919)

1. When was the Rowlatt Act passed?

- (a) 1909 (b) 1919
(c) 1930 (d) 1942

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (b)

During the viceroyalty of Lord Chelmsford, a sedition committee was appointed by the Government in 1917 with Justice Rowlatt, which made certain recommendations to curb sedition activity in India. The Rowlatt Act, 1919, gave unbridled powers to the Government to arrest and imprison suspects without trial. The Act caused a wave of anger among all sections of the society. A well-known description of the bill at that time was: No Daleel, No Vakil, No appeal which means No plea, No lawyer, No appeal.

2. Which of the following Acts enabled the British Government to suspend the right of Habeas Corpus?

- (a) The Indian Councils Act, 1909
(b) The Indian Councils Act, 1919
(c) The Rowlatt Acts, 1919
(d) The Government of India Act, 1935
(E) None of the above/More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. Assistant Audit Officer 2022

Ans. (c)

The Rowlatt Act, 1919 was passed in March 1919 which gave police such sweeping powers that anyone could be arrested anytime and could be detained without any trial. Thus this act gave the British Government to suspend the right of Habeas Corpus.

3. The Jallianwala Bagh Massacre happened in the context of which Gandhian Satyagraha?

- (a) Swadeshi Satyagraha (b) Rowlatt Satyagraha
(c) Bardoli Satyagraha (d) Individual Satyagraha
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

64th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (b)

Rowlatt Act also known as black Act (termed by Gandhiji) was a legislative Act passed by the Imperial Legislative Council in 1919. The Act allowed the British Government to arrest any Indian without any trial or warrant. The Act was based on Sedition Committee. In Rowlatt Satyagraha, Gandhiji tried to utilize the Home Rule League.

4. Indian National Congress opposed the Rowlatt Act because it aimed-

- (a) To limit the individual liberty
(b) To ban on Indian National Congress
(c) To enlarge the communal delegations
(d) To imprison national leaders charging the traitors to the nation

41st B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (a)

In March, 1919, the Imperial Legislative Council of British India passed the Rowlatt Act. The Imperial Legislative Council passed this law so they could try certain cases without a jury decision and detain people without fair and proper trial. Mostly the Indian public disliked this Act because it aimed to limit individual liberty.

5. The massacre of the crowd at Jallianwala Bagh at Amritsar took place on :

- (a) May 5, 1918 (b) April 1, 1919
(c) April 13, 1919 (d) July 29, 1919

38th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1992

46th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (c)

The Jallianwala Bagh Massacre or Amritsar Massacre was an important incident in the history of Indian Freedom Movement during the British rule. On April 13, 1919 the infamous Jallianwalla Bagh incident took place. On that day a large crowd gathered in the enclosed ground of Jallianwalla Bagh to protest against the Government's new repressive measures and to protest against the arrest of two famous leaders of Punjab Dr. Saifuddin Kitchlu and Dr. Satyapal. Others had come to attend the annual Baisakhi fair. Being outside from the city, many villagers were unaware of the martial law that had been imposed. Dyer entered the area, blocked the exit points, and opened fire on the crowd, killing thousands of people.

6. Why did people gather to demonstrate at Jallianwala Bagh?

- (a) To protest against the arrest of Gandhi and Lajpat Rai
(b) To protest against the arrest of Kitchlu and Satyapal
(c) To offer prayers on the Baisakhi Day
(d) To protest against the arbitrarily of inhuman acts of the Punjab Government.

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

7. Rabindranath Tagore gave up his 'Knighthood' because of –

- (a) Brutal suppression of Civil Disobedience Movement
(b) Execution of Bhagat Singh
(c) Jallianwala Bagh Tragedy
(d) Chauri Chaura Incident
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (c)

Rabindra Nath Tagore returned his Knighthood to the British Government as a token of protest against the Jallianwala Bagh massacre in 1919.

8. Who from the following killed Michael O' Dwyer responsible for Jallianwala Bagh massacre?

- (a) Prithvi Singh Azad (b) Sardar Kishan Singh
(c) Udham Singh (d) Sohan Singh Josh

45th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (c)

On 13 March, 1940, at Caxton Hall in London, Udham Singh, an Indian Independence activist who had witnessed the events in Amritsar and was himself wounded, shot and killed Michael O'Dwyer, the British Lieutenant-Governor of Punjab at the time of the massacre, who had approved Dwyer's action and was believed to be the main planner.

9. Sir Michael O'Dwyer was shot dead on 13th March, 1940 in London by:

- (a) Madan Lal Dhingra (b) M.P.T. Acharya
(c) V.D. Savarkar (d) Udham Singh
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of the above question.

10. Who was the Prime Minister of England when the Montague-Chelmsford Act was passed in 1919?

- (a) Lloyd George (b) George Hamilton
(c) Sir Samuel Hoare (d) Lord Salisbury
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (a)

David Lloyd George was the Prime minister of England when the Montague-Chelmsford Act was passed in 1919. He was Prime Minister of England from 1916 to 1922.

11. Muddiman Committee was appointed to report on the working of the

- (a) Dyarchy (b) Communal representation
(c) Federalism (d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

BPSC (Tre-3) {Class 9-10}–2024

Ans. (a)

The British Government had set up a Committee under Sir Alexander Muddiman which was popularly known as Muddiman Committee or Reforms Enquiry Committee. The concept behind the Committee's appointment was to make an investigation on the functioning of the Constitution as established in 1921 by the Indian Council Act of 1919, namely the diarchy issue. The Report was submitted in 1925.

Khilafat Movement

1. Which event served as a catalyst for the Khilafat Movement?

- (a) The Treaty of Versailles
- (b) The Partition of Bengal
- (c) The Jallianwala Bagh Massacre
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

BPSC (Tre-3) {Class 6-8}–2024

Ans. (a)

The Ottoman Empire, having sided with the Central Powers during World War I, suffered a major military defeat. The Treaty of Versailles (1919) reduced its territorial extent and diminished its political influence but the victorious Europe powers promised to protect the Ottoman Sultan's status as the caliph. However, under the Treaty of Sevres (1920), territories such as Palestine, Syria, Lebanon, and Iraq were severed from the empire.

2. Why did Mahatma Gandhi support the Khilafat Movement?

- (a) The Khalifa had given shelter to Indian revolutionaries
- (b) Gandhiji wanted to win the support of the Indian Muslims against the British
- (c) The Khalifa supported Indian struggle for freedom
- (d) The Khalifa was a friend of Gandhiji

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (b)

The Indian Muslims were incensed when they discovered that their loyalty had been ruined during the war and the assurances of generous treatment to Turkey after the war, a promise made by British statesmen had no intention of fulfilling it. The Muslims like Ali brothers, Muhammad Ali Hasrat Mohani and Shaukat Ali and Maulana Abul Kalam Azad had organized a Khilafat Party. Gandhi decided to extend their support to the Khilafat Movement as this was an opportunity to unite the Hindu and Muslim. Mahatma Gandhi was elected President of the All-India Khilafat Conference held at Delhi on November 23-24, 1919. The Amritsar Session of the Congress was held in December 1919, which gave a great fillip to the Khilafat agitation.

3. Who viewed the Khilafat Movement as an opportunity for integrating Hindus and Muslims which will not appear again within coming hundred years?

- (a) Ali Brothers
- (b) Abul Kalam Azad

- (c) Mahatma Gandhi
- (d) Khan Abdul Gaffar Khan

40th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

4. In which city was the conference of Khilafat Committee in 1920 held that requested Gandhiji to assume the leadership of Non-co-operation Movement?

- (a) Lucknow
- (b) Lahore
- (c) Allahabad
- (d) Karachi

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (c)

In 1920, Gandhi suggested Khilafat Committee to adopt a programme of non-violent, non-cooperation to protest the Government behaviour. In June, 1920 the Khilafat Committee at Allahabad (Now Prayagraj) unanimously accepted his suggestion and asked Gandhi to lead the Movement. In September, 1920, during the Calcutta session under the presidentship of Lala Lajpat Rai, resolution of Non-cooperation Movement was adopted.

5. Moplah Rebellion in 1921 was an offshoot of :

- (a) Khilafat Movement
- (b) Mutiny of 1857
- (c) Swadeshi Movement
- (d) Non-Cooperation Movement

43rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (a)

The Moplah peasants revolted against the Hindu landlord's oppressive policies, which were in alliance with the British. The Hindu landlords redistributed their lands and the Moplahs, who had been suffering, were tempted to revolt, a pitched battle between the British regiment and the Moplahs which killed several Europeans. On the other hand, the Khilafat Movement also turned more aggressive, and the situation become very confusing, and it was very difficult to make a difference between the meetings of Khilafat Movement and the meeting by Moplah peasants. Thus, both the Movements were merged together.

Non-Cooperation Movement

1. The Non-Cooperation Movement was started in –

- (a) 1918
- (b) 1919
- (c) 1920
- (d) 1921

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (c)

In September, 1920, Congress met in Calcutta in a special session in which Gandhi proposed the Non-cooperation resolution which was opposed by C.R. Das. In December, 1920, at annual Congress Session in Nagpur, it was thoroughly discussed and endorsed by all. During the Nagpur Session, it was C.R.Das who proposed the Non-cooperation resolution.

2. Gandhiji launched the Non-Cooperation Movement in –

- (a) 1920 (b) 1919
(c) 1921 (d) 1922

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (a)

The Movement was formally inaugurated on the 1st of August, 1920 by Gandhi ji. Non-cooperation Movement achieved unprecedented success in Western India, Bengal and Northern India. Many distinguished persons like Rajendra Prasad, Motilal Nehru, Lala Lajpat Rai, Vallabhbhai Patel left their lucrative legal practice and joined the Movement with Gandhiji. At that time, Gandhiji Promised Swaraj within one year.

3. Which of the following statements are not correct regarding the Non-Cooperation Movement in the towns?

1. Only the upper caste and the rich took part in the movement.
2. The council elections were boycotted even by the Justice Party of Madras.
3. Thousands of students left government-controlled schools, headmasters and teachers resigned and lawyers gave up their practice.

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 1 and 3 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

68th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (a)

- During the years 1919-1922, two mass movements emerged in India as a means to oppose British rule : the Khilafat movement and the Non-Cooperation movement. The Non-Cooperation Movement marked the beginning of the Gandhian Movement against British colonialism.
- The movement saw significant participation from students, who left government-established schools and colleges in large numbers to join the cause. However, as the movement progressed, some of them began to harbor reservations about Gandhi's program. Hence statement 3 is correct.

- Indian business groups, benefiting from the emphasis on Swadeshi (indigenous production and boycott of foreign goods) by the nationalists, supported the economic boycott called for during the movement.

- Peasants also actively participated in the movement, but it did lead to confrontations between different castes, particularly between the lower and upper castes.

- Initially, the movement was led by individuals from the middle classes, but as time passed, many of them expressed reservations about Gandhi's approach. Hence statement 1 is incorrect.

- The Non-Cooperation Movement provided an opportunity for the oppressed masses to express their grievances against both the British and their Indian oppressors.

- Women played a crucial role in the movement, participating in large numbers, giving up purdah (seclusion), and contributing their ornaments to the Tilak Fund.

- The movement faced violent reprisals from the police, resulting in the loss of many lives.

- Regarding the Justice Party, which was active in the Madras Presidency, it did not support the Non-Cooperation Movement. The party sought to work within the existing political system and preferred continued British presence. They disagreed with Mahatma Gandhi, particularly due to his praise for Brahminism. Hence statement 2 is incorrect.

- In summary, the Non-Cooperation Movement saw widespread participation from various sections of society, but as it progressed, some segments showed reservations, and it also faced opposition from political groups like the Justice Party.

4. A pleader of Bihar who left his lucrative practice during Non-Cooperation Movement was :

- (a) Jai Prakash Narayan (b) Rajendra Prasad
(c) Sahajanand Saraswati (d) Raj Kumar Shukla
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (b)

Rajendra Prasad was one of a leader who left his lucrative practice to support non-cooperation movement. He wrote a book named 'India Divided'.

5. In which area was Rahul Sankrityayan active in the Non-Cooperation Movement of 1920?

- (a) Chhapra (b) Delhi
(c) Lucknow (d) Patna

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (a)

Rahul Sankrityayan, original name Kedar Nath Pandey was active in Chhapra in the Non-cooperation Movement. Local leaders like Rahul Sankrityayan and Nagnarayan spread the message of Non-cooperation in Chhapra, Bihar. Mahapandit Rahul Sankrityayan was born Azamgarh (U.P.) (1893 – 1963), he is also called the Father of Hindi Travel literature, and was one of the most widely travelled scholars of India, spending forty-five years of his life on travels away from his home.

6. Who led cultivators in Bihar during the Non-cooperation Movement?

- (a) Swami Vidyanand (b) Raj Kumar Shukla
(c) Shri Krishna Singh (d) J.B. Sen
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (a)

Swami Vidyanand was a peasant leader who led several agitations for the redressal of peasants grievances in Bihar. Swami Vidyanand while campaigning for the non-cooperation movement linked up peasant issue with it.

7. Due to which of the event, Mahatma Gandhi halted the Non-Cooperation Movement?

- (a) Kakori Case
(b) Chauri-Chaura incident
(c) Jallianwala Bagh Massacre
(d) Muzaffarpur case

46th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2004

Ans. (b)

The infamous Chauri-Chaura incident took place in a small town by the same name near Gorakhpur in Uttar Pradesh in February, 1922. This painful event led to the suspension of the Non-Cooperation Movement by Mahatma Gandhi.

8. Which of the following statements regarding the Indian freedom struggle is not correct?

- (a) Mahatma Gandhi was arrested in the year 1921.
(b) Gandhiji withdrew from the Non-Cooperation Movement due to the Chauri-Chaura Incident.
(c) Gandhiji gave his first major public speech at Banaras Hindu University.
(d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

68th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (a)

Gandhiji was arrested on 10 March, 1922 after withdrawal of non-cooperation movement due to the Chauri-Chaura incident. Hence only option (a) is not correct, (b) & (c) are correct.

9. Who organized the 'Swadesh Bandhav Samiti' during the Indian Freedom Struggle?

- (a) Ashwini Kumar Dutta (b) Batukeshwar Dutta
(c) Surya Sen (d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

B.P.S.C. PRT 2023 Shift II

Ans. (a)

Ashwini Kumar Dutta organized the Swadesh Bandhav Samiti during the Indian freedom struggle. It aimed to promote the consumption of indigenous products and the boycott of foreign goods.

10. After which incident, Mahatma Gandhi had called Non-cooperation Movement as his "Himalayan Blunder"?

- (a) Chauri Chaura (b) Kheda Satyagraha
(c) Nagpur Satyagraha (d) Rajkot Satyagraha

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (a)

Mohandas Karamchand Gandhi was among India's most fervent Nationalists, fighting for Indian Independence against British rule. He started Non-Cooperation Movement in 1920. It was the first campaign at the National level. In 1922, 23 policemen trapped inside the station during the protest in a town called Chauri Chaura, were burned to death. After this incident, Mahatma Gandhi called off the Non-cooperation Movement and called it as his "Himalayan Blunder" or a big mistake.

11. In which state is 'Chauri Chaura', where in February 1922 AD a police station was set on fire?

- (a) Rajasthan (b) Madhya Pradesh
(c) Bihar (d) Uttar Pradesh
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Re-Exam) (Pre) 2021

Ans. (d)

On February 4, 1922, protesters set fire to a police post at Chauri Chaura in Gorakhpur district of Uttar Pradesh during the Non-cooperation movement, In which several police personnel were killed.

12. Indicate true sequence of events concerning the postponement of Non-cooperation Movement :

- (1) Police firing in Chauri-Chaura
(2) Police station set fired by violent crowd
(3) Postponement of Movement by Gandhiji
(4) Arresting of Gandhiji

Select your answer of the following code –

- (a) 1, 2, 3 and 4 (b) 2, 1, 3 and 4

(c) 4, 1, 2 and 3

(d) 2, 1, 4 and 3

40th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (a)

On 4th February, 1922, the angry residents of Chauri-Chaura village gathered in front of the police station to protest against the arrest of their leader, while campaigning against the sale of liquor. However the police opened fire on the villagers, which angered them to such an extent that they set the police station on fire killing twenty-three policemen. Gandhi, worried about the increasing use of violence, immediately withdrew the Movement. The working committee of the Congress met in February, 1922 and decided to withdraw the Movement and urged the party workers to get involved in constructive works, such as popularizing Khadi, establishing National schools and working towards Hindu-Muslims unity. Gandhi was arrested on 10th March, 1922 for six years. The Non-cooperation Movement ended. Thus, option (a) is the correct answer.

13. One of the prevailing beliefs in Bihar during the Non-cooperation Movement of 1920-22 was that he would win because Gandhi was:

- (a) was the epitome of religion.
- (b) was an accomplished politician.
- (c) knew the ways to defeat the British.
- (d) knew English.

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (c)

Gandhiji successfully led the mill workers' strike in Ahmedabad, Gujarat in the year 1918 and in the year 1920, in his non-violent non-cooperation with the British government, not only the goods but also the institutions run or supported by the British in India such as legislatures, courts, including boycotting work or school. This program ignited enthusiasm in the country and broke the noose of foreign rule. Gandhiji also brought Hindus and Muslims together on the stage. Gandhiji's raise as a great man His actions created fear among the British rulers and the people of Bihar believed that we would win because Gandhiji knew how to defeat the British. Through constructive work, Gandhi came much closer to the 90 percent of the country's population living in villages than any other Indian leader. In this way, awakening was created in the population of crores living in the villages and by raising the demand of Swarajya from the level of middle class movement, it became a nationwide indomitable mass movement.

14. During 1923-28, the repetition of revolutionary activities in Indian politics was due to :

- (a) Rising influence of leaders like Hardayal and Lajpat Roy

(b) Postponement of non-cooperation movement by Gandhiji

(c) Influences of foreign events

(d) Refusal of Indian demand by Britishers

41st B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (b)

The suspension of Non-cooperation Movement in 1922 and the absence of any political activity in the country disappointed the many Nationalistic people of the country. They were dissatisfied with the political leadership of Mahatma Gandhi and the way of Non-violence in the freedom struggle. They were inspired by the violent revolutionary activities in Russia, China, Ireland and Turkey and they accepted the violent Revolutionary Movements to overthrow the British rule from India. Thus, this duration is considered as the repetition of revolutionary activities in Indian politics.

15. People were urged to abstain from alcohol in Gandhiji's Non-Cooperation Movement. As a result, there was a huge decrease in the revenue of the government. A state government circulated a list of prominent individuals who used to drink alcohol in order to encourage people to drink again. Name that state.

- (a) Andhra Pradesh
- (b) Bihar
- (c) Bombay
- (d) Gujarat
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

64th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (b)

As a result of Gandhiji's Non-Cooperation Movement, there was a huge decrease in the revenue of the government due to people abstaining from alcohol. Therefore, the government of Bihar and Odisha released a list of great and famous people who used to consume alcohol to publicize and disseminate the beneficial effects of alcohol on health. This list included Alexander, Julius Caesar, Napoleon, Shakespeare, etc.

16. "A Sanyasi who came to that district after a spell as an indentured labourer in Fiji, carrying a copy of Tulsidas Ramayana on his back from which he would recite verses to rural audience." The peasant leader referred to here is

- (a) Baba Ram Chandra
- (b) Jhinguri Singh
- (c) Yadunandan Sharma
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

68th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (a)

The Peasant leader referred here is Baba Ram Chandra. As an indentured labourer, he had been to Fiji, an Island nation in Pacific. He was an active participant in non-cooperation movement in Awadh area and organised peasants against the landlords.

Formation of Swaraj Party (1923)

1. Swaraj Party was formed after the failure of the :

- (a) Non-Cooperation Movement
- (b) Quit India Movement
- (c) Civil Disobedience Movement
- (d) Swadeshi Movement

43rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (a)

Swaraj Party was formed by the leaders like Motilal Nehru and Chittaranjan Das in 1923 after the failure of the Non-Cooperation Movement.

2. Swaraj Party was formed following the failure of:

- (a) Non-Cooperation Movement
- (b) Civil Disobedience Movement
- (c) Rowlatt Bill Satyagraha
- (d) Champaran Satyagraha
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

3. Who established Swaraj Party in 1923?

- (a) Mahatma Gandhi
- (b) Vallabhbhai Patel
- (c) C.R. Das and Motilal Nehru
- (d) B.R. Ambedkar
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

4. Who successfully led the Bardoli Satyagraha?

- (a) Vallabhbhai Patel
- (b) Motilal Nehru
- (c) J. B. Kripalani
- (d) Jawaharlal Nehru
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Re-Exam) (Pre)-2021

Ans. (a)

'The Bardoli movement' was Successfully led by Vallabhbhai Patel in the year 1928, Patel was given the title of Sardar by the women of Bardoli.

5. Which of the following movements was led and successful under the leadership of Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel?

- (a) Satyagraha in support of Khadi peasants, Gujarat
- (b) Satyagraha of workers of cotton mills, Ahmedabad, Gujarat
- (c) Satyagraha of Bardoli, Gujarat
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

B.P.S.C. PRT 2023 Shift I

Ans. (c)

In year 1928, the peasant of Bardoli Gujarat started their Satyagraha under the leadership of Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel. They protested against the government proposal into increase land revenue by 30 percentage.

6. Who established Swaraj Dal in Bihar?

- (a) Shri Krishna Singh (b) Ramlal Shah
- (c) Bankim Chandra Mitra (d) Sachindra Nath Sanyal
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (a)

A branch of Swaraj Dal was formed in Bihar which was lead by Sri Krishna Singh.

7. The famous slogan 'Swaraj should be for common people not only for classes' was given by-

- (a) C.R. Das (b) C. Rajagopalachari
- (c) Motilal Nehru (d) Gopi Nath Saha

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (a)

The famous slogan 'Swaraj should be for common people not only for classes' was given by C.R.Das. He wanted "Swaraj for the masses, not for the classes." To him, "Swaraj is Government by the people and for the people."

8. Mahatma Gandhi presided over which Session of the Indian National Congress?

- (a) 1922 (b) 1924
- (c) 1928 (d) 1930
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C. (Pre.) 2017

Ans. (b)

Indian National Congress organised its 39th annual session at Belgaum which is a city in modern day Karnataka. Mahatma Gandhi was the President of this session. This was the only session presided by Gandhiji. It took place in 1924.

Simon Commission (1927)

1. When did Simon Commission visit India?

- (a) 1927 (b) 1928
- (c) 1929 (d) 1931

38th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1992

Ans. (b)

Montagu-Chelmsford reform (Government of India Act), 1919 provided for a Constitutional Commission to review its working. Simon Commission was appointed in November, 1927 by the British Conservative Government under Stanley Baldwin to report on the working of the Indian Constitution established by the Government of India Act of 1919. The Commission consisted of seven members under the chairmanship of Sir John Simon. The commission did not consist of any Indian member, so Indians opposed and boycotted the commission calling it as 'White Commission.' Simon Commission reached Bombay on February 3, 1928.

2. Fill in the blanks:

The Nehru Report was drafted by a Committee headed by and the subject was

- (a) Motilal Nehru and Jawaharlal Nehru; India's relationship with the British Empire
- (b) Jawaharlal Nehru; Local Self-Government in India
- (c) Motilal Nehru; Constitutional arrangements in India
- (d) Jawaharlal Nehru; Constitutional arrangements in India

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (c)

The Nehru Report was drafted by a committee headed by Motilal Nehru and the subject was Constitutional arrangements in India.

Lahore Session of Congress, Proposal of Complete Independence (1929)

1. The proposal of Purna-Swaraj was passed in Lahore Congress in the year-

- (a) 1919 (b) 1929
- (c) 1939 (d) 1942

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (b)

In Lahore session of Congress in 1929, proposal of Purna-Swaraj was passed. After that Jawaharlal Nehru hoisted the flag of India's independence on 31 December, 1929 on the bank of Ravi River at Lahore. It was decided the 26 January, 1930 would be celebrated as Poorna Swaraj Day and hence till 1947, 26 January was celebrated as Poorna Swaraj Day.

2. Who raised the Flag of Independence at the Congress Session of 1929?

- (a) Maulana Muhammad Ali
- (b) Pandit Jawaharlal Nehru
- (c) Vallabhbhai Patel
- (d) Subhas Chandra Bose
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

64th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

3. Which day was declared as 'Purna Swaraj Day' by the Indian National Congress?

- (a) 26-01-1930 (b) 15-08-1947
- (c) 30-01-1948 (d) 31-12-1950
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

4. In which Session Indian National Congress passed Complete Independence (Purna Swaraj) Resolution?

- (a) 1920 AD Nagpur (b) 1924 AD Belgaon
- (c) 1929 AD Lahore (d) 1931 AD Karachi
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Re-Exam) (Pre) 2021

Ans. (c)

The Annual session of the congress was held in Lahore in December 1929. Jawaharlal Nehru was the president of this conference. In this the congress for the first time passed a resolution aiming at Purna Swaraj.

Civil Disobedience Movement

1. Dandi March was undertaken in :

- (a) 1932 (b) 1931
- (c) 1929 (d) 1930

44th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (d)

Mahatma Gandhi started his famous Dandi March accompanied by his trusted volunteers from Sabarmati Ashram on March 12, 1930. The march was over 241 miles, from Gandhi's ashram in Sabarmati to Gujarat's coastal village of Dandi. The volunteers walked for 24 days. On April 5, 1930 he reached Dandi and on 6 April he violated the salt law, manufacturing salt by boiling seawater. This marked the beginning of the Civil Disobedience Movement. This Movement spread all over India under the leadership of Mahatma Gandhi. A leader like C. Rajagopalachari took up Salt March in Tamil Nadu from Trichinopoly to Vedaranyam.

2. Who among the following participated in the Salt Satyagraha of Gandhi?

- (a) Sarojini Naidu
- (b) Rajkumari Amrit Kaur
- (c) Kamla Devi Chattopadhyaya
- (d) All of these

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (d)

On March 12, 1930 Mahatma Gandhi led by selected followers started from Sabarmati Ashram on the famous salt march to Dandi beach to manufacture salt. They reached Dandi on 5th April 1930. There, Gandhiji broke the salt law, marking the launch of Civil Disobedience Movement. Women played a leading part in this movement. All the women (Sarojini Naidu, Rajkumari Amrit Kaur and Kamladevi Chattopadhyaya) given in the options participated in the Salt Satyagraha of Gandhi.

3. The famous Dandi March led by Mahatma Gandhi during the Civil Disobedience Movement covered a distance of approximately—

- (a) 241 Miles
- (b) 400 kilometers
- (c) 200 kilometers
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

BPSC (Tre-3) {Class 6-8}—2024

Ans. (a)

Mahatma Gandhi with his 80 followers marched 240 miles from Sabarmati Ashram to coastal town of Dandi (now located in Navasari district, Gujarat) where they broke the government law by gathering natural salt found on the sea shore, and boiling sea water to produce salt. Salt Satyagraha March started on 12th March 1930 from Sabarmati Ashram and reached Dandi after 24 days on 5th April 1930.

4. What was the ultimate goal of Gandhiji's Salt Satyagraha?

- (a) Repeal of Salt laws
- (b) Curtailment of the government's power
- (c) Economic relief to the common people
- (d) 'Purna Swaraj' for India
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C. (Pre.) 2017

Ans. (e)

Britain's Salt Act of 1882 prohibited Indians from collecting or selling salt. They can only buy it putting financial burden on them. Gandhiji did his Salt Satyagraha to break the salt law and thus curtailing governments' power and also putting pressure for the repeal of salt laws. Hence more than one option is correct. Purna Swaraj was not the aim of Salt Satyagraha.

5. In 1930, Mahatma Gandhi started Civil Disobedience Movement from:

- (a) Sevagram
- (b) Dandi
- (c) Sabarmati
- (d) Wardha

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (b)

Mahatma Gandhi on March 12, 1930, with his 80 volunteers started his famous Dandi March from Sabarmati Ashram to Dandi (in Navsari district of Gujrat) and violated the salt law on April 6, 1930 walking 241 miles in 24 days.

6. For how many days did Dandi March last?

- (a) 10 days
- (b) 20 days
- (c) 24 days
- (d) 30 days
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

7. Agitation against Chaukidari Tax in Begusarai was a part of—

- (a) Non-Cooperation Movement
- (b) Civil Disobedience Movement
- (c) Quit India Movement
- (d) Khilafat Movement

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (b)

Agitation against Chaukidari Tax in Begusarai was a part of the Civil Disobedience Movement.

8. Who led the Salt Satyagraha in Bhagalpur

- (a) Shri Krishna Singh
- (b) Mahadev Lal Sarraf
- (c) Kumar Mishra
- (d) Satyanarayan
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (b)

The Salt Satyagraha at Bihpur in Bhagalpur was led by Mahadev Lal Sarraf, Deep Narayan Singh, Rameshwar Narayan Agrawal, Kailash Behari Lal and Zeharul Hasan Hashmi.

9. After the failure of the Civil Disobedience Movement, Gandhiji gave importance to :

- (a) Constructive programmes
- (b) Limited use of violence
- (c) Negotiation with British
- (d) None of the above

41st B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (a)

Gandhiji gave importance to the constructive programmes after the failure of the Civil Disobedience Movement. In October, 1934 Gandhi decided to move away from the active politics to give his full time to 'Harijanotthan.' In September, 1932 Mahatma Gandhi founded All India Anti-Untouchability League for the welfare of Harijans and in 1933 he published the weekly magazine 'Harijan.'

10. Who was the founder of All India Harijan Sangh in 1932?

- (a) Dr. B. R. Ambedkar
- (b) Jagjivan Ram
- (c) Mahatma Gandhi
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

68th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (c)

If the question is referring to All India Harijan Sevak Sangh then correct option is (c). Harijan Sevak Sangh as an all India institute was formed by Gandhiji in 1932 to eradicate untouchability in India.

11. Prabhavati Devi was the freedom fighter of which field?

- (a) Champaran
- (b) Patna
- (c) Bhagalpur
- (d) Shahabad

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (b)

The women of Bihar such as Prabhavati Devi, Rajvanshi Devi, Suniti Devi and Radhika Devi contributed in the Freedom Movement. Prabhavati Devi was a freedom fighter from Patna.

Gandhi-Irwin Pact

1. Gandhi-Irwin Pact was signed in :

- (a) 1931
- (b) 1935
- (c) 1942
- (d) 1919

44th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (a)

According to Gandhi-Irwin Pact, Gandhiji called off the Civil Disobedience Movement and agreed to take part in second Round Table Conference in London. He also agreed to stop boycotting the British goods. In return Viceroy agreed to withdraw ordinances promulgated against Civil Disobedience Movement and release only those prisoners who were not charged with violence. It was signed on 5th March 1931 between Gandhiji & Viceroy Lord Irwin.

2. In which year the famous Gandhi-Irwin Pact took place?

- (a) 1929 AD
- (b) 1930 AD
- (c) 1931 AD
- (d) 1932 AD
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Re-Exam) (Pre)-2021

Ans. (c)

On March 5, 1931 with the view to involving the congress in the Second Round Table conference, Gandhi- Irwin Pact was signed.

3. Gandhi-Irwin Pact took place in :

- (a) 1930
- (b) 1931
- (c) 1932
- (d) 1933

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

4. The Second Round Table Conference in London was held in the backdrop of the :

- (a) Emerson-Gandhi Pact
- (b) Hailey-Gandhi Pact
- (c) Irwin-Gandhi Pact
- (d) Gandhi-Simon Pact

46th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2004

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

5. Who played an important role in the signing of Gandhi-Irwin Pact?

- (a) Motilal Nehru
- (b) Madan Mohan Malviya
- (c) Tej Bahadur Sapru
- (d) Chintamani

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (c)

After noticing the expansion of Civil Disobedience Movement, Viceroy Lord Irwin released Mahatma Gandhi on January 26, 1931. The conversation started between Gandhi and Irwin in the mid-February, 1931 which was the efforts of Tej Bahadur Sapru and M.R. Jaykar. The pact known as Gandhi-Irwin Pact took place on March 5, 1931. In context to the pact, Sarojini Naidu termed them as 'The Two Mahatmas.'

Round Table Conference

1. Which of the following Indian leaders attended the First Round Table Conference in London?

- (a) Maulana Mohammad Ali
- (b) Maulana Abul Kalam Azad
- (c) Mahatma Gandhi
- (d) Pt. Jawaharlal Nehru

44th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (a)

The report of the Simon Commission was published on 10th June and 24th June, 1930. Political organizations had refused the recommendations of Commission. Main leaders of Congress were in jails. British Government organized 1st Round Table Conference in November, 1930 to January, 1931 in London in the environment of frustration and dissatisfaction. 89 Indian representative members participated in 1st Round Table Conference, but Congress did not participate. Main participants of 1st Round Table Conference were: Tejbahadur Sapru, Srinivas Shastri, Muhammad Ali, Muhammad Shafi, Aga Khan III, Fazlul Haq, Muhammad Ali Jinnah, Homi Modi, M.R. Jaykar, Munje, Bhimrao Ambedkar and Sundar Singh Majithia, etc.

2. The Indian National Congress did not take part in which of the following Round Table Conferences?

- (a) First
- (b) Second
- (c) Third
- (d) Participated in all
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2017

Ans (e)

Indian National Congress did not take part in first & third round table conference. So, option (e) will be correct answer.

3. Mahatma Gandhi returned to India in December, 1931 empty-handed from

- (a) London
- (b) Moscow
- (c) Washington
- (d) Tokyo

44th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (a)

Congress participated for the first time in the Second Round Table Conference. Gandhi, as a sole representative, participated in the Conference but the Conference was declared unsuccessful due to some dissensions and Gandhi returned India in December 1931 empty handed.

4. On which issue did the Second Round Table Conference fail?

- (a) Communal Delegations
- (b) Granting Dominion Status
- (c) The date of transfer of ruling power
- (d) Postponement of Civil Disobedience Movement

41st B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (a)

The Second Round Table Conference ended in December, 1931 in which Mahatma Gandhi took part as sole representative of Congress. The Conference failed completely due to dispute on communal matters. Dalit leader B.R. Ambedkar demanded separate electorates for depressed classes which were refused by Gandhi. Later, the Second Round Table Conference was dismissed on 1 December, 1931 due to dispute on communal delegations.

5. Which Round Table Conference held in 1932?

- (a) First
- (b) Second
- (c) Third
- (d) Fourth

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (c)

The Third Round Table conference was held from 17 November, 1932 to 24 December, 1932.

6. Who wrote the pamphlet 'Now or Never'?

- (a) Md. Jinnah
- (b) Md. Iqbal
- (c) Rahmat Ali
- (d) Khafi Khan
- (e) None of the above/ More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C. (Pre.) 2017

Ans. (c)

Rahmat Ali wrote the Pamphlet, "Now or Never; Are We to Live or Perish Forever?" also known as the Pakistan declaration in 1933. He wrote this addressing British and Indian delegates during the Third Round Table Conference.

Communal Award and Poona

Pact (1932)

1. A separate electoral group was made by the communal Tribunal of Ramsay MacDonald first time in August, 1932–

- (a) for Muslims
- (b) for Indian Christians
- (c) for Anglo-Indians
- (d) for Untouchables

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (d)

British Prime Minister Ramsay Macdonald announced Communal Award on 16 August, 1932. According to Legislative Assembly provisions, few seats of Legislative Assembly were reserved for minorities whose candidates were to be elected by separate electorates. Muslims and Sikhs were already considered as minorities. Now the depressed, Dalits (untouchables) were to be declared as minorities as per provisions of the new law.

2. How many seats were given to depressed classes under Communal Award and Poona Pact?

- (a) 74 and 79 respectively
- (b) 71 and 147 respectively
- (c) 78 and 80 respectively
- (d) 78 and 69 respectively

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (b)

The number of reserved seats for depressed classes in Provincial Legislatures were 71 in Communal Award which was increased to 148 by Poona Pact (Madras = 30, Sindh with Bombay = 15, Punjab = 8, Bihar and Odisha = 18, Central Provinces = 20, Assam = 7, Bengal = 30, United Provinces = 20). However, some books mention that there are 147 seats. In addition to this, 18% seats in General class seats were reserved for depressed class in Central Legislature.

3. The purpose of Poona Pact was:

- (a) Hindu-Muslims unity
- (b) To provide representation of untouchables
- (c) To privileged the Kings
- (d) Reconsideration of Dyarchy

46th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2004

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

Congress Socialist Party (1934)

1. The first meeting of the Congress Socialist Party was held in :

- (a) Delhi
- (b) Nasik
- (c) Patna
- (d) Lahore

44th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (c)

Congress Socialist Party was established in May, 1934 in Patna during the meeting of Congress Committee. In October, 1934, policies and systems of Congress Party were decided in Bombay.

2. The first session of Congress Socialist Party was held in year –

- (a) 1921
- (b) 1934
- (c) 1937
- (d) 1939

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

3. The Congress Socialist Party was founded in 1934 by:

- (a) Jawaharlal Nehru and Vinoba Bhave
- (b) Jawaharlal Nehru and Jay Prakash Narayan
- (c) Jayprakash Narayan and Acharya Narendra Dev
- (d) Ashok Mehta and Dr. Rajendra Prasad
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. Re-Exam (Pre) 2020

Ans. (c)

Congress Socialist Party was formed by Acharya Narendra Dev, Jai Prakash Narayan in October 1934.

4. Jayprakash Narayan was associated with the Party:

- (a) Congress Party
- (b) Communist Party
- (c) Congress Socialist Party
- (d) Kisan Sabha

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (c)

Jai Prakash Narayan, Yogendra Shukla and Acharya Narendra Dev, etc. formed Congress Socialist Party in the year 1934 within the Indian National Congress.

5. Bihar Socialist Party was founded by –

- (a) J.P. Narayan
- (b) Satyabhakta
- (c) M.N. Roy
- (d) Subhash Chandra Bose

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (a)

Phulan Prasad Varma formed the Bihar Socialist Party in 1931, in a meeting held at his home. The socialist party was influenced by the ideologies of Marx and Lenin & also of the Fabian Society. Bihar Socialist Party was formed from within the 'Indian National Congress'. Jai Prakash Narayan, Gangasharan Singh, Rambriksh Benipuri and Ramanand Mishra etc. was associated with Bihar Socialist Party.

6. Who formed the 'Bihar Socialist Party' in 1931?

- (a) Phulan Prasad Varma
- (b) Swami Yoganand
- (c) Narhari Parikh
- (d) Dadabhai Naoroji
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

7. Who started the Asiatic Society of Bengal in 1784?

- (a) Max Muller
- (b) Charles William
- (c) William Jones
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

B.P.S.C. Headmaster 07-12-2023

Ans. (c)

Asiatic Society of Bengal, scholarly society founded on Jan. 15, 1784, by Sir William Jones (a British lawyer and Orientalist) to encourage oriental studies. It was established to encourage Europeans to study about orientals research (Asia) and the surrounding regions.

8. Who is known as “Loknayak”?

- (a) Mahatma Gandhi (b) Subhash Chandra Bose
(c) Jay Prakash Narayan (d) Bal Gangadhar Tilak

46th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2004

Ans. (c)

Jay Prakash Narayan is famous as “Loknayak.” He secretly organized Indian public during ‘Quit- India Movement’ with Ram Manohar Lohia and Aruna Asaf Ali in 1942. He declared “Sampoorna Kranti” at Gandhi Maidan Patna on 5 June, 1974. He was awarded “Bharat Ratna” posthumously in 1999.

9. Which title was given to Jaya Prakash Narayan?

- (a) Praja Hitechhu (b) Lok Nayak
(c) Lokmanya (d) Rashtra Nayak
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

10. By which name is Jay Prakash Narayan known?

- (a) Lokmanya (b) Loknayak
(c) Lokhitvadi (d) Lokneta

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

11. Jay Prakash diwas was celebrated in:

- (a) January, 1946 (b) February, 1946
(c) March, 1946 (d) April, 1946

43rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (d)

In April, 1946, ‘Jay Prakash Day’ was celebrated for the release of Jay Prakash from prison. A rally was conducted in Bankipur Maidan of Patna where the release of Jay Prakash Narayan was demanded and criticism of Government policy regarding the arrest of political persons was made.

12. Shri Narsingh Narayan was –

- (a) Socialist (b) Nationalist
(c) Internationalist (d) Communist

45th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (a)

Shri Narsingh Narayan was a socialist and he was related with Bihar Socialist Party.

13. Who became champion of socialism and wanted to overthrow of British rule, Princely states, Landlordism and Capitalism in 1933?

- (a) Rajendra Prasad (b) Jawaharlal Nehru
(c) Bhulabhai Desai (d) Sardar Patel
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (b)

Jawaharlal Nehru was an avowed supporter of socialism. Nehru wanted to overthrow British rule, Princely states, landlordism and Capitalism in 1933. Nehru's socialism was influenced by socialism of Soviet Union. He travelled the Soviet Union in November, 1927.

Provincial Election and Formation of Cabinet (1937)

1. The Provincial Governments were constituted under the Act of-

- (a) 1935 (b) 1932
(c) 1936 (d) 1947

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (a)

Provincial assembly elections were held under the Indian Government Act, 1935 in which Congress won a full majority in 5 provinces – Madras, Bihar, Central Provinces and Berar, United Province and Orissa. Congress made its ministries in 6 states: Madras, Central Provinces and Berar, Bihar, Bombay, Orissa and United Province in July, 1937. Only in Bengal, Punjab and Sindh Congress did not secure enough support.

2. In which working Committee did the Congress adopt the policy of abolishing land ownership?

- (a) Working Committee, 1937
(b) Working Committee, 1942
(c) Working Committee, 1945
(d) Working Committee, 1946

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (a)

The Congress Working Committee adopted the policy of abolishing land ownership in 1937. Tenancy (Amendment) Act was passed by the Congress Government in United Province and Bihar. Each Congress governed province attempted to improve irrigation facilities and to save farmers from cruel policies of money lenders.

Tripuri Crisis of Congress (1939)

1. Who was elected the President of Indian National Congress in 1938?

- (a) Abul Kalam Azad
- (b) Subhash Chandra Bose
- (c) Pattabhi Sitaramaiya
- (d) J. B. Kripalani

41st B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (b)

Subash Chandra Bose was elected President of Congress in Haripura Session (Gujarat) of February, 1938, unopposed. It is well known that Subhash Chandra Bose was re-elected as President of Tripuri Session (1939) of INC by defeating Pattabhi Sitaramaiya (who was supported by Gandhiji).

Indian Princely States

1. The purpose of the Butler Committee, 1927:

- (a) Modernization of Indian Army
- (b) Innovative modernization of Indian Agriculture.
- (c) Implementation of Sensor over National Newspapers.
- (d) Improvement of relationships between Indian Provinces and the Crown.

46th B.P.C.S. (Pre) 2004

Ans. (d)

The Indian States Committee appointed a committee under the Chairmanship of Sir Harcourt Butler, which was popularly known as 'The Butler Committee' to investigate and clarify the relationship between paramount power and the princes of Princely States in 1927 A.D.

The recommendations of committee were.

The relationship of the paramount power of the state was not merely a contractual relationship but a living, growing relationship shaped by the circumstances and policy.

British paramount preserve the princely State.

The state should not be transferred without their agreement to a relationship with a new government in British India responsible to an Indian Legislature.

2. All India State People's Conference was set up –

- (a) in 1924
- (b) in 1926
- (c) in 1927
- (d) in 1929

40th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (c)

All India State People's Conference was set up in December, 1927. More than 1500 political workers of different States participated in this Conference. All India States People Conference was formed in which men like Balwant Rai Mehta, Manilal Kothari and G.R. Abhyankar played a significant role.

Second World War

1. Who was the British Prime Minister of Britain during the Second World War?

- (a) Clement Attlee
- (b) Anthony Eden
- (c) Winston Churchill
- (d) Herald Wilson

38th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1992

Ans. (c)

Winston Churchill was the Prime Minister of Britain during IInd World War. His tenure was from 1940-45 and 1951-55.

Demand for Pakistan

1. Who among following led the movement for the separate State Pakistan?

- (a) Aga Khan
- (b) Nawab Salim Ullah
- (c) Liaqat Ali Khan
- (d) Md. Ali Jinnah

38th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1992

Ans. (d)

From March 22 to 24, 1940, the session of Muslim League was held at Lahore in the Presidentship of Mohammad Ali Jinnah. In this session, he demanded a separate Muslim Nation apart from India. Jinnah said in his speech that he would not accept anything other than a separate Muslim Nation.

2. The resolution demanding the formation of Pakistan was passed by Muslim league in the year of –

- (a) 1939
- (b) 1940
- (c) 1941
- (d) 1942

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (b)

On March 23, 1940, the Muslim League passed the famous resolution of 'Pakistan' at Lahore Session. The Resolution declared: "No constitutional plan would be workable or acceptable to the Muslims unless contiguous geographical units are demarcated into regions which should be so constituted with such territorial readjustments as may be necessary. That the areas in which the Muslims are numerically in the majority as in the North-Western and Eastern zones of India should be grouped to constitute Independent States in which the constituent units shall be autonomous and sovereign".

Individual Satyagraha (1940)

1. Who started the Individual Civil Disobedience?

- (a) Vinoba Bhave (b) Jawaharlal Nehru
(c) Sardar Patel (d) Shaikat Ali

44th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (a)

After completely rejecting August Proposal, Congress initiated Individual Satyagraha in the leadership of Gandhiji. The Satyagraha was a symbolic statement of moral protest against the British Government's policy for India. On October 17, 1940 Mahatma Gandhi selected Acharya Vinoba Bhave as the first Satyagrahi (the proponent of Satyagraha) and Jawaharlal Nehru as the second.

2. In 1940, Vinoba Bhave started individual Satyagraha from

- (a) Punnappa-Vayalar, Kerala
(b) Nadiad in Kheda district, Gujarat
(c) Pavnar, Maharashtra
(d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

68th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (c)

After rejecting August proposal, individual Satyagrah was started under the leadership of Mahatma Gandhi. He chose Vinoba Bhave in 1940 as his first Satyagrahi. Vinoba Bhave started his individual Satyagrah from Pavnar, Maharashtra.

3. Who was the first Satyagrahi of the Individual Satyagraha Movement?

- (a) Sarojini Naidu (b) C. Rajagopalachari
(c) Vinoba Bhave (d) Subhash Chandra Bose
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

4. Who was the third Satyagrahi of Individual Satyagraha launched by Mahatma Gandhi in 1940?

- (a) Vinoba Bhave (b) Jawaharlal Nehru
(c) Rajendra Prasad (d) Brahma Dutt
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Re-Exam) (Pre)-2021

Ans. (d)

In the year 1940, Gandhiji decided to run individual satyagraha. In this, Vinoba Bhave was become the first, Jawaharlal Nehru was the second and Brahma Dutt was the third.

5. Who decided to oppose the war efforts peacefully by initiating a policy of Individual Civil Disobedience in 1941?

- (a) Tej Bahadur Sapru
(b) Maulana Abul Kalam Azad
(c) Jawaharlal Nehru
(d) Mahatma Gandhi
(e) None of the above / More than one of the above

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Ans. (d)

In the year 1940, Gandhiji decided to run individual Satyagrah or Individual Civil Disobedience. Satyagraha was a symbolic statement of moral protest against the British Government's policy for India.

6. The word 'Sarvodaya' was primarily used by :

- (a) Mahatma Gandhi
(b) Pandit Nehru
(c) Vinoba Bhave
(d) Jai Prakash Narayan

46th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2004

Ans. (a)

The word 'Sarvodaya' was primarily used by Mahatma Gandhi. Vinoba Bhave established the 'Sarvodaya Samaj' to promote the ideas of Mahatma Gandhi.

Cripps Mission (1942)

1. "The offer of Cripps really gave us nothing. If we accepted the offer, we might have to rue in the future _____ War had given India an opportunity for achieving her freedom. We must not lose it by depending upon a mere promise." Who wrote these words?

- (a) Jawaharlal Nehru
(b) Maulana Abul Kalam Azad
(c) Mahatma Gandhi
(d) Subhas Chandra Bose
(e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2022

Ans. (b)

Maulana Abul Kalam Azad say about that proposals put forward to the Indians by the British delegation Cripps Mission (year 1942). "The offer of Cripps really gave us nothing. If we accepted the offer, we might have to rue in the future... war had given India an opportunity for achieving her freedom. We must not lose it by depending upon a mere promise."

2. Who viewed the Cripps proposal as a 'Post-dated cheque upon a crashing bank'?

- (a) Mahatma Gandhi (b) Jawaharlal Nehru
(c) J.B. Kriplani (d) Jay Prakash Narayan

44th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (a)

Cripps Mission visited India and announced the draft proposal. Mahatma Gandhi called the proposal as "the post-dated cheque".

Quit India Movement

1. In 1942 AD, on the occasion of which festival Jai Prakash Narayan escaped from Hazaribagh jail?

- (a) Baisakhi (b) Holi
(c) Dussehra (d) Deepawali
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Re-Exam) (Pre), 2021

Ans. (d)

During the Quit India Movement, on the day of Diwali, November 9 in 1942. Jai Prakash Narayan escaped from jail along with his comrades.

2. On 6th July, 1942, at the Working Committee of the Congress, Mahatma Gandhi discussed for the first time his 'Quit India Policy'. The President of the Committee was :

- (a) Rajagopalachari
(b) Maulana Abul Kalam Azad
(c) Pandit Jawaharlal Nehru
(d) Annie Besant

43rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (b)

In July, 1942, the meeting of Congress Working Committee held at Wardha in which Maulana Abul Kalam Azad, Sarojini Naidu, Jawaharlal Nehru, Vallabh Bhai Patel, Dr. Rajendra Prasad, Sitaramaiya, G.B. Pant, Prafulla Chandra Ghosh, Sayyid Mehmood, Asaf Ali, J.B. Kriplani, Mahatma Gandhi etc. had taken part and passed a resolution named 'Quit India Movement', was chaired by the then Congress President Maulana Abul Kalam Azad.

3. Quit India movement began on:

- (a) 9th August, 1942 (b) 10th August, 1942
(c) 15th August, 1942 (d) 16th August, 1942

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (a)

The historic session of the All India Congress Committee began on the 7th August, 1942 and was concluded 8th August, 1942 at Gowalia Tank Maidan, Bombay. Quit India movement began on 9th August, 1942. The Committee asserted India's right to freedom and decided to start a mass struggle with non-violent means on the widest possible scale. Addressing the conference, Gandhiji gave the call "Do or Die," either to get India free or to die in this attempt. But before the Movement could be launched Gandhiji and all other leaders of the Congress were imprisoned under Operation Zero Hour. Gandhiji and Sarojini Naidu were kept in Agha Khan Palace at Poona (now Pune). The Movement of 1942 mostly affected the State of Bombay, Bengal, Bihar, Odisha, United Province and Madras. Though the whole country participated in this Movement.

4. The slogan 'Do or Die' was related with –

- (a) Dandi (b) Non-cooperation
(c) Khilafat (d) Quit India

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (d)

The statement is associated with 'Quit India Movement.' On August 8, 1942 resolution for Quit India Movement was passed with certain Amendments. The statement of Gandhiji, "I am not going to be satisfied with anything short of Complete Freedom. Maybe, the British Government will propose the abolition of salt tax, the drink evil, etc. But I will say, "nothing less than freedom." Here is a mantra that I give you. You may imprint it on your hearts and let every breath of yours give expression to it. The mantra is: 'Do or Die.' We shall either free India or die in the attempt" is particularly important.

5. When did Baldev Sahai resigned from the post of Advocate General?

- (a) 1942 (b) 1943
(c) 1913 (d) 1911

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (a)

The failure of August proposal (1940) and Cripps Mission (1942) led to Quit India Movement. After the rejection of demand for establishment of National Government in India, the Wardha proposal was confirmed in the annual meeting of AICC on August 8, 1942 at Gwaliya Tank Ground, Bombay. As soon as the Quit India Movement started on August 9, 1942, British Government arrested high-level leaders of Congress under the operation 'Zero Hour'. In the protest, Baldev Sahai resigned in 1942 from the post of Advocate General of Bihar.

6. Quit India Movement was led by :

- (a) B.R. Ambedkar (b) Jawaharlal Nehru
(c) Mahatma Gandhi (d) None of them

45th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (c)

In August, 1942 Mahatma Gandhi launched the 'Quit India Movement'. The next day Gandhi, Nehru and many other leaders of the Indian National Congress were arrested by the British Government. However in the given options, (c) is most appropriate option.

7. On the outbreak of 1942, the people proclaimed the establishment of a National Government under Siaram Singh at

- (a) Patna (b) Bhagalpur
(c) Champaran (d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

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Ans. (b)

In August 1942, the impact of the Quit India movement on the people of Bhagalpur district in Bihar intensified. People came out in large numbers to hoist flags, held violent demonstrations at government offices and participated in mass processions.

8. All India Azad Dasta at Bakri Ka Tapu was organised during the Quit India Movement by:

- (a) Ram Manohar Lohia
(b) Usha Mehta
(c) Chittu Pandey
(d) Jay Prakash Narayan
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. Re-Exam (Pre) 2020

Ans. (d)

All India Azad Dasta, was formed by Jay Prakash Narayan in the Terai region of Nepal in Bakri Ka Tapu to fight a Guerrilla war against British.

9. Who organized the 'Azad Dasta'?

- (a) Vinoba Bhave
(b) Jayaprakash Narayan
(c) Jwala Prasad
(d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

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Ans. (b)

The Azad Dasta was a revolutionary organization which was founded by Jayaprakash Narayan during the Quit India Movement of 1942. The main aim of the organization was to paralyze government machinery and military training, and camps were set up to prepare the men to partake in revolutionary activities.

10. During which Movement 'Azad Dasta' was active in Bihar?

- (a) Champaran Satyagraha
(b) Non-Cooperation Movement
(c) Civil Disobedience Movement
(d) Quit India Movement
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Re-Exam) (Pre)-2021

Ans. (d)

Jay Prakash Narayan formed Azad Dasta in Bihar after escaping from jail during the 'Quit India Movement'.

11. The Prime Minister of England during Quit India Movement was

- (a) Chamberlain (b) Churchill
(c) Clement Attlee (d) Macdonald

46th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (b)

Winston Spencer Churchill (1940-1945) was the Prime Minister of England during the Quit India Movement.

12. Who launched secret radio during the Quit India Movement?

- (a) Usha Mehta (b) Subhadra Kumari Chauhan
(c) Sucheta Kripalani (d) Annie Besant
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Re-Exam) (Pre)-2021

Ans. (a)

During the Quit India Movement, secret congress Radio broadcast from different parts of Bombay. In this Usha Mehta was an important member of radio operating group.

13. Which area was affected widest with the communal riots due to 'Quit India' Movement?

- (i) Bihar (ii) Bengal
(iii) Gujarat (iv) United Province

Select your answer of the following code –

- (a) i and ii (b) only i
(c) ii and iii (d) i and iv

41st B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (d)

Riots generated due to Quit India Movement (1942) mostly spread in Bihar and Uttar Pradesh (United Provinces). The atmosphere of revolt was generated here. Azamgarh, Ballia and Gorakhpur in Eastern United Province and Gaya, Bhagalpur, Saran, Poorniya, Shahabad, Muzzafarpur and Champaran in Bihar were the centre of the riots.

14. Dr. Rajendra Prasad was arrested on 9th August, 1942 and was sent to :

- (a) Camp Jail (b) Hazaribag Jail
(c) Bhagalpur Jail (d) Bankipur Jail

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

43rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (d)

On August 9, 1942 Gandhi and other main leaders of Congress were arrested. Gandhi and Sarojini Naidu were kept in Aga Khan Palace at Pune and the other members of Congress Working Committee (Nehru, Abul Kalam Azad, Govind Ballabh Pant, Dr. Pattabhi Sitaramaiyya, Dr. Saiyyad Mahmood, Acharya Kriplani) were kept in the fort of Ahmednagar. Dr. Rajendra Prasad, a member of Congress Working Committee, was not in Bombay thus he was arrested in Patna under Bharat Security Rules and sent to Patna (Bankipur) jail.

15. After passing the resolution of 'Quit India Movement' Gandhiji was arrested –

- (a) in Yarawada Jail
(b) in Naini Jail
(c) in the fort of Ahmednagar
(d) in Aga Khan Palace

41st B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of the above question.

16. On 9th August, 1942 the two arrested leaders of Hazaribag were

- (a) Ramlal and Devilal
(b) Narayan Singh and Sukhlal Singh
(c) Ramnath and Devnath
(d) Shiv Kumar and Ramanand

43rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (d)

On August 8, 1942 Quit India Movement was approved by Congress. On August 9, 1942 Gandhiji and other main leaders of Congress were arrested. Shiv Kumar and Ramanand were arrested from Hazaribag (Patna).

17. With the news of Gandhi and other Congress leaders arrest in 1942, a riot in Bihar took place, leading to a total breakdown in the rail services. The most affected area was :

- (a) Munger (b) Gaya
(c) Patna (d) Shahabad

43rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (a)

On August 9, 1942 Gandhiji and other main leaders of Congress were arrested. Police launched a suppression cycle to crack down the Movement. Outraged by the suppression of the police, the public attacked at several places. Police stations, Railway stations and post offices were on their target. Rail lines were uprooted at several places. As a result, rail services were disrupted completely. Medinipur district of Bengal, Baliya district of Uttar Pradesh and Munger district of Bihar were the centre of public anger. The incident of uprooting railway tracks mostly happened in Bihar. Munger was the most affected district which remained cut off from the outside world for 2 weeks.

18. In which context did Jay Prakash Narayan get the recognition of national leader?

- (a) Quit India Movement
(b) Establishment of Congress Socialist Party
(c) Bhoodan Movement
(d) Making the member of Congress Executive Committee

41st B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (a)

Jay Prakash Narayan got the recognition as a national leader during Quit India Movement. All the main leaders of Congress were arrested at the start of the movement. Congress leaders who couldn't be arrested started to consolidate public secretly. Jay Prakash Narayan, Ram Manohar Lohia, and Aruna Asaf Ali were the main leaders among them.

19. Who among the following escaped from Hazaribagh Jail during the Quit India Movement?

- (a) Sachchidanand Sinha (b) Jay Prakash Narayan
(c) Jagjivan Ram (d) Rafi Ahmed Kidwai
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

20. Where was Shri Yogendra Shukla brought on the 7th December, 1942?

- (a) Ranchi (b) Munger

(c) Patna

(d) Bhagalpur

45th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (c)

On November 9, 1942 Yogendra Shukla along with Jay Prakash Narayan escaped from Hazaribag jail but was arrested at Muzzafarpur and 7th December, 1942 sent to Patna.

21. Who was the wife of Mr. Jagat Narayan Lal?

(a) Mrs. Rampyari

(b) Mrs. Sundari Devi

(c) Mrs. Bhagawati Devi

(d) Mrs. Mangala Devi

37th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1991

Ans. (a)

During the Quit India Movement, Rampyari Devi, wife of Mr. Jagat Narayan Lal addressed the assembly in Bankipur and called people to Quit Government jobs.

22. Two statements are given below; the one is Assertion (A) and other is the Reason (R), read them carefully-
Assertion (A) : Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS) was separate from Quit India Movement, 1942.

Reason (R) : It thought that the freedom of India will be delayed due to this Movement.

Which of them correct from the given statements-

(a) (A) and (R) are individually true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).

(b) (A) and (R) are individually true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).

(c) (A) is true, but (R) is false.

(d) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

40th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (c)

Assertion (A) is true, but reason (R) is false. Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS) was isolated from Quit India Movement, 1942. From 1940 to the end of colonial power in 1947, RSS did not take part in any National Movement.

Subhash Chandra Bose and

Azad Hind Fauj

1. Who formed the Forward Bloc?

(a) Subhas Chandra Bose (b) Rajendra Prasad

(c) Bhagat Singh

(d) B.R. Ambedkar

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

44th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (a)

Subhash Chandra Bose resigned from the Presidentship of Congress after Tripuri Congress and Founded 'Forward Bloc' in 1939.

2. In which country was the honorific 'Netaji' added before the name of Subhash Chandra Bose?

(a) India

(b) Italy

(c) Germany

(d) Japan

(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (c)

The term 'Netaji' before the name of Subhash Chandra Bose was provided by the German Ministry of Foreign Affairs. He founded the 'Forward Bloc' in the year 1939.

3. Who joined Subhas Chandra Bose to found All India Forward Bloc and actively associated with the INA movement?

(a) Jay Prakash Narayan (b) Baikunth Shukla

(c) Sheel Bhadra Yajee (d) Ram Narain Prasad

(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (c)

Sheel Bhadra Yajee was a freedom fighter from Bihar who was associated with Mahatma Gandhi and Subhash Chandra Bose. Yajee joined Subhash Chandra Bose to found All India Forward Bloc and actively associated with the INA movement.

4. The result of whose brain is I.N.A. and who founded it?

(a) Subhash Chandra Bose (b) Mohan Singh

(c) Chandra Shekhar Azad (d) Bhagat Singh

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (b)

The Indian National Army (INA) was the brainchild of Giani Pritam Singh Dhillon along with Major Fujiwara and Captain Mohan Singh in 15 July, 1942. Giani Pritam Singh became actively involved in the Indian Independence Movement and Gadar Party. He was instrumental in the failed 1915 mutiny that he stirred among a Bengal Lancers regiment. The authorities started hunting him. He fled via Burma to Bangkok, in 1919, where some Indian revolutionaries from other parts of India were living. Once in Bangkok, he mingled with the local Sikh community and through his missionary work began spreading the message of the Gadar party. Then he met with Iwaichi Fujiwara, head of the Japanese field intelligence section in the region, who had even before

the declaration of war by Japan, reached an agreement of collaboration with the Japanese at Bangkok. It was Giani Pritam Singh's idea to work with Iwaichi Fujiwara who released Indian soldiers who were asked to join an Indian National Army to fight for Indian independence. These plans were started long before the war broke out, among a group of revolutionaries based in Bangkok. Thus, Capt. Mohan Singh was not the founder of INA, but was only the first operational Commander of the INA. He accepted the position at Giani Ji and Iwaichi Fujiwara insistence. The brains behind INA were Iwaichi Fujiwara and Giani Pritam Singh Dhillon.

5. In which year was the Indian National Army founded?

- (a) 1940
- (b) 1941
- (c) 1942
- (d) 1943

43rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (c)

Indian National Army was formed under the leadership of Captain Mohan Singh. It was formally proclaimed in April, 1942 and declared the subordinate military wing of the Indian Independence League in June, 1942. The unit was dissolved in December, 1941 after apprehensions of Japanese motives with regards to the INA led to disagreements and distrust between Mohan Singh and INA leadership on the one hand and the League's leadership, most notably Ras Behari Bose on the other. A large number of the INA's initial volunteers however, later went on to join the INA in its second incarnation under Subhash Chandra Bose. Bose arrived in Singapore on 2 July and in October, 1943 formally announced the establishment of the Provisional Government of Free India and took charges of INA.

6. Organization of Azad Hind Fauz was declared on:

- (a) 26 January, 1930
- (b) 8 August, 1942
- (c) 21 October, 1943
- (d) 18 February, 1946

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (c)

Ras Behari Bose handed over the charge of INA to Subhash Chandra Bose on 4th July, 1943 on 21 October, 1943 S.C. Bose formally announced the establishment of the Provisional Government of Free India.

7. Where was Azad Hind Fauz set up in 1943?

- (a) Japan
- (b) Burma
- (c) Singapore
- (d) Malaya

45th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (d)

On 4th July, 1943 in Singapore, Subhash Chandra Bose named the Indian Independence League as Indian National Army (I.N.A.). At that time, Singapore Island was a part of British Malay.

8. Who among the following advocates had appeared for the INA trials at Delhi in 1945-46?

- (a) Dr. Rajendra Prasad
- (b) Bhulabhai Desai
- (c) K.M. Munshi
- (d) Sardar Patel
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (b)

Three Indian National Army soldiers Shahnawaz Khan, Gurbaksh Singh Dhillon and Prem Kumar Sehgal were accused of treason against the country during the World War II. Bhulabhai Desai, T.B. Sapru, Kailash Nath Katju, Jawaharlal Nehru, etc. was part of the defence team of the three INA soldiers. The trial began in November, 1945 at Red Fort in Delhi. Bhulabhai Desai headed the group of advocates to argue the case on behalf of the Indian National Army.

9. At the Congress Working Committee meeting at Allahabad (April-May, 1947), who of the following members was able to secure a majority for his plan of a Guerilla War against the Japanese due to India's unequivocal stand against Nazism, Fascism and imperialism?

- (a) Subhash Chandra Bose
- (b) Sarojini Naidu
- (c) Maulana Azad
- (d) Jawaharlal Nehru

46th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2004

Ans. (d)

Pt. Jawaharlal Nehru was able to secure a majority for his plan of Guerilla war against the Japanese due to India's clear stand against Nazism, Fascism and Imperialism.

10. Who proceeded to organise the Provisional Government of Free India outside the country?

- (a) Raja Mahendra Pratap
- (b) Rash Behari Bose
- (c) Subhash Chandra Bose
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

BPSC (Tre-3) {Class 9-10}-2024

Ans. (b)

Rash Bihari Bose proceeded to organise the Provincial Government of free India outside the country.

To remove the British Colonial rule over India, Rash Bihari Bose, a veteran freedom fighter, founded India Independence League in 1942 in Tokyo, Japan.

Later, in July 1943, Subhas Chandra Bose took over the charge of President of India-Independence League. The provisional Government of Free India was founded in October 1943 by Subhash Chandra Bose.

11. With which incident Subhas Chandra Bose compared to Napoleon's March to Paris on his return from Elba?

- (a) Mahatma Gandhi's Champaran Visit
- (b) Mahatma Gandhi's Salt March
- (c) Mahatma Gandhi's Quit India Movement
- (d) Mahatma Gandhi's participation in Second Round Table Conference

BPSC Agriculture Department-2024

Ans. (b)

Subhash Chandra Bose compared Mahatma Gandhi's Salt March to Napoleon's March to Paris on his return from Elba. The Salt March was a civil disobedience campaign led by Gandhi in 1930 to protest British rule in India.

Cabinet Mission Plan (1946)

1. The Cabinet Mission was sent to India for which of the following?

- 1. To establish a national government
- 2. To work out a constitutional arrangement for the transfer of power
- 3. To work out the details of Jinnah's demand for Pakistan

- (a) 3 only
- (b) 1 only
- (c) 2 only
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

68th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (c)

Cabinet mission was sent to India in 1946 to work out a constitutional arrangement for the transfer of power. It was neither sent to establish the government nor to work out the details of Jinnah demand for Pakistan.

2. Who among the following was not a member of the Cabinet Mission sent to India in 1946 A.D.?

- (a) Sir Stafford Cripps
- (b) Ramsay MacDonald
- (c) A. V. Alexander
- (d) Lord Pathick Lawrence

- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Re-Exam) (Pre)-2021

Ans. (b)

The Cabinet Mission reached India in March 1946. The members of this mission were Sir Stafford Cripps, Lord Pethick Lawrence and A.V. Alexander. Ramsay Macdonald was not a member of cabinet mission.

3. Cabinet Mission was presided over by :

- (a) Lord Attlee
- (b) Strafford Cripps
- (c) Clement Attlee
- (d) Sir P. Lawrence

45th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (d)

End of World War II saw the Labour Party under Clement Attlee win elections in England (U.K.). Mr. Attlee was sympathetic towards India's demand for freedom. Clement Attlee announced on February 19, 1946 the dispatch of the Mission for Constitutional Reforms. The Cabinet Mission arrived in Delhi on 24 March, 1946. The Cabinet Mission to India consisted of the Secretary of State Mr. Pethick Lawrence, Sir Stafford Cripps, President of the Board of Trade and A.V. Alexander.

4. The Cabinet Mission came to India in :

- (a) February 1942
- (b) March 1942
- (c) April 1942
- (d) May 1942
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above.

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (e)

See the explanation of the above question.

5. Who was not the member of the Cabinet Mission?

- (a) Pethick Lawrence
- (b) Wavell
- (c) Stafford Cripps
- (d) A.V. Alexander
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C. (Pre.) 2017

Ans. (b)

Cabinet Mission consisted of Secretary of State Pethick-Lawrence, Sir Stafford Crips, the president of Board of Trade and A.V. Alexander. Wavell was not part of it.

6. Who among the following was not the member of the Cabinet Mission?

- (a) P. Lawrence
- (b) A. V. Alexander
- (c) J. Andrew
- (d) None of them

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

7. Which Congress President negotiated with both Cripps Mission and Lord Wavell?

- (a) Abul Kalam Azad (b) Jawaharlal Nehru
(c) J.B. Kriplani (d) C. Rajagopalachari

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (a)

Abul Kalam Azad negotiated with both Cripps Mission and Lord Wavell.

8. Who was allotted the Portfolio of the Labour Department in the Interim Government's Cabinet of 1946 AD?

- (a) Jagjivan Ram
(b) Dr. Rajendra Prasad
(c) Dr. Anugraha Narayan Singh
(d) Syed Ali Zaheer
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Pre)-2021

Ans. (a)

In the interim Government formed in 1946, the labour department was given to Babu Jagjivan Ram. Rajendra Prasad was given the Department of Food and Agriculture. Syed Ali Zaheer was given the department of law.

Constituent Assembly (1946)

1. Sachchidananda Sinha was associated with :

- (a) Quit India Movement (b) Dandi March
(c) Civil Disobedience Movement (d) None of these

44th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (a)

Sachchidanand Sinha was associated with Quit India Movement. He was elected as temporary Chairman in the first session of the Constituent Assembly (9 December, 1946).

2. Dr. Rajendra Prasad was elected the Chairman of the Constituent Assembly in –

- (a) September 1946 A.D. (b) October 1946 A.D.
(c) November 1946 A.D. (d) December 1946 A.D.
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Re-Exam) (Pre)-2021

Ans. (d)

On December 9, 1946 the first meeting of the constituent assembly was presided by Dr. Sachchidanand Sinha, the temporary Chairman on December 11, 1946, the constituent assembly elected Dr. Rajendra Prasad unopposed as the permanent Chairman of the constituent assembly.

3. Who was the Finance Minister in the Interim Government?

- (a) Liaquat Ali Khan (b) Sardar Patel
(c) M.A. Jinnah (d) Jawaharlal Nehru
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (a)

In the reconstituted Interim Government (1946), the post of Finance Minister was with Liaquat Ali Khan, Home Affairs Department with Sardar Patel and Foreign Affairs and Commonwealth Department with Jawaharlal Nehru.

4. Which portfolio did Rajendra Prasad hold in the interim government formed in 1946?

- (a) Finance
(b) Defense
(c) Home
(d) Food and Agriculture
(e) None of the above/ More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (d)

In the interim government formed in the year 1946, Rajendra Prasad had the Food and Agriculture Department, Baldev Singh had the Defence Department, Vallabhbhai Patel had the Home Affairs Department.

Formation of Interim Government (1946) Partition of India and Independence

1. Who presided over the Delhi Session of Indian National Congress in 1947?

- (a) J. B. Kripalani (b) Rajendra Prasad
(c) Abul Kalam Azad (d) Jawaharlal Nehru

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (a)

When Congress Committee accepted the proposal of divided India in Delhi on 15th June, 1947, J.B. Kriplani was the President of Indian National Congress. This proposal was presented by Gobind Ballabh Pant and supported by Maulana Azad, Sardar Patel and Jawaharlal Nehru. In November, 1947 J.B. Kriplani resigned from Congress Chairmanship. After that, Dr. Rajendra Prasad became Interim Chairman of Congress. Pattabhi Sitaramaiya became next President of Congress in Jaipur Session in 1948. Then P.D. Tandon became new President of Congress in Nasik Session.

2. Who was the last Governor-General of Independent India?

- (a) C. Rajagopalachari (b) Rajendra Prasad
(c) Lord Mountbatten (d) Lord Canning

46th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2004

Ans. (a)

C. Rajagopalachari (1948-50) was the last Governor-General of Independent India. He was the first Indian Governor-General of Independent India. He was Chief Minister of Madras (Tamilnadu) (1952-54). In 1959, he left Congress due to some differences and formed a new party entitled 'Swatantra Party.'

3. The first Indian to hold office as Governor-General of independent India was –

- (a) Rajagopalachari (b) Surinder Nath
(c) Dr. Rajendra Prasad (d) B. R. Ambedkar

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

4. The first Indian who assumed the office of Governor General in independent India was—

- (a) Jammalal Bajaj (b) C. Rajagopalachari
(c) Dr. Rajendra Prasad (d) M.A. Ansari

46th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2003-04

Ans. (b)

C. Rajagopalachari was the first and last Indian Governor General of independent India in 1948–50. Remained on this post till January 26, 1950. He was the Chief Minister of Madras (Tamilnadu) from 1952-1954. In the year 1959, due to differences with the Congress leaders on various issues, he left the Congress and formed the 'Swatantra Party'.

5. Who was the Congress President at the time of transfer of power in 1947 to India by the British?

- (a) Jawaharlal Nehru (b) Rajendra Prasad
(c) Abul Kalam Azad (d) J.B. Kriplani

46th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (d)

During the partition of India, the Congress President was J. B. Kriplani who was Congress President from November, 1946 to November, 1947. He became President of I.N.C. in Meerut Session, 1946. He resigned from his post in November, 1947.

6. Who was the President of Indian National Congress at the time of partition of India?

- (a) J. B. Kriplani
(b) Jawaharlal Nehru

- (c) Maulana Abul Kalam Azad
(d) C. Rajagopalachari
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (a)

At the time of partition of India J. B. Kriplani was the President of the Indian National Congress. He became the president of the Meerut session on 23 November 1946 and remained the president till November 1947. After his resignation, Dr. Rajendra Prasad was made the president.

7. On February 20, 1947, Prime Minister Attlee announced the British Government's decision to withdraw from India latest by

- (a) June 1948 (b) August 1947
(c) January 1948 (d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

68th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (a)

On 20 February, 1947 British Prime Minister, announced in the British Parliament's House of Commons that the British would leave India by 30 June, 1948. Hence option (a) is correct.

8. Who hailed free India's first Prime Minister Jawaharlal Nehru as an outstanding leader of courage and vision?

- (a) Maulana Abul Kalam Azad
(b) Lord Mountbatten
(c) Sardar Patel
(d) Clement Attlee
(e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2022

Ans. (b)

Lord Mountbatten hailed Jawaharlal Nehru as an outstanding leader of courage and foresight as the first Prime Minister of India.

9. Which incident/incidents shocked British Prime Minister Clement Attlee, who had to declare that the edifice of the British imperialism had suffered a severe jolt?

- (a) Failure of the Cabinet Mission
(b) Revolt of the Royal Indian Navy
(c) Rejection of the Cripps Mission
(d) Campaign of the INA and Revolt of the Royal Indian Navy
(e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2022

Ans. (d)

The incidents such as the pride of the Indian National Army (INA) and the Revolt of the Royal Indian Navy had shocked British Prime Minister Clement Attlee, who had to declare that the edifice of the British imperialism had suffered a severe jolt.

10. The Royal Indian Navy Mutiny, also known as the Bombay Mutiny, took place in the year—

- (a) 1946 (b) 1942
- (c) 1930 (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

BPSC (Tre-3) {Class 6-8}–2024

Ans. (a)

The Royal Indian Navy (RIN) Mutiny, often known as the Indian Naval Mutiny, is one frequently forgotten revolt. The mutiny started on February 18, 1946. It was an insurrection of Indian naval ratings, soldiers, police personnel and civilians against the British government in India.

Constitutional Development of India

1. In which of the following Indian National Congress Sessions, the resolutions related to the Fundamental Rights were passed for the first time?

- (a) Surat Session—1907
- (b) Gaya Session—1922
- (c) Karachi Session—1931
- (d) None of the above

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (c)

Karachi Session of Congress took place in the leadership of Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel on 29-31 March, 1931. Congress passed the resolutions related to Fundamental Rights and the national economic programme for the first time in this session.

2. When was the Indian Independence Bill passed by the House of Lords in England?

- (a) 14 July, 1947 (b) 15 July, 1947
- (c) 16 July, 1947 (d) 14 August, 1947
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2018

Ans. (c)

The Indian Independence Bill was introduced in British parliament on 16 July 1947. The Act Provided for the partition of India and the establishment of the two dominions (India and Pakistan).

3. The Regulating Act was passed in –

- (a) 1773 (b) 1774
- (c) 1785 (d) 1793

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (a)

Regulating Act, 1773, was passed by the British Parliament for the regulation of the British East India Company's Indian Territories, mainly in Bengal. The main provisions of the Act were the appointment of a Governor-General of Fort William in Bengal with supervisory powers over the Presidencies of Madras (now Chennai) and Bombay (now Mumbai). The Governor-General had a Council of four member who were given the power to cast a vote but no veto. Warren Hastings was appointed the first Governor General of Bengal.

4. In which year was the Regulation Act passed?

- (a) A.D. 1757 (b) A.D. 1765
- (c) A.D. 1773 (d) A.D. 1793

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

5. Under the provision of Regulating Act, a Provincial Assembly for Bihar was set up in—

- (a) 1772 (b) 1774
- (c) 1776 (d) 1778

40th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (b)

The main purpose of Regulating Act was to regulate the activities of Company under British Rule. It was passed by the British Parliament in 1773 and implemented in India in 1774. According to the provisions of this Act, a Provincial Assembly was set up in Bihar in 1774.

6. When did Bihar become a separate province in India?

- (a) 1897 (b) 1905
- (c) 1907 (d) 1912
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

64th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (d)

On 22 March 1912, both Bihar and Odisha divisions were separated from Bengal Presidency as Bihar and Orissa Province. On 1 April 1936, Bihar and Orissa became separate provinces. 22nd March is also celebrated as Bihar Divas.

7. Which of the following Acts empowered Lord Cornwallis to overrule the decision of his Council?

- (a) Regulating Act (b) Act of 1786

- (c) Charter Act of 1793 (d) Charter Act of 1813

44th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (b)

The Act of 1786 was enacted to give him the power of working as Both Governor General & commander in Chief. Thus via act of 1786, Lord Cornwallis became the first effective ruler of British India.

8. When were the rights of the tenants on land in Bengal and Bihar recognized by the Bengal Tenancy Act?

- (a) 1968 (b) 1881
(c) 1885 (d) 1893
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

64th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (c)

Bengal Tenancy Act, 1885 recognised the rights of the tenants on land in Bengal and Bihar. The objective of this act was to define the rights and liabilities of Zamindars and Tenants.

9. Which Act provisioned competitive exam system for Civil Services?

- (a) 1833 (b) 1853
(c) 1858 (d) 1882

46th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (b)

The Charter Act, 1853 provided that the salary of the members of Board of Control, its Secretary and other Officers would be fixed by the British Government but the payments would be made out of the Company's funds. The number of the Court of Directors was reduced from 24 to 18 of whom 6 were to be nominated by the Crown. The Court of Directors was divested of its right to patronage and Company's services were thrown open to competition and no discrimination of any kind was to be made. A committee with Macaulay was formed in the following year (1854) to give effect to the scheme of appointment in Civil Service through competition.

10. To control the media in India, 'Acts' were passed in –

- (a) 1835, 1867, 1878, 1908
(b) 1854, 1864, 1872, 1910
(c) 1854, 1872, 1908, 1910
(d) 1867, 1908, 1910, 1919

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (a)

In 1835, Press Act was announced for the censorship of media. Registration Press and Books Act was passed in 1867. The Vernacular Press Act was passed in 1878 by Lord Lytton

to control the printing and circulation of seditious material, specifically that which could produce disaffection against the British Government in India in the minds of the masses. In addition to this in 1908, Lord Minto passed a bill to regulate the press. In this Act, the Government was authorized to seize any publication if found anti-government.

11. Which of the following Acts introduced separate electorate system in India?

- (a) The Regulating Act, 1773
(b) The Charter Act, 1833
(c) The Pitt's India Act, 1784
(d) The Indian Councils Act, 1909
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (d)

Indian Council Act, 1909 introduced separate electorate for Muslims in the country. The act also called Morley-Minto Reforms, 1909 introduced communal representation in the country.

12. The Montagu-Chelmsford Report formed the basis of –

- (a) the Indian Councils Act, 1909
(b) the Government of India Act, 1919
(c) the Government of India Act, 1935
(d) the Indian Independence Act, 1947

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (b)

The basis of Indian Council Act, 1919 was the report of India State Secretary Edwin Montague and Viceroy Lord Chelmsford.

13. The post of the Indian High Commission was created by which Act?

- (a) The Indian Councils Act, 1909
(b) The Government of India Act, 1919
(c) The Government of India Act, 1935
(d) The Indian Independence Act, 1947
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C. (Pre.) 2017

Ans. (b)

Post of Indian High Commission was created by the Government of India Act, 1919.

14. Who among the following became India's unofficial Ambassador to England?

- (a) Surendranath Banerjee
(b) Dadabhai Naoroji
(c) Swami Vivekananda

- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

B.P.S.C. School Teacher (Class 11-12) 15-12-2023

Ans. (b)

Dadabhai Naoroji set forth the Indian demands in the British parliament and thus he was called the 'unofficial ambassador of India'. Naoroji was thrice elected as the president of the Indian National Congress in 1886, 1893 and 1906. His monumental treatise on the economic and political exploitation of the British in India Poverty and Un-British Rule in India, published in 1901 remains a gospel of Indian economic nationalism.

15. Government of India Act, 1935 abolished-

- (a) Provincial autonomy
- (b) Provincial dyarchy
- (c) Federal structure of India
- (d) Responsible Central Government

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (b)

The Government of India Act 1935 was originally passed in August, 1935 and is said to have been the longest (British) Act of Parliament ever enacted by that time. The most significant aspects of the Act were:

The grant of a large measure of autonomy to the provinces of British India which ended the system of dyarchy introduced by the Government of India Act, 1919.

Provision of direct elections was made.

A partial reorganization of the provinces.

The establishment of a Federal Court.

Membership of the provincial assemblies was altered to include more elected Indian representative.

16. Who described the Government of India Act, 1935 as a 'Charter of Slavery'?

- (a) Mahatma Gandhi
- (b) Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose
- (c) Maulana Hasrat Mohani
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

B.P.S.C. School Teacher (Class 11-12) 15-12-2023

Ans. (e)

The Government of India Act of 1935 was a major constitutional reform enacted by the British Parliament to redefine British India's governance. It was an attempt to meet Indian demands for greater participation in governance while maintaining British control. Jawahar Lal Nehru described this act as a 'Charter of Slavery'.

17. About which Act, Jawaharlal Nehru had said, "We were provided with a car with all brakes and no engine"?

- (a) Act of 1858
- (b) Act of 1909
- (c) Act of 1919
- (d) Act of 1935
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (d)

Jawaharlal Nehru compared the Government of India Act, 1935 with "a car which has a brake but no engine." Jawaharlal Nehru was the Prime Minister of India from 1947 to 1964. In fact, the policy of Non-Alignment is the creation of Jawaharlal Nehru and he is the propounder of Panchsheel Theory.

18. Which agreement failed to resolve the border issues between India and China, ultimately leading to the conflict?

- (a) Tashkent Agreement
- (b) Shimla Agreement
- (c) Panchsheel Agreement
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

BPSC (Tre-3) {Class 6-8}-2024

Ans. (c)

The 1954 Sino-Indian Agreement, also called the Panchsheel Agreement, officially the Agreement on Trade and Intercourse between Tibet Region and India, was signed by China and India in Peking on 29 April 1954.

19. Which Act is not the landmark in the development of the Constitution during the British Rule?

- (a) The Regulating Act, 1773
- (b) The Charter Act, 1833
- (c) The Government of India Act, 1919
- (d) The Protection of Civil Rights Act, 1955
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (d)

The Protection of Civil Rights Act (PCR Act), 1955 was enacted and notified on 8th May 1955. It was amended in 1976 and was renamed as "Protection of Civil Rights Act, 1955", before this it was known as Untouchability (Offences) Act, 1955. The Act extends to whole of India and provides punishment for the practice of untouchability. Hence it has nothing to do with development of constitution. Therefore option (d) is correct option.

Modern History : Miscellaneous

1. Which event marked the beginning of the League of Nations' decline in influence and authority?

- (a) The outbreak of World War II
- (b) The Italian invasion of Abyssinia
- (c) The invasion of Manchuria by Japan
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

BPSC (Tre-3) {Class 6-8}–2024

Ans. (d)

- Among its successes were its fight against the international trade in opium and sexual slavery and its work to alleviate the plight of refugees, particularly in Turkey in the period up to 1926. One of its innovations in this latter area was the 1922 introduction of the Nansen passport, the first internationally recognized identity card for stateless refugees.
- The League failed to intervene in many conflicts leading up to World War II, including the Italian invasion of Abyssinia, the Spanish Civil War, and the Second Sino-Japanese War.

2. The publication of which influential pamphlet by Thomas Paine in 1776 helped to galvanize support for independence among the American colonists?

- (a) "Declaration of Independence"
- (b) "The Federalist Papers"
- (c) "Common Sense"
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

BPSC (Tre-3) {Class 6-8}–2024

Ans. (c)

Common Sense, written by Thomas Paine and first published in Philadelphia in January 1776, was in part a scathing polemic against the injustice of rule by a king. Common Sense helped to sway colonists towards supporting a war for independence and laid the groundwork for the eventual set-up of the republic.

3. "... the turning point in Jawaharlal's 'mental development' came with his active participation in the Brussels Congress against colonial oppression and imperialism in February 1927." Who wrote these words?

- (a) S. Gopal
- (b) B. R. Nanda
- (c) Michael Brecher
- (d) B. N. Pandey
- (e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2022

Ans. (a)

"The turning point in Jawaharlal's mental development came with active participation in the Brussels Congress against colonial oppression and imperialism in February 1927." S. Gopal wrote these words.

4. The British ruled India for a long period due to the

- (a) liberal policies of the Congress
- (b) imprisonment of Indian leaders
- (c) policy of Divide and Rule
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

B.P.S.C. School Teacher (Class 11-12) 15-12-2023

Ans. (c)

The British ruled India for a long period due to the policy of Divide and Rule. The Divide and Rule policy is a strategy that was used by the British during colonial rule in India. This policy was used to keep the Indians divided so that they would be easier to control. The British used this policy to create divisions among the different religious groups, castes, and ethnicities. They also used it to put different regions against each other.

5. Which of the following is true about Dr. B. R. Ambedkar?

- (a) He published *Mooknayak*.
- (b) He founded 'Bahishkrit Hitakarini Sabha'.
- (c) He passed away in 1956.
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

B.P.S.C. PRT 2023 Shift II

Ans. (d)

Dr. B.R. Ambedkar was born in 1891 in Mhow, Madhya Pradesh and passed away in 1956. He founded Bahishkrit Hitakarini Sabha (1924) and he published *Mooknayak* in 1920.

6. How did the study of history help in creating a feeling of nationalism in India towards the end of the 19th century?

- (a) By urging people to struggle and change the miserable conditions of life under the British rule
- (b) By reinterpreting history and refuting the British portrayal of Indians as backward, primitive and incapable of governing themselves
- (c) By writing about India's glorious past and urging people to take pride in their achievements

- (d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

68th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (d)

The study of history helped in creating a feeling of nationalism in India towards the end of 19th century by–

- Urging people to struggle and change the miserable conditions of life under the British rule.
- Reinterpreting history and refuting the British portrayal of Indians as backward, primitive and incapable of governing themselves.
- Writing about India's glorious past and urging people to take pride in their achievements.

7. When did Sri Lanka become independent?

- (a) 1945 (b) 1947
(c) 1948 (d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

B.P.S.C. PRT 2023 Shift II

Ans. (c)

Sri Lanka became independent in 1948. Significantly, Sri Lanka was the colony of British Empire.

8. During the freedom struggle, a parallel movement launched in the Indian States (in the States ruled by the Indian rulers such as Kashmir, Nizam's Hyderabad, Travancore, etc.) was

- (a) Swaraj Movement
(b) State People's Movement
(c) Praja Mandal Movement
(d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

68th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (c)

In 1920s during freedom struggle various people's movement were launched in the princely states of British Raj. These movements were called states peoples conference or Praja Mandals. These movements were spearheaded by people living in princely states who were subject to the rule of local aristocrats rather than the British Raj. They campaigned against those feudatory rulers, and sometimes also the British administrators, in attempts to improve their civil rights.

9. Who started newspaper Motherland in September 1921 to disseminate the Hindu-Muslim unity and Gandhian ideology?

- (a) Shah Mohammad Zubair (b) Mazhar-ul-Haq

- (c) Anugrah Narayan Sinha (d) Shambhu Sharan
(e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. Assistant Audit Officer 2022

Ans. (b)

Maulana Mazharul Haque started the publication of newspaper called "Motherland" in September 1921, from Patna. He was an educationist, lawyer, freedom fighter.

10. On which date, Sukhdev, Bhagat Singh and Rajguru were hanged?

- (a) 12th November, 1930 (b) 23rd March, 1931
(c) 7th September, 1931 (d) 4th March, 1931
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Re-Exam) (Pre)-2021

Ans. (b)

Bhagat Singh, Rajguru and Sukhdev were hanged on March 23, 1931 after being convicted in the Lahore Conspiracy Case.

11. Where was Jhansi ki Rani Laxmibai died?

- (a) Lucknow (b) Kanpur
(c) Gwalior (d) Jhansi
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Re-Exam) (Pre) 2021

Ans. (c)

Rani Lakshambai of Jhansi Died in Gwalior. The museum of Maharani Lakshambai is situated in Gwalior itself.

12. In which conspiracy case, three Englishmen were detained on conspiracy charges?

- (a) Nasik Conspiracy Case
(b) Kanpur Conspiracy Case
(c) Meerut Conspiracy Case
(d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

B.P.S.C. PRT 2023 Shift II

Ans. (c)

Meerut Conspiracy Case was a controversial legal Saga that played out in British India between 1929 and early 1933. It began with the arrest and subsequent trial of twenty nine trade unionist including three Englishmen.

13. Subhas Chandra Bose renamed Nicobar Island as

- (a) Swaraj Island (b) Shaheed Island
(c) Balidan Island (d) Navodaya Island
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Re-Exam) (Pre) 2021

Ans. (a)

After liberating the Andaman and Nicobar Islands from the British Empire with the Azad Hind Fauj, Netaji Subhash Chandra Bose hoisted his flag there and named the Andaman Island as 'Shaheed' and Nicobar a 'Swaraj' island.

14. "The Indian National Congress was founded on the basis of safety valve theory, to protect the British Government from threats." Which leader said that?

- (a) C. Rajagopalachari
- (b) Lala Lajpat Rai
- (c) Bipin Chandra Pal
- (d) None of them

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (b)

Safety valve theory was used by the extremist leader Lala Lajpat Rai in 'Young India'. He considered Congress to be brainchild of Dufferin. He believed that the British would use the congress organisation to protect the British government from threat.

15. Which of the following event happened first?

- (a) Quit India Resolution
- (b) Arrival of the Cripps Mission
- (c) Arrival of Lord Wavell as the Governor General
- (d) Arrival of the Cabinet Mission
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (b)

Events	Year
Arrival of the Cripps Mission	March 1942
Quit India Resolution	August 1942
Arrival of Lord Wavell as the Governor General	October 1943
Arrival of the Cabinet Mission	1946
Therefore, the first of the given events was the arrival of 'Cripps Mission' under the leadership of Stafford Cripps.	

16. ESIC Act was passed in—

- (a) 1948
- (b) 1949
- (c) 1950
- (d) 1951
- (e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. Project Manager Prelims 2021

Ans. (a)

Employee' State Insurance Act was passed by the parliament in the year 1948. It was the first major legislation on Social Security for workers in Independent India.

17. "So always with the assent and often to the dictates of the Chamber of Commerce, the Government of India is carried on and this is the 'White Man's Burden.'" Who said this?

- (a) Bankim Chandra Chatterjee
- (b) Mahatma Gandhi
- (c) Sachchidananda Sinha
- (d) Rajendra Prasad
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

64th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (c)

The above statement was said by Sachidananda Sinha.

18. In which year was the Punjab Hindu Sabha founded?

- (a) 1905
- (b) 1909
- (c) 1915
- (d) 1917
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2018

Ans. (b)

In year 1909, Lal Chand and U.N Mukerji established the Punjab Hindu Sabha (Punjab Hindu Assembly).

19. "So long as this third power, i.e. England is here, our communal differences would keep on troubling us" Who said this?

- (a) Dr. Rajendra Prasad
- (b) Maulana Abul Kalam Azad
- (c) Jawaharlal Nehru
- (d) Vinayak Damodar Savarkar
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. Re-Exam (Pre) 2020

Ans. (e)

Louis Fisher was an American journalist who among his many works, also wrote biography of Mahatma Gandhi, 'A Life of Mahatma Gandhi' (1950). During one of the interviews for this biography, above statement was said by Mahatma Gandhi to him on the issue of communalism.

20. Rajani Palme Dutt said, "They both fought and collaborated with imperialism." Which political grouping was he referring to?

- (a) The Indian National Congress
- (b) The Communists Party of India
- (c) The Swaraj Party
- (d) Hindustan Socialist Republican Association.
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

64th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (a)

Rajni Palme Dutt said the above lines in reference to Indian National Congress.

Rajni Palme Dutt (19 June 1896-20 December, 1974) was a leading Journalist and theoretician in the Communist Party of Great Britain.

21. 'New Lamps for Old' was a series of articles (1893-94) that criticized the Congress for being out of touch with the 'proletariat.'

Who was the author of these articles?

- (a) Aurobindo Ghose (b) A. O. Hume
(c) G.K. Gokhale (d) B.G. Tilak

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (a)

Aurobindo Ghose (15 August, 1872- 5 December, 1950) was an Indian Nationalist, scholar, poet, mystic, philosopher, yogi and guru. 'New Lamps for Old' is a title of fiery series authored by Sri Aurobindo. Sri Aurobindo wrote the article series on the request of his Cambridge day's friend K.G. Deshpande. K.G. Deshpande was an in charge of a weekly published from Bombay called 'Induprakash.' This article was written on the political situation of India. Specially criticizing the policies of Congress towards colonial rule in India.

22. Ramchandra Sharma belonged to which village?

- (a) Gogri (b) Indrapur
(c) Pema (d) Amhara

45th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001-02

Ans. (d)

Ramchandra Sharma was a resident of Amhara (Patna). He was a prominent leader of Forward Bloc in Bihar.

23. By which Act, the English declared that "all officers in India open to merit irrespective of nationality or colour"?

- (a) The Charter Act of 1813
(b) The Charter Act of 1833
(c) The Charter Act of 1853
(d) The Indian Council Act, 1861
(e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. Auditor 2021

Ans. (c)

The Charter Act of 1833 legalised the British Colonisation of India and territorial possessions of company were held by it in the name of British crown. The act also stated that merit should be the basis of employment to government service and not birth, colour, religion or race.

24. Who among the following Indian is known as Gurudev?

- (a) Rabindra Nath Tagore (b) C. Rajagopalachari
(c) Lala Lajpat Roy (d) B.R. Ambedkar

38th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1992-93

Ans. (a)

Rabindranath Tagore was an icon of Indian culture. He was a poet, philosopher, musician, writer, and educationist. He was popularly called as Gurudev. He also became the first Asian to become a Nobel laureate when he won Nobel Prize for his collection of poems, Gitanjali, in 1913; he was awarded knighthood by the British King George V; established Viswabharati University; two songs from his Rabindrasangit canon are now the national anthems of India and Bangladesh.

25. Who was the writer of 'Banglar Mati, Banglar Jal', which was originally a protest song against the Partition of Bengal in 1905 by Lord Curzon, and for which the West Bengal Assembly passed a resolution as the new State Anthem recently?

- (a) Kazi Nazrul Islam (b) Rabindranath Tagore
(c) Sukanta Bhattacharya (d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

B.P.S.C. School Teacher (Class 9-10) 08-12-2023

Ans. (b)

Rabindranath Tagore was the writer of 'Banglar Mati, Banglar Jal', which was originally a protest song against the Partition of Bengal in 1905 by Lord Curzon, and for which the West Bengal Assembly passed a resolution as the new State Anthem recently.

26. Who gives the Slogan 'Jai Jawan', 'Jai Kisan' ?

- (a) Lal Bahadur Shastri (b) Subhash Chandra Bose
(c) Devi Lal (d) Morariji Desai

38th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1992

Ans. (a)

'Jai Jawan Jai Kisan' (English: Hail the Soldier, Hail the Farmer) was a slogan given to India by the then Prime Minister of India, Sri Lal Bahadur Shastri in 1965, in a public gathering at Ramlila Maidan, Delhi.

27. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the codes given below the Lists :

List-I (Names of Slogans)	List-II (Related Political Parties/Politicians)
A. Garibi Hatao	1. Left Front
B. Save Democracy	2. Indira Congress
C. Land to the Tiller	3. Janata Party

D. Protect the Self-respect of Telugus

4. N. T. Rama Rao

- | | A | B | C | D |
|-----|----------------------------|---|---|---|
| (a) | 2 | 1 | 3 | 4 |
| (b) | 2 | 3 | 1 | 4 |
| (c) | 1 | 4 | 3 | 2 |
| (d) | More than one of the above | | | |
| (e) | None of the above | | | |

B.P.S.C. PRT 2023 Shift I

Ans. (b)

Correct pair of the following :	
List-I	List-II
(Names of Slogans)	(Related Political Parties/Politicians)
Garibi Hatao	Indira Congress
Save Democracy	Janata Party
Land to the Tiller	Left Front
Protect the Self-respect of Telugus	N. T. Rama Rao

28. Who is known as the father of Dyarchy?

- | | |
|--|-----------------------|
| (a) Lord Clive | (b) Hector Munro |
| (c) Lord Macaulay | (d) Sir Leonel Curtis |
| (e) None of the above/More than one of the above | |

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (d)

Sir Leonel Curtis is known as the father of Dyarchy. His ideas concerning dyarchy were important in the development of the Government of India Act 1919. In Dyarchy (rule of two), the concept of executive councilors and popular ministers was introduced in which subjects were divided into two lists-Reserved and Transferred subjects.

29. Which lady contributed the largest in the Indian Politics after 1947?

- | | |
|-----------------------|----------------------|
| (a) Aruna Asaf Ali | (b) Kamla Rani Singh |
| (c) Tarkeshwari Sinha | (d) Rabari Devi |

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (a)

Aruna Asaf Ali was an Indian Independence activist and a freedom fighter. She participated in the Quit India Movement (1942) from underground. After India's Independence, she became associated with the left socialist group, which merged with the Communist Party of India in 1955. She was a leading member of the Indo-Soviet Cultural Society, All India Peace Council and National Federation of Indian women. Overall she contributed a lot in Indian Politics after 1947.

30. "It will be our blunder if we leave people of Bihar and their Government unsafe before the violence and uncivilized attacks of league leaders." In the year 1946 who told this?

- | | |
|---------------------|-----------------------|
| (a) Mahatma Gandhi | (b) Jawahar Lal Nehru |
| (c) Rajendra Prasad | (d) Sardar Patel |

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (d)

The above statement was made by Sardar Patel in 1946, with reference to the riots in Bihar.

31. Who raised the demand of 'Complete Independence' for the first time in 1921?

- | |
|-----------------------------|
| (a) Maulana Muhammad Ali |
| (b) Pandit Jawaharlal Nehru |
| (c) Mahatma Gandhi |
| (d) Maulana Hasrat Mohani |

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (d)

Maulana Hasrat Mohani was one of the greatest leaders in India. Maulana Hasrat Mohani fought against the British Government for freedom. Maulana Hasrat Mohani raised the demand of Complete Independence for the first time in 1921.

32. The Banaras Session of August, 1923 of the Hindu Mahasabha was presided over by :

- | |
|--------------------------------|
| (a) Swami Shraddhananda |
| (b) Rajendra Prasad |
| (c) Lala Lajpat Rai |
| (d) Pandit Madan Mohan Malviya |

43rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (d)

The Banaras Session of August, 1923 of the Hindu Mahasabha was presided over by Pandit Madan Mohan Malviya, which was attended by around 1500 delegates including Hindu, Jain, Sikh and Parsi.

33. In which year was V.D. Savarkar elected the President of the Hindu Mahasabha?

- | | |
|--|----------|
| (a) 1938 | (b) 1916 |
| (c) 1935 | (d) 1919 |
| (e) None of the above/More than one of the above | |

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2018

Ans. (e)

V.D Savarkar elected the president of the Hindu Mahasabha in 1937. The Hindu Mahasabha under Savarkar leadership endorsed the idea of the India as a Hindu Rashtra (Hindu Nation).

34. Identify the years those are closest to the founding of the Communist Party of India and the RSS respectively.

- (a) 1915, 1914 (b) 1925, 1925
(c) 1928, 1929 (d) 1925, 1939

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (b)

Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS) was founded on September 27, 1925 in Nagpur by Keshav Baliram Hedgewar, on the other hand, the Communist Party of India was founded on December 26, 1925 in Kanpur. Atal Bihari Vajpayee is the first Swayamsevak to become Prime Minister of India.

35. The real name of the 'Frontier Gandhi' is :

- (a) Purushottam Das Tandon
(b) Netaji Subhash Chandra Bose
(c) Abdul Ghaffar Khan
(d) Maulana Abul Kalam Azad

43rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (c)

Khan Abdul Ghaffar Khan was a Pashtun independence activist and a spiritual leader nicknamed as "Frontier Gandhi" due to his political activities and close association with the Indian leader, Mahatma Gandhi. He was a lifelong pacifist who advocated non-violent opposition and founded the Khudai Khidmatgar ("Servants of God") to protest against the British-controlled army using peaceful protests and political activism. He was awarded Bharat Ratna in 1987.

36. Who is known as 'Frontier Gandhi'?

- (a) M. A. Jinnah (b) Shaikat Ali
(c) Abul Kalam Azad (d) Abdul Gaffar Khan
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Re-Exam) (Pre)-2021

Ans. (d)

Khan Abdul Ghaffar was popularly Known as 'Frontier Gandhi'.

37. Ambabai, a woman freedom fighter, belonged to which of the following States of India?

- (a) Kerala (b) Andhra Pradesh
(c) Karnataka (d) Madhya Pradesh

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (c)

Amba Bai was born in the erstwhile Mysore state (now in Karnataka). She became a widow at very young age. After getting inspiration from Gandhi, she picketed foreign cloth and liquor shops in Udipi during Salt Satyagraha.

38. Rajendra Prasad belonged to :

- (a) U.P. (b) Bihar
(c) Madhya Pradesh (d) None of these

44th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (b)

Dr. Rajendra Prasad was born on December 3, 1884 in Ziradei village in Siwan district of Bihar. He was the first President of Independent India. He was the President of the Constituent Assembly that drafted the Constitution.

39. Jagat Narayan Lal was sent to :

- (a) Bankipur Jail (b) Camp Jail
(c) Bhagalpur Jail (d) Hazaribagh Jail

45th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (d)

Jagat Narayan Lal was sent to Hazaribagh Jail during the freedom struggle. After the release of Jagat Narayan Lal on July 13, 1929, Rajendra Prasad addressed a meeting in Gulabg, Patna on July 14, 1929.

40. What was the common relationship between Katherine Mayo, Aldous Huxley, Charles Andrews and William Digby?

- (a) They wrote commentaries on the condition of India during the British rule
(b) They were supporters of the Indian National Movement
(c) They were opponents of the Indian National Movement
(d) They were friends of Mahatma Gandhi

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (a)

Katherine Mayo was an American researcher and historian known for her polemical book Mother India (1927). Aldous Huxley was an English writer and philosopher. Charles Freer Andrews was a social reformer in India. He was also one of the best friends of Mahatma Gandhi. William Digby (May 1, 1849 - September, 1904) was a British author and journalist. The common relationship between all of them is that they wrote commentaries on the condition of India during the British rule.

41. Match List-I with List-II :

- | List—I | List—II |
|------------------------------|--------------------------|
| A. Servants of India Society | 1. Debendranath Tagore |
| B. Tattwabodhini Sabha | 2. Gopal Krishna Gokhale |
| C. Atmiya Sabha | 3. Ram Mohan Roy |
| | 4. Keshab Chandra Sen |

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

- | | A | B | C |
|-----|---|---|---|
| (a) | 2 | 1 | 3 |
| (b) | 2 | 4 | 3 |
| (c) | 1 | 2 | 3 |
| (d) | 1 | 4 | 3 |

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (a)

Correct match is as follows :

Servants of India Society	—	Gopal Krishna Gokhale
Tattwabodhini Sabha	—	Debendranath Tagore
Atmiya Sabha	—	Raja Ram Mohan Roy

42. To establish global peace and cooperation among the peoples, which of the following concept introduced by the Jawaharlal Nehru?

- (a) Non-alignment (b) Panchsheel
(c) Peaceful coexistence (d) None of these.

46th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2004

Ans. (a)

The first Prime Minister, Jawaharlal Nehru, played a crucial role in setting the national agenda. He introduced the concept of Non-Alignment to establish peace and cooperation among people. The three major objectives of Nehru's foreign policy were to preserve the hard-earned sovereignty, protect territorial integrity and promote rapid economic development. Nehru wished to achieve these objectives through the strategy of Non-Alignment. The roots of Non-Alignment Movement (NAM) goes back to the friendship between three leaders – Yugoslavia's Josip Broz Tito, India's Jawaharlal Nehru, and Egypt's leader Gamal Abdel Nasser– who held a meeting in 1956. Indonesia's Sukarno and Ghana's Kwame Nkrumah strongly supported them. These five leaders came to be known as the five founders of NAM. The first non-aligned summit was held in Belgrade in 1961.

43. Which one of the following was not a dominant caste in Bihar during the pre-independent period?

- (a) Bhumihar (b) Rajputs
(c) Kayasthas (d) Kurmi

46th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2004

Ans. (d)

During the Pre-Independence period, in Bihar Bhumihar, Rajput and Kayasthas were the dominant castes while Kurmi caste was not a dominant caste.

44. Name the Deoband scholar who played a significant role in the freedom movement.

- (a) Abul Kalam Azad (b) Mohammad Ali Jinnah
(c) Badruddin Tyabji (d) Chirag Ali

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (a)

Abul Kalam Azad was the scholar related to Deoband. He Published Al-Nadwah magazine. He also served as the president of Congress between 1940 to 1946. 'India Wins Freedom' is his famous book.

45. Who organised the 'Khudai Khidmatgar' in 1929?

- (a) Abdul Gaffar Khan
(b) Ali Brothers
(c) Ansari Brothers
(d) Maulana Abul Kalam Azad
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (a)

Khan Abdul Gaffar Khan, also called Bacha Khan and Frontier Gandhi had organized a volunteer brigade 'Khudai Khidmatgar', popularly known as the 'Red Shirts' who were pledged to the freedom struggle and non-violence. This organization played an active role in the Civil Disobedience Movement.

46. Which of the following pairs is correct?

- (a) Vinoba Bhave - Second Individual Satyagrahi
(b) C.R. Das - Deshbandhu
(c) William Wedderburn - Congress President in 1907
(d) Shyamji Krishna Verma- Founder of India House in Paris
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (b)

Vinoba Bhave was 1st Individual Satyagrahi, Rasbehari Ghosh was president of Surat Session of Congress in 1907, whereas Shyamji Krishna Verma was founder of India House in London. Hence option (b) is correct as C.R. Das was popularly called as Deshbandhu.

47. When was the Punjab Land Alienation Act passed?

- (a) 1850 (b) 1895
(c) 1900 (d) 1905
(e) None of the above/ More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C. (Pre.) 2017

Ans. (c)

Punjab Land Alienation Act was passed in 1900 AD. It was introduced by British Raj to limit transfer of land ownership in Punjab province.

48. The Department of State was established under whose headship?

- (a) Mahatma Gandhi (b) J.L. Nehru
(c) G.B. Pant (d) Sardar Patel
(e) None of the above/ More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C. (Pre.) 2017

Ans. (d)

Department of State was formed in 1947. It replaced Political Department of British Government. Sardar Patel was made head of this department.

49. The objective of 'Antodaya' program is –

- (a) Development of minorities
(b) Advancement of Dalits
(c) To help the poorest of the poor
(d) Complete eradication of poverty

41st B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (c)

Antyodaya program aims to help the poorest of the poor. The idea of this program was first presented by Mahatma Gandhi. In this context, Gandhiji was influenced by John Ruskin's book Unto this Last.

50. Match correctly.

- | | |
|------------------|------------------|
| A. Bardoli | 1. Maharashtra |
| B. Chauri-Chaura | 2. Gujarat |
| C. Yarwada | 3. West Bengal |
| D. Noakhali | 4. Uttar Pradesh |

- | | | | | |
|-----|---|---|---|---|
| | A | B | C | D |
| (a) | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| (b) | 2 | 1 | 4 | 3 |
| (c) | 2 | 4 | 1 | 3 |
| (d) | 4 | 3 | 1 | 2 |

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (c)

Bardoli is situated in Gujarat. Chauri-Chaura is situated in Gorakhpur (Uttar Pradesh). Yerwada is located in Maharashtra and Noakhali is a place in West Bengal where gruesome riots happened during independence.

51. Who is considered as the creator of Modern Bihar?

- (a) Sachchidananda Sinha
(b) Kumar Kalika Prasad Sinha
(c) Sir Ganesh Singh
(d) Acharya Narendra Dev
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (a)

Sachchidananda Sinha (10 November 1871-6 March 1950) was an Indian lawyer parliamentarian & journalist. He was born in Arrah, the then Bengal Presidency (in present-day Bihar). He began a movement for a separate province of Bihar with a small group of people. It was realized in 1912 with the formation of the Bihar (carved out of Bengal presidency).

52. Religious Organisation established by Mother Teresa is called :

- (a) Sisters of Charity (b) Missionaries of Charity
(c) Organisation of love (d) Charity for all

38th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1992

Ans. (b)

The Religious organisation established by Mother Teresa is called "Missionaries of Charity".

53. Which organization of India has the motto, "Dharmo Rakshati Rakshitah (law protects when it is protected)"?

- (a) The Research and Analysis Wing
(b) The Indian Army
(c) The Indian Supreme Court
(d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

B.P.S.C. PRT 2023 Shift I

Ans. (a)

Dharmo Rakshathi Rakshitha is RAW's motto that translate to one who does not follow Dharm is destroyed and while the one who follows it is protected by dharma itself. After there were intelligence failures during the 1962 China-India war and the India-Pakistan war in 1965, RAW came into existence.

54. The Indian Nationalist leader who delivered lecture on Joseph Mazzini and the 'Young Italy' movement was

- (a) Subhas Chandra Bose (b) Surendranath Banerjee
(c) Jawaharlal Nehru (d) None of the above

BPSC Agriculture Department-2024

Ans. (b)

The Indian Nationalist leader who delivered lecture on Joseph Mazzini and the 'Young Italy' movement was Surendranath Banerjee.

55. Welby Commission (1895) was constituted on which of the following matters?

- (a) Education in India (b) Indian Expenditure
(c) Land Revenue (d) None of the above

BPSC Agriculture Department-2024

Ans. (b)

The Welby Commission was a group set up by the British Government to investigate wasteful spending in India. Established in 1895, its official name was the Royal Commission on the Administration of Expenditure of India.

56. How did World War I affect India's trade balance?

- (a) It had no significant impact on India's trade balance
- (b) It resulted in a deficit in trade due to decreased exports
- (c) It led to a surplus in trade due to increased exports
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

BPSC (Tre-3) {Class 6-8}–2024

Ans. (b)

The First World War affected India's import trade more than the export traffic. The cessation of trade with hostile countries and the dislocation of markets in Britain, France and Belgium caused an immediate decline in both imports and exports. The revival of exports from 1916 took place in the context of increasing government war time demand for jute bags, hides and skins for the manufacture of army boots and greatly benefited Indian exporters. Imports on the other hand lagged in their rate of recovery although after 1919, there was a veritable upsurge in imports as well.

57. Hitler's autobiography, which outlined his political ideology and future plans for Germany, is titled

- (a) The Communist Manifesto
- (b) Das Kapital
- (c) Mein Kampf
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

BPSC (Tre-3) {Class 6-8}–2024

Ans. (c)

Details of Hitler's rule and his policies can be learned from his autobiography, Mein Kampf, written in jail. The work describes the process by which Hitler became antisemitic and outlines his political ideology and future plans for Germany.

Magazines, Books and Their Authors

1. Who wrote the book, India Divided?

- (a) Rajendra Prasad
- (b) Maulana Abul Kalam Azad
- (c) Penderel Moon
- (d) Amba Prasad
- (e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2022

Ans. (a)

The author of the book "India Divided" is Dr. Rajendra Prasad, the former president of India. The first edition of this book was published in year 1946. Dr. Rajendra Prasad divided this book into six parts he primarily discusses various aspects of India's partition.

2. Match List-I with List-II :

List—I

- A. Charaka
- B. Brahmagupta
- C. Varahamihira
- D. Vishakhadatta

List—II

- 1. Mathematics
- 2. Medicine
- 3. Playwright
- 4. Astrology

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

	A	B	C	D
(a)	2	1	4	3
(b)	1	2	3	4
(c)	3	2	4	1
(d)	1	4	3	2

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (a)

Charaka was physician who is believed to have lived during the 1st–2nd Century CE, although exact date of birth and death is uncertain. Brahmagupta belonged to Gupta dynasty and was a renowned Astronomer and Mathematician. Varahamihira was an astrologer and Vishakhadatta was a playwright during Gupta dynasty.

3. Who was the author of the famous Allahabad Prasasti?

- (a) Kalidasa
- (b) Harisena
- (c) Ravikirti
- (d) Shudraka
- (e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2022

Ans. (b)

The author of the famous 'Allahabad Prasasti' was Harisena. Harisena presented a laudatory description of Samudragupta on the Ashoka Pillar in Allahabad known as the 'Prayaga Prashasti'. In this inscription the names of administrative officials under Samudragupta are also mentioned, including Sandhivigrahaka, Kumaramatyia and Mahadandanayaka, among other.

4. Who is the author of Ashtanga Hridayam, a famous book for Ayurveda?

- (a) Banabhatta
- (b) Vagbhata
- (c) Charaka
- (d) Dhanvantari
- (e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. Assistant Audit Officer 2022

Ans. (b)

Ashtanga Hridayam is a famous text of Ayurveda. It was written by Maharshi Vagbhata.

5. Which one of the following was a journal brought out by Abul Kalam Azad?

- (a) Zamindar (b) The Comrade
- (c) Al-Hilal (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

68th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (c)

The Al-Hilal was a newspaper brought out by Abul Kalam Azad. It was used as medium for criticising various oppressive policies of British Raj in India. The paper was shut down under the Press Act, in 1914.

6. Who started the journal 'Bahishkrit Bharat'?

- (a) Jyotiba Phule (b) Karsandas Mulji
- (c) Bal Gangadhar Tilak (d) Babasaheb Ambedkar
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (d)

The journal "Bahishkrit Bharat" was started by Bhimrao Ambedkar. He formed an organization called 'Bahishkrit Hitkarini Sabha' in Bombay in July, 1924.

7. Futuhat-i-Alamgiri was written by

- (a) Ishwardas Nagar (b) Bhimsen
- (c) Haridas (d) None of them

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (a)

The book Futuhat-i-Alamgiri was written by Ishwardas Nagar who was a Mughal Officer. This work contains some significant events of the reign of Aurangzeb.

8. Nitisara, an early book of politics, was written by

- (a) Kautilya (b) Kamandaka
- (c) Charaka (d) None of them

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (b)

Nitisara was written by Kamandaka. It refined the field of political thought in India and became one of the most influential works in the genre across South and Southeast Asia.

9. Which one of the following books was written by Tilak?

- (a) India in Transition
- (b) Gita Rahasya
- (c) Gokhale-My Political Guru
- (d) Discovery of India

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (b)

Lokmanya Bal Gangadhar Tilak wrote the book 'Gita Rahasya' in Mandalay jail.

10. Who was the author of the book, Mahatma Gandhi and Bihar : Some Reminiscences?

- (a) Syed Ali Zaheer
- (b) Dr. Rajendra Prasad
- (c) Jivatram Bhagwandas Kripalani
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

B.P.S.C. PRT 2023 Shift I

Ans. (b)

Dr. Rajendra Prasad was the author of Mahatma Gandhi and Bihar : Some Reminiscences. It was written in 1949.

11. Which one of the following statements is correct?

- (a) A Bunch of Old Letters was written by Dr. Rajendra Prasad.
- (b) Brahma Dutt was the second Satyagrahi in the Individual Satyagraha.
- (c) The Indian Struggle was written by Subhas Chandra Bose.
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

B.P.S.C. PRT 2023 Shift I

Ans. (c)

Subhash Chandra Bose is the author of the book 'The Indian Struggle 1920-1934'. 'A Bunch of old letters' was written by Jawahar Lal Nehru. Jawahar Lal Nehru was second Satyagrahi in the individual Satyagraha.

12. What was the name of the first book of Raja Ram Mohan Roy published in 1815?

- (a) Vedanta Grantha (b) Tuhfat-ul-Muwahhidin
- (c) Bharathi Vilasa (d) Shakuntalam
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2018

Ans. (a)

Raja Ram Mohan Roy, the founder of the Brahmo Samaj and was the great scholar and thinker .

Raja Ram Mohan Roy some Literary works are Tuhfat-ul-Muwahhidin (1804), vedanta Grantha (1815).

13. Who was the author of Indian Unrest?

- (a) Dadabhai Naoroji (b) Annie Besant
- (c) Lala Lajpat Rai (d) Valentine Chirol

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (d)

'Indian Unrest' was written by Valentine Chirol. He termed Bal Gangadhar Tilak as 'The father of the Indian Unrest.' As a result, Tilak sued him for defamation.

14. Match the names mentioned in column I with the names mentioned in column II and select the right answer using the codes given below :

Column I (Books)	Column II (Authors)
A. History of the Freedom Movement in India	1. Tara Chand
B. History of the Freedom Movement in Bihar	2. W.W. Hunter
C. Anand Math	3. Raja Ram Mohan Roy
D. Precepts of Jesus	4. Father Bulke
E. Our Indian Musalmans	5. K.K. Dutta
	6. Bankim Chandra Chatterjee

Code :

	A	B	C	D	E
(a)	1	4	6	3	2
(b)	2	4	3	2	1
(c)	1	5	6	3	2
(d)	None of these				

41st B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (d)

'History of the Freedom Movement in India' written by Tara Chand is the history of India's Freedom Struggle. 'Anand Math' based on Sanyasi Rebellion (1763-1800) was written by Bankimchandra Chatterjee. 'Precepts of Jesus' is the masterpiece of Raja Ram Mohan Roy. 'The Indian Musalmans' is the creation of W.W. Hunter and K.K. Dutta wrote 'History of the Freedom Movement in Bihar.'
Note: In the given question, W.W. Hunter's book has been named 'Our Indian Musalmans', which is wrong. The name of W.W. Hunter's book is 'The Indian Musalmans'.

15. Who has written the book 'Unhappy India'?

- (a) Bal Gangadhar Tilak (b) Annie Besant
 (c) Lala Lajpat Rai (d) A.O. Hume
 (e) None of the above/ More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (c)

Lala Lajpat Rai is the author of 'Unhappy India'. Bal Gangadhar Tilak edited 'Kesari' and 'Mahratta' and Annie Besant edited 'Commonweal' and 'New India'.

16. Who wrote the book, Poverty and un-British Rule in India?

- (a) R.C. Dutt (b) Dadabhai Naoroji

- (c) Bipin Chandra Pal (d) Lajpat Rai
 (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

64th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (b)

Dadabhai Naoroji wrote 'Poverty and Un-British Rule in India'.

17. Who had translated the Bengali play, Nil Darpan into English?

- (a) Dinabandhu Mitra
 (b) James Long
 (c) Antonio Gramsci
 (d) Michael Madhusudan Dutt
 (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2018

Ans. (d)

Nil Darpan was written by Dinabandhu Mitra. It was originally written in Bengali. It is also known as Indigo Planter Mirror. It was translated into English by Michael Madhusudan Datt.

18. Who wrote the book, India for Indians.

- (a) C. R. Das (b) M.G. Ranade
 (c) V. D. Savarkar (d) S.N. Banerjee
 (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (a)

Chittaranjan Das, popularly called Deshbandhu (5th November 1870- 16 June 1925) was an Indian leading Bengali politician, a prominent lawyer, an activist of the Indian National Movement & founder leader of the Swaraj Party during British occupation in India. He wrote the Book "India for Indians",.

19. The novel 'Durgesha Nandini' is written by :

- (a) Rabindranath Tagore
 (b) Taraknath Gangopadhyaya
 (c) Swarna Kumari
 (d) Bankim Chandra Chatterjee

43rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (d)

'Anand Math' is associated with the rise of the National movement in India. In 1865, Bankim Chandra Chatterjee wrote his first novel named 'Durgesh Nandini.' He wrote 'Vande Mataram' and later included it in Anand Math.

20. The author of 'Rajaniti Ratnakara' is –

- (a) Chandesvara (b) Vidyapati
 (c) Jyotiresvara (d) Haribrahmadeva
 (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (a)

The author of Rajaniti Ratnakara is Chandesvara. Kirtilata, Kirttipataka and Purusha Pariksha are the works of Vidyapati. Vidyapati is also known by the Sobriquet Maithi Kavi Kokil (the poet cuckoo of Maithili) and Abhinav Jaydev.

21. Who wrote the book, Desher Katha?

- (a) Sakharam Ganesh Deuskar
- (b) Rajendra Prasad
- (c) Nivaran Chandra
- (d) Murali Mohan Prasad
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (a)

Desher Katha was written by Sakharam Ganesh, published in 1904. It is a document of the screaming of the living Indian public in the chains of slavery and torture of exploitation in the British Empire.

Sakharam Ganesh Deuskar, thinker of the Indian Public awakening who had a wonderful confluence of localism and pan-Indianness in his thinking and writing. Born and raised in a Bengali environment but of Marathi origin, Deuskar acted as a bridge between the renaissance of Maharashtra and Bengal.

22. Who wrote 'Jhanda Geet'?

- (a) Rabindranath Tagore
- (b) Bankim Chandra Chatterjee
- (c) Maithili Sharan Gupta
- (d) Shyamlal Parshad

46th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (d)

'Jhanda Geet' (Vijayi Vishwa Tiranga Pyaara Jhanda Uncha Rahe Humara) was written by Shyamlal Parshad.

23. Who is the author of the book 'A Gallery of Rascals'?

- (a) Arundhati Roy
- (b) Ruskin Bond
- (c) Vikram Seth
- (d) Toni Morrison
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (b)

Ruskin Bond, (born 19 May 1934) is an Indian author of British descent. The Indian council for child Education has recognised his role in the growth of children's literature in India. He was awarded Sahitya Akademi Award in 1992 for our Trees still Grow in Dehra, has also Authored the Book 'A gallery of Rascals'.

24. The Book "Nineteen Eighty-Four" is written by

- (a) R.K. Narayan
- (b) Khushwant Singh
- (c) George Orwell
- (d) None of the above

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (c)

The book 'Nineteen Eighty-Four' was written by George Orwell.

Art and Culture

1. The temple of Deogarh near Jhansi and the sculptures in the temple at Garhwa near Allahabad are the important remains of the

- (a) Maurya art
- (b) Gupta art
- (c) Rashtrakuta art
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

68th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (b)

Dashavatar temple, Deogarh (Lalitpur) near Jhansi is a temple of Gupta period and is earliest known Panchayatan temple in North India.

Garhwa fort is temple complex in Shankargarh, Prayagraj belonging to Gupta period.

2. Pietra dura is related to which of the following?

- (a) Decorating the walls with floral designs made of semi-precious stones
- (b) Building sloping walls in Minars
- (c) Use of arch in construction
- (d) Use of marble in buildings
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (a)

Pietra dura called parchinkari in Indian subcontinent is an mosaic artwork that flourished in Florence Italy in the late 16th & 17th centuries. In this semi precious stone were cut into shapes are were made into mosaics. Resulting decorative mosaics were used primarily for tabletops & wall panels.

3. The Brihadisvara Temple at Thanjavur was constructed by which King?

- (a) Rajaraja I
- (b) Rajendra I
- (c) Rajendra II
- (d) Kulottunga I
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2018

Ans. (a)

The Brihadeshwara Temple at Thanjavur was built by Rajaraja I. It is a Hindu Temple dedicated to Lord Shiva. It is in the list of UNESCO World Heritage site. It is one of the largest temple in India and is an example of Dravidian architecture during the Chola period.

4. The mighty gateways found at the temples of South India are called -:

- (a) Shikhars
- (b) Gopurams
- (c) Devalayas
- (d) Mandaps
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C. (Pre.) 2017

Ans. (b)

The mighty gateways found at the temples of South India are called Gopurams. These gates usually ornate, show great craftsmanship of Dravidian architecture.

5. Various States and their popular dance styles are given as follows-

- | | |
|----------------------|------------|
| (A) Andhra Pradesh | 1. Bihu |
| (B) Assam | 2. Burra |
| (C) Himachal Pradesh | 3. Ghoomar |
| (D) Rajasthan | 4. Nati |

What will be the correct matching of state and dance?

Code :

- | | | | | |
|-----|---|---|---|---|
| | A | B | C | D |
| (a) | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| (b) | 2 | 1 | 3 | 4 |
| (c) | 2 | 1 | 4 | 3 |
| (d) | 2 | 4 | 3 | 1 |

38th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1992

Ans. (c)

The correctly matched states with their popular dance styles is as follows –

- | | | |
|------------------|---|---------|
| Andhra Pradesh | - | Burra |
| Assam | - | Bihu |
| Himachal Pradesh | - | Nati |
| Rajasthan | - | Ghoomar |

6. Paper came to be used in India in the -:

- (a) 12th century (b) 13th century
(c) 14th century (d) 15th century
(e) None of the above/ More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C. (Pre.) 2017

Ans. (e)

Paper technology likely arrived in India from China through Tibet and Nepal around the Mid-7th century, when Buddhist monks freely travelled. According to Irfan Habib, it is reasonable to presume that paper manufacturing reached Sindh before 11th century. However Aayog has accepted (a) as the correct option.

7. Which one of the following pair is wrong?

- (a) Bhimsen Joshi - Classical Vocal Music
(b) Alla Rakha Khan - Tabla
(c) Debu Chaudhari - Sitar
(d) M.S. Subbalakshmi - Flute

38th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1992

Ans. (d)

M.S. Subbalakshmi was a famous classical singer, who was also awarded the most prestigious award of India, Bharat Ratna in the year 1998. Other pairs are correctly matched.

Award

1. Which award is given for excellence in sports?

- (a) Jamnalal Bajaj Award (b) Arjuna Award
(c) Tagore Award (d) Moortidevi Award

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (b)

Arjuna Award is given for excellence in sports. Jamnalal Bajaj Award is an Indian Award for promoting Gandhian values, social work and social development. The Tagore Award is an award given in commemoration of the 150th birth anniversary of the Nobel Laureate Rabindranath Tagore (1861–1941) for cultural harmony. The Moortidevi Award is an annual literary award in India presented by the Bharatiya Jnanpith organization for work which emphasizes Indian philosophy and culture.

2. Which of the following foreigner citizen has been awarded 'Bharat Ratna'?

- (a) Nelson Mandela (b) Bill Clinton
(c) Adolf Hitler (d) Boris Yeltsin

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (a)

Nelson Mandela was awarded 'Bharat Ratna' in 1990 for his incredible work in the abolishment of apartheid in South Africa. His movement was based on Gandhian values.

3. Which one of the following is correctly matched?

- (a) Sachchidananda Sinha–Indian People
(b) S. A. Dange–Navayug
(c) Mohammad Ali–Comrade
(d) Dr. Rajendra Prasad–India Divided
(e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. Auditor 2021

Ans. (b)

Sripad Amrut Dange was not associated with Navayuga. He was associated with newspaper "The Socialist". Rest are correctly matched.

4. Who among the following journalists is the recipient 'Magsasey' Award?

- (a) Khushwant Singh (b) Arun Shorie
(c) Dharmavir Bharti (d) Kamleshwar

38th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1992

Ans. (b)

The famous Indian journalist Arun Shourie was awarded 'Magsaysay Award' in 1982.

Indian Polity and Governance

The Constitutional Development of India

1. The first Session of Constituent Assembly was held on :

- (a) 9th December, 1946 (b) 15th August, 1947
(c) 26th November, 1949 (d) 26th January, 1946
(e) None of the above / More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre) (Re- Exam), 2020

Ans. (a)

The Indian Constituent Assembly was established with the commencement of its first meeting on December 9, 1946.

2. Indian Constitution was adopted by the Constituent Assembly on -

- (a) 26 November, 1949 (b) 15 August, 1949
(c) 2 October, 1949 (d) 15 November, 1949

43rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1990

Ans. (a)

The Preamble of the Constitution states, "We the People of India enact, adopt and give to ourselves this Constitution on 26 November, 1949". This date is considered as the date of adoption, completion and passing of the Constitution. On the same day the provisions relating to Citizenship, elections, provisional parliament, temporary and transitional provisions were given immediate effect. Rest of the provisions came into effect on 26 January, 1950. Thus 26 January, 1950 is considered as commencement date of the Constitution.

3. January 26 was selected as the date for the inauguration of the Constitution, because-

- (a) The Congress had observed it as the Independence Day in 1930.
(b) On that day the Quit India Movement was started in 1942.
(c) It was considered to be an auspicious day.
(d) None of the above.

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (a)

The Purna Swaraj declaration was promulgated by the Indian National Congress in Lahore Session (1929) where Congress asked people of India to observe 26 January as Independence

Day. After that Congress had regularly observed 26 January as the Independence Day of India. The new Constitution of India, as drafted and approved by the Constituent Assembly of India, was mandated to come into effect from 26 January 1950, to commemorate the 1929 declaration.

4. Who of the following was the Chairman of the 'Provincial Constitution Committee' of the Constituent Assembly of India?

- (a) Sardar Vallabh Bhai Patel
(b) Rajendra Prasad
(c) K. M. Munshi
(d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

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Ans. (a)

The Provincial Constitution Committee held its first meeting on 5 May 1947, during which Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel was unanimously elected as Chairman. However, by the time the Committee met again on 6 June, partition had been announced.

5. Who was the Labour Minister in Jawaharlal Nehru's Provisional Government?

- (a) Aruna Asaf Ali (b) C. Rajagopalachari
(c) Jagjivan Ram (d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

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Ans. (c)

In 1946 Jagjivan Ram the Minister in Jawaharlal Nehru interim government, the first Cabinet of India as a Labour Minister and also a member of the Constituent Assembly of India, where he ensured that social justice was enshrined in the constitution.

6. Indian Constitution was adopted by -

- (a) Constituent Assembly (b) British Parliament
(c) Governor-General (d) Indian Parliament

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (a)

The Constitution of India was officially adopted on the 26th of November, 1949 and signed by the members of the Constituent Assembly on 24th of January, 1950.

7. Constitution Day of India is celebrated on

- (a) 26th October
- (b) 26th November
- (c) 26th January
- (d) 15th August
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (b)

The Constitution Day of India is celebrated on 26th November since the Constitution of India was adopted by the Constituent Assembly on 26th November, 1949 and signed by the then President Rajendra Prasad. Some of the provisions of the Constitution came into force at once while the remaining provisions of the Constitution came into force on 26th January, 1950, the commencement date of the Constitution.

8. Who was the President of the Indian National Congress at the time of partition of India?

- (a) J.B. Kripalani
- (b) Jawaharlal Nehru
- (c) Maulana Abul Kalam Azad
- (d) C. Rajagopalachari
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (a)

J.B. Kripalani was the President of the Indian National Congress at the time of Partition of India.

9. In Indian political system which one is supreme?

- (a) The Supreme Court
- (b) The Constitution
- (c) The Parliament
- (d) Religion

45th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (b)

The Constitution is supreme in the Indian political system. The Constitution of India is the supreme law of India. It lays down the framework defining fundamental political principles, establishes the structure, procedures, powers and duties of Government institutions and sets out fundamental rights, directive principles and the duties of the citizens.

10. Which of the following statements is true?

- (a) The Federal form of Government is in United States of America.
- (b) The government of India is federal and unitary both.
- (c) The government of France is of federal form.
- (d) The Prime Minister of Pakistan is appointed by the people.

38th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1992

Ans. (a)

The United States is a federal constitutional republic, which consists of 50 States, while India is a Union of 28 States and 8 Union Territories. Article 1 of the Indian Constitution declares it as the Union of States. A federal government is one in which there is division of powers between the central government and state governments by the Constitution itself and both operate in their respective jurisdictions independently. Some of the Constitution experts state the Indian Constitution has unitary nature because at the time of emergency it provides a strong center, but the reality is that the Indian Constitution is of federal nature having some unitary features.

11. Which of the following may be called the effect of Russian Revolution in India?

- (a) The Publication of book 'Red Revolution' by R. S. Avasthi in 1920-21
- (b) The visit of Russia by Jawaharlal Nehru and Rabindranath Tagore
- (c) The formation of communist Party in India in mid-1920s
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

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Ans. (d)

The Russian Revolution of 1917 had a significant impact on the Indian independence movement. The formation of the Communist Party of India in the mid-1920s was one of the direct effects, as the revolutionary ideas and principles of communism inspired many Indian nationalists.

By the mid-1920s the Communist Party was formed in India. Its members kept in touch with the Soviet Communist Party. Important Indian political and cultural figures took an interest in the Soviet experiment and visited Russia, among them Jawaharlal Nehru and Rabindranath Tagore, who wrote about Soviet Socialism. In India, writings gave impressions of Soviet Russia.

In Hindi, R.S. Avasthi wrote in 1920-21 Russian Revolution, Lenin, His Life and His Thoughts, and later The Red Revolution. S.D. Vidyalkar wrote The Rebirth of Russia and The Soviet State of Russia. There was much that was written in Bengali, Marathi, Malayalam, Tamil and Telugu.

12. In which of the following periods mainly the new type of political consciousness grew during British rule in India?

- (a) During the first half period of 20th Century
- (b) During the second half period of 19th Century
- (c) During the first half period of 19th Century